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7000: God's people

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7010: The church as the people of God

- 7020: church, the
- 7030: unity

7020: church, the

The community of faithful believers, of whom Jesus Christ is the head, called out from the world to serve God down the ages. Scripture emphasises that the church is the body of Christ whose members are intended to be filled with the Holy Spirit. Scriptural understanding of the church is corporate, rather than solitary or individual.

7021: church, OT anticipations of

As the people of God, the Christian church is continuous with Israel. The OT provides important anticipations of the church.

OT terms for the people of God

The descendants of Abraham

2CH 20:7; ; ISA 41:8–41:9; ; ROM 4:16; ; GAL 3:7 “children of Abraham” in the NT refers to those who, like Abraham, put their faith in God

The saints

The term for saints “means set apart for God”, “made holy”, and is the most frequently used NT term for Christians: 1SA 2:9; ; 2CH 6:41 parallel PSA 132:9; ; PSA 16:3, PSA 31:23; ; DAN 7:18

The assembly

assembly “means a community gathered together in response to God’s call to serve and worship him”. Its NT equivalents include the synagogue and the church: PSA 1:5, PSA 107:32, PSA 149:1

The scope of the OT people of God

Israel as God's people

EXO 6:7 See also EXO 19:5–19:6; LEV 26:12; JER 30:22; EZK 36:28; HOS 2:23

Not all Israelites are God's people

ROM 9:6–9:7 Even within Israel there are believers and unbelievers. See also EZR 9:8 Those Israelites who

believed were sometimes called “a remnant”; ISA 1:9, ISA 11:11, ISA 11:16; JER 23:3; EZK 14:22; MIC 2:12

God's people included non-Israelites

ISA 2:2–2:3 parallel MIC 4:1–4:2 See also EXO 12:38, EXO 12:48–12:49; DEU 31:12; RUT 4:10–4:11

The formation of the OT people of God

God's people are formed through God's promises

GEN 12:2 See also GEN 15:5, GEN 17:5–17:6, GEN 22:17–22:18; EXO 1:7

God's people are chosen and called

DEU 7:6 See also 1CH 16:13 parallel PSA 105:6; PSA 33:12; EZK 20:5

God's people have been redeemed

DEU 5:6 parallel EXO 20:2 See also EXO 6:6, EXO 19:4; EZK 20:6

God formed a covenant with his people

EXO 24:8 See also EXO 19:5, EXO 34:10, EXO 34:27; DEU 4:13; JDG 2:1; JER 31:31

OT images of the people of God

As God's bride

JER 2:2 This OT image is taken up in the many references to Jesus Christ as the bridegroom and the church as his bride. See also ISA 62:5; HOS 2:16, HOS 2:19–2:20; EPH 5:25–5:27; REV 21:2

As God's vine

ISA 5:1–5:7 PSA 80:8; ; JER 2:21; ; EZK 17:5–17:6, EZK 19:10; ; HOS 10:1

As God's flock

PSA 95:7 See also PSA 74:1, PSA 77:20, PSA 100:3; ISA 40:11; ZEC 9:16; MAT 26:31; ZEC 13:7; LUK 12:32; JHN 10:16 ACT 20:28–20:29; 1PE 5:2–5:3

As God's inheritance

DEU 4:20 See also PSA 28:9, PSA 33:12; ISA 19:25; MAL 3:17

As God's family

AMO 3:1–3:2 See also EXO 4:22–4:23 Israel was sometimes called God's “firstborn son” as well as his children; DEU 1:31, DEU 32:6; PSA 103:13; ISA 1:2, ISA 30:9; HOS 11:1; MAL 2:10

Requirements of the people of God

To obey God's word

DEU 5:1 See also EXO 24:3; DEU 6:1–6:3, DEU 13:4; JOS 1:7; 1SA 15:22

To remember their redemption

DEU 5:15 See also DEU 7:18, DEU 15:15, DEU 16:12; PSA 105:5

To commemorate their redemption

EXO 12:25–12:27 The focus of Israel's commemoration of their redemption was the Passover, which is one of the ceremonies lying behind the Lord's Supper. See also NUM 9:2–9:3; DEU 16:1; LUK 22:14–22:20

To love God wholeheartedly

DEU 6:5 See also DEU 10:12, DEU 11:1, DEU 19:9; JOS 23:11

The marks of the people of God**Circumcision as a mark of God's people**

GEN 17:10–17:14; ; LEV 12:3; DEU 10:16, DEU 30:6; ; JER 4:4; ; ROM 2:27; ; COL 2:11

The presence of God

EXO 25:8, EXO 33:15–33:16, EXO 40:35; ; NUM 10:33–10:36; ; 2CH 5:14

7022: church, and Jesus Christ

See [2212: Jesus Christ, head of the church](#)

7023: church, and Holy Spirit

See [3275: Holy Spirit, in the church](#)

7024: church, nature and foundations of

The church is the people called by God, who are united by their faith in Christ and by their common life in him. Various descriptions and metaphors emphasise the continuity between the people of God in the OT and NT.

NT images of the church**The body of Christ**

ROM 12:4–12:5 See also 1CO 12:12, 1CO 12:27; EPH 3:6, EPH 5:23; COL 1:18, COL 1:24, COL 2:19, COL 3:15

God's building or temple

1CO 3:16–3:17 See also 1CO 3:10; 2CO 6:16; EPH 2:21–2:22; HEB 3:6, HEB 10:21; 1PE 2:5

A plant or vine

JHN 15:1–15:8 See also ROM 11:17–11:24; 1CO 3:6–3:8

Jesus Christ's flock

JHN 10:14–10:16 See also MAT 25:33; LUK 12:32; ACT 20:28–20:29; 1PE 5:2–5:4

The bride of Christ

REV 21:2 See also EPH 5:25–5:27, EPH 5:31–5:32; REV 19:7, REV 22:17

God's household or family

EPH 2:19 See also JHN 8:35–8:36; GAL 6:10; EPH 3:15; 1TI 3:15; HEB 2:11; 1PE 2:17, 1PE 4:17

NT descriptions of the church**Emphasising continuity with the OT church**

Abraham's offspring: ROM 4:16; ; GAL 3:7, GAL 3:29; ROM 9:25; ; 2CO 6:16; ; HEB 13:12; ; 1PE 2:9–2:10; GAL 4:26; ; HEB 12:22; ; REV 3:12, REV 21:2, REV 21:9–21:10; GAL 6:16 the Israel of God

Emphasising God's call and authority in the church

Sons of God: MAT 5:9; ; JHN 1:12; ; ROM 8:15–8:16; ; 2CO 6:18; ; GAL 3:26, GAL 4:5–4:6; ; 1JN 3:10; MAT 24:22; ; ROM 11:7; ; 2TI 2:10; ; 1PE 1:1; ROM 8:17; ; GAL 3:29, GAL 4:7; ; TIT 3:7; ; HEB 1:14, HEB 6:17; ; 1PE 1:4; 1PE 2:5, 1PE 2:9; ; REV 1:6, REV 5:10, REV 20:6

Descriptions applied to the church by outsiders

Followers of the Way: ACT 9:2, ACT 19:9, ACT 19:23, ACT 22:4, ACT 24:14; ACT 11:26 Christians; ; ACT 24:5 “the Nazarene sect” means people belonging to Jesus the “Nazarene” (Mt 2:23)

Descriptions used by Christians

The believers. All these titles are seldom in the singular, emphasising the corporateness of Christian life: ACT 1:15, ACT 2:44, ACT 5:12; ; GAL 6:10; ; 1TI 4:12; ; 1PE 2:17; ACT 6:1–6:2, ACT 9:19, ACT 11:26, ACT 14:22, ACT 20:1; ROM 1:7, ROM 15:25; ; 1CO 6:1, 1CO 14:33; ; EPH 1:1; ; PHP 4:21; ; COL 1:12; ; JUD 1:3

Other NT descriptions of the church

1TI 3:15 the pillar and foundation of the truth; ; HEB 12:23 The church of the firstborn. “the firstborn” is plural, referring to Christians as those born again through their union with Christ, who is the firstborn.

The foundation of the church**Jesus Christ as the church's foundation-stone**

1CO 3:11 See also MAT 7:24–7:25, MAT 21:42 parallels MRK 12:10, LUK 20:17; ACT 4:11; EPH 2:20; 1PE 2:6; ISA 28:16; 1PE 2:7; PSA 118:22

Apostles and prophets as founders of the church

EPH 2:19–2:20 See also MAT 16:18–16:19; REV 21:14

The church as God's people**A people chosen by God**

1PE 2:9 See also JHN 15:16; ROM 8:33; EPH 1:4; COL 3:12; 2TH 2:13; JAS 2:5; 1PE 1:2

A people called by God

ROM 1:6 See also ACT 2:39; 1CO 1:2, 1CO 1:9; GAL 1:6; 2TH 2:14; 2TI 1:9; JUD 1:1

A people loved by God

1PE 2:10 See also EPH 2:1–2:5; TIT 3:4–3:7

God's covenant people

HEB 8:8–8:10 See also ROM 11:27; ISA 59:20–59:21; HEB 10:16; JER 31:31–31:33

7025: church, unity and fellowship of

The church is one in essence, because it is founded on one gospel, united to one Lord and indwelt by one Spirit. Its unity is under constant threat because of the tendency to division that is inherent in fallen humanity, and needs to be continually maintained and actively expressed in fellowship.

The unity of the church**The church is one**

ROM 12:5 See also 1CO 12:12, 1CO 12:20; EPH 4:25

The church transcends all barriers

COL 3:11 See also JHN 10:16; ACT 10:28–10:29, ACT 10:47, ACT 15:8–15:9; GAL 3:28; EPH 2:14–2:16, EPH 3:6 The great divide threatening the first Christians was between Jew and Gentile, but the church was able to unite the two into one body in Christ.

The church's unity reflects the unity within the Trinity

EPH 4:4–4:6 The unity of the church is built around the persons of the Trinity: one Spirit, one Lord, one Father. See also JHN 17:11; ROM 3:29–3:30, ROM 10:12–10:13; GAL 3:27–3:28

The church's unity is the work of the Trinity

EPH 2:16–2:18 See also JHN 11:52; ACT 10:45–10:47; 1CO 12:13; EPH 2:22, EPH 4:3

The purpose of the church's unity**To lead others to faith**

JHN 17:23 See also JHN 17:21

To lead believers to maturity

EPH 4:13

The nature of the church's unity

PHP 2:1–2:2 Emphasis is placed on an inner unity of mind and spirit rather than external uniformity. See also 2CO 13:11; PHP 1:27; COL 2:2

Appeals for unity in the church

EPH 4:3 See also ROM 12:10, ROM 15:5, ROM 15:7; 1CO 12:25; COL 3:14; 1PE 3:8

The church's unity is expressed in fellowship**Fellowship with God**

1CO 1:9 See also 2CO 13:14; PHP 2:1; 2PE 1:4; 1JN 1:3, 1JN 1:6–1:7

Fellowship expressed by meeting together

ACT 2:46 See also ACT 2:1, ACT 2:42, ACT 5:12, ACT 6:2; 1CO 14:26; HEB 10:25

Fellowship expressed through sharing resources

ACT 2:44–2:45 See also ACT 4:32, ACT 4:34–4:37, ACT 11:27–11:30; ROM 15:26; 1CO 16:1–16:2; 2CO 8:2–8:5, 2CO 8:13–8:14, 2CO 9:13; PHP 4:14–4:18

Fellowship through suffering

REV 1:9 See also ROM 8:17; 2CO 1:7; PHP 3:10, PHP 4:14; HEB 10:33–10:34, HEB 13:3

Fellowship through shared spiritual blessings

1CO 9:23 See also ROM 11:17; PHP 1:7; 2TH 2:14; 1PE 5:1; JUD 1:3

Specific actions which express fellowship and unity in the church**Sharing in the Lord's Supper**

1CO 10:16–10:17 See also ACT 2:46, ACT 20:7; 1CO 11:33

Baptism as an expression of unity

EPH 4:4–4:6 See also 1CO 12:13

Extending hospitality

ACT 28:7; ; ROM 12:13, ROM 16:23; ; 1TI 5:10; ; TIT 1:8; ; 1PE 4:9; ; 3JN 1:8

Greeting one another

ACT 18:27; ; ROM 16:3–16:16; ; 1CO 16:19–16:20; ; COL 4:10; ; PHM 1:17

Welcoming former opponents

ACT 9:26–9:27; ; GAL 2:9; ; 2CO 2:5–2:8

Divisions in the church**Causes of division in the NT church**

Personal ambition: MRK 9:34, MRK 10:35–10:41 parallel MAT 20:20–20:24; ACT 6:1; ACT 15:37–15:40; ; PHP 4:2; ROM 16:17; ; JUD 1:19; 1CO 1:11–1:12, 1CO 3:3–3:4; 1CO 6:1–6:6 litigation and disputes; 1CO 11:18, 1CO 11:20–11:21; ; JAS 4:1–4:3

Warnings against divisions in the church

1CO 1:10 See also ROM 12:16, ROM 16:17; 2CO 12:20; EPH 4:31; JAS 4:11

Acceptable differences in the church

In secondary matters of conscience, Christians are to respect rather than judge each other. These things need not impair the essential unity that is in Christ: ROM 14:1–14:3, ROM 14:5–14:6; ; 1CO 8:9–8:13; 1CO 12:4–12:6, 1CO 12:14–12:25; ; GAL 2:7

Necessary divisions in the church

Between the true gospel and heretical alternatives: 2CO 11:2–11:6, 2CO 11:13–11:15; ; GAL 1:6–1:9; ; COL 2:8, COL

2:16–2:19; ; 1TI 4:1–4:6; ; 1JN 2:18–2:19; ; 2JN 1:9–1:11; ; JUD 1:18–1:20; 1CO 5:9–5:10; ; 2TH 3:6; ; 1TI 6:3–6:5; ; 2TI 3:2–3:9; ; 2PE 1:20–1:21, 2PE 2:1–2:3; ; REV 2:20, REV 2:24, REV 3:1, REV 3:4; ACT 15:2, ACT 15:5–15:6, ACT 15:19; ; GAL 2:11

7026: church, leadership of

Jesus Christ is the absolute head of the church. He sets leaders in the church to enable the whole church to grow into maturity. Christ's authority in the church is acknowledged more by the church's obedience to God than through any particular form of government.

Jesus Christ alone is head of the church

COL 1:18 See also MAT 23:8–23:10; EPH 1:22, EPH 4:15, EPH 5:23; COL 2:19; HEB 3:3

The Holy Spirit directs the church

ACT 13:2 See also ACT 15:28, ACT 16:6–16:7, ACT 20:28; ROM 8:14; 1CO 12:11; REV 2:7, REV 2:11

The appointment of leaders in the church

God calls and equips leaders

EPH 4:11 See also MAT 16:18; ACT 1:24–1:26, ACT 9:15–9:16, ACT 20:28, ACT 26:16–26:18; 1CO 12:28; GAL 1:15–1:17

Delegated leadership

ACT 6:3–6:6, ACT 14:23; ; TIT 1:5

The appointment of apostles

MRK 3:13–3:19 parallels MAT 10:1–10:4, LUK 6:12–6:16 1CO 9:1–9:2; ; 2CO 3:3; ; EPH 2:20; ; REV 21:14; ACT 2:42, ACT 15:6, ACT 15:22–15:23; ; 1TH 2:6; ; 2PE 3:2; ; JUD 1:17

Prophets as leaders

ACT 15:32 Judas and Silas were leaders in the Jerusalem church (Ac 15:22). See also ACT 11:27–11:30, ACT 13:1–13:2; ROM 12:6 The role of prophets as leaders is distinct from the gift of prophecy, which was in principle available to all; 1CO 12:28, 1CO 14:29–14:30; EPH 3:5

Evangelists as leaders

ACT 21:8 See also EPH 4:11; 2TI 4:5

Pastors and teachers as leaders

ACT 20:28 See also JHN 21:15–21:17; ACT 13:1; ROM 12:7; 1CO 12:28; 1TI 3:2; TIT 1:9; JAS 3:1; 1PE 5:2 Pastors are also called “shepherds”.

Elders as leaders

1TI 3:1 “Elder” and “overseer” or “bishop” are more or less interchangeable. See also ACT 11:30, ACT 14:23, ACT 15:2, ACT 15:22, ACT 20:17; 1TI 5:17; TIT 1:5; JAS 5:14; 2JN 1:1

Deacons as leaders

PHP 1:1 “Deacon” means “one who serves”. See also ACT 6:5–6:6; 1TI 3:8

Qualifications for church leadership

The first apostles were witnesses of Jesus Christ's life and resurrection: ACT 1:21–1:22, ACT 10:41; ; 1CO 9:1–9:2, 1CO 15:7–15:8; ; 2PE 1:16; ACT 6:3; ; 1TI 3:1–3:12, 1TI 5:17; ; TIT 1:6–1:9; ; 1PE 5:1–5:4

Responsibilities of church leaders

To preach the gospel

ROM 1:15; ; 1CO 1:17; ; GAL 2:8; ; EPH 3:8; ; 1TI 2:7

To teach sound doctrine

1TI 4:6, 1TI 4:13, 1TI 5:17; ; HEB 13:7

To give direction in church life

ACT 15:2, ACT 15:6, ACT 15:22–15:23, ACT 16:4, ACT 20:28–20:31; ; 1TI 5:17; ; 1PE 5:2

To be an example in loving service

MAT 20:26–20:28 parallel MRK 10:43–10:45; ; MRK 9:35; ; JHN 13:13–13:15; ; HEB 13:7; ; 1PE 5:3

To train and appoint other leaders

ACT 14:23; ; 1TI 4:14; ; 2TI 2:2; ; TIT 1:5

To pray for the sick

JAS 5:14

To exercise discipline in the church

2CO 13:10; ; 1TH 5:12; ; 1TI 1:20, 1TI 5:20; ; TIT 3:10; ; 3JN 1:10

The church's responsibilities to its leaders

To respect and submit to its leaders

ACT 16:4; ; 1TH 5:12–5:13; ; 1TI 5:19; ; HEB 13:17

To pray for its leaders

EPH 6:19; ; 1TH 5:25

To support its leaders financially

1CO 9:7–9:14; ; PHP 4:15–4:19; ; 1TI 5:17–5:18

The corporate government of the church

In choosing leaders

ACT 6:3–6:6

In implementing decisions

ACT 15:22–15:29

In building up the church

ROM 12:4–12:8; ; 1CO 12:4–12:12, 1CO 12:27; ; EPH 4:3, EPH 4:7–4:16; ; 1PE 4:10–4:11

In discerning true and false teachings

1JN 4:1–4:3; ; 2JN 1:10; ; REV 2:2

In exercising discipline

MAT 18:15–18:20; ; 1CO 5:4–5:5; ; 2CO 2:6–2:8; ; 2TH 3:14–3:15

The structure of the church**The pattern of church life**

ACT 2:42 See also ACT 2:46, ACT 5:42

The house church

ACT 1:13–1:14, ACT 12:12, ACT 16:40; ; ROM 16:5; ; 1CO 16:19; ; COL 4:15; ; PHM 1:2

The local church

ACT 13:1; ; ROM 16:1; ; 1CO 1:2 It is unknown whether there were subdivisions of the church in towns such as Corinth; ; 1TH 1:1

Churches in a region

ACT 9:31, ACT 15:41; ; 1CO 16:1; ; 2CO 8:1; ; GAL 1:2, GAL 1:22; ; REV 1:4 Normally the NT speaks of “churches” in an area rather than of a unified regional structure.

The universal church

MAT 16:18 1CO 12:28; ; EPH 1:22, EPH 3:10, EPH 5:25

7027: church, purpose and mission of

The church is called to praise and glorify God, to establish Jesus Christ’s kingdom, and to proclaim the gospel throughout the world.

God’s purposes for the church**To praise God**

1PE 2:9 See also EPH 1:5–1:6, EPH 1:11–1:12, EPH 1:14; HEB 13:15; 1PE 2:5

To share God’s glory

ROM 8:29–8:30 See also MAT 13:43; JHN 17:24; ROM 9:23; 1CO 2:7; PHP 3:21; COL 3:4; 2TH 2:14; REV 2:26–2:27, REV 3:4–3:5, REV 3:21

God will build his church

MAT 16:18–16:19 See also MAT 27:40 parallel MRK 15:29; JHN 2:19–2:22; 1CO 3:9; EPH 2:21–2:22, EPH 4:11–4:13; HEB 3:3–3:6; 1PE 2:5

To challenge Satan’s dominion

EPH 3:10–3:11 “rulers and authorities in the heavenly realms” refers to the powers of evil. See also MAT 16:18; EPH 6:12; 1JN 2:14

To go into the world in mission

2CO 5:18 See also MAT 5:13–5:16, MAT 28:19–28:20; MRK 16:15; LUK 24:48; JHN 20:21; ACT 1:8; PHP 2:15–2:16; COL 1:27

The church’s mission**To preach the gospel to the world**

MRK 13:10 parallel MAT 24:14 See also MAT 28:19; LUK 24:47; JHN 10:16; ACT 13:47

To do good to all

GAL 6:10 See also MAT 25:37–25:40; LUK 6:35; ACT 9:36; EPH 2:10; 1TI 6:18; JAS 1:27; 1PE 2:12

Images of the church’s mission

MAT 5:13–5:16; JHN 15:5–15:8 MAT 7:18–7:19; ; ROM 7:4; ; EPH 5:9–5:10; ; PHP 1:11; ; COL 1:6, COL 1:10; ; JAS 3:17; MRK 9:50; ; LUK 14:34–14:35; ROM 13:12–13:14; ; EPH 5:8; ; PHP 2:15; ; 1TH 5:5–5:6

The growth of the church**Numerical growth among the first Christians**

ACT 11:21 See also ACT 2:41, ACT 2:47, ACT 4:4, ACT 5:14, ACT 6:1, ACT 6:7, ACT 9:31, ACT 9:42, ACT 11:24, ACT 12:24, ACT 13:49, ACT 16:5, ACT 17:4, ACT 18:8, ACT 19:20

The church is to grow to maturity

EPH 4:12–4:13 See also PHP 1:6, PHP 3:13–3:15; 2TH 1:3

Aspects of growth

Growth in character: 2CO 9:10; ; 1TH 3:12; EPH 4:15; ; COL 1:10; ; 2PE 3:18; HEB 6:1 growth in understanding

Prayers for the growth of the church

EPH 3:14–3:19 See also EPH 1:17–1:19; PHP 1:9–1:11; COL 1:9–1:12; 1TH 3:11–3:13; 2TH 1:11–1:12

Visions of the church’s final destiny

REV 7:9–7:10 John’s vision of the church in glory. See also MAT 24:31; JHN 10:16; EPH 1:10; 1TH 4:16–4:17; HEB 12:22–12:23; REV 21:2

7028: church, life of

The church lives its life in union with Christ and in the power of the Holy Spirit. It is called to mutual love, holy living, and to worship.

The church lives its life in union with Christ**The church lives in Christ and Christ lives in the church**

1CO 1:30 See also MAT 18:20; JHN 15:5, JHN 17:21; 1CO 8:6; GAL 2:20; COL 1:27, COL 2:6; 1JN 4:13

Believers are united with Christ in baptism

GAL 3:27 See also ACT 2:38, ACT 19:5; ROM 6:3–6:4; COL 2:12

The church lives its life in the power of the Holy Spirit

The church lives in the Spirit, and the Spirit lives in the church

ROM 8:9–8:11 The indwelling Spirit is identified with the presence of Jesus Christ. See also 1CO 3:16; GAL 5:16, GAL 5:25; EPH 2:22; 2TI 1:14; 1JN 2:27

The Spirit is given to the church

ACT 1:4–1:5 See also JHN 20:22; ACT 2:4, ACT 15:8; ROM 7:6, ROM 15:16; 1CO 6:11; GAL 3:3; 1PE 1:1–1:2

The Spirit seals the church

EPH 1:13 See also 2CO 1:22, 2CO 5:5; EPH 4:30

The Spirit guides the church

REV 2:7 See also ACT 8:29, ACT 10:19, ACT 11:12, ACT 13:2, ACT 20:23, ACT 21:4

The Spirit teaches the church

1CO 2:13 See also JHN 16:13; EPH 1:17

The Spirit sanctifies the church

ROM 15:16 See also 1CO 6:11; 2TH 2:13; 1PE 1:2

The Spirit endows the church with gifts

1CO 12:7 See also ROM 12:6–12:8; 1CO 12:8–12:11, 1CO 12:28; EPH 4:11

The church as a fellowship

As a fellowship of mutual love

1TH 5:11 See also ROM 15:2; 1CO 14:12; GAL 6:10; 1TH 4:18; HEB 10:25

As a fellowship of ordinary people

1CO 1:26–1:27 See also LUK 6:20; JAS 2:5

The distinctiveness of the church

The church as a chosen people

1PE 2:9 See also EPH 1:4; COL 3:12

The church as a holy people

HEB 12:14 See also ROM 11:16, ROM 15:16; 1CO 1:2; EPH 2:21, EPH 5:3; 1TH 3:13; HEB 2:11; 1PE 1:15–1:16; 2PE 3:11

The church as a people set apart

2CO 7:1 The repeated call to be separate from evil is the practical outworking of the church's sanctification. See also 1CO 5:9–5:12; 2CO 6:14–6:18; EPH 5:7; 2TH 3:14; 2TI 3:1–3:5; TIT 3:10–3:11

The church as a heavenly people

JHN 17:14–17:16 See also LUK 10:20; 1CO 15:48; GAL 4:26; EPH 2:6; PHP 3:20; COL 3:1–3:4; HEB 11:16, HEB 12:22–12:23

The church and worship

Praise in the life of the church

HEB 13:15 See also ACT 2:47; 1CO 14:26; EPH 5:18–5:20; PHP 3:3; COL 3:16

Prayer in the life of the church

Corporate prayer in the church: ACT 1:14, ACT 2:42, ACT 4:24–4:31, ACT 12:5, ACT 12:12, ACT 20:36, ACT 21:5; ROM 15:30; ; EPH 6:19–6:20; ; COL 4:2–4:4; ; 1TH 5:25; ; 2TH 3:1; ; HEB 13:18; EPH 6:18 prayer for all Christians; ; 1TI 2:1–2:2 prayer for all, including secular leaders

Baptism in the life of the church

ACT 2:38; ; 1CO 1:13; ; GAL 3:26–3:27; ; EPH 4:4–4:5; ; COL 2:11–2:12; ; 1PE 3:21

The Lord's Supper in the life of the church

1CO 10:16–10:17 The breaking of bread was central to the church's worship and a vital expression of its fellowship. See also ACT 2:42, ACT 2:46, ACT 20:7; 1CO 10:21, 1CO 11:17–11:34

The suffering of the church

Suffering persecution from a hostile world

JHN 16:33 See also MAT 5:10–5:12; 1CO 4:12; 2CO 4:9; 1TH 3:4; 2TI 3:12

Sharing in the sufferings of Christ

PHP 3:10 See also JHN 15:20; ROM 8:17; 2CO 4:10–4:11; 1PE 4:13

Suffering as the road to glory

JAS 1:12 See also ROM 5:3, ROM 8:18; 2CO 4:17; 2TI 2:11–2:12; 1PE 5:10

7030: unity

The bringing together of separate or fragmented parts into a unified whole. It is God's ultimate goal to unite the whole of creation; his desire for unity is evident, too, in the life of his people. God himself acts as a unity in all his works.

7031: unity, God's goal of

God's purpose is to bring together and reconcile to himself the whole of creation. This desire for unity is a reflection of the unity within the Godhead; it is expressed in marriage, and demonstrated in the fellowship of the church.

Unity is a reflection of God's person

DEU 6:4; JHN 17:22 See also MRK 12:29, MRK 12:32; JHN 1:1, JHN 17:11; GAL 3:20; 1JN 5:7

Alienation is a result of sin

Alienation from God

GEN 3:8, GEN 3:23–3:24; ; ISA 59:2; ; EZK 28:16; ; JAS 4:4

Alienation from one another

GEN 4:7–4:9, GEN 4:23–4:24, GEN 6:11; ; JAS 4:1–4:2; ; JUD 1:19

God's purpose in unity

To bring together all peoples

PSA 133:1; EPH 1:9–1:10

To unite all peoples under his rule

ZEC 14:9 See also GEN 49:10; PSA 72:8–72:11; ISA 2:2–2:4 parallel MIC 4:1–4:3; JHN 10:16; PHP 2:9–2:11; REV 11:15

To unite all peoples in worship

ISA 19:23–19:25 See also PSA 86:9; ISA 56:6–56:8; ZEC 8:20–8:23, ZEC 14:16; MRK 11:17; REV 15:4

To bring reconciliation between Jew and Gentile

EPH 2:11–2:19 See also ISA 14:1; ROM 10:12; GAL 3:28; COL 3:11

To bring reconciliation among his people

JER 50:4 See also ISA 11:10–11:13; EZK 37:21–37:24; MIC 2:12; MAT 5:24; PHP 4:2

To reconcile humanity to himself

COL 1:19–1:22 See also ROM 5:10–5:11; 2CO 5:18–5:19; HEB 10:19–10:20

Expressions of unity brought by God

Unity between husband and wife

GEN 2:24 See also MAL 2:15; MAT 19:5–19:6 parallel MRK 10:7–10:8; 1CO 6:16, 1CO 7:4, 1CO 7:10–7:11

Marriage as an expression of unity between God and his people

JER 2:2; EPH 5:31–5:32 See also ISA 54:5; JER 31:32; HOS 2:16; JHN 3:29; REV 19:7, REV 21:2, REV 21:9

Unity within the church

JHN 17:21 See also ACT 2:1, ACT 4:32; 1CO 1:10, 1CO 10:17, 1CO 12:12; EPH 4:13

7032: unity, of God's people

A distinguishing characteristic of God's people, which derives from their common relationship with God, and is expressed in commitment to one another, mutual concern, concerted action and harmony within the believing community.

Unity in a common relationship with God

As children of God

MAL 2:10 See also PSA 133:1; MAT 23:8–23:9; ROM 8:15–8:17; COL 1:2, COL 1:12; 1JN 5:1

As the people of God

1PE 2:9–2:10 See also EXO 6:7, EXO 19:5–19:6; DEU 7:6; 2SA 7:24 parallel 1CH 17:22; MAL 3:17; EPH 1:14; HEB 11:25

Unity in a common union with Christ

1CO 10:16–10:17, 1CO 12:27 See also JHN 11:52; ROM 12:4–12:5; 1CO 12:12; GAL 3:26–3:28; EPH 2:17–2:19, EPH 4:16; COL 3:11

Unity through common receiving of the Holy Spirit

1CO 12:13 See also ISA 34:16; ACT 10:45–10:47; 1CO 12:4–12:11; 2CO 13:14; EPH 2:22; HEB 6:4

Unity in a common faith

EPH 4:4–4:6 See also EPH 4:13; TIT 1:4; 1JN 1:1–1:3; JUD 1:3

Expressions of unity among God's people

Commitment to one another

1SA 18:1–18:4; ; RUT 1:16–1:17; ; 1TH 2:8

Sharing possessions

ACT 4:32 See also LUK 3:11; ACT 2:44–2:45; ROM 12:13, ROM 15:27; GAL 6:6; 2TI 2:6

Giving support

JOS 22:3 See also DEU 3:18; HEB 10:24–10:25

Sharing troubles

2CO 1:7; ; PHP 4:14

Unity expressed in agreement with one another

Living in harmony

PSA 133:1; EPH 4:3; 1PE 3:8 See also ROM 12:16, ROM 14:17; 1CO 10:24; EPH 4:25; PHP 4:2; COL 1:12–1:14, COL 3:15

United in purpose

PHP 1:27 See also JDG 20:11; 1SA 14:7; EZR 3:8–3:10; NEH 4:6; MAT 18:19–18:20

Of one mind

1CO 1:10 See also 2CH 30:12; PHP 2:2

Unity expressed in worshipping together

ROM 15:5–15:6 See also PSA 22:22, PSA 68:26, PSA 122:1; 1CO 14:26; HEB 2:12

Unity marks out God's people

JHN 17:21–17:23 See also JHN 13:34–13:35

7033: unity, of God

See [1170: God, unity of](#)

7100: Titles of the people of God

- 7105: believers
- 7110: body of Christ
- 7115: children of God
- 7120: Christians
- 7125: elect, the
- 7130: flock, God's
- 7135: Israel, as the people of God
- 7140: people of God
- 7145: remnant
- 7150: righteous, the
- 7155: saints
- 7160: servants of the Lord

7105: believers

Those who have faith in God. After Pentecost, the term came to be used specifically to refer to Christians, that is, to those who believe and trust in God, as he has made himself known through Jesus Christ. The NT stresses that Jesus Christ brings the faith of OT believers to perfection and to its proper fulfilment.

Believers as those who have faith in God

1KI 18:3–18:4 See also JHN 4:39–4:42; ACT 16:15; JAS 2:1

OT believers looked forward to the NT faith

HEB 11:13 See also HEB 11:39; 1PE 1:10–1:12

The church is referred to as the believers

ACT 5:12 See also ACT 1:15, ACT 2:44, ACT 4:32, ACT 9:41; 1TI 4:12

In the early church a distinction was sometimes made between Jewish and Gentile believers

ACT 15:23 See also ACT 10:45, ACT 11:1–11:3, ACT 15:5, ACT 21:20–21:25

The term believer is synonymous with Christian

1CO 7:12–7:13 See also ACT 15:2, ACT 16:1; 1CO 6:5, 1CO 14:22; 2CO 6:14–6:15; 1TH 1:7; 1TI 5:16

Believers are members of God's family

GAL 6:10 See also 1TI 6:2; 1PE 2:17

7110: body of Christ

The term refers both to the physical body of Jesus Christ, which was broken on the cross in order that redemption might be accomplished through him, and to the church.

Jesus Christ's physical body

His birth

JHN 1:14 See also ROM 1:3; GAL 4:4; 1TI 3:16

His bodily needs

MAT 8:24 parallels MRK 4:38, LUK 8:23; ; MRK 11:12 parallel MAT 21:18; ; LUK 4:2 parallel MAT 4:2; ; JHN 4:6, JHN 19:28

His physical suffering

MAT 27:26 parallels MRK 15:15, JHN 19:1 See also MAT 27:28–27:30 parallels MRK 15:17–15:19, JHN 19:2–19:3; LUK 22:44

His real physical death

JHN 19:31–19:37 See also MAT 27:35 parallels MRK 15:24–15:25, LUK 23:33, JHN 19:23; ACT 2:23

His burial

MRK 15:43–15:46 parallels MAT 27:58–27:60, LUK 23:52–23:53, JHN 19:38–19:42

His physical resurrection

LUK 24:37–24:43 See also MAT 28:9; JHN 20:19–20:20, JHN 20:27

The body of Christ symbolised in the Lord's Supper

MAT 26:26 parallels MRK 14:22, LUK 22:19 See also JHN 6:51–6:58; 1CO 10:16, 1CO 11:23–11:30

The church as the body of Christ

Believers as members of the body of Christ

1CO 12:27 See also ROM 12:4–12:5; 1CO 12:12; EPH 4:4; COL 1:24

Jesus Christ as the head of the body

COL 1:18 See also EPH 1:22, EPH 5:23

Jesus Christ's resurrection body is a new temple

JHN 2:19–2:22 See also EPH 2:19–2:22

Life in the body of Christ

Baptism is into the body of Christ

1CO 12:13 See also GAL 3:27

Believers receive spiritual life through the body of Christ

COL 2:19 See also 1CO 10:16–10:17; EPH 4:15–4:16

Believers care for each other in the body of Christ

1CO 12:25–12:26 See also EPH 4:25, EPH 5:29–5:30; COL 3:15

Believers have different gifts in the body of Christ

ROM 12:4–12:5 See also ROM 12:6–12:8; 1CO 12:12–12:31; EPH 4:11–4:13

7115: children of God

Israel and the church are the chief objects of God's fatherly love. People become God's children through faith and are then encouraged by Scripture to imitate their heavenly Father in their daily living.

Human beings as God's children

GEN 1:27, GEN 6:2, GEN 6:4; ; PSA 82:6; ; MAL 2:10; ; LUK 3:38; ; EPH 3:14

Israel as God's children

HOS 11:1 See also EXO 4:22–4:23; PSA 73:15, PSA 80:15; ISA 43:6, ISA 63:16; JER 31:20; ROM 9:4

Israel as God's rebellious children

ISA 1:2 See also DEU 32:5, DEU 32:20; ISA 30:1, ISA 30:9; JER 3:4–3:5, JER 4:22; EZK 20:21

God's son

Promises of God's son

2SA 7:12–7:14 parallel 1CH 17:11–17:13 These words referred originally to David's son, Solomon, but in the NT they are applied to Jesus Christ. See also 1CH 22:10, 1CH 28:6; PSA 2:7, PSA 89:26–89:27

Jesus Christ as God's son

HEB 1:5 See also MAT 3:17 parallels MRK 1:11, LUK 3:22; LUK 1:32; ACT 13:33; ROM 1:4

Jesus Christ's followers as God's children

MAT 9:2 parallel MRK 2:5; ; MAT 9:22 parallels MRK 5:34, LUK 8:48

Becoming God's children through faith in Jesus Christ

Becoming God's children by new birth

JHN 1:12–1:13 See also JHN 12:36; ROM 9:8; GAL 3:26; 1JN 5:1

Becoming God's children by adoption

EPH 1:5 See also ROM 8:23 This adoption will be fully realised in the future; GAL 4:4–4:5

Becoming God's children by the Spirit

ROM 8:15 See also GAL 4:6

God's dealings with his children

God loves his children

1JN 3:1 See also DEU 1:31; PSA 103:13; EPH 5:1

God disciplines his children

DEU 8:5 See also PRO 3:11–3:12; HEB 12:5–12:10

God does not abandon his children

HOS 1:10 God had previously (Hos 1:9) announced his judgment that Israel would be his people no longer.

See also DEU 31:6, DEU 31:8; JOS 1:5; HEB 13:5; JER 31:9; MAL 3:17; LUK 15:24; ROM 9:26

Behaviour expected of God's children

God's children imitate their heavenly Father

EPH 5:1 See also MAT 5:48; LUK 6:36

God's children live by the Father's standards

PHP 2:15 See also LEV 11:44–11:45; DEU 14:1–14:2; MAT 5:9, MAT 5:44–5:45 parallel LUK 6:35–6:36; ROM 8:14; 2CO 6:17–6:18; 1PE 1:14–1:16; 1JN 3:10

The privileges and blessings of being God's children

God's children are eternally secure

JHN 8:35 See also ROM 8:16, ROM 8:21; 1JN 5:19

The needs of God's children are always supplied

MAT 7:9–7:11 parallel LUK 11:11–11:13 See also MAT 6:25–6:32 parallel LUK 12:22–12:30 needs for the present life; LUK 20:36; ROM 8:23 promises for the life to come

God's children have a sure inheritance

REV 21:7 See also JER 3:19; ROM 8:17–8:19; GAL 4:7; 1JN 3:2

7120: Christians

Those who belong to Jesus Christ; other designations in Scripture are believers, disciples and the children of God. Originally a nickname, the term is only used three times in the Bible.

The use of the term

Disciples first called Christians

ACT 11:26

Agrippa not persuaded

ACT 26:28

Suffering as a Christian

1PE 4:16

Other biblical designations of Christians

Christians described as believers

ACT 2:44 See also ACT 4:32, ACT 5:12; GAL 6:10; JAS 2:1; 1PE 2:17

Christians described as brothers

HEB 2:11 See also ACT 15:3; COL 1:2; 2TH 2:13; REV 19:10

Christians described as disciples

MAT 28:19 See also ACT 6:1, ACT 6:7, ACT 13:52, ACT 14:22

Christians described as children of God

1JN 3:1 See also JHN 1:12; ROM 8:16, ROM 8:21; GAL 3:26–4:7

Christians described as the church

ACT 12:5 See also ACT 5:11, ACT 8:1, ACT 15:3; ROM 16:5; 2CO 1:1; COL 1:18, COL 1:24; 1TI 3:15

Christians described as the elect

1PE 1:1 See also MAT 24:22; ROM 11:7; 2TI 2:10; TIT 1:1

Christians described as heirs of God

ROM 8:17 See also GAL 3:29, GAL 4:7; EPH 3:6; 1PE 3:7

Christians described as members of God's household

EPH 2:19 See also 1TI 3:15

Christians described as the people of God

1PE 2:10 See also EPH 2:19; COL 3:12; REV 21:3

Christians described as saints

ROM 1:7 See also ROM 15:25; 1CO 6:2; 2CO 1:1, 2CO 13:13; EPH 1:15, EPH 1:18; 1TI 5:10; JUD 1:3

7125: elect, the

Those chosen by God, entirely of his grace, for the special privilege of experiencing salvation.

Israel as the elect

DEU 7:6 See also EXO 19:4-19:6; PSA 105:6, PSA 105:43, PSA 135:4; ISA 41:8-41:9, ISA 43:10, ISA 44:1-44:2, ISA 45:4; AMO 3:2; ROM 11:1-11:18

The church as the elect

EPH 1:4-1:13; 1PE 1:1-1:2 See also JHN 10:4-10:5; 1TH 1:4-1:5; 1PE 2:9, 1PE 5:13; 2JN 1:1, 2JN 1:13

Individuals chosen by God as his elect**Abraham**

GEN 18:18-18:19

Moses

PSA 106:23

David

1KI 8:16; ; PSA 89:3-89:4

Rufus

ROM 16:13

God's elect enjoy his presence and favour**The elect are assured of the presence of God**

HEB 13:5-13:6 See also JOS 1:1-1:9; PSA 23:1-23:6

The elect are assured of the protection of God

MAT 24:22 parallel MRK 13:20 See also ROM 8:33-8:39; REV 17:14

The elect are assured of a place in the world to come

MRK 13:26-13:27 parallel MAT 24:30-24:31 See also ISA 65:17-65:25; JHN 14:1-14:3; JAS 2:5; 2PE 1:10-1:11

The elect are assured of justice

LUK 18:7-18:8

Responsibilities of the elect

COL 3:12-3:17 See also DEU 14:1-14:2

7130: flock, God's

God's people are frequently portrayed as a flock of sheep, for whom he cares with the tenderness and concern of a loving shepherd.

The divine shepherd**God portrayed as a shepherd**

PSA 23:1 See also PSA 80:1

Jesus Christ portrayed as a shepherd

JHN 10:11 See also MAT 26:31; ZEC 13:7

God's people are his flock**Israel and Judah depicted as God's flock**

PSA 77:20 See also PSA 78:52; ISA 63:11; JER 13:17, JER 31:10, JER 50:17; MIC 2:12, MIC 7:14

NT believers depicted as God's flock

ACT 20:28 See also LUK 12:32; JHN 10:14-10:16

God cares for his flock

ISA 40:11 See also PSA 95:6-95:7; EZK 34:11-34:16; MIC 5:4; ZEC 9:16

God judges his flock

EZK 34:17-34:24 See also ZEC 11:7-11:16

The under-shepherds of the flock**Many of Israel's leaders exploited God's flock**

EZK 34:2-34:3 See also JER 10:21; ZEC 11:4-11:5; JHN 10:12-10:13

God will judge the corrupt shepherds

EZK 34:7-34:10 See also JER 23:1-23:5, JER 25:34-25:36; ZEC 10:3, ZEC 11:17

Church leaders are to care for God's flock

1PE 5:2-5:3 See also ACT 20:28-20:29

7135: Israel, as the people of God

God called Israel out of Egypt to be his own treasured possession and his covenant faithfulness with them is maintained, despite their persistent disobedience.

God's election of Israel**The nation was founded upon God's promises to the patriarchs**

GEN 12:1-12:3 See also GEN 17:1-17:8, GEN 35:9-35:13

Israel as God's chosen possession

1KI 8:53 See also EXO 19:3–19:6; DEU 7:6, DEU 32:7–32:12; PSA 135:3–135:4

God redeemed Israel from Egypt

EXO 6:6–6:7 See also EXO 3:7–3:10; 2SA 7:22–7:24 parallel 1CH 17:20–17:22

God enters into a special covenant relationship with Israel

EXO 24:3–24:8

Israel's privileged status within the covenant

ROM 9:4–9:5 See also ROM 3:1–3:2; PHP 3:4–3:6

Israel's disobedience to the covenant**Israel provoked God in the wilderness**

PSA 78:40–78:41 See also EXO 32:1–32:10; NUM 11:1–11:6, NUM 14:1–14:4

Israel's unfaithfulness in the promised land

ISA 1:4 See also JDG 2:10–2:13; JER 11:9–11:10; EZK 20:27–20:28

Israel exiled for her sins

2KI 18:11–18:12 See also 2KI 25:8–25:12 parallels JER 39:8–39:10, JER 52:12–52:16

God's promise to restore Israel**God's promise not to abandon Israel completely**

DEU 4:31 See also LEV 26:44–26:45; ISA 6:11–6:13 Though Israel will be destroyed, a holy remnant will be left; JER 31:35–31:37

God's promise to bring Israel back to the land

JER 30:3 See also ISA 43:5–43:7; EZK 37:11–37:14

God's promise to reunite Israel

JER 3:18 See also EZK 37:15–37:23; HOS 1:10–1:11

The promise of a restored relationship between Israel and God

JER 31:31–31:34 See also ISA 40:1–40:2; EZK 36:24–36:28

Israel returns from exile

EZR 1:1–1:5 parallel 2CH 36:22–36:23

Jesus Christ, the Saviour of Israel**Jesus Christ's ministry was specifically to the nation of Israel**

MAT 10:5–10:6 See also MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30

Jesus accepts the title "Christ" (Messiah), God's anointed deliverer for Israel

MAT 16:16–16:17 parallels MRK 8:29, LUK 9:20 Although Jesus accepted the title "Messiah" (Christ), he did

not fulfil contemporary Israelite hopes of a political deliverer.

Jesus Christ declares to Israel the good news of God's reign

MRK 1:14–1:15 Jesus Christ takes up Isaiah's message of good news, that God is coming in sovereign power to restore Israel (see Isa 40:9–10, 52:7). See also MAT 4:23, MAT 9:35; LUK 8:1

Israel's rejection of Jesus Christ**Israel warned that rejection of Christ means exclusion from the kingdom**

MAT 8:11–8:12 See also MAT 21:33–21:46 parallels MRK 12:1–12:12, LUK 20:9–20:19; MAT 22:1–22:10 parallel LUK 14:16–14:24; LUK 13:28–13:30

Israel's rejection of the gospel

ROM 9:30–10:4 See also ACT 28:24–28:28; ISA 6:9–6:10; 1TH 2:14–2:16

God's faithfulness to Israel maintained**Membership of the true Israel is based on God's election, not merely on physical descent from Abraham**

ROM 9:6–9:18

A remnant of Israel has been elected by grace

ROM 11:1–11:12

Paul declares that "all Israel" will be saved

ISA 59:20–59:21; ; ROM 11:25–11:32 The phrase "all Israel" is interpreted as either: (1) the total number of the elect (either Jews, or Jews and Gentiles) of every generation, or (2) the great majority of Jews of the final generation who will be saved when Christ returns.

The new Israel**The church as the new Israel**

GAL 6:15–6:16; PHP 3:3 See also 1PE 2:9–2:10

The church described as the 12 tribes of Israel

JAS 1:1 See also REV 7:4–7:8 Some see this as a reference to members of actual Jewish tribes, but others see it as symbolic of all the faithful believers who live through the time of tribulation; REV 21:12 The number 12 emphasises the continuity of the NT church and the OT people of God.

The apostles as the 12 leaders of the new Israel

MAT 19:28 See also LUK 22:29–22:30; REV 21:14

7140: people of God

Those called out to belong to God and serve him in his world. God called Israel to be his people in the OT, anticipating the calling of the church in the NT.

7141: people of God, in OT

The OT relates how God called Israel to be his people.

Chosen by God

DEU 7:6 See also DEU 4:37; 1KI 3:8; ISA 41:8–41:9, ISA 43:1, ISA 44:1–44:2; EZK 20:5

Loved by God

DEU 7:7–7:8 See also DEU 4:37, DEU 23:5; 1KI 10:9; PSA 44:3

Sanctified by God

DEU 28:9 See also EXO 19:6, EXO 22:31; LEV 11:44–11:45; DEU 14:2; ISA 62:12

God's possession

EXO 19:5 See also DEU 14:2, DEU 26:18; PSA 135:4; ISA 43:1; MAL 3:17

God's inheritance

DEU 4:20 See also DEU 9:26, DEU 9:29; PSA 28:9, PSA 33:12, PSA 68:9, PSA 74:2; JER 10:16; JOL 3:2; MIC 7:14

God's servants

DEU 32:36 See also NEH 1:6, NEH 1:11; PSA 135:14; ISA 41:8–41:9

God's children

EXO 4:22 See also DEU 32:6; ISA 63:16, ISA 64:8; JER 3:19, JER 31:9; HOS 11:1

God's sheep

PSA 95:6–95:7; EZK 34:11–34:16 See also PSA 28:9, PSA 74:1, PSA 79:13, PSA 80:1, PSA 100:3; ISA 40:11; JER 23:1, JER 31:10

7142: people of God, in NT

The NT relates how the Christian church is the new people of God, assuming all the privileges and responsibilities of Israel in the OT, but with a universal mission to all the world, rather than any one nation.

NT believers are God's people

ROM 9:22–9:26 See also 1PE 2:10; 2CO 9:12; EPH 5:3; REV 22:21

Believers are the true children of Abraham

GAL 3:29 See also MAT 3:9 parallel LUK 3:8; ROM 4:16–4:18; GAL 3:6–3:9, GAL 4:22–4:31; 1PE 3:6

The church is the people of God

God's chosen people

1PE 2:9 See also COL 3:12; 1TH 1:4; 2TH 2:13

God's children

JHN 1:12–1:13 See also GAL 3:26, GAL 4:4–4:6; EPH 1:5; PHP 2:14–2:15

God's possession

EPH 1:13–1:14; ; TIT 2:14; ; 1PE 2:9

God's servants

1PE 2:16; ; REV 1:1, REV 2:20

The temple of God

1PE 2:5 See also EPH 2:19–2:22; HEB 3:6

The body of Christ

EPH 1:22–1:23 See also ROM 12:4–12:5; 1CO 12:27; EPH 4:11–4:13

Jesus Christ sends believers into all the world

ACT 1:8 See also MAT 28:19; MRK 13:10, MRK 16:15; LUK 24:47; JHN 17:20–17:24

7145: remnant

A small group of people who remain faithful to God, despite widespread unbelief or faithlessness around them. God preserves a remnant in order to ensure a renewed and restored people in the future.

God preserves a remnant of his people

Noah and his family

GEN 7:23 See also GEN 6:7–6:8, GEN 6:18, GEN 7:1, GEN 7:7

Joseph and the sons of Israel

GEN 45:7 See also GEN 50:20

Seven thousand faithful in Israel

1KI 19:18

Survivors of Assyria's invasion of Judah

2KI 19:4 parallel ISA 37:4 See also 2KI 18:13

Survivors of the destruction of Israel

People from the northern kingdom of Israel who had moved to Judah and so escaped its destruction by Assyria: 2CH 11:14, 2CH 15:9, 2CH 31:6, 2CH 34:9

Judah as the remnant of God's people

2KI 17:18; 2KI 21:14; ; 2CH 34:21

Survivors of the fall of Jerusalem

Those taken as exiles into Babylon: 2KI 25:11; ; 2CH 36:20; 2KI 25:12 parallel JER 39:10; ; 2KI 25:22–25:23; ; JER 40:11–40:12, JER 40:15, JER 42:2, JER 43:5

Those who returned after the exile

EZR 9:8 See also EZR 2:1–2:2, EZR 9:13; NEH 1:2; HAG 1:12–1:14

Those waiting for Jesus Christ's coming

LUK 2:25, LUK 2:38; ; JHN 1:12

The remnant as the few who escape judgment

DEU 4:27 See also ISA 10:22; ROM 9:27; JER 6:9, JER 44:14, JER 44:28; EZK 5:12EZK 9:8, EZK 11:13 EZK 17:21; AMO 3:12, AMO 5:3

God's promise of hope and restoration

Hope for a remnant seen in the coming of the Messiah

ISA 11:1 See also ISA 6:13; JER 23:5; ZEC 3:8

God's promise that survivors will remain

ISA 4:2–4:3 See also ISA 1:9; ROM 9:29; ISA 17:6, ISA 37:31–37:32 parallel 2KI 19:30–19:31; EZK 14:22; JOL 2:32

Themes associated with the remnant

The land restored to the remnant of God's people

ISA 27:12–27:13; ; ZEP 2:7–2:10; ; ZEC 8:6–8:12, ZEC 10:9

A second exodus

ISA 4:5–4:6, ISA 10:26, ISA 11:11, ISA 11:15–11:16, ISA 31:5; ; JER 16:14–16:15

Restoration of the people

ISA 10:20–10:21 See also ISA 11:12, ISA 28:5, ISA 35:8–35:10, ISA 46:3–46:4; JER 31:7**JER 23:3** See also MIC 2:12

Further promises associated with the remnant

The promise of future hope

ISA 60:21–60:22, ISA 61:4–61:6; ; JOL 3:1; ; MIC 4:6–4:7, MIC 5:7–5:9

God's promise of forgiveness to the remnant

JER 50:20 See also ISA 33:24; JER 31:34, JER 33:7–33:8; MIC 7:18

A renewed relationship with God

JER 24:5–24:7, JER 32:37–32:40; ; ZEP 3:12–3:17

The need for faithful obedience

ISA 1:19; ; JER 42:6–42:10, JER 44:7–44:8; ; EZR 9:14

The remnant as heirs of God's new covenant

JER 31:2 The promise of the new covenant is made to the surviving remnant of Israel; ; JER 31:31–31:33

A faithful remnant among the Jews

ROM 11:5 See also LUK 1:16, LUK 12:32; ROM 11:7, ROM 11:15, ROM 11:23, ROM 11:25–11:26; JAS 1:1

A faithful remnant from among the Gentiles

ISA 56:6–56:8; ; ZEC 14:16; ; JHN 10:16 Jesus Christ's other sheep are believing Gentiles who will be gathered with the believers of Israel; ; ACT 15:17; ; AMO 9:12; ; ROM 11:17; ; EPH 3:6

God's new Israel includes all believers

MAT 19:28 parallel LUK 22:30; ; GAL 6:16; ; 1PE 1:1, 1PE 2:9

Other references to a surviving remnant

Og, king of Bashan, only survivor of the Rephaites: DEU 3:11; ; JOS 13:12; JDG 20:46–20:47 survivors from the tribe of Benjamin; ; 2CH 18:16 the scattered remains of Israel's army under Ahab; ; ISA 16:4 fugitives from Moab; ; ISA 21:16–21:17 few survivors from Kedar

7150: righteous, the

The designation, especially in the OT, of those who live and act in accordance with God's commands.

Characteristics of the righteous

PRO 20:7 See also PSA 37:21; PRO 10:11, PRO 10:20–10:21, PRO 10:31–10:32, PRO 12:5, PRO 13:5, PRO 15:28, PRO 21:25–21:26, PRO 29:7, PRO 29:27; MAT 25:31–25:40

God's dealings with the righteous

He loves them

PSA 146:8 See also GEN 18:20–18:32

He protects them

PRO 18:10 See also PSA 1:5–1:6, PSA 37:16–37:17, PSA 37:39, PSA 55:22; PRO 10:29, PRO 11:8, PRO 12:21

He provides for them

PRO 10:3 See also PSA 37:25; PRO 13:25

He blesses them

PSA 5:12 See also JOB 36:7; PRO 3:33, PRO 10:6–10:7

He hears their petitions

1PE 3:12 See also PSA 34:17; PRO 15:29

The faith of the righteous

HAB 2:4 See also ROM 1:17; GAL 3:11; HEB 10:38

The righteous are secure

PRO 12:3 See also PRO 10:30, PRO 11:28, PRO 12:7, PRO 28:1

The righteous can be corrupted

EZK 18:24 See also EXO 23:8; DEU 16:19; PSA 125:3; EZK 3:20, EZK 33:12–33:13

The oppression of the righteous

PSA 37:12–37:13 See also PSA 31:17–31:18, PSA 94:21; LAM 4:11–4:13; AMO 2:6–2:7, AMO 5:12; HAB 1:4

The equality, in human terms, of the righteous and the wicked

MAT 5:45 See also ECC 8:12–8:14, ECC 9:1–9:2

The reward of the righteous

PRO 10:16 See also PSA 37:29, PSA 58:10–58:11, PSA 92:12–92:15; PRO 10:6–10:7, PRO 10:28, PRO 11:23, PRO 11:30–11:31, PRO 13:21–13:22, PRO 15:6; ISA 3:10

The death of the righteous

ISA 57:1 See also PSA 116:15; PRO 14:32

The hope of the righteous

LUK 14:12–14:14 See also PSA 17:14–17:15; PRO 14:32; MAL 3:17–3:18; ACT 24:14–24:16

7155: saints

The people of God, especially in relation to their being set apart from the world to serve him. Believers are called upon to lead holy lives worthy of their calling.

Saints are set apart for God

1CO 1:2 To be holy is to be set apart. The same Greek word is used in the NT for both “holy” and, in the plural, “saints”. See also DEU 7:6, DEU 26:19; PSA 4:3; ROM 1:7; HEB 10:10

They are members of God’s covenant people

PSA 85:8 See also 2CH 6:41 parallel PSA 132:9; PSA 30:4, PSA 34:9, PSA 50:5, PSA 79:1–79:2, PSA 132:16

They are believers

ROM 16:15 See also ROM 8:27, ROM 15:31; PHP 4:21–4:22; COL 1:26; 1TI 5:10

They make up the church

1CO 14:33 See also ACT 9:32; EPH 1:1; COL 1:2

Saints are to live lives worthy of their calling

EPH 5:3–5:4 See also ROM 16:2; EPH 4:1–4:3; 2PE 3:11; REV 13:10, REV 14:12

Saints have responsibility for one another

ROM 12:13 See also ROM 15:25–15:26; 1CO 6:1, 1CO 16:1–16:2, 1CO 16:15; 2CO 9:1–9:2, 2CO 9:12

Saints have spiritual union with Jesus Christ

HEB 2:11 See also JHN 15:4–15:5; 1CO 1:2; EPH 1:1; PHP 1:1, PHP 4:21; COL 1:2; 2TH 1:10

Saints may be persecuted

JHN 15:19 See also DAN 7:21, DAN 7:25, DAN 8:24; JHN 17:14; ACT 9:13, ACT 26:10; REV 13:7, REV 16:6

Saints are precious in God’s sight

PSA 16:3 See also PSA 116:15, PSA 147:11, PSA 149:4; EPH 1:18

They enjoy God’s protection

1SA 2:9 See also PSA 31:23, PSA 37:28, PSA 97:10; PRO 2:8

They experience exaltation

DAN 7:18 See also PSA 149:6–149:9; DAN 7:22, DAN 7:27; MAT 27:52; 1CO 6:2; COL 1:12

7160: servants of the Lord

A description of individuals, groups, and the nation of Israel. Isaiah portrays a unique servant whom the NT identifies as Jesus Christ.

Individuals as servants of the Lord

The patriarchs as servants of the Lord

EXO 32:13 See also GEN 18:3, GEN 32:10; DEU 9:27; 1CH 16:13; PSA 105:6

Moses as the servant of the Lord

EXO 14:31 See also NUM 12:7–12:8; DEU 34:5; JOS 1:1–1:2; NEH 1:7–1:8; MAL 4:4

Other leaders as servants of the Lord

NUM 14:24; ; JOS 5:14, JOS 24:29; ; JDG 2:8, JDG 15:18

David as the servant of the Lord

PSA 89:20 See also 1SA 23:11; 2SA 7:5 parallel 1CH 17:4; 1KI 14:8

Other kings as servants of the Lord

1KI 3:7–3:9; ; 2CH 32:16

Individual prophets as servants of the Lord

1KI 14:18, 1KI 18:36; ; 2KI 14:25; ; ISA 20:3

Paul as the servant of the Lord

ACT 27:23 See also ROM 1:1; EPH 3:1

Other individual believers as servants of the Lord

1SA 1:11; ; JOB 1:8, JOB 2:3, JOB 42:7–42:8; ; HAG 2:23; ; LUK 1:38, LUK 1:48, LUK 2:29; ; JAS 1:1; ; 2PE 1:1; ; JUD 1:1; ; REV 1:1

Pagan kings as servants of the Lord

JER 25:9 See also ISA 45:1; JER 43:10

Groups of servants of the Lord

The people of Israel as the Lord’s servants

ISA 41:8–41:9 See also LEV 25:42, LEV 25:55; NEH 1:6, NEH 1:10; ISA 43:10; JER 30:10–30:11 parallel JER 46:27–46:28; LUK 1:54

Failure of the people of Israel to serve the Lord

ISA 42:19 See also JDG 10:6; 1SA 12:10; NEH 9:35; MAL 3:14

Priests as the Lord’s servants

EXO 28:1, EXO 28:41; ; LEV 7:35; ; NUM 18:7; ; HEB 8:5

Levites as the Lord’s servants

DEU 18:7; ; 1CH 23:28–23:31; ; EZR 6:18; ; EZK 44:11

Prophets as the Lord’s servants

JER 7:25 See also JER 29:19, JER 44:4; EZK 38:17; DAN 9:6; AMO 3:7; ZEC 1:6; MAT 21:34–21:36 parallels MRK 12:2–12:5, LUK 20:10–20:12; REV 10:7

Other nations as the Lord's servants**PSA 72:11** See also ISA 56:6; ZEP 3:9**The Lord's servants recognised as such by pagans****DAN 3:26** See also DAN 6:16, DAN 6:20; ACT 16:17**The unique servant of the Lord****Isaiah's vision of this servant****ISA 42:1–42:4** See also ISA 49:1–49:6, ISA 50:4–50:9, ISA 52:13–53:12**Jesus Christ's life identifies him as the Lord's servant****MAT 12:17–12:21** See also MAT 8:16–8:17, MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45; MAT 26:28 parallel MRK 14:24; MAT 27:12–27:14 parallel MRK 15:2–15:5; MRK 9:12; JHN 1:29, JHN 12:38**NT leaders proclaim Jesus Christ as the Lord's servant****ACT 8:30–8:35** See also ACT 3:13, ACT 3:26; ROM 10:16, ROM 15:21; PHP 2:6–2:8; 1PE 2:21–2:25**The Lord's service****An exclusive service****DEU 6:13** See also DEU 10:12, DEU 10:20; JOS 22:5, JOS 24:14–24:24; MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13**Serving the Lord as he requires****COL 3:23–3:24** See also PSA 2:11; LUK 1:74, LUK 12:35–12:36; ROM 7:6; EPH 6:7; 2TI 2:24; 1PE 2:16**The Lord's care for his servants****PSA 35:27** See also ISA 54:17, ISA 65:13–65:15; DAN 3:28**The reward of the Lord's servants****REV 22:3–22:5** See also LUK 12:37–12:38, LUK 19:17; JHN 12:26, JHN 15:14–15:15**7200: History of God's people in OT**

- 7203: ark, Noah's
- 7206: community
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- 7263: theocracy
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7203: ark, Noah's

The craft built at God's command by Noah and his family as a means of escape from the flood. The ark is seen as corresponding to the redemption offered to believers through Jesus Christ.

The building of the ark**The command to build****GEN 6:14** See also GEN 6:1–6:13, GEN 6:15–6:16**Its purpose for Noah and his family****GEN 6:17–6:18****Its purpose for the animals****GEN 6:19** See also GEN 6:20–6:22**The ark and the flood****Noah obeyed God****GEN 7:5** See also GEN 7:1–7:4, GEN 7:6–7:16**The ark served its purpose****GEN 7:17** See also GEN 7:18–7:24, GEN 8:1–8:19, GEN 9:1–9:17**The significance of the ark elsewhere in Scripture****An instance of judgment****MAT 24:38–24:39** parallel LUK 17:26–17:27 Judgment clearly divides humanity into the saved and the lost. See also 2PE 2:5**An example of faith****HEB 11:7** Noah took God at his word in circumstances which must have appeared ridiculous.**A symbol of salvation****1PE 3:20–3:21** The link between the ark and baptism is in the twin ideas of water and salvation.**7206: community**

A group, small or large, of people. In Scripture it denotes the people of Israel, especially in pre-monarchic times and particularly during the period of the wilderness wanderings.

The community of Israel in the wilderness**EXO 16:1** See also EXO 17:1; NUM 13:26, NUM 20:22, NUM 20:29**Moses and Aaron communicate God's instructions to the wilderness community**

EXO 35:1, EXO 35:4, EXO 35:20; ; NUM 10:2–10:3

Rebellion, discontent and grumbling within the wilderness community

EXO 16:2–16:10; ; NUM 14:1–14:2, NUM 14:27, NUM 14:35–14:36, NUM 16:8–16:33, NUM 16:41, NUM 20:1–20:4, NUM 27:14

Responsibilities towards one another within the wilderness community

LEV 10:6; ; NUM 1:53

Leaders and officials, under Moses, of the wilderness community

EXO 16:22 See also EXO 34:31; NUM 26:9, NUM 31:13, NUM 31:26–31:27, NUM 32:1–32:5

Censuses of the wilderness community

NUM 1:1–1:3 See also EXO 38:25; NUM 1:17–1:19, NUM 4:34

The community identity of pre-monarchic Israel

The importance of a community identity in matters of worship

LEV 4:13–4:21 See also EXO 12:3–12:19, EXO 12:47–12:49; LEV 16:5, LEV 16:32–16:33; NUM 3:6–3:7, NUM 8:9–8:11, NUM 8:20–8:21, NUM 15:22–15:26, NUM 19:9

The importance of a community in legal matters

LEV 20:1–20:5 See also NUM 15:15

God promised that the patriarchs' descendants would be a community of nations

GEN 35:11 See also GEN 28:3, GEN 48:4

The families of the priests and Levites described as a community

2CH 31:14–31:18

The Jews referred to as a community in NT times

ACT 25:24

7209: congregation

A group of people gathered or called together for a purpose. In Scripture a congregation refers particularly to the Israelites gathered for worship; it is also used of Christians in the NT.

The congregation of the Israelites

For the giving of the Ten Commandments

See also EXO 19:17; DEU 5:22

For hearing God's word

NEH 8:1–8:9 See also DEU 5:1; NEH 8:18, NEH 9:1–9:3

For praising God

PSA 22:22 See also PSA 40:9–40:10, PSA 68:26; HEB 2:12

To make a sin offering for the sin of the community

LEV 4:13–4:14; ; NUM 15:24

For the ordination of priests and Levites

LEV 8:3–8:4; ; NUM 8:9

For census, retribution and major events

LEV 24:14; ; NUM 1:18; ; JOS 18:1; ; JDG 20:1; ; 1SA 10:17

Exclusion from the assembly

DEU 23:1–23:8

In the NT

Jewish congregations in the synagogue

LUK 4:20 See also ACT 13:5, ACT 13:14–13:15, ACT 14:1

Christian congregations

ACT 2:46–2:47 See also ACT 5:12, ACT 11:26, ACT 20:7; 1CO 14:33–14:34; JAS 2:2

7212: exile

A period of absence from one's homeland, often imposed as a form of punishment. The OT regards Israel's exile in Babylon as a form of divine punishment for past sin and as an opportunity for renewal and rededication.

Exile commanded by God for his purposes

GEN 12:1 See also GEN 11:4, GEN 11:8–11:9; PSA 44:11; ZEC 2:6; MAT 2:13–2:15

Exile imposed as a form of punishment

On individuals

GEN 3:23 See also GEN 17:14; LEV 7:20, LEV 18:29, LEV 19:8, LEV 20:17; DEU 28:36; 1SA 12:25; 2KI 24:15–24:16; 2CH 36:4, 2CH 36:10; ZEC 5:3

On Israel

LEV 26:33 See also DEU 4:25–4:27, DEU 28:36, DEU 28:64; 1KI 8:46; 2KI 18:9–18:12, 2KI 25:11; 1CH 5:26; 2CH 36:20; ISA 5:13; JER 25:8–25:11, JER 27:10; AMO 5:27

On other nations

AMO 1:5, AMO 1:15, AMO 5:5

Exile through military defeat

2KI 18:9–18:11 See also 2KI 15:29, 2KI 24:16; 1CH 8:6; JOB 30:8; JER 50:17; JOL 3:1–3:2; MIC 1:16

Exile through personal choice

To escape danger

EXO 2:15 See also GEN 16:6–16:8, GEN 35:6–35:7; 1SA 19:18, 1SA 21:10; 2SA 13:38–13:39; REV 1:9

To escape natural disaster

GEN 46:5–46:6 See also GEN 26:1–26:3; RUT 1:1

To support friends

2SA 15:19–15:21

At the advice of others

GEN 27:42–27:45; ; 1SA 20:12–20:13

Those exiled because of their faith**1PE 1:1** See also ACT 8:1, ACT 11:19; HEB 11:8–11:9, HEB 11:14–11:15, HEB 11:27, HEB 11:38; JAS 1:1**God does not intend exile to be permanent****2SA 14:14** See also GEN 46:4; NUM 35:25; 2CH 36:21; ISA 51:11, ISA 61:4–61:6, ISA 63:17; JER 16:14–16:15, JER 29:10–29:14, JER 30:3, JER 32:37**7215: exile, the**

The period of Israel's captivity in foreign lands, under Assyria in the eighth century B.C., and under Babylon in the sixth. Such exile is regarded by biblical writers as a judgment upon Israel for her folly and unfaithfulness. It is also seen as a time of repentance and renewal leading eventually to restoration.

7216: exile, in Assyria

People of the northern kingdom of Israel were taken into exile after their defeat by the Assyrians and the fall of Samaria. The Israelites were transported to Assyria in stages, starting with the upper strata of society. They were replaced by immigrants from other parts of the Assyrian empire. The Israelites had to share their land with these people when they returned from exile after the downfall of the Assyrians. This was the origin of the Samaritan people.

Israel was warned of coming punishment for her misconduct**God warned his people****DEU 28:62–28:66; ISA 5:12–5:13** See also LEV 26:27–26:28; DEU 28:49–28:57; ISA 10:5–10:6; HOS 8:1–8:8, HOS 13:16; AMO 3:2, AMO 3:11, AMO 5:27, AMO 9:4, AMO 9:7–9:9; MIC 1:6–1:7**Some prophecies referred specifically to Assyria as God's instrument****ISA 8:4–8:7, ISA 10:5–10:6** See also HOS 8:9–8:10; NAM 1:11–1:13**Warning through Solomon****1KI 8:46–8:50****The history of Israel's capture**

Tiglath-Pileser III invades Israel in 743 B.C. but withdraws upon payment of slave-indemnity
See also 2KI 15:19–15:20

A further attack takes place ten years later

2KI 15:29; ; 1CH 5:26

Shalmaneser V comes on the scene

2KI 17:3–17:6 After a three-year siege, Samaria falls in 722 B.C.

Israelites are removed to Assyria under Sargon II**2KI 17:5–17:7** See also 2KI 17:23**Non-Israelites are settled in Israel**

2KI 17:24

God sees his people in their distress**PSA 69:33** See also LEV 26:40–26:46**Assyria to be punished eventually****ISA 10:5** Despite having been used as God's instrument, Assyria will come under God's judgment. See also ISA 10:12; NAM 3:18–3:19**Nineveh will fall****NAM 1:14, NAM 2:1–2:2** See also NAM 3:1–3:5**God's people will be restored**

HOS 1:10–1:11; ; AMO 9:14–9:15

7217: exile, in Babylon

The southern kingdom of Judah was conquered by Babylon under Nebuchadnezzar. Before and after the destruction of Jerusalem in 587 B.C. the population was taken into exile in three stages.

The entire episode was within the purposes of God and under his control**The reason for the captivity****2KI 21:11–21:15** See also 1CH 9:1; EZR 9:7**The captivity foretold by the prophets****ISA 39:5–39:7** See also JER 1:14–1:16, JER 13:17, JER 13:19; EZK 12:11, EZK 21:24**Babylon the instrument of God's chastisement of Judah**

JER 22:25, JER 25:8–25:11

A remnant would be spared

EZK 12:16

The historical details**Nebuchadnezzar marches against Jerusalem****DAN 1:1–1:2** See also 2KI 25:1–25:21 parallel 2CH 36:17–36:20; JER 39:1–39:10, JER 52:4–52:27**The people of Judah are taken into exile in three stages****JER 52:27–52:30**

God watches over his people during their captivity

The LORD hears and answers the prayers of his people in captivity

See also PSA 69:33; DAN 9:17–9:23, DAN 10:12–10:14

Babylon spares certain captives, and gives them some freedom and dignity

2KI 25:27–25:30; ; DAN 1:12–1:20, DAN 2:48–2:49, DAN 3:30, DAN 6:28

God encourages his people during their captivity

PSA 69:33; ; JER 29:11; ; EZK 36:37–36:38

Promises of eventual restoration

EZK 36:8

The promise of return from exile

JER 33:7–33:8 See also JER 16:15, JER 23:3, JER 24:5–24:7, JER 27:22, JER 29:14, JER 30:3, JER 31:27–31:28; LAM 4:22; EZK 34:12–34:13; ZEP 3:20

Restoration to be a demonstration of God's grace

EZK 36:22

The promise of covenant renewal

See also JER 31:31–31:34; EZK 34:25, EZK 36:26–36:27

The promise of return fulfilled

2CH 36:22–36:23 parallel EZR 1:1–1:3; ; NEH 7:6

Babylonian oppressors to be punished

JER 25:12–25:14 See also JER 30:16, JER 50:18, JER 51:49, JER 51:55–51:56, JER 51:64; EZK 36:7

7221: exodus, the

The escape of the Israelites from slavery in Egypt under Moses' leadership. Despite their great deliverance, hardness of heart and disobedience towards God persisted. Divine deliverance in the exodus foreshadowed the act of salvation through Jesus Christ.

7222: exodus, events of

The escape of the Israelites from slavery in Egypt and their deliverance in the crossing of the Red Sea. The beginning of a long and difficult journey under Moses' leadership to Canaan, the promised land.

God's promise of deliverance

EXO 6:1–6:8 See also EXO 3:7–3:10

The LORD smites the Egyptians with ten plagues

Pharaoh refuses, despite the plagues, to let the Israelites leave: EXO 11:9–11:10; ; PSA 105:26–105:36

The plague on the firstborn and the Passover

EXO 12:31 See also EXO 12:23

The Israelites leave Egypt

EXO 12:37–12:41; NUM 33:3–33:5 See also PSA 105:37–105:38

The crossing of the Red Sea

EXO 14:29–14:31 See also EXO 13:17–14:28

The Israelites' travels: described in detail in Exodus, Numbers, Deuteronomy and Joshua

NUM 33:6–33:48

God's mighty deliverance remembered in confession

PSA 106:6–106:7; DAN 9:15

Events of the exodus: remembered in the Passover Feast

EXO 12:24–12:28 See also JOS 5:10

7223: exodus, spiritual significance of

Scripture records the many instances of praise being given to God on account of the exodus. The events of the exodus, however, reveal the lack of faith, the hardness of heart and the spiritual stubbornness that can persist among believers. Scripture warns of the consequences of these things. In addition the exodus is seen as an act of divine deliverance which foreshadows the greater act of salvation through Jesus Christ.

How great God is: remember what he has done

The song of Moses and Miriam after the crossing of the Red Sea

EXO 15:1–15:4

The psalmist praises God for his deliverance in the exodus

PSA 77:19–77:20 See also PSA 78:12–78:14, PSA 78:51–78:53, PSA 105:26–105:45, PSA 106:7–106:12, PSA 114:1–114:4, PSA 136:13–136:16

Joshua compares the crossing of the Jordan to the crossing of the Red Sea

JOS 4:23–4:24

Nehemiah leads the people in praise of God by reciting all his wonderful deeds

NEH 9:9–9:12

God did great things in the past: he will do them again

DEU 7:17–7:19

Rahab recounts what the LORD did at the Red Sea

JOS 2:10–2:11

Isaiah looks forward to a future deliverance as a second exodus

ISA 43:16–43:19 See also ISA 11:15–11:16, ISA 51:10

The exodus is remembered at the renewal of the covenant at Shechem

JOS 24:16–24:18 See also JOS 24:5–24:7

Warnings against hardness of heart

HEB 3:7–3:9, HEB 3:16; 1CO 10:1–10:5 See also PSA 95:7–95:11

The disobedience of the Israelites despite their knowledge of God's deliverance

ISA 12:8–12:9 See also JDG 6:7–6:10; 2CH 7:22; JER 2:5–2:6, JER 7:22–7:26, JER 11:1–11:8 **ACT 7:36–7:39**

A picture of the deliverance from sin won for believers by Jesus Christ

HEB 4:2 See also HEB 3:1–4:13

The exodus as a sign of God's love

HOS 11:1

The exodus as an example of faith

HEB 11:29

7227: flood, the

A universal catastrophe by means of which the world was overwhelmed by water as the judgment of God on sinful humanity. Only Noah, his family and the animals were saved.

Details of the flood

Its source

See also GEN 7:4, GEN 7:11–7:12, GEN 8:2

Its extent

GEN 7:17–7:20

Its duration

GEN 7:24

Its effect

See also GEN 7:21–7:23

The flood was God's judgment on sinful humanity

Wickedness had become universal

GEN 6:5, GEN 6:11–6:13

Judgment would be universal

GEN 6:7, GEN 6:13, GEN 6:17, GEN 7:4

Judgment was universal

GEN 7:21–7:22

Those not destroyed by the flood

Noah, who was blameless in the midst of wickedness

GEN 6:8–6:9

Noah and his family kept safe in the ark

GEN 7:23 See also GEN 6:14, GEN 6:18, GEN 7:1, GEN 7:7, GEN 7:13, GEN 8:15–8:16, GEN 8:18; 2PE 2:5, 2PE 2:9

God kept the animals safe in the ark

GEN 6:19–6:21, GEN 7:2–7:3, GEN 7:8–7:9, GEN 7:14–7:16, GEN 8:1, GEN 8:17, GEN 8:19

God promised never to send another universal flood

God decided this in his heart

GEN 8:21–8:22 See also ISA 54:9

God established his covenant with Noah

GEN 9:8–9:11

The rainbow as the sign and reminder of God's covenant

GEN 9:12–9:17

The story of the flood used figuratively

Of the judgment to come

DAN 9:26; ; 2PE 3:6–3:7

Of Jesus Christ's second coming

MAT 24:36–24:44 parallel LUK 17:26–17:27

Of baptism

1PE 3:20–3:21

7230: genealogies

In Scripture, lists of the descendants or forebears of an individual, or a record of the names of particular groups of people.

Genealogies as records of ancestors and lines of descent

MAT 1:1–1:17 parallel LUK 3:23–3:38 See also GEN 10:1–10:32, GEN 11:10–11:32, GEN 36:10–36:43; 1CH 1:1–6:30, 1CH 9:35–9:44; HEB 7:3

Kinds of genealogies

Population lists

1CH 9:1 See also GEN 46:8–46:27; 1CH 9:3–9:22; 2CH 31:16; EZR 2:1–2:67 parallel NEH 7:5–7:69

Heads of families

1CH 9:34 See also 1CH 8:1–8:28, 1CH 9:7–9:9, 1CH 26:31

Men eligible for military service

1CH 7:2 See also NUM 26:1–26:62; 1CH 7:4–7:11, 1CH 7:30–7:40

Some prophets may have been responsible for recording or maintaining genealogies
2CH 12:15

Christians are urged to avoid fruitless discussions concerning genealogies
TIT 3:9 See also 1TI 1:3-1:4

7233: Israel, as northern kingdom

The northernmost region of the two kingdoms, comprising the ten northern tribes which broke away from Judah in 930 B.C. and remained independent until the Assyrian conquest of 722 B.C., when the nation was exiled because of its sinfulness.

Origins of the division between Judah and Israel

Israelite settlement in Canaan had developed around two distinct regions in the north and south
JOS 18:5

The northern Israelite tribes were less ready to transfer allegiance from Saul to David
2SA 2:10 See also 2SA 19:41-20:2 Israel seems to have been ready to follow Sheba, because he came from the same tribe as Saul.

Israel's separation from Judah was the result of disobedience under Solomon
1KI 11:26-11:33

Rehoboam's folly provoked Israel's rebellion
1KI 12:1-12:17 parallel **2CH 10:1-10:17**

Israel's foreign affairs

Israel at war with Judah (c. 930-886 B.C.)
1KI 14:30 parallel **2CH 12:15**; ; **2CH 13:2-13:3**, **2CH 16:1** parallel **1KI 15:16-15:17**

Israel's wars with Aram (c. 886-753 B.C.)
1KI 15:18-15:20 parallel **2CH 16:2-16:4**; ; **1KI 20:1**, **1KI 20:26**; ; **2KI 6:24-6:25**, **2KI 10:32-10:33**, **2KI 13:3**, **2KI 13:24-13:25**, **2KI 14:28**

Israel's alliance with Judah against Aram and Moab (853 B.C.)
1KI 22:1-22:4 parallel **2CH 18:1-18:3**; ; **2KI 3:4-3:7**

Israel attacked by Assyria (c. 743-734 B.C.)
2KI 15:19-15:20, **2KI 15:29**

Israel's alliance with Aram against Judah (c. 735/734 B.C.)
2KI 16:5; ; **ISA 7:1**

Israel conquered by Assyria, and her inhabitants exiled (722 B.C.)
2KI 17:3-17:6 parallel **2KI 18:9-18:11**

Centres of worship in Israel

The calf idols in Bethel and Dan
1KI 12:26-12:33 See also **2KI 10:29**

Worship of Baal and Asherah in the capital, Samaria
1KI 16:32-16:33

Gilgal was also a centre of worship
 See also **HOS 12:11**

Condemnation of Israel's way of life

Israel's worship condemned
AMO 4:4-4:5 Amos' language here is full of irony. See also **HOS 8:11-8:13**; **AMO 5:21-5:24**

The corruption of Israel's priests condemned
HOS 6:9 See also **HOS 4:6-4:9**

Israel's unfaithfulness to God condemned
HOS 5:7 See also **2KI 17:7-17:23**; **HOS 4:10-4:13**

Prophetic condemnation of sin in Israel
HOS 4:1-4:2 See also **HOS 6:11-7:2**; **AMO 2:6-2:8**, **AMO 5:12**

Israel condemned for looking to foreign nations for help instead of to God
HOS 11:12-12:1 See also **HOS 5:13-5:15**, **HOS 7:8-7:11**, **HOS 8:9-8:10**

God's attitude to the northern kingdom of Israel

God's call to Israel to repent
HOS 14:1-14:2 See also **HOS 10:12**; **AMO 5:4-5:6**

God's attempt to call Israel back through hardship
1KI 17:1 See also **AMO 4:6-4:11**

God's rejection of Israel
HOS 1:6 See also **2CH 25:5-25:7**; **HOS 1:8-1:9**

God's punishment of Israel
AMO 5:26-5:27 See also **HOS 10:5-10:8**; **AMO 3:11-3:12**

God's intention to restore Israel
HOS 1:10 See also **HOS 2:23**, **HOS 14:4-14:8**; **AMO 9:11-9:15**

7236: Israel, as united kingdom

The 12 tribes proclaimed Saul as their first king in 1050 B.C., and remained united under David and Solomon, until the rebellion of the ten northern tribes in 930 B.C.

Israel's request for a king

Israel requested a king because it had been governed by corrupt judges
1SA 8:1-8:5

Israel requested a king to be like the other nations
1SA 8:19–8:20

Israel requested a king because of the threat from Ammon
1SA 12:12

Israel's request for a king seen as a rejection of God
1SA 8:6–8:7 See also 1SA 10:19, 1SA 12:16–12:19

Israel under Saul (1050–1010 B.C.)

Israel oppressed by the Philistines
1SA 13:19–13:20

Saul chosen as Israel's deliverer
1SA 10:1 See also 1SA 10:17–10:25, 1SA 11:14–11:15

Israel victorious under Saul
1SA 14:47–14:48 See also 1SA 11:11–11:13, 1SA 15:7–15:8

Israel's war with the Philistines
1SA 14:52 See also 1SA 13:5–13:7, 1SA 14:20–14:23, 1SA 17:51–17:53

The popularity of David in Israel
1SA 18:30 See also 1SA 18:6–18:9

Israel defeated by the Philistines, and the death of Saul
1SA 31:1–31:10 parallel 1CH 10:1–10:10

Israel under David (1010–970 B.C.)

Civil war in Israel between David and Ish-Bosheth, Saul's son
2SA 3:1 See also 2SA 2:8–2:17

David appointed king over Israel
2SA 5:1–5:3 parallel 1CH 11:1–11:3 See also 1SA 16:1

David makes Jerusalem the capital of Israel
2SA 5:6–5:10 parallel 1CH 11:4–11:9

Israel victorious under David
See also 2SA 8:1–8:14 parallel 1CH 18:1–18:13

Officials in Israel under David
2SA 8:15–8:18 parallel 1CH 18:14–18:17; ; 2SA 20:23–20:26

Civil war in Israel between David and his son Absalom
2SA 15:10–15:12, 2SA 18:1–18:8

God's judgment on Israel during David's reign
2SA 21:1, 2SA 24:1–24:16 parallel 1CH 21:1–21:15

All Israel contributes in preparation for the building of the temple
1CH 29:6–29:9

Israel under Solomon (970–930 B.C.)

Officials in Israel under Solomon
1KI 4:1–4:19

Prosperity of Israel under Solomon
1KI 10:27 parallel 2CH 1:15 See also 1KI 4:20–4:25

Israel's trade relations under Solomon
1KI 10:22 parallel 2CH 9:21 See also 1KI 5:8–5:12 parallel 2CH 2:11–2:16; 1KI 10:11–10:12 parallel 2CH 9:10–9:11; 1KI 10:28–10:29 parallel 2CH 9:28

Solomon's building programme in Israel
1KI 6:1–6:37 parallel 2CH 3:1–3:14; ; 1KI 7:1–7:12, 1KI 9:17–9:19 parallel 2CH 8:1–8:5

Solomon puts Israelites to forced labour
1KI 5:13–5:18

Division in Israel (930 B.C.)

Opposition to Solomon
1KI 11:14–11:26

Israel divided because of its apostasy
1KI 11:29–11:33

Rebellion in Israel against forced labour
1KI 12:1–12:19 parallel 2CH 10:1–10:19

7239: Jerusalem

The city in southern Palestine, situated in the Judean hills, around 20 miles west of the Dead Sea. Established as the Israelite capital by David, it remained the capital of Judah from the reign of Rehoboam until its destruction by the Romans in A.D. 70.

7240: Jerusalem, history of

Jerusalem was originally a Jebusite city, occupied by Israel at the time of David. At this stage, it became the capital city of Israel. Following the disintegration of the united kingdom, the city became the capital of the southern kingdom of Judah.

Pre-Israelite Jerusalem

Inhabited by Jebusites
JDG 19:9–19:12 See also GEN 10:15–10:16, GEN 15:18–15:21; EXO 3:7–3:8, EXO 23:23, EXO 34:11; NUM 13:29; DEU 7:1–7:2; JOS 3:10, JOS 9:1–9:2, JOS 10:1–10:7, JOS 15:7–15:8, JOS 18:28

Israelites unable to occupy Jerusalem
JOS 15:63 See also JDG 1:4–1:8 Although the men of Judah defeated the Jebusites in this battle, their victory was not sufficient to conquer them nor to gain permanent control over the city; JDG 1:21

Jerusalem conquered by David**1CH 11:4–11:9** parallel 2SA 5:6–5:10**Jerusalem as the site of the ark**

See also 2SA 6:12–6:19 parallel 1CH 15:25–16:3

Jerusalem capital city of David and Solomon**2SA 5:4–5:5** See also 2SA 9:13, 2SA 11:1, 2SA 12:29–12:31 parallel 1CH 20:1–20:3; 2SA 14:23–14:24, 2SA 15:13–15:14; 1KI 2:10–2:12, 1KI 2:36–2:45, 1KI 3:1, 1KI 8:1, 1KI 10:1–10:5, 1KI 10:26–10:27, 1KI 11:41–11:43**Jerusalem capital of the southern kingdom****1KI 14:21** See also 1KI 12:16–12:19 parallel 2CH 10:16–10:19; 1KI 12:25–12:27, 1KI 15:9–15:10, 1KI 22:42 parallel 2CH 20:31; 2KI 8:16–8:17 parallel 2CH 21:5; 2KI 12:1 parallel 2CH 24:1; 2KI 15:1–15:2 parallel 2CH 26:3; 2KI 18:1–18:2 parallel 2CH 29:1; 2KI 18:13–18:35 parallels 2CH 32:9–32:19, ISA 36:1–36:22; 2KI 21:1 parallel 2CH 33:1; 2KI 23:31–23:33 parallel 2CH 36:2–36:3**Jerusalem conquered by the Babylonians****2KI 24:18–25:12** parallels 2CH 36:11–36:20, JER 39:1–39:10, JER 52:1–52:16**The rebuilding of Jerusalem**

See also 2CH 36:23; EZR 1:1–1:4; NEH 2:1–6:19

Jerusalem capital of Persian province of Judah**NEH 1:1–1:3** See also EZR 3:1, EZR 4:4–4:6, EZR 10:7; NEH 13:6–13:7, NEH 13:15–13:16**Jerusalem in NT times****MAT 2:1–2:3** See also MAT 3:1–3:6 parallel MRK 1:3–1:5; MAT 4:25, MAT 15:1 parallel MRK 7:1; LUK 2:22, LUK 2:41, LUK 4:9; JHN 11:55; ACT 9:1–9:2, ACT 25:1–25:3**Prophetic warning of the destruction of Jerusalem****LUK 21:20–21:24** See also LUK 23:26–23:31**7241: Jerusalem, significance of**

Chosen by God as the location for his sanctuary, Jerusalem was his symbolic dwelling and became the only acceptable place for sacrificial worship. It retained its symbolic significance in NT times when it came to represent the hope of restoration and renewal for the people of God.

Jerusalem chosen by God**1KI 11:32** See also 1KI 8:44–8:51 parallel 2CH 6:34–6:39; 1KI 11:36, 1KI 14:21 parallel 2CH 12:13; 2KI 23:27; NEH 1:8–1:9**The ark of the covenant brought to Jerusalem****1CH 15:1–15:3** See also 2SA 6:1–6:19 parallel 1CH 15:25–16:3**The temple located in Jerusalem****2CH 3:1** See also 1CH 6:31–6:32; 2CH 20:27–20:28, 2CH 33:7, 2CH 36:14, 2CH 36:22–36:23 parallel EZR 1:1–1:3; PSA 68:28–68:29; MRK 11:11, MRK 11:15–11:16; LUK 2:41–2:51, LUK 4:9; ACT 22:13–22:18**Jerusalem the only acceptable place for sacrificial worship****DEU 12:1–12:7** See also DEU 12:20–12:28; 1KI 12:26–13:3, 1KI 14:22–14:24, 1KI 22:42–22:43 parallel 2CH 20:31–20:33; 2KI 12:1–12:3, 2KI 16:1–16:4 parallel 2CH 28:1–28:4; 2KI 23:1–23:20 parallel 2CH 34:29–34:32; 2CH 30:1–31:1; ISA 66:20; HOS 10:8; JHN 4:20–4:21**Jerusalem referred to as God's dwelling-place****PSA 135:21** See also ISA 24:23, ISA 31:9; JER 3:17**Personification of Jerusalem****ISA 52:1–52:2** See also PSA 147:12; ISA 3:8, ISA 40:2, ISA 41:27, ISA 52:9, ISA 62:6–62:7; JER 2:1–2:2, JER 4:14, JER 6:8, JER 13:9, JER 13:26–13:27, JER 15:5; LAM 1:17, LAM 2:13–2:15; EZK 5:8, EZK 16:1–16:63, EZK 23:1–23:49; ZEP 3:14–3:17; ZEC 9:9–9:10; MAT 23:37–23:39 parallel LUK 13:34–13:35**Jerusalem the place of Jesus Christ's triumphal entry**

LUK 19:28–19:38

Jerusalem the place of Jesus Christ's death and resurrection

LUK 23:26–23:49, LUK 24:1–24:12, LUK 24:13–24:33

The outpouring of the Holy Spirit in Jerusalem**ACT 1:4–1:9** See also ACT 2:1–2:21**Jerusalem the administrative centre of the church****ACT 8:1** See also ACT 8:14, ACT 8:25, ACT 11:1–11:22, ACT 11:27, ACT 12:25, ACT 13:13, ACT 15:1–15:29, ACT 16:4; 1CO 16:1–16:3; GAL 1:15–1:19, GAL 2:1–2:10**The new Jerusalem****REV 21:1–21:5** See also EZK 48:30–48:35; GAL 4:25–4:26; HEB 12:18–12:24; REV 3:11–3:13, REV 21:9–21:27**7245: Judah, kingdom of**

The southernmost of the two kingdoms into which Israel split after the death of Solomon. It was ruled by a series of Davidic kings until the sixth century B.C., when it became a province of the Babylonian empire.

Origin of the kingdom of Judah

1KI 12:1–12:24 parallel 2CH 10:1–11:4

Loss of the wealth amassed in Judah

1KI 14:25–14:26 parallel 2CH 12:9 See also 1KI 15:18–15:19 parallel 2CH 16:2–16:3; 2KI 12:17–12:18, 2KI 14:14 parallel 2CH 25:24; 2KI 16:8 parallel 2CH 28:21; 2KI 18:14–18:16; 2CH 24:23

Apostasy in Judah

1KI 14:22–14:24 See also 2KI 8:16–8:19 parallel 2CH 21:5–21:7; 2KI 16:10–16:16, 2KI 21:2–21:16 parallel 2CH 33:2–33:10; 2CH 28:22–28:23

Religious revival in Judah

2KI 18:2–18:7 parallels 2CH 29:1–29:2, 2CH 31:1, 2CH 31:20–31:21 See also 2KI 12:1–12:16 parallel 2CH 24:1–24:14; 2KI 23:1–23:25; 2CH 34:1–34:13, 2CH 34:29–34:33, 2CH 29:1–31:1, 2CH 35:1–35:19

The reign of Athaliah in Judah

2KI 11:1–11:16 parallel 2CH 22:10–23:21

Coalitions between Judah and Israel

2KI 8:28–8:29 parallel 2CH 22:5–22:6 See also 1KI 22:1–22:5 parallel 2CH 18:1–18:3; 2KI 3:4–3:7

War in Judah

With Israel

1KI 15:6 See also 1KI 14:30 parallel 2CH 12:15; 1KI 15:16–15:17 parallel 2CH 16:1; 2KI 14:8–14:14 parallel 2CH 25:17–25:24; 2KI 16:5

With other nations

2KI 14:7 See also 2KI 8:20–8:22 parallel 2CH 21:8–21:10; 2KI 18:8, 2KI 18:13–19:36 parallels 2CH 32:9–32:19, ISA 36:1–36:22; 2CH 21:16–21:17, 2CH 25:11–25:12, 2CH 28:17–28:18

Judah's loss of independence and change of status from kingdom to province

2KI 25:1–25:12 parallels 2CH 36:17–36:20, JER 39:1–39:10 See also 2KI 25:22–25:24 parallel JER 40:7–40:9

7248: patriarchs

The patriarchs: Abraham, Isaac, Jacob and his twelve sons

HEB 7:4 See also JHN 7:22; ACT 7:8–7:9; ROM 9:5, ROM 11:28, ROM 15:8

David also called a patriarch

ACT 2:29

7251: pillar of cloud and fire

A physical manifestation of the presence of God among his people; a special form of theophany particularly associated with Israel being offered guidance on the exodus journey.

Functions of the pillar of cloud and fire

To lead Israel

EXO 13:21–13:22 See also EXO 40:36–40:37; NUM 9:17, NUM 14:14; NEH 9:12, NEH 9:19

To separate and protect Israel from the armies of Egypt

EXO 14:19–14:20 This was just before the crossing of the Red Sea.

To represent God's presence, especially to Moses

EXO 33:9 See also NUM 12:5–12:6; DEU 31:15–31:16; PSA 99:7

Effects of the pillar of cloud and fire

It evoked worship

EXO 33:10

It caused the nations to speak of God

NUM 14:14

Experiencing the cloud did not guarantee acceptance by God

1CO 10:1–10:5

7254: plumb-line

A cord weighted with lead that is used in building to check that vertical structures are true. It is used symbolically to refer to the divine standard against which God, the builder of his people, tests and judges them. It also symbolises the standards by which God will rebuild his people.

The plumb-line as the measuring tool of a structure

ZEC 1:16, ZEC 4:9–4:10 Using the plumb-line Zerubbabel will carry out his God-given task of building the temple. See also JER 31:38–31:40; ZEC 2:1–2:2

God's plumb-line reveals the nation's failure

Although built true, Israel has become corrupt

AMO 7:7–7:8 See also ISA 1:21–1:24, ISA 5:1–5:2, ISA 5:7, ISA 59:14

God's testing brings judgment

2KI 21:13 See also ISA 34:11; LAM 2:8

God will rebuild his people

God's promise to rebuild Israel

JER 31:4 See also PSA 69:35–69:36, PSA 147:2; ISA 54:11–54:12

They will be rebuilt true to God's plumb-line

ISA 28:16–28:17 See also PSA 51:18–51:19; ISA 1:25–1:26; PSA 89:14, PSA 97:2, PSA 99:4; ISA 16:5

7257: promised land, the

The territory of the Canaanite nations given by God to Abraham and his descendants as part of his covenant with them.

7258: promised land, early history of

The promise of a homeland, made to Abraham, began to unfold through Moses and Joshua. Moses taught that the land was to be held in trust by God's people, obedience to God's ways bringing blessing in the land and disobedience bringing his judgment.

The location of the promised land

GEN 15:18–15:21 See also NUM 34:1–34:12; DEU 7:1

Traditional descriptions of the promised land

EXO 3:17 See also NUM 13:26–13:27; DEU 8:7–8:8; JER 32:22; EZK 20:6

The promised land and Abraham

The covenant with Abraham

GEN 15:7–15:21 See also GEN 13:14–13:17, GEN 17:7–17:8

The promised land given to Abraham's descendants

GEN 12:7 See also GEN 17:8, GEN 24:7; EXO 33:1

A burial plot was Abraham's only earthly possession in the promised land

GEN 25:9–25:10 See also GEN 23:3–23:20

The promised land and the patriarchs

GEN 26:2–26:5 See also GEN 28:12–28:15, GEN 35:11–35:12, GEN 50:24–50:25

Later generations look back to the promise made to the patriarchs

DEU 1:8 See also EXO 32:13–32:14; DEU 6:20–6:23; NEH 9:7–9:8; PSA 105:8–105:11 parallel 1CH 16:15–16:18

The promised land and Moses

Moses is called to lead Israel into the promised land

DEU 10:11 See also EXO 3:16–3:17, EXO 6:1–6:8; NUM 11:12

A whole generation is not permitted to enter the promised land

JOS 5:6 See also NUM 14:20–14:38, NUM 32:9–32:13; PSA 106:24–106:27

Moses and Aaron are not permitted to enter the promised land

NUM 20:12 See also NUM 20:23–20:29, NUM 27:12–27:14; DEU 32:48–32:52, DEU 34:1–34:4

Moses' instructions to destroy the inhabitants of the land and their practices

DEU 7:16 See also NUM 33:50–33:53; DEU 7:1–7:6, DEU 12:2–12:3, DEU 18:9–18:12

The instructions for distributing the promised land

NUM 33:54 See also NUM 34:13–34:15, NUM 36:5–36:9; JOS 14:1–14:5; PSA 78:55

Obedience to the law was a condition for enjoying the blessings of the promised land

DEU 6:1–6:3 See also EXO 20:12 parallel DEU 5:16; LEV 26:3–26:12; DEU 6:17–6:19, DEU 7:12–7:15, DEU 11:8–11:15, DEU 28:1–28:8; JER 11:1–11:5

Warnings not to forget God and follow Canaanite ways

DEU 11:16–11:17 See also EXO 34:12–34:16; LEV 18:1–18:5; NUM 33:55–33:56; DEU 8:10–8:14, DEU 28:15–28:19; JOS 23:14–23:16

Laws concerning the land

LEV 25:23–25:24 The promised land is seen as belonging to God. See also EXO 23:10–23:11; LEV 25:1–25:7, LEV 25:8–25:13; NUM 35:33–35:34

The promised land and Joshua

Joshua is called to lead the Israelites into the promised land

DEU 31:7–31:8 See also DEU 3:28; JOS 1:1–1:6

The Israelites enter the promised land and begin to possess it

JOS 3:14–3:17, JOS 11:16–11:23, JOS 21:43

God's people are given rest

JOS 21:44–21:45 See also DEU 12:10; JOS 1:13–1:15

7259: promised land, later history of

Established firmly in the land under David and Solomon, God's people ultimately began to neglect the terms of the covenant and were warned by the prophets of the consequent judgment and exile.

Israel's failure to take full possession of the promised land under the judges

JDG 1:19 See also JDG 1:27–1:35, JDG 2:1–2:3, JDG 18:1

Israel was finally established in the promised land under David and Solomon

1CH 22:18 See also 2SA 7:10–7:11 parallel 1CH 17:9–17:10; 1KI 4:21, 1KI 4:25

The promised land and the prophets

The prophetic condemnation of the life of God's people in the promised land

JER 2:7 See also JER 3:1–3:3; EZK 22:23–22:29; HOS 4:1–4:3

Prophetic warning of coming judgment on the land and exile from it

ISA 13:9 See also ISA 8:6–8:8; JER 10:17–10:18, JER 16:10–16:13; EZK 7:2–7:4; AMO 7:17

Prophetic assurance of ultimate deliverance and restoration to the promised land

JER 30:3 See also ISA 14:1–14:2, ISA 60:15–60:22; JER 24:5–24:7; EZK 11:17, EZK 37:11–37:14; AMO 9:14–9:15; ZEC 2:10–2:12

The desolation of the promised land

By Antiochus Epiphanes

DAN 8:9–8:14 The growing horn is Antiochus Epiphanes who tried to wipe out the Jewish faith in 168 B.C., forbidding Jewish practices and defiling the temple with pagan sacrifices and prostitution. See also DAN 11:29–11:35 The help that would be received by God's people probably refers to the Maccabean revolt and the cleansing of the temple in 165 B.C., although by NT times the land would be occupied by Rome.

By Rome

LUK 21:20–21:24 parallels MAT 24:15–24:21, MRK 13:14–13:19 Jesus Christ prophesies the desolation of the nation by Rome in A.D. 70.

The promised land in the NT

Referred to by Stephen

See also ACT 7:3–7:7, ACT 7:45–7:47

Referred to by Paul

ACT 13:16–13:19

Referred to by Hebrews

HEB 11:8–11:10 Abraham was looking for a more permanent city than the promised land could ever provide; ; HEB 11:13–11:16

The concept of spiritual rest

HEB 3:18–4:11

The church looks beyond the promised land

ACT 1:6–1:8 The apostles' concern was for the deliverance of the promised land from Roman domination, but Jesus Christ shows God's concern to be far wider,

to all nations. See also REV 5:9–5:10, REV 7:9–7:17, REV 21:9–21:27

7263: theocracy

The form of government among the early Israelites in which God was their supreme ruler, and his laws their laws.

The covenant at Sinai established the theocracy

EXO 19:5–19:6 See also EXO 19:8, EXO 24:3, EXO 24:7–24:8; DEU 5:27

Moses and Joshua renewed the theocratic covenant

DEU 26:16–26:19, DEU 29:9–29:15; ; JOS 24:24–24:25

Under the theocracy God was the Israelites' supreme ruler

DEU 33:5 "Jeshurun" means "the upright one", i.e., Israel. See also NUM 23:21; DEU 33:26; JDG 8:23; PSA 145:1

In the theocracy Israel was governed by God's laws

EXO 20:1–20:17 parallel DEU 5:6–5:21; ; EXO 21:1; ; DEU 4:1–4:2, DEU 4:13–4:14, DEU 17:18–17:19, DEU 31:12–31:13; ; JOS 1:7–1:8

Israel rejected the theocracy

1SA 8:7 See also 1SA 8:19, 1SA 10:19, 1SA 12:12

7266: tribes of Israel

The divisions of Israel on lines of kinship, according to descent from the twelve sons of Jacob. These divisions were most pronounced in the period before Saul became king of Israel but were maintained throughout Israel's history.

Origin of the tribes of Israel

Twelve sons of Jacob

GEN 35:22–35:26 See also GEN 29:31–29:35, GEN 30:3–30:13, GEN 30:17–30:24, GEN 35:16–35:18

Increased in number while living in Egypt

GEN 46:5–46:27 See also EXO 1:1–1:7

Blessings on the tribes of Israel

GEN 49:1–49:28; ; DEU 33:1–33:29

Association of the twelve apostles with the tribes of Israel

MAT 19:28 See also MAT 10:1–10:4 parallels MRK 3:13–3:19, LUK 6:12–6:16; LUK 22:28–22:30; ACT 1:12–1:26; REV 21:12–21:14

Other NT references to the tribes of Israel

JAS 1:1 See also ACT 26:6–26:7

The tribes of Israel in end-time prophecy

REV 7:1–7:8 See also EZK 47:13–47:14, EZK 48:1–48:35; REV 21:9–21:14

The tribe of Asher

The genealogy of Asher

GEN 46:17 See also NUM 26:44–26:47; 1CH 7:30–7:40

The history of Asher

In the wilderness: NUM 1:40–1:41, NUM 10:25–10:28; DEU 27:12–27:13; ; JOS 19:24–19:31; ; JDG 7:22–7:23; 2CH 30:6–30:11; ; LUK 2:36–2:38

The tribe of Benjamin

The genealogy of Benjamin

GEN 46:21 See also NUM 26:38–26:41; 1CH 7:6–7:12, 1CH 8:1–8:40, 1CH 9:1–9:9

The history of Benjamin

In the wilderness: NUM 1:36–1:37, NUM 2:18–2:23; DEU 27:12; ; JOS 18:11–18:28; ; 1CH 12:1–12:2; JDG 19:1–21:23 the war against Benjamin; 1KI 12:21–12:24 parallel 2CH 11:1–11:4; ; 2CH 11:5–11:12; ; EZR 1:5

The tribe of Dan

The genealogy of Dan

NUM 26:42–26:43

The history of Dan

In the wilderness: NUM 1:38–1:39, NUM 2:25, NUM 10:25; DEU 27:12–27:13; ; JOS 19:40–19:47; ; JDG 18:1–18:31

The tribe of Ephraim

The tribe of Ephraim was descended from Joseph's younger son

JOS 14:4 See also GEN 48:1–48:20

The genealogy of Ephraim

NUM 26:35–26:37 See also 1CH 7:20–7:29

The history of Ephraim

In the wilderness: NUM 1:32–1:33, NUM 2:18; JOS 16:1–16:10, JOS 17:14–17:18; ; JDG 1:29, JDG 7:22–8:3; JDG 12:1–12:6 the war against Ephraim

Later prophecies against Ephraim

ISA 7:2–7:9

The tribe of Gad

The genealogy of Gad

GEN 46:16 See also NUM 26:15–26:18

The history of Gad

In the wilderness: NUM 1:24–1:25, NUM 2:10–2:14; NUM 32:28–32:36; ; DEU 3:12–3:17, DEU 29:7–29:8; ; JOS 13:24–13:28; JOS 1:12–1:18, JOS 4:10–4:13, JOS 22:1–22:34; ; 1CH 5:18–5:22; 1CH 5:25–5:26, 1CH 12:37

The tribe of Issachar

The genealogy of Issachar

GEN 46:13 See also NUM 26:23–26:25; 1CH 7:1–7:5

The history of Issachar

In the wilderness: NUM 1:28–1:29, NUM 2:3–2:6; DEU 27:12; ; JOS 19:17–19:23; ; JDG 10:1; 1CH 12:38–12:40; ; 2CH 30:10–30:20

The tribe of Judah

The genealogy of Judah

NUM 26:19–26:22 See also GEN 46:8–46:12; 1CH 2:1–4:23

The tribe of Judah in the wilderness

NUM 1:26–1:27 See also NUM 2:3–2:4, NUM 13:1–13:6, NUM 34:16–34:19; DEU 27:11–27:12, DEU 33:7

Judah was prominent among the tribes

GEN 49:8–49:12 See also NUM 2:1–2:9, NUM 7:10–7:17, NUM 10:11–10:14; JDG 1:1–1:20

The territory of the tribe of Judah

JOS 18:5 See also JOS 11:21, JOS 15:1–15:63 the extent of the allotment for Judah; JOS 20:1–20:7 cities of refuge in Judah; JOS 21:1–21:4, JOS 21:9–21:16 1SA 17:1, 1SA 22:3–22:5, 1SA 23:21–23:23, 1SA 27:8–27:10, 1SA 30:11–30:16; 2SA 2:1, 2SA 24:5–24:7

Early evidence of the distinction between Judah and the other tribes

2SA 24:9 parallel 1CH 21:5 See also 1SA 11:8, 1SA 17:52, 1SA 18:16; 2SA 2:8–2:11, 2SA 3:9–3:10, 2SA 5:5 2SA 11:11, 2SA 12:8, 2SA 19:40–20:2 Judah remained loyal to David when Israel rebelled; 2SA 21:2, 2SA 24:11; 1KI 1:35, 1KI 4:20, 1KI 4:25

The separation of Judah from the northern tribes

1KI 12:1–12:24 parallel 2CH 10:1–11:4

The continuing tribal identity of Judah

2CH 19:8–19:11 See also 2KI 17:18–17:20; PSA 78:67–78:68; EZK 37:15–37:28, EZK 48:1–48:8, EZK 48:30–48:31; REV 7:1–7:8

The tribe of Levi

The genealogy of Levi

EXO 6:16–6:25; ; NUM 3:17–3:20, NUM 26:57–26:62

The tribe of Levi is set apart to God

EXO 32:25–32:29 Their loyalty to the LORD set them apart.; NUM 1:47–1:53, NUM 3:38

They were claimed by God as a substitute for the firstborn males of Israel

NUM 3:11–3:13 See also NUM 3:40–3:45, NUM 8:15–8:18

The tribe of Levi received no allotment of land

DEU 18:1–18:2 See also NUM 18:23; JOS 13:32–13:33, JOS 14:3–14:4

The tribe of Levi lived in designated towns

NUM 35:1–35:8 See also LEV 25:32–25:34; JOS 21:1–21:42 parallel 1CH 6:54–6:80

Tithes and offerings given by the rest of Israel supported the tribe of Levi

NUM 18:21–18:24 See also DEU 14:22–14:29; NEH 10:37–10:38, NEH 13:4–13:13

Moses blesses the tribe of Levi

DEU 33:8–33:11

The tribe of Levi in the period of the monarchy

1CH 12:26–12:28 Their fighting men join David at Hebron; ; 1CH 23:2–23:24 David divides them into three groups and organises their responsibilities; ; 1CH 27:16–27:17 David sets an army officer over them.

The tribe of Manasseh

The tribe of Manasseh was descended from Joseph's older son

JOS 14:4 See also GEN 48:3–48:20; NUM 26:28–26:37; 1CH 7:14–7:19

Manasseh in the wilderness

NUM 1:34–1:35 See also NUM 2:18–2:21, NUM 27:1–27:11, NUM 36:1–36:12

The division of Manasseh into two

The half-tribe of Manasseh was allocated territory in Gilead: NUM 32:33, NUM 32:39–32:42; ; DEU 3:13–3:15, DEU 29:7–29:8; ; JOS 12:4–12:6, JOS 13:29–13:31; ; 1CH 5:23; JOS 13:6–13:7, JOS 16:1–16:4, JOS 17:1–17:13; ; JDG 1:27; JOS 22:1–22:34 the threat of war against the half-tribe of Manasseh and the other Transjordan tribes

Manasseh in the period of the judges

JDG 7:23 See also JDG 6:11–6:16, JDG 6:33–6:35, JDG 11:1–11:11, JDG 12:1–12:7

Manasseh under the monarchy

1CH 5:26 See also 1CH 12:19–12:20, 1CH 26:32; 2CH 15:9, 2CH 30:1–30:20, 2CH 34:8–34:9

The tribe of Naphtali

The genealogy of Naphtali

GEN 46:24 See also NUM 26:48–26:50

The history of Naphtali

In the wilderness: NUM 1:42–1:43, NUM 2:25–2:30; DEU 27:12–27:13; ; JDG 1:33, JDG 4:4–4:10, JDG 6:33–6:35; 2KI 15:29; ; 1CH 12:38–12:40; ; 2CH 34:1–34:7

The territory of Naphtali

ISA 9:1 See also JOS 19:32–19:39; MAT 4:13–4:16

The tribe of Reuben

The genealogy of Reuben

NUM 26:5–26:7 See also GEN 46:8–46:9; EXO 6:14; 1CH 5:1–5:10

The history of Reuben

In the wilderness: NUM 1:20–1:21, NUM 2:10–2:16, NUM 16:1–16:3; NUM 32:1–32:38; ; DEU 3:12–3:17, DEU 29:7–29:8; ; JOS 13:15–13:23; JOS 1:12–1:18, JOS 4:10–4:13, JOS 22:1–22:34; ; 1CH 5:18–5:22; 1CH 5:25–5:26, 1CH 11:42, 1CH 12:37, 1CH 26:32, 1CH 27:16

The tribe of Simeon

The genealogy of Simeon

EXO 6:15 See also GEN 46:10; NUM 26:12–26:14; 1CH 4:24–4:37

The history of Simeon

In the wilderness: NUM 1:22–1:23, NUM 2:10–2:16; JOS 19:1–19:9; ; 1CH 4:38–4:43, 1CH 12:23–12:25; 2CH 15:9, 2CH 34:1–34:7

The tribe of Zebulun

The genealogy of Zebulun

GEN 46:14 See also NUM 26:26–26:27

The history of Zebulun

In the wilderness: NUM 1:30–1:31, NUM 2:3–2:9; DEU 27:12–27:13; ; JDG 1:30, JDG 4:6, JDG 4:9–4:10, JDG 5:13–5:14, JDG 5:18, JDG 6:33–6:35, JDG 12:11–12:12; 1CH 12:33, 1CH 12:40; ; 2CH 30:10–30:20

The territory of Zebulun

ISA 9:1 See also JOS 19:10–19:16; MAT 4:12–4:16

7269: Zion

The geographical and spiritual centre of life among God's people.

7270: Zion, as a place

Originally the name of the southernmost hill on which the Canaanite fortress-city of Jebus was located. It was conquered by David around 1000 B.C. and renamed Jerusalem. Situated on the borders of Judah and Israel, it became David's capital. As the city expanded, the name Zion came to be applied to the whole city.

The name of Zion**1CH 11:4–11:5** parallel 2SA 5:6–5:7**The early history of Zion****Early mention of Zion****GEN 14:18****Early attempts to take control of Zion****JOS 15:63** parallel JDG 1:21**Zion as the City of David****Considered an impregnable fortress in David's time****2SA 5:6** parallel 1CH 11:4–11:5 See also 2SA 5:8**Captured by David****2SA 5:7** parallel 1CH 11:4**Zion, established by David as his new capital and renamed****2SA 5:9** parallel 1CH 11:7**Further strengthened by David****1CH 11:8** parallel 2SA 5:9**The location of David's palace****2SA 5:11** parallel 1CH 14:1**The new resting place for the ark of the covenant****1CH 15:1–16:6** parallel 2SA 6:1–6:23**Zion as the name of the extended city of Jerusalem****ISA 33:20** See also 2KI 19:20–19:21 parallel ISA 37:21–37:22; ISA 4:3; LAM 1:4–1:8; JOL 2:32; ZEP 3:14–3:16**7271: Zion, as a symbol**

Central to the life of the nation of Israel, it became the symbol of the whole nation and was seen, especially by the prophets, as the focus of God's promises and his final victory. In the NT Zion is a symbol of the new Israel, the church.

Zion as the dwelling-place of God**PSA 135:21** See also PSA 76:2, PSA 132:13–132:14; JOL 3:17**Zion as a symbol of God's people****A symbol of Jerusalem****PSA 9:14** See also ISA 52:1–52:2; LAM 2:8–2:10; MIC 4:6–4:8; MAT 21:5 parallel JHN 12:15; ZEC 9:9**A symbol of Judah****PSA 78:68** See also JER 14:19**A symbol of Israel****LAM 2:1** See also ISA 46:13**Zion as the object of God's attention****The object of God's love****PSA 87:2** See also PSA 102:13–102:16**The object of God's blessing****PSA 133:3** See also PSA 132:13–132:16, PSA 147:12–147:14**The object of God's judgment****JER 26:18** See also MIC 3:12; ISA 1:8–1:9; JER 6:2–6:5, JER 6:22–6:23; JOL 2:1–2:2**Zion as the focus of God's presence and promises****The security of Zion because of God's presence****PSA 46:4–46:7** See also PSA 48:1–48:14, PSA 125:1–125:2; ISA 37:22–37:23 parallel 2KI 19:21–19:22; JOL 3:16**The restoration of Zion because of God's promises****JER 30:17–30:22** See also PSA 126:1–126:3; JER 29:10–29:14, JER 31:38–31:40; MIC 4:6–4:7**The salvation of Zion because of God's coming king and Saviour****ZEC 9:9–9:10** parallels MAT 21:5, JHN 12:15 See also ISA 62:11–62:12; MIC 4:8**Zion destined to be a city for all peoples****PSA 102:21–102:22** See also PSA 87:4–87:6; ISA 2:2–2:4 parallel MIC 4:1–4:3; ISA 56:3–56:7; ZEC 14:16**Zion as an NT symbol of the new Israel, the church****HEB 12:22–12:23** See also ROM 9:33; 1PE 2:6; ISA 8:14, ISA 28:16; HEB 11:16; REV 14:1**7300: Institutions and culture of OT**

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- 7366: freewill offering
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- 7372: hands, laying on of
- 7374: high places
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- 7382: house of God
- 7384: household gods
- 7386: incense
- 7388: kinsman-redeemer
- 7390: Levites
- 7392: lots, casting of
- 7394: memorial
- 7396: Most Holy Place
- 7398: New Moon festival
- 7400: New Year, the
- 7402: offerings
- 7404: ordinances
- 7406: Passover
- 7408: Pentecost
- 7410: phylactery
- 7412: priesthood
- 7416: purification
- 7418: Purim
- 7420: Rabbi
- 7422: ritual
- 7424: ritual law
- 7426: ritual washing
- 7428: Sabbath
- 7434: sacrifice
- 7438: sanctuary
- 7440: scapegoat
- 7442: shrine
- 7444: sin offering
- 7446: slavery
- 7452: snake, bronze
- 7454: sprinkling
- 7456: synagogue
- 7458: tabernacle, the
- 7462: tassel
- 7464: teachers of the law
- 7466: temples
- 7474: Tent of Meeting
- 7476: thank-offering
- 7478: washing
- 7480: wave offering
- 7482: Year of Jubilee

7302: altar

A construction, usually of wood, stone or metal, for the offering of sacrifice. The conflict between true and false religion often focused on altars, which were of key significance in biblical times.

Early altars built to the LORD

GEN 8:20 These early altars were erected at sites where God's presence or power had been experienced. GEN 12:7–12:8, GEN 13:18, GEN 22:9; GEN 26:25 by Isaac; GEN 33:20, GEN 35:7; EXO 17:15, EXO 24:4; JOS 8:30 by Joshua; ; JDG 6:24 by Gideon; ; JDG 21:4 by unnamed Israelites; ; 1SA 7:17 by Samuel; ; 1SA 14:35 by Saul; ; 2SA 24:25 parallel 1CH 21:26 by David

Solomon's temple altar

It was preceded by the tabernacle altar of burnt offering: EXO 27:1–27:8, EXO 30:1–30:10, EXO 37:25–37:28, EXO 38:1–38:7; ; HEB 9:3–9:4; 1KI 8:22, 1KI 6:20

OT pagan altars

A symptom of decline in the northern kingdom

1KI 16:32; ; 2KI 23:15; ; HOS 8:11, HOS 10:1

A symptom of decline in the southern kingdom

2KI 16:10 ignoring the command in Dt 12:2–3; ; 2KI 21:3; ; ISA 17:8; ; JER 11:13, JER 19:13; ; ZEP 1:5

Josiah's reform targeted illicit altars

2KI 23:12 See also DEU 7:5, DEU 12:8–12:14 Josiah was implementing the law requiring sacrifice to be offered only on the altar at the sanctuary of God's choice; 2KI 23:15–23:20

The altar in the second temple

EZR 3:2–3:3 See also EZR 7:17

Laws concerning the altar of burnt offering

Its construction

EXO 20:24–20:26 An earlier more basic form than in the tabernacle. No human hand was to shape the stones. See also EXO 27:1–27:8, EXO 38:1–38:7

Its use for the daily sacrifice

EXO 29:38–29:39 See also EXO 30:28; NUM 4:13, NUM 7:10, NUM 7:84

Its use for asylum

1KI 1:50–1:51 See also EXO 21:14; 1KI 2:28; AMO 3:14

Laws concerning the incense altar

Its construction

EXO 30:1–30:5 See also EXO 37:25–37:28

Its use

EXO 30:7 See also EXO 30:8–30:10; NUM 4:11

Altars in the NT

The Jerusalem temple altar

MAT 5:23–5:24 See also MAT 23:18–23:20; 1CO 9:13, 1CO 10:18; HEB 7:13, HEB 9:4

Pagan altars

ACT 17:23

The cross as an “altar”

HEB 13:10

Altars in heaven

REV 6:9 The lives of martyred saints are compared to the blood of offerings poured out at the base of the altar; **REV 8:3** The prayers of God’s people are like incense, offered to him on the heavenly altar. See also REV 9:13, REV 11:1, REV 14:18, REV 16:7

7304: anointing

The application of oil was associated with times of rejoicing and celebration. It also possessed a deeper significance, including that of being singled out by God for special favour or responsibilities.

Anointing as a social custom

In personal grooming

ECC 9:8 The associations here are of joy and well-being. See also RUT 3:3; PSA 92:10; ISA 57:9; AMO 6:6; MAT 6:17

Anointing guests as a mark of honour

PSA 23:5 See also LUK 7:36–7:39, LUK 7:44–7:47; JHN 12:3

Anointing corpses as a burial preparation

MRK 16:1 See also MAT 26:6–26:12; JHN 19:38–19:40

Anointing religious objects

EXO 40:9–40:11 Anointed objects are set apart (consecrated), to be used only in the performance of religious ceremonies. See also GEN 28:18; EXO 30:22–30:33

Anointing people for office

Priests

EXO 40:12–40:15 See also LEV 4:16, LEV 21:10–21:12; 1CH 29:22

Kings

1KI 1:39 See also 1SA 10:1, 1SA 16:12–16:13; 2SA 5:3; 2KI 11:12

A prophet

1KI 19:15–19:16 the only reference to the anointing of a prophet

Anointing people for other purposes

For purification

LEV 14:15–14:18

For healing

MRK 6:13 It has been suggested that anointing in a healing context may be related to the use of oil for medicinal purposes. See also JAS 5:14

The figurative use of anointing

Anointing by God

1SA 26:9 Israel’s king is frequently referred to as “the LORD’s anointed”. His physical anointing is seen as symbolising a divine anointing. The word “Messiah” literally means “the anointed one”; **ISA 45:1** Cyrus, as God’s agent for a specific task, is referred to as “his anointed”. See also 2SA 23:1; PSA 2:2, PSA 45:2, PSA 89:20; EZK 28:14

God’s people in the OT

1CH 16:22 parallel PSA 105:15

Christian believers

2CO 1:21–1:22 See also 1JN 2:20, 1JN 2:27 This anointing is not received in an outward ceremony but by sharing in the Holy Spirit’s anointing of Jesus Christ.

Jesus Christ as God’s Anointed One (the Messiah)

ACT 4:26–4:27 Jesus Christ’s receiving of the Holy Spirit at his baptism was his “anointing” for his Messianic work; **ACT 10:38** Note the link between anointing and the Holy Spirit. See also DAN 9:25–9:26; LUK 4:18; ISA 61:1; HEB 1:9

7306: ark of the covenant

A rectangular wooden box, overlaid with gold, measuring 3.75 x 2.25 x 2.25 feet (1.1 x 0.7 x 0.7 metres). It contains the Law tablets and symbolises God’s presence with his people.

Descriptions of the ark

EXO 25:22; ; LEV 16:2; ; NUM 10:33; ; JOS 3:6, JOS 4:5, JOS 4:9; ; 1SA 4:11

The construction of the ark

EXO 25:10–25:16; ; DEU 10:1; ; EXO 31:1–31:7, EXO 35:10–35:12, EXO 37:1–37:5; ; DEU 10:3; ; EXO 39:33, EXO 39:35, EXO 40:1–40:5, EXO 40:20–40:21

The construction of the atonement cover

EXO 25:17–25:21, EXO 26:34, EXO 30:6, EXO 37:6–37:9, EXO 39:35, EXO 40:20

The care of the ark

NUM 3:30–3:32, NUM 4:5; ; DEU 10:8, DEU 31:9

Major events in the history of the ark

The ark is taken to the promised land

JOS 3:3, JOS 3:6, JOS 3:15–3:16, JOS 6:4–6:16, JOS 8:33

The ark is the focus of the covenant renewal at Mount Ebal

JDG 20:26–20:28

The ark is captured by the Philistines

1SA 4:1–4:11, 1SA 4:17–4:22, 1SA 5:1–5:12

The ark is returned to Israel

1SA 6:1–6:3, 1SA 6:10–6:15, 1SA 6:19, 1SA 7:1–7:2

The ark is brought to Jerusalem

2SA 6:1–6:12 parallel 1CH 13:3–13:14; ; 2SA 6:17 parallel 1CH 16:1; ; 1CH 15:1, 1CH 16:37; ; 2SA 7:2–7:7 parallel 1CH 17:1–17:6; ; 2SA 15:24–15:25, 2SA 15:29 David is fleeing from Absalom.

The ark is placed in the temple

1KI 8:1–8:6 parallel 2CH 5:2–5:7

The ark in later Israelite history

2CH 35:3 The ark must have been moved from the temple.

The function of the ark

To contain the tablets of the Law

DEU 10:5 See also EXO 25:16, EXO 25:21, EXO 40:20; DEU 31:24–31:26; 1KI 8:9; HEB 9:4 The jar of manna and Aaron's rod were originally placed beside the ark (Ex 16:34; Nu 17:10), and were probably put inside it at a later date.

As the place where God reveals his commands to Moses

NUM 7:89 See also EXO 25:22, EXO 30:6, EXO 30:36

As a symbol of the presence of God

LEV 16:2 See also NUM 10:33–10:36; JOS 7:6; JDG 20:27; 2SA 7:2 parallel 1CH 17:1; 2CH 6:41 parallel PSA 132:8

Used on the Day of Atonement

LEV 16:13–16:15

The ark's holiness and effect

Irreverent treatment of the ark brings judgment

2SA 6:6–6:7 parallel 1CH 13:9–13:10 See also JOS 3:4; 1SA 5:1–5:4, 1SA 5:8–5:12, 1SA 6:19

The presence of the ark brings blessing

2SA 6:11 parallel 1CH 13:14

A restored Israel in which the ark has no place

JER 3:16

The ark in John's revelation

REV 11:19 The ark here symbolises the presence of God and is open and visible, not hidden in the Most Holy Place.

7308: Atonement, Day of

The most holy day of Israel's year (the tenth day of the seventh month) on which the high priest entered the Most Holy Place to offer sacrifices for the sins of the nation. Hebrews sees this day as symbolic of the achievements of Jesus Christ on the cross.

The priestly rituals on the Day of Atonement

The priest's own preparations

See also LEV 16:4, LEV 16:6, LEV 16:11–16:14

The preparation of two male goats

LEV 16:7–16:10; EXO 30:10; ; LEV 16:15–16:19; LEV 16:10, LEV 16:20–16:22

Concluding procedures

LEV 16:23–16:28

Additional offerings on the Day of Atonement

NUM 29:8–29:11

Features unique to the Day of Atonement

The priest entered the Most Holy Place

HEB 9:7 See also LEV 16:2

Sacrifice was made for all the sins of all the people

LEV 16:30 See also EXO 30:10; LEV 16:16–16:17, LEV 16:21–16:22, LEV 16:34

It was a festival requiring humility and fasting

NUM 29:7 This provides a contrast to all other religious festivals which were times of joyous celebration and feasting. "deny yourselves" includes the idea of fasting. See also LEV 16:29, LEV 16:31, LEV 23:27–23:32; ACT 27:9

The Day of Atonement is paralleled and contrasted with the achievements of Jesus Christ in his death

Jesus Christ entered the Most Holy Place

HEB 9:24 See also HEB 6:19–6:20, HEB 9:11–9:12

Jesus Christ's blood was offered in sacrifice

HEB 9:12 See also ROM 3:25

Jesus Christ's sacrifice was outside the city gates

HEB 13:11–13:12

Jesus Christ's sacrifice was once for all

HEB 9:25–9:26 See also HEB 10:12

Jesus Christ's sacrifice gives inner rather than ritual cleansing

HEB 9:13–9:14 See also HEB 9:9–9:10

Jesus Christ's sacrifice gives access to God

HEB 10:19–10:20 On the Day of Atonement no-one else was allowed to be in the Tent of Meeting, let alone in the Most Holy Place. Access into the intimate presence of God is now the right of all believers. See also LEV 16:17; MAT 27:51; EPH 2:18, EPH 3:12

7310: avenger of blood

The one responsible in OT law for carrying out the death penalty in the case of murder, usually, the murdered person's next of kin.

The responsibility of the avenger of blood

NUM 35:16–35:21 See also NUM 35:26–35:27; DEU 19:11–19:12

Protection from the avenger of blood

NUM 35:10–35:15 See also NUM 35:22–35:25; DEU 19:4–19:6; JOS 20:1–20:6

Examples of avenging of blood

GEN 4:24; ; 2SA 3:27, 2SA 14:11

God as an avenger of blood

DEU 32:43 See also JDG 9:23–9:24; 2KI 9:7; PSA 9:12, PSA 79:10; REV 6:10, REV 19:2

7312: Baal

Literally “master”, used to refer to a variety of local gods in the Near East, encountered by Israel in Canaan. In the later period, the word comes to refer especially to the local god of the city of Tyre (Baal Melgart), on account of the increasing importance of that city in the region.

The history of Baal worship

In the exodus period

NUM 25:3–25:5 A Moabite deity whose worship involved sexual immorality. See also NUM 22:41; DEU 4:3; PSA 106:28; HOS 9:10

In the time of the judges

JDG 2:12–2:13 Ashtoreth was the consort of Baal. See also JDG 3:7, JDG 6:31–6:32, JDG 8:33, JDG 10:6; 1SA 7:4, 1SA 12:10

In the time of Elijah

1KI 17:1 The proclamation of a drought and the contest on Carmel challenged the supposed power of Baal. See also 1KI 16:30–16:33, 1KI 18:18–19:1, 1KI 22:53; 2KI 10:18–10:29, 2KI 11:17–11:18

During the later monarchy in the north

HOS 2:2–2:13 Lovers are gods such as Baal. See also HOS 11:2, HOS 13:1

During the later monarchy in the south

2CH 28:1–28:2 The Judean kingdom copied the idolatry in the north. See also JER 2:8, JER 7:9; HOS 3:3

7314: blood

The symbol of life, which thus plays an especially important role in the sacrificial system of the OT. The shedding of the blood of a sacrificial animal represents the giving up of its life. The “blood of Christ” refers to Jesus Christ's obedient giving of his life, in order to achieve redemption and forgiveness.

7315: blood, as basis of life

Scripture treats blood as the basis of life, and regards the shedding of blood as representing the end of life.

Blood symbolises life

LEV 17:10–17:14 See also GEN 9:4–9:6; DEU 12:20–12:25; 2SA 23:15–23:17; PSA 72:14; JER 2:34; EZK 33:1–33:6; MAT 27:3–27:4; LUK 11:50–11:51 parallel MAT 23:35–23:36

Blood indicating violent death

GEN 4:8–4:11 See also GEN 9:6; JDG 9:22–9:24; 1KI 2:5–2:6, 1KI 2:28–2:34; 2KI 9:30–9:33

Shedding blood as a sin

EXO 20:13 parallel DEU 5:17 See also GEN 42:21–42:22; DEU 21:1–21:9; 2KI 21:16; PRO 1:10–1:19; ISA 26:21; MAT 15:18–15:19 parallel MRK 7:20–7:21; ROM 1:28–1:29

The eating of blood forbidden

LEV 3:17 See also LEV 7:26–7:27, LEV 17:10–17:14; DEU 12:23; 1SA 14:31–14:34; ACT 15:19–15:20, ACT 15:29

7316: blood, and OT sacrifices

The pouring out of animals' blood in sacrifice was God's provision, under the old covenant, for the atonement of sin.

God's provision of blood sacrifice to establish the old covenant

EXO 24:4–24:8 See also HEB 9:18–9:20

God's provision of blood sacrifices within the old covenant

Blood sacrifices and the priesthood

EXO 29:10–29:21 parallel LEV 8:14–8:24; ; LEV 9:8–9:14, LEV 16:1–16:14

Blood sacrifices and various offerings

LEV 1:1-1:17 the burnt offering, to gain favour or express devotion; ; LEV 3:1-3:17 the fellowship, or peace, offering, to express gratitude; ; LEV 4:1-4:35 the sin offering, to gain forgiveness; ; LEV 5:14-5:19 the guilt offering, where restitution was required; ; LEV 16:15-16:22 the Day of Atonement, for the cleansing of the nation from unintentional sin

Blood sacrifices and the Passover

EXO 12:1-12:14 See also 2CH 30:15-30:20, 2CH 35:1-35:19; EZR 6:19-6:21; MRK 14:12 parallel LUK 22:7-22:8

Blood sacrifices must come from animals without defect

LEV 22:17-22:25 See also EXO 12:5; LEV 1:3, LEV 3:1, LEV 4:3, LEV 5:15; NUM 28:9, NUM 28:11; DEU 15:21; EZK 43:22-43:27

Blood sacrifices must not come from human beings

2KI 23:10 See also 2KI 17:17, 2KI 21:1-21:6; EZK 20:25-20:26; MIC 6:7

The limited effect of blood sacrifices

They can become mere external ritual

ISA 1:11-1:13 See also ISA 66:2-66:4

They are worthless without obedience to God

HOS 6:6 See also 1SA 15:22-15:23; PSA 40:6-40:8; AMO 4:4-4:5, AMO 5:21-5:27

They are unable to cleanse the conscience

HEB 9:9-9:10 See also HEB 10:1-10:4

7317: blood, of Jesus Christ

The shedding of the blood of Jesus Christ is seen as representing the giving of his life as an atoning sacrifice for the sins of humanity.

The blood of Jesus Christ as part of his humanity

JHN 19:33-19:34 See also LUK 22:44; ACT 5:28; 1JN 5:6

The blood of Jesus Christ as a sacrifice

HEB 9:12-9:14, HEB 9:23-9:26, HEB 10:3-10:14, HEB 13:11-13:12

The blood of Jesus Christ as a symbol of atonement

ROM 3:25 See also EPH 1:7; REV 7:14

The effects of the blood of Jesus Christ

The institution of the new covenant

1CO 11:25 parallels MAT 26:27-26:28, MRK 14:23-14:24, LUK 22:20 See also HEB 9:11-9:15, HEB 12:24, HEB 13:20

Redemption

ACT 20:28; ; 1PE 1:1-1:2, 1PE 1:18-1:19; ; REV 5:9-5:10

Forgiveness and justification

ROM 5:9 See also MAT 26:28 parallels MRK 14:24, LUK 22:20; ROM 3:25-3:26

Victory over evil and Satan

REV 7:14-7:17, REV 12:10-12:11

Liberation from sin

REV 1:5-1:6

The promise of total restoration

COL 1:19-1:20

The blood of Jesus Christ and believers**Believers are cleansed from all sin**

HEB 9:14, HEB 10:22, HEB 13:12; ; 1JN 1:6-1:9

Believers have a new confidence before God

EPH 2:13; ; COL 1:19-1:22; ; HEB 10:19-10:22

The blood of Jesus Christ and the Lord's Supper**Invitations to share in the blood of Jesus Christ**

1CO 10:16 See also JHN 6:53-6:57

Warnings about sinning against the blood of Jesus Christ

1CO 11:27 See also HEB 10:28-10:31

7318: blood, as symbol of guilt

Blood is often used as an image of people's sin and guilt, and the judgment which follows. Blood-guilt is ascribed to those who are responsible for the shedding of innocent blood.

Blood as an image of sin and guilt

ISA 59:2-59:3 See also LEV 20:9-20:13, LEV 20:27; 2SA 1:14-1:16; ISA 1:15-1:18; NAM 3:1; ACT 18:6

Blood as an image of judgment

ISA 34:5-34:6 See also EXO 7:14-7:21; PSA 78:44, PSA 105:29; ACT 2:19-2:20; JOL 2:30-2:31

Blood as a sign of the end times

ACT 2:19-2:20 See also JOL 2:30-2:31; REV 6:12-6:15, REV 8:7-8:9, REV 16:3-16:6

Blood-guilt, the result of shedding innocent blood**Examples of blood-guilt**

GEN 4:8-4:11 See also 2SA 1:14-1:16, 2SA 4:5-4:12; EZK 35:5-35:9; HAB 2:12; MAT 27:3-27:8, MAT 27:24; ACT 5:28

The right to avenge blood-guilt under the law

DEU 19:11-19:13 See also NUM 35:16-35:28

Restraint to avoid further blood-guilt

DEU 4:41–4:42 See also GEN 4:15; NUM 35:6–35:34; DEU 19:4–19:10; JOS 20:1–20:9

Blood-guilt cannot be forgotten

GEN 9:5–9:6 See also GEN 4:10–4:16, GEN 42:22; 1KI 2:28–2:33; ISA 26:21; MAT 23:30–23:31

7320: breastpiece

A pouch worn on the chest of the high priest.

The breastpiece was worn by the high priest

LEV 8:5–8:9 See also EXO 28:15–28:16, EXO 28:29, EXO 39:8–39:9

It was adorned with twelve precious stones

EXO 28:17–28:21 See also EXO 25:3–25:7, EXO 39:10–39:14

It contained the Urim and Thummim

EXO 28:30 The Urim and Thummim were used in decision-making. See also LEV 8:8

It was attached to the ephod

EXO 28:22–28:28 See also EXO 39:15–39:21

7322: burnt offering

Probably the earliest and most basic form of sacrifice. It is seen fundamentally as a gift to God, either in thanksgiving for his goodness or for atonement for sin.

Hebrew names for the burnt offering

DEU 33:10 The rarer Hebrew expression means something whole or complete; **PSA 66:13** The commoner expression in Hebrew means that which “goes up” to God. See also 1SA 7:9; PSA 51:19

Early examples of burnt offerings

GEN 8:20 GEN 22:2–22:8, GEN 22:13; ; EXO 10:25, EXO 18:12, EXO 20:24, EXO 24:5; ; JOB 1:5

Regulations concerning the burnt offering**How the offering is to be made**

LEV 1:1–1:17, LEV 6:8–6:13, LEV 7:8 the entitlement of the priest; ; MAL 1:8

Occasions for making the offering

NUM 28:9–28:10 It was an additional offering on the Sabbath. EXO 29:38–29:42; ; EZR 3:3; LEV 8:18–8:21 at the ordination of priests; LEV 16:3, LEV 16:24; NUM 28:11–28:14 on the first of the month, the new moon; NUM 28:19, NUM 28:23; LEV 23:12, LEV 23:18; ; NUM 28:27; NUM 29:2, NUM 29:6; NUM 29:13; LUK 2:24 for purification after childbirth

Burnt offerings in idolatrous worship

EXO 32:6; ; 2KI 10:25

Warnings about misplaced confidence in the burnt offering

1SA 15:22 See also ISA 1:11–1:15; JER 7:21–7:22; HOS 6:6; AMO 5:25; MIC 6:6–6:8

NT references to the burnt offering**Jesus Christ endorsed the prophets’ teaching**

MRK 12:33–12:34 See also MAT 9:13, MAT 12:7

The holy life of Jesus Christ is the perfect burnt offering

HEB 10:5–10:10 See also HEB 10:14

7324: calf worship

A heathen (notably Egyptian and Canaanite) practice, in which statues of bull calves were worshipped as symbols of fertility and physical strength. Contrary to the second commandment this was copied by the Israelites and by Jeroboam after the division of the kingdom, in both cases incurring God’s wrath.

Aaron made a golden calf for the Israelites to worship**This act was born partly of impatience**

EXO 32:1–32:4 See also EXO 32:7–32:8; PSA 106:19–106:22; ACT 7:41

It was swiftly condemned

EXO 32:19–32:20 See also EXO 32:35; DEU 9:16–9:21; PSA 106:23

King Jeroboam initiated calf worship**As a matter of expediency**

1KI 12:26–12:30 See also 2KI 17:15–17:16; 2CH 11:14–11:15, 2CH 13:8

Jeroboam’s sin was one of the main reasons for the Assyrian captivity

2KI 17:18–17:28 See also HOS 8:4–8:9, HOS 10:5–10:6

Calf worship is detestable and useless

DEU 7:25; ; ISA 44:9–44:20, ISA 46:6–46:7; ; ROM 1:21–1:23

7326: cannibalism**God warns his people about cannibalism**

DEU 28:53; ; LEV 26:29; ; JER 19:9

Cannibalism as a result of God’s judgment on his disobedient people

2KI 6:24–6:29; ; LAM 2:20, LAM 4:10; ; EZK 5:10

7328: ceremonies

Formal outward practices and rituals symbolising or marking events of importance or spiritual significance. Although they had their place in biblical cultural life, they may become empty and hypocritical, losing their deep spiritual meaning. Ceremonies thus become symbolic of empty legalism which should be rejected.

Ceremonies marking important events

Different stages in life

GEN 50:7, GEN 50:10–50:11; ; EXO 13:2; ; JDG 14:10; ; JER 34:5; ; JHN 2:1–2:2, JHN 20:4

Temple worship

NEH 13:9 See also 1KI 9:25; 1CH 16:40; 2CH 8:13, 2CH 29:15PSA 5:7, PSA 118:19–118:20, PSA 138:2 ACT 3:1

Appointing leaders

ACT 13:2–13:3 See also LEV 8:30; 1SA 16:13; 1KI 1:39; ACT 6:5–6:6, ACT 9:17; 1TI 4:14

Historical events

RUT 4:7–4:8 See also GEN 35:14; EXO 12:14, EXO 13:9; JOS 4:4–4:9; 1SA 7:12; LUK 22:19 parallel 1CO 11:24–11:25

Ceremonies as spiritual symbols of God's presence

MAT 18:20 There is a sense in which any gathering of believers is ceremonially symbolic of God's presence. See also EXO 30:25–30:29; NUM 4:4, NUM 10:35–10:36 The ark of the covenant was a symbol of God's presence among his people. It, and its location, the tabernacle and later, the Most Holy Place, were therefore centres of the most elaborate ceremonies; 1KI 8:3–8:6 parallel 2CH 5:4–5:7; 1KI 8:29 parallel 2CH 6:20; 1CH 6:49; HEB 9:1–9:7

Initiation ceremonies

Circumcision

LEV 12:3 See also GEN 17:10; JOS 5:2; LUK 2:21–2:24

Baptism

MAT 28:19 See also ACT 2:38, ACT 16:33–16:34; 1PE 3:21

Ceremonies relating to ritual cleansing

EXO 30:18–30:20 See also LEV 14:14–14:18, LEV 16:26, LEV 22:6; NUM 19:7; HEB 9:10 Many aspects of ritual activity were added to the biblical ones in Jewish laws and regulations.

Ceremonies relating to atonement

LEV 17:11 See also LEV 4:20, LEV 8:30–8:35, LEV 16:10; HEB 5:1

Ceremonies conveying spiritual realities

Passover: a ceremony symbolising salvation history

LUK 22:15–22:16 See also 2KI 23:21–23:22; EZR 6:21–6:22; MAT 26:17 parallels MRK 14:12, LUK 22:7–22:9

Baptism: a ceremony symbolising new birth

JHN 3:5 See also ACT 10:48, ACT 22:16; GAL 3:27; COL 2:12

Marriage: a ceremony symbolising faithful partnership

MAT 19:6 parallel MRK 10:9; ; EPH 5:25–5:28; ; HEB 13:4; ; REV 19:7

Ceremonies which lapsed into hypocrisy

Washing ceremonies without accompanying inner cleanliness

MAT 23:25 See also MAT 23:27–23:28; MRK 7:4

Sacrificial ceremonies without inner repentance

AMO 5:21–5:22 See also 1SA 15:22; PSA 51:16–51:17; ISA 1:11–1:17; HOS 8:11–8:13; MAL 1:8

Initiation ceremonies without real commitment

1CO 7:19 See also ACT 15:1, ACT 15:8–15:10; ROM 2:28–2:29; GAL 5:6

Jesus Christ brings freedom from meaningless ceremonies

GAL 5:1 See also GAL 4:8–4:10; EPH 2:14–2:18; COL 2:13–2:23; HEB 7:18–7:19

7330: chief priests

A group of individuals in charge of temple worship in Jerusalem, and regarded as leading representatives of the Jewish people, who came into conflict with Jesus Christ and plotted his death.

OT references to the chief priest

2CH 19:11 See also 2KI 25:18 parallel JER 52:24 Seraiah2CH 24:6, 2CH 24:11 2CH 31:10 Azariah; EZR 7:5 Ezra was descended from Aaron the chief priest

The chief priests were in charge of temple worship in Jerusalem

MAT 2:4 They were expected to pronounce on matters of Jewish law and interpretation of Scripture; ; MAT 21:15 Temple discipline was their responsibility.

Jesus Christ predicted his suffering at the hands of the chief priests and elders

MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22 See also MAT 20:18 parallel MRK 10:33

The response of the chief priests to Jesus Christ

They were puzzled by Jesus Christ's teaching

MAT 21:23 parallels MRK 11:27–11:28, LUK 20:1–20:2
See also MAT 21:45–21:46 parallel LUK 20:19; JHN 7:32, JHN 7:45, JHN 11:47 As official representatives of the Jewish people, they feared the political repercussions of Jesus Christ's popularity.

They and the elders plotted Jesus Christ's death

MAT 26:3–26:5 parallel MRK 14:1 See also MAT 26:59 parallel MRK 14:55; MAT 27:1

They collaborated with Judas

MAT 26:14 parallels MRK 14:10, LUK 22:4; ; MAT 26:47 parallels MRK 14:43, LUK 22:52, JHN 18:3; ; MAT 27:3–27:6

The role of the chief priests in the trial of Jesus Christ

They made accusations against Jesus Christ

MAT 27:12 parallel MRK 15:3; ; LUK 22:66, LUK 23:10

They persuaded the crowd against Jesus Christ

MAT 27:20; ; LUK 23:4, LUK 23:13; ; JHN 19:6

They mocked Jesus Christ

MAT 27:41 parallel MRK 15:31

They handed Jesus Christ over to Pilate

MRK 15:10; ; LUK 24:20; ; JHN 18:35

They persuaded Pilate to have the tomb guarded

MAT 27:62–27:66

They bribed the soldiers

MAT 28:11–28:15

They rejected Jesus Christ as king

JHN 19:15, JHN 19:21

The chief priests' attempt to prevent the preaching of the gospel

By silencing the apostles

ACT 4:23, ACT 5:24

By authorising Paul to arrest believers

ACT 9:14, ACT 9:21, ACT 26:10, ACT 26:12

The involvement of the chief priests in the arrest and trial of Paul

ACT 22:30, ACT 23:14, ACT 25:2, ACT 25:15

7332: child sacrifice

Child sacrifice is unconditionally condemned in Scripture. The few cases in which it is known to have taken place are probably due to the influence of Israel's pagan neighbours.

Laws forbidding child sacrifice

LEV 18:21 Molech was the god of the Ammonites. See also EXO 22:29 to be interpreted with reference to Ex 13:12–16 and Ex 34:19,22; DEU 18:10

Instances of child sacrifice

2KI 3:27, 2KI 16:3 parallel 2CH 28:3; ; 2KI 17:17, 2KI 17:31, 2KI 21:6 parallel 2CH 33:6; ; 2KI 23:10 Josiah's reforms involved desecrating Topheth, where child sacrifices were offered; ; ISA 57:5; ; JER 7:31

Arguments against child sacrifice

Child sacrifice is the idolatrous practice of the nations

DEU 12:31 See also LEV 20:2–20:5; PSA 106:35–106:38; JER 32:35; HOS 13:2

It defiles God's people

EZK 20:26 See also EZK 20:31

It defiles God's sanctuary

EZK 23:37, EZK 23:39

It incurs God's anger

JER 19:4–19:5; ; EZK 16:20–16:21, EZK 16:36–16:37; ; HOS 13:2

God's unique command to Abraham to sacrifice Isaac

GEN 22:1–22:2 This was a test of obedience for Abraham. The following verses dispel any idea that God desires human sacrifice; ; HEB 11:17; JHN 3:16; ; ROM 8:32

7334: circumcision

The practice of cutting away the foreskin of male children, usually within a short time of birth. In the OT, the practice is seen as a sign of membership of the people of God. The NT makes it clear that Christians are under no obligation to be circumcised.

7335: circumcision, physical

In the OT, circumcision is seen as an outward sign of membership of Israel, the people of God.

The significance of circumcision in God's covenant with Abraham

GEN 17:10–17:14 See also ACT 7:8

Circumcision is also for Abraham's descendants

GEN 17:7

Circumcision as a sign of national identity

Dinah's brothers and the Shechemites: GEN 34:8–34:9, GEN 34:14–34:17; EXO 4:24–4:26; ; JOS 5:4–5:8

Circumcision is integrated into the Mosaic law

LEV 12:3; ; JHN 7:22 It was later sometimes forgotten that circumcision predated the Mosaic law.

Circumcision as an important Passover restriction

EXO 12:44, EXO 12:48–12:49; ; JDG 14:3 Some of Israel's neighbours practised circumcision, but not the Philistines.

Circumcision was not necessarily a sign of consecration to God

JER 9:25–9:26

NT accounts of circumcision practised in obedience to the law

LUK 1:59 John; ; LUK 2:21 Jesus Christ; ; JHN 7:23 Circumcision was permitted on the Sabbath; ; PHP 3:5 Paul refers to his own circumcision; ; ACT 16:3 Timothy

The subject of circumcision debated by the first Christians

ACT 10:45, ACT 11:2, ACT 15:5; ; GAL 2:3 That Titus, a Greek, was not required to be circumcised illustrates the change in the attitude of the church concerning the relevance of the law to Gentile believers; ; EPH 2:11; ; COL 3:11; ; TIT 1:10

7336: circumcision, spiritual

On its own, the physical sign of circumcision is no guarantee of finding favour in the sight of God. It was intended to be the outward sign of inward consecration and should be accompanied by repentance, faith and obedience. Paul stresses that circumcision confers no special privileges upon individuals; it is faith in God, rather than any outward sign, that ensures that believers stand in a right relationship to God.

Physical circumcision has no value without the obedience of the heart

DEU 30:6 See also DEU 10:14–10:16; JER 4:4 ROM 2:28–2:29 See also ROM 2:25–2:27; 1CO 7:19

Circumcision and faith

GAL 5:6 See also ROM 3:30

Abraham's righteousness depended on his faith, not on the covenant of circumcision

GAL 3:6; ; GEN 15:6; ; ROM 4:9–4:12

Paul values the law as part of God's plan

ROM 3:1–3:2

The sharp debate about circumcision for Christians**The Council of Jerusalem**

ACT 15:1–15:19

Jewish Christians in Jerusalem criticise Peter for accepting hospitality from Cornelius and his (uncircumcised) friends

ACT 11:1–11:3

God's acceptance of uncircumcised Gentiles is clear from the outpouring of the Holy Spirit upon them

ACT 10:44–10:46 See also ACT 10:34

Peter's misgivings about Gentile believers and the law

GAL 2:11–2:16 the dispute between Paul and Peter

Imposing circumcision upon Gentile Christians denies the freedom of the gospel

GAL 5:1–5:6 To insist on circumcision is to nullify the work of Jesus Christ on the cross. See also GAL 2:3–2:5, GAL 3:14

“Judaizers” should be resisted

GAL 5:7–5:12, GAL 6:12–6:13, GAL 6:15; ; PHP 3:2–3:3; ; TIT 1:10–1:11

To be “in Christ” is to be spiritually circumcised

COL 2:11–2:12 See also COL 3:11

Paul's confidence in Jesus Christ

PHP 3:4–3:9

The relationship between baptism and circumcision in the NT

COL 2:11–2:13 Both circumcision and baptism may each be described as a “seal”. Baptism signifies entry into the new covenant in the same way that circumcision marked initiation into the old; ; ROM 4:11 Abraham the father of all believers; ; 2CO 1:21–1:22; ; EPH 1:13

7338: cities of refuge

Cities set apart at the time of the conquest of Canaan as places of refuge for those who had killed people by accident.

7340: clean and unclean

The distinction between things which were ritually acceptable and unacceptable to God. Animals were classified as either clean or unclean, denoting their suitability or unsuitability for sacrifice and food. The motives and intentions of the heart were also sometimes judged to be clean or unclean, as uncleanness was often linked with sin.

The OT distinction between clean and unclean

The command to distinguish between clean and unclean

LEV 15:31 See also LEV 10:8–10:11, LEV 20:22–20:26; EZK 22:26, EZK 44:23

The distinction between clean and unclean animals

GEN 7:2 See also GEN 7:8–7:9, GEN 8:20; LEV 11:1–11:47 parallel DEU 14:3–14:20; LEV 27:11–27:13

The NT attitude to clean and unclean animals

MRK 7:14–7:23 parallel MAT 15:10–15:20; ; ACT 10:11–10:15, ACT 11:5–11:9

Places and inanimate objects could be clean or unclean

LEV 10:14 See also LEV 4:12, LEV 6:11, LEV 11:32–11:38, LEV 14:33–14:57; 2CH 13:11

Causes of uncleanness

Physical contact with anything unclean

LEV 5:2–5:3 See also LEV 7:19; HOS 9:3–9:4; HAG 2:10–2:14

Contact with corpses

NUM 19:11 See also LEV 21:1–21:4, LEV 21:10–21:12; NUM 6:5–6:8

Infectious skin diseases

LEV 13:1–13:46 See also LEV 14:1–14:32; MAT 8:2–8:4 parallels MRK 1:40–1:44, LUK 5:12–5:14

Certain bodily functions

LEV 12:2 See also LEV 12:5, LEV 15:1–15:33

Consequences of uncleanness

Exclusion from worship

LEV 22:3–22:5 See also LEV 12:4; NUM 9:6–9:12; 1SA 20:24–20:26; 2CH 23:19, 2CH 30:17

Isolation from God's people

NUM 5:2 See also LEV 7:20–7:21; DEU 23:10–23:11

Cleansing from uncleanness

LEV 16:29–16:30 See also LEV 12:6–12:8, LEV 16:15–16:16, LEV 22:4–22:7; NUM 6:9–6:12, NUM 19:1–19:22, NUM 31:21–31:24; HEB 9:13

Inner, spiritual cleanness and uncleanness

JOB 33:9; PSA 51:7 See also GEN 20:5; PSA 24:3–24:4; PRO 20:9; ISA 1:15–1:16, ISA 64:6; LAM 1:8; EZK 36:25; MAT 15:10–15:20 parallel MRK 7:14–7:23; MAT 23:25–23:28; ACT 10:28

7342: cleanliness

Careful, fastidious attention to personal hygiene, particularly important in the climate of the Near East. In Scripture, sin is associated with lack of cleanliness, whereas redemption and baptism are linked with washing.

Cleanliness through bathing

As part of general personal hygiene

RUT 3:1–3:3 See also JHN 13:10

For cleansing from uncleanness

LEV 17:15–17:16 See also LEV 14:8–14:9, LEV 15:13; 2KI 5:9–5:14

Cleanliness through washing feet

A customary practice after a journey

GEN 19:1–19:2 See also GEN 18:1–18:5, GEN 24:32, GEN 43:24; 1SA 25:40–25:42; 2SA 11:6–11:8; LUK 7:36–7:47

As a sign of humility and love

JHN 13:2–13:17 See also 1TI 5:9–5:10

Cleanliness through washing clothes

As part of general personal hygiene

ISA 7:3 See also 2KI 18:17 parallel ISA 36:2

For cleansing from uncleanness

LEV 11:40 See also EXO 19:10–19:11, EXO 19:14–19:15; LEV 13:6, LEV 16:26; NUM 8:7, NUM 19:21

Cleanliness through washing faces and hands

MAT 6:16–6:18 See also EXO 30:18–30:21, EXO 40:30–40:31; MAT 15:2

Cleanliness through washing infants at birth

EZK 16:4–16:5

Cleansing agents

JER 2:22 See also JOB 9:30–9:31; MAL 3:2

The Pharisees' concern with outer cleanliness to the exclusion of inner purity

MRK 7:1–7:23 parallel MAT 15:1–15:20 See also LUK 11:37–11:41

Cleanliness used metaphorically

Lack of cleanliness associated with sin

ZEC 3:1–3:7 See also ISA 4:4; MAT 12:43–12:45 parallel LUK 11:24–11:26

Cleanliness associated with righteousness and purity

REV 19:14 See also JER 4:14; EPH 5:25–5:27; TIT 3:4–3:7; JAS 4:8; REV 15:6, REV 19:8

Baptism compared to washing away sins**ACT 22:16** See also 1PE 3:21–3:22**7344: curtain**

Mentioned chiefly in relation to the construction of the tabernacle. The curtain which separated off the Most Holy Place symbolised the separation between God and humanity. The tearing of the curtain when Jesus Christ was crucified symbolised the end of this separation and gave access into God's presence for believers.

Curtains for the construction of the tabernacle

EXO 26:1–26:6 See also EXO 36:8–36:13 **EXO 26:7–26:13** See also EXO 36:14–36:18 **EXO 26:36–26:37** See also EXO 36:37–36:38 **EXO 27:9–27:18** See also EXO 38:9–38:19, EXO 35:10–35:17 parallel EXO 39:33–39:40; NUM 3:25–3:26

The curtain in the Most Holy Place**The Most Holy Place shielded with a curtain**

HEB 9:2–9:4 See also EXO 26:31–26:33, EXO 40:2–40:3, EXO 40:21; NUM 4:5; 2CH 3:14 As in the tabernacle, the Most Holy Place in Solomon's temple was shut off with a curtain.

The curtain symbolises separation from God**LEV 16:2** See also NUM 18:7; HEB 9:6–9:9**The curtain indicates the hiddenness of God**

PSA 18:11 parallel 2SA 22:12 See also EXO 20:21; DEU 4:11; JOB 22:14; PSA 97:2; 1TI 6:16

The torn curtain symbolises access to God

MAT 27:51 parallels MRK 15:38, LUK 23:45 **HEB 10:19–10:20** See also HEB 6:19–6:20

Other examples of tent curtains

SNG 1:5; ; ISA 54:2

7346: death penalty

The lawful taking of human life by the civil or military authorities. The death penalty was inflicted by all nations in the ancient world. In Israel, the main method was stoning, amongst other nations, other forms such as hanging, beheading and crucifixion were used.

The ultimate authority for the death penalty lies with God alone**Examples of God taking human life**

EXO 12:29 See also NUM 16:35; 1SA 6:19, 1SA 25:38; 2SA 6:7 parallel 1CH 13:10; ACT 12:23

God may delegate his authority to human beings

GEN 9:6; ; JOS 7:15, JOS 7:25; ; 1SA 15:3, 1SA 15:32–15:33

The role of the civil authority

ACT 25:11; ; ROM 13:1, ROM 13:3–13:4

Causes of the death penalty**Sacrilege**

EXO 19:12–19:13

Serious abuse of one's parents

EXO 21:15, EXO 21:17; ; DEU 21:18–21:21; ; MAT 15:4

Adultery

LEV 20:10; ; DEU 22:22; ; JHN 8:5

Blasphemy

LEV 24:16; ; JHN 19:7

Idolatry

LEV 20:2

Immorality

LEV 20:11–20:16; ; DEU 22:21–22:25

Kidnapping

EXO 21:16

Murder

GEN 9:6; ; EXO 21:12

Rebellion

DEU 17:12

Sabbath-breaking

EXO 31:14–31:15; ; NUM 15:32–15:36

Witchcraft

LEV 20:27; ; 1SA 28:9

Rape of a betrothed virgin

DEU 22:23–22:29

Bestiality

EXO 22:19

Child sacrifice

LEV 20:2–20:5

Means of executing the death penalty**Beheading**

GEN 40:19; ; MRK 6:27 parallel MAT 14:9–14:10

Burning

DAN 3:6

Crucifixion

MAT 27:26 parallels MRK 15:15, JHN 19:16; ; MAT 27:38 parallels MRK 15:27, LUK 23:33

Hanging

GEN 40:22; ; DEU 21:22–21:23; ; ACT 5:30; ; GAL 3:13

Impalement

EZR 6:11; ; EST 2:23, EST 5:14, EST 7:9–7:10, EST 9:12–9:13

Stoning

LEV 24:23; ; DEU 21:18–21:21; LEV 20:2, LEV 24:14; ; NUM 15:35; LEV 24:23; ; NUM 15:36; ; JOS 7:25; 1KI 21:11–21:13; ; 2CH 24:21; ; ACT 7:54–7:59; JHN 8:58–8:59, JHN 10:31–10:33; JHN 8:3–8:11 Jesus Christ refuses to carry out a stoning.

The sword

EXO 32:27; ; 1SA 15:33, 1SA 22:18–22:19; ; 1KI 2:29, 1KI 2:46; ; 2CH 23:14–23:15; ; DAN 2:5; ; ACT 12:2; ; HEB 11:37

Wild beasts

DAN 6:16

The commutation of the death penalty

GEN 4:15; ; EXO 21:13, EXO 21:29–21:30; ; NUM 35:6; ; DEU 4:42, DEU 19:1–19:10

7348: defilement

The result of making oneself or someone else unclean in God's sight. Outward, physical defilement comes from contact with someone or something unclean, whereas sin produces inner, spiritual defilement.

Defilement through contact with anything unclean

LEV 20:25 See also LEV 7:19–7:21, LEV 11:41–11:45, LEV 21:1–21:4, LEV 22:4–22:5; NUM 5:1–5:3, NUM 6:9, NUM 6:12; EZK 4:9–4:15, EZK 44:25; DAN 1:8; HAG 2:10–2:14; MAL 1:7

Defilement through bodily emissions

LEV 12:2–12:7, LEV 15:1–15:17

Defilement by sin

EZK 14:11 See also LEV 19:31; PSA 106:34–106:39; JER 2:23; LAM 4:14; EZK 20:1–20:44, EZK 22:1–22:4, EZK 23:28–23:30, EZK 37:23

Defilement as a result of illicit sexual relations

LEV 18:20 See also GEN 34:1–34:5 rape; GEN 34:27, GEN 49:3–49:4; LEV 18:23–18:30 bestiality; LEV 21:7, LEV 21:9, LEV 21:13–21:15 NUM 5:19–5:22, NUM 5:27–5:30; DEU 24:1–24:4; 1CH 5:1; EZK 18:6, EZK 22:11 incest; EZK 23:7, EZK 23:17, EZK 33:26 adultery; REV 14:4

Defilement of God's house

LEV 15:31 NUM 19:13, NUM 19:20; 2CH 29:4–29:5, 2CH 36:14; ; PSA 74:4–74:7, PSA 79:1; JER 7:30, JER 32:32–32:35; EZK 5:11, EZK 9:7, EZK 23:38; ; ACT 21:27–21:28 Paul was falsely accused of bringing Gentiles into the temple area.

Defilement of God's name

EZK 43:7–43:8

Defilement of altars and offerings

EXO 20:25 See also NUM 18:30–18:32; 2KI 23:16, 2KI 23:19

Defilement of the land

NUM 35:34 See also JOS 22:19; ISA 24:5; JER 2:7, JER 3:9, JER 16:18; EZK 36:17–36:18

7350: drink offering

A sacrificial offering of wine poured out at the foot of the altar, to accompany a burnt, fellowship or grain offering.

The drink offering was an ancient custom

GEN 35:14

Drink offerings were proportionate to the size of animal sacrificed

See also NUM 15:5, NUM 15:7, NUM 15:10

Drink offerings were required on feasts and sacred days

As part of the daily offerings: EXO 29:41; ; NUM 28:7–28:8; LEV 23:13 Firstfruits; LEV 23:18; ; NUM 28:31; LEV 23:37; ; NUM 29:30–29:31; NUM 28:24 Passover; ; NUM 28:9–28:10 Sabbath offerings; ; NUM 28:14 monthly offerings; ; NUM 29:6 Feast of Trumpets; ; NUM 29:11 Day of Atonement

Occasions for making a drink offering**To accompany sacrifices for unintentional sins**

NUM 15:24

To mark special occasions

NUM 6:17 after taking a Nazirite vow; ; 1CH 29:21 at the accession of a king; ; 2CH 29:35 during a religious reformation; ; EZK 45:17 in Ezekiel's vision of restored worship

God's displeasure when drink offerings were poured out to idols

JER 7:18 See also ISA 57:6; JER 19:13, JER 32:29, JER 44:17–44:19, JER 44:25; EZK 20:28

Drink offerings as a symbol**Of restoration after a locust plague**

JOL 2:13–2:14

Of devotion and sacrifice

PHP 2:17 See also 2SA 23:15–23:17; 2TI 4:6–4:8

7352: ephod

A garment worn by priests and high priests

EXO 28:4 See also EXO 28:6–28:13, EXO 39:2–39:7; LEV 8:7; JDG 17:5; JDG 18:17–18:20; 1SA 2:28, 1SA 22:18, 1SA 23:9; HOS 3:4

Worn by people other than priests

2SA 6:14 parallel 1CH 15:27 See also JDG 8:27; 1SA 2:18

7354: feasts and festivals

The OT makes reference to a number of feasts and festivals, which generally commemorate an event in Israel's history (e.g., the Feast of Passover) or some season of the year (e.g., the Feast of Weeks). In the NT, some of these festivals are given new meanings, such as Pentecost, which was originally a harvest festival, but which came to celebrate the coming of the Holy Spirit.

7355: feasts and festivals, nature of

Israel's feasts and festivals were to be times of religious and community celebration. Ordained by God, they were to be the outward expression of a right spiritual attitude.

Feasts and festivals were appointed by God

EXO 5:1 See also EXO 10:9; HOS 9:5

Israel's three annual festivals

The three pilgrim festivals

EXO 23:14–23:19; 2CH 8:12–8:13 EXO 12:14; ; NUM 28:17; LEV 23:15–23:21; ; NUM 28:26; LEV 23:39–23:41; ; NUM 29:12; ; JDG 21:19; ; 1KI 8:65 parallel 2CH 7:8

They were a joyful response to God's blessings

ZEC 8:19 Contrasting with fasts. See also NAM 1:15

They were celebrated with sacrifices and offerings

NUM 29:39; ; EZK 46:11

Israel's other festivals

New Moon festivals: NUM 10:10; ; 1SA 20:18; ; 1CH 23:31; ; HOS 2:11; EXO 32:5; ; 1KI 12:32–12:33

Festivals should be the outward expression of a right spiritual attitude

ISA 1:14, ISA 29:1; ; HOS 5:7; ; MAL 2:3; ; 1CO 5:8

OT festivals find their fulfilment in Jesus Christ

COL 2:16–2:17

7356: Feast of Dedication

This feast began on 25th Kislev (November/December) and lasted seven days. It celebrated the cleansing of

the temple and altar by Judas Maccabeus after they had been defiled by Antiochus Epiphanes.

Jesus Christ was challenged to declare his messiahship at the Feast of Dedication

JHN 10:22–10:24

7357: Feast of Firstfruits

The date of the offering of firstfruits, a celebration of God's gift of the harvest, is not clear; it was probably held on 16th Abib.

Offerings made at the celebration of the firstfruits

A burnt offering and a grain offering

LEV 23:12–23:13

Other offerings

LEV 23:19–23:20

7358: Feast of Tabernacles

This feast began on 15th Tishri (September/October) and lasted seven days. It celebrated the first gathering of the fruit and grain harvests and also God's provision for his people during their wilderness journey from Egypt to the promised land.

Instructions for celebrating the Feast of Tabernacles

EXO 23:16 See also EXO 23:14, EXO 34:22–34:23; LEV 23:33–23:34, LEV 23:39; NUM 29:12; DEU 16:13, DEU 16:14, DEU 16:16

People lived in booths for the duration of the Feast of Tabernacles

LEV 23:40, LEV 23:42–23:43

The offerings to be made on each day of the Feast of Tabernacles

LEV 23:37; ; NUM 29:13–29:38

The Feast of Tabernacles was celebrated throughout Israel's history

2CH 8:12–8:13 under Solomon; EZR 3:4; ; NEH 8:17–8:18; JHN 7:2–7:3, JHN 7:37–7:38

7359: Feast of Trumpets

This feast, which is not specifically mentioned as such in the OT, took place at the observance of the new moon in the month of Tishri (September/October). It signalled the end of the agricultural year.

It was to be a day of rest, commemorated with the sounding of trumpets

LEV 23:24–23:25; ; NUM 29:1

Offerings were made to God

LEV 23:25; ; NUM 29:2–29:5

Celebrated after the exile

NEH 8:2–8:6

7360: Feast of Unleavened Bread

The feast was kept from 15th–21st Abib (March/April), to commemorate the haste with which the Israelites left Egypt. It was always celebrated in the calendar of feasts with the Feast of Passover.

Celebrating the Feast of Unleavened Bread

EXO 12:15–12:20 See also EXO 12:39, EXO 23:15; LEV 23:6; NUM 28:17; DEU 16:3

All use of yeast was forbidden during the Feast of Unleavened Bread

All leaven was to be removed from the home before the feast began

EXO 12:19, EXO 13:7; ; DEU 16:4

No yeast was to be used in the preparation of food

EXO 12:18–12:20, EXO 13:6–13:7, EXO 23:15

Sacrifices made at the Feast of Unleavened Bread

LEV 23:8; ; NUM 28:19–28:24

The Feast of Unleavened Bread in NT times

MRK 14:1, MRK 14:12; ; ACT 12:3; ; 1CO 5:6–5:8

7361: Feast of Weeks

This feast, which took place seven weeks after Passover in Sivan (May/June), was also known as the Feast of Pentecost. It expressed joy and thankfulness to God for the harvest.

The Feast of Weeks was one of three compulsory feasts

EXO 23:16, EXO 34:22

Offerings made at the Feast of Weeks

The firstfruits of the wheat harvest were offered to God

NUM 28:26; ; DEU 16:10 The offerings brought were to be in proportion to the harvest.

Two loaves of bread were also offered

LEV 23:17

Burnt offerings and sin offerings were made

LEV 23:18–23:20 parallel NUM 28:27–28:30

The Feast of Weeks (Pentecost) in the NT

ACT 2:1–2:4 The term “Pentecost” refers to the 50 days that separate this feast from the Passover Sabbath.

7364: fellowship offering

Sacrificial meals shared by offerer, people and priests. The name of these offerings is related to the Hebrew “shalom”, meaning “wholeness” or “peace”, and they are therefore also known as “peace offerings”.

Fellowship offerings were required by God

See also EXO 20:24

Their purpose was thanksgiving, vow fulfilment or freewill offering

LEV 7:11–7:18

Regulations for making a fellowship offering

The animal

LEV 3:1, LEV 3:6, LEV 3:12

Its slaughter

LEV 3:2, LEV 3:8, LEV 3:13, LEV 17:5–17:6

All requirements must be fulfilled for the offering to be acceptable

LEV 19:5, LEV 22:21; ; JOS 22:29; AMO 5:22, AMO 5:24

The fellowship offering was shared

God received the best

LEV 3:3–3:5, LEV 3:9–3:11, LEV 3:14–3:16

The priests received their share as food

LEV 7:29–7:34

The people ate the rest

LEV 10:14

Fellowship offerings affirmed the covenant relationship

The Sinai covenant with Israel: EXO 20:24, EXO 24:4–24:6; ; JOS 8:31–8:32; 1SA 10:8, 1SA 11:15; ; 1KI 9:25

The celebration of fellowship offerings

At seasonal festivals

LEV 23:19 the Feast of Weeks; ; NUM 29:39 the Feast of Tabernacles

On other religious and national occasions

At the completion of the time of separation of a Nazirite: NUM 6:14, NUM 6:17–6:18; NUM 10:10 at New Moons and other festivals; NUM 7:17, NUM 7:23, NUM 7:29; NUM 15:8; ; DEU 27:7; 2SA 6:17–6:18 on bringing

the ark to Jerusalem; ; 2SA 24:25 on locating the site for the temple; 1KI 8:63–8:64 parallel 2CH 7:7 at the dedication of the temple; 2CH 29:35, 2CH 30:22, 2CH 31:2, 2CH 33:16; PRO 7:14; EZK 45:15, EZK 45:17, EZK 46:2, EZK 46:12

Fellowship offerings in idolatrous worship

EXO 32:6

7366: freewill offering

An offering that in some ways resembled the thank-offering or peace offering. It was completely voluntary, prompted by an occasion of celebration or spiritual significance. The animal offered was eaten at a festive banquet.

Instructions for presenting a freewill offering

The animal to be offered

LEV 22:17–22:22, LEV 22:23 Some slightly deformed animals were perhaps acceptable because the freewill offering was voluntary.

Eating the offering

LEV 7:16

Freewill offerings were associated with joy and celebration

PSA 54:6–54:7 See also DEU 16:9–16:12 during the Feast of Weeks

Occasions for making freewill offerings

In maintaining public worship and at times of religious renewal

EXO 35:20–35:29 Building the temple. See also 2CH 31:14 Hezekiah's reformation EZR 1:4–1:6, EZR 2:68, EZR 7:16, EZR 8:28; NEH 7:70–7:72 EZK 46:11–46:12 Ezekiel's visionary ideal temple

As an additional offering at certain festivals

NUM 29:39; DEU 12:5–12:6, DEU 12:17–12:18

Prophetic criticism of bragging over freewill offerings

AMO 4:5 A sarcastic attack on the offering of freewill gifts as a way to gain prestige.

7368: grain offering

An offering that was usually offered as an accompaniment to animal sacrifices, but in special circumstances was presented alone. It could be cooked in various ways or presented uncooked. The offering could be made for a variety of purposes, depending on the sacrifice it accompanied.

The Hebrew word for grain offering“ can also mean simplygift“

See also GEN 4:4, GEN 32:13; 1SA 2:17; 1KI 4:21; MRK 7:11

The ingredients of the grain offering

Flour, oil and incense

LEV 2:1–2:2

Salt

See also LEV 2:13 Salt, which prevented corruption, was offered with all the offerings.

No yeast or honey

LEV 2:11

Roasted ears of corn

LEV 2:14–2:16

The preparation of the grain offering

LEV 2:4 oven-baked like bread; ; LEV 2:5–2:6 on a griddle or in a pan

The presentation of the grain offering

By fire

LEV 2:2 See also LEV 2:3 It might be eaten, but only by the priests and in the sanctuary.

Accompanying vow fulfilment or freewill offerings

NUM 15:1–15:10

With an animal sacrifice

NUM 15:6 See also NUM 15:8–15:9 the larger the animal, the larger the grain offering

With the two daily offerings

EXO 29:38–29:41

Circumstances under which the grain offering was presented alone

LEV 6:19–6:23 when a priest was consecrated; NUM 5:15, NUM 5:25

The character of the grain offering

It is most holy

LEV 6:17

It is an aroma pleasing to the LORD

See also LEV 2:2, LEV 2:9

7370: guilt offering

An offering that resembled the sin offering, but was offered especially in cases where restitution could be made for an unintentional sin.

Circumstances for making the guilt offering

Unintentional sin against God

LEV 5:17 See also LEV 5:15

Sin against a neighbour where restitution can be made

LEV 5:16 Where restitution is possible it is a requirement; ; LEV 6:1–6:5 A surcharge of twenty per cent was to be added; ; NUM 5:5–5:8 Restitution must be made to God if the wronged person is not accessible.

The nature of the guilt offering

A ram without defect
LEV 5:18

Regulations governing the offering
See also LEV 7:1–7:6; NUM 18:9

Other situations requiring a guilt offering

LEV 14:12–14:14 cleansing from infectious diseases; ; LEV 19:20–19:22 wronging a man by intercourse with a slave girl promised to him; ; NUM 6:12 cleansing a Nazirite after contact with a dead body; ; EZR 10:19 for returning exiles who had intermarried

Guilt offerings in Ezekiel's vision of the temple
EZE 40:38–40:39, EZE 42:13, EZE 44:29, EZE 46:20

The death of the “suffering servant” is interpreted as a guilt offering
ISA 53:10

7372: hands, laying on of

An action of God or human beings, often understood to convey healing, blessing or the gift of the Holy Spirit. It also indicates the conferring of authority upon individuals for the purpose of ministry.

Laying on of hands and the communication of gifts

Laying on of hands communicates God's blessing
MRK 10:16 parallel MAT 19:15 See also GEN 48:14–48:20

Laying on of hands conveys God's healing
LUK 4:40 See also MAT 8:3 parallels MRK 1:41, LUK 5:13 the man with leprosy; MAT 9:18 parallel MRK 5:23 Jairus' daughter; MAT 9:29–9:30; MRK 6:5, MRK 7:32–7:35, MRK 16:18; LUK 13:13 the crippled woman; ACT 28:8; JAS 5:14

Laying on of hands conveys the gift of the Holy Spirit
ACT 8:17 See also DEU 34:9; ACT 8:19, ACT 9:17, ACT 19:6

Laying on of hands conveys reassurance
REV 1:17 See also MAT 17:7

Laying on of hands in commissioning for service
NUM 27:18–27:23 See also NUM 8:10; DEU 34:9; ACT 6:6, ACT 13:3; 1TI 4:14, 1TI 5:22; 2TI 1:6

Laying on of hands in the OT sacrificial system

Laying on of hands in sin offerings

LEV 16:21 See also EXO 29:10; LEV 4:4, LEV 4:15, LEV 8:14; 2CH 29:23

Laying on of hands in other offerings

LEV 1:4 See also EXO 29:15, EXO 29:19; LEV 3:1–3:2, LEV 8:18, LEV 8:22

Laying on of hands without reference to God

Laying hands on people with intent to harm

GEN 37:27; ; JOS 2:19; ; 1SA 23:7, 1SA 26:9–26:11, 1SA 26:23; ; ISA 11:14; ; LUK 21:12

Laying on of hands in punishment

LEV 24:14; ; NEH 13:21

The metaphorical laying of God's hand on people

God's hand brings favour

NEH 2:8 See also EZR 7:6, EZR 7:28, EZR 8:18; NEH 2:18

God's hand brings protection

EZR 8:31 See also EZR 7:9

God's hand brings prophetic revelation

EZE 1:3 See also EZE 3:14, EZE 3:22, EZE 8:1, EZE 33:22, EZE 37:1, EZE 40:1

God's hand brings judgment

EXO 7:4 See also 1SA 5:6–5:12; JER 15:6; EZE 39:21; ACT 13:11

7374: high places

Natural heights were sometimes the sites of shrines devoted to the LORD. However, the term usually refers to the places where shrines were set up to foreign gods, especially shrines where the worship of the LORD was in rivalry with Jerusalem.

High places referring to mountainous areas

HAB 3:19 See also DEU 32:13; PSA 18:33 parallel 2SA 22:34

High places express divine lordship

AMO 4:13 See also MIC 1:3

High places referring to shrines to the LORD

High places were the focus of worship before the building of Solomon's temple
1KI 3:2–3:3

High places associated with Samuel

1SA 9:12 See also 1SA 9:13–9:14, 1SA 9:19

Associated with other prophets
1SA 10:5

High places referring to foreign shrines

In Canaan before the conquest

DEU 33:29

Among Israel's neighbours

ISA 15:2 See also ISA 16:12

Israelite use of high places condemned

The building of shrines on high places

1KI 12:31

High places condemned by God

LEV 26:30 See also NUM 33:52; DEU 12:2

High places condemned by the prophets

EZK 20:28–20:29 See also JER 17:3

High places associated with foreign gods

JER 32:35 Baal; ; 1KI 11:7 Chemosh and Molech

Worship at the high places

High places regarded as unsatisfactory places to worship the LORD

2CH 32:12 See also 2KI 18:4 The presence of Asherah poles is evidence of a consort for the LORD, typical of Baal worship, but alien to the Biblical concept of God; 2CH 31:1

Characteristics of worship at the high places

2KI 17:11 burning incense; ; 2KI 23:20 the presence of priests; ; 2CH 28:25 sacrifices; ; EZK 43:7 a site for the tombs of kings

Removal of the high places

LEV 26:30; ; NUM 33:52; ; 2CH 14:3, 2CH 17:6

Commended for the zeal shown

2KI 23:5 See also 2KI 23:8, 2KI 23:15

Used as a test

1KI 15:14, 1KI 22:43; ; 2KI 12:2–12:3, 2KI 14:3–14:4, 2KI 15:3–15:4, 2KI 15:34–15:35; ; 2CH 20:32–20:33

7376: high priest

One of the most important people in Israel, responsible for the spiritual welfare of the nation and, in particular, for making atonement for the sins of the people. The NT recognises Jesus Christ as bringing this role to fulfilment, making the perfect sacrifice for the sins of his people, as both high priest and the sacrificial victim.

7377: high priest, in OT

The OT emphasises the spiritual importance of the high priest, especially as the one who makes atone-

ment for the sins of the nation. It also sets out his duties and responsibilities.

The role of the high priest

Making atonement on the Day of Atonement

LEV 16:3 See also LEV 16:1–16:34

Teaching

DEU 33:10 See also EZR 7:12; NEH 8:2

Providing oracles

LEV 8:8 See also NUM 27:21; DEU 33:8

Interceding

EZR 9:5

Administering the sanctuary

NUM 3:38

Anointing kings

2KI 11:12

Supervising censuses

NUM 26:1–26:2

Encouraging soldiers

DEU 20:2

Titles used to refer to the high priest

The priest

EXO 31:10

The anointed priest

LEV 4:3 See also EXO 30:30; LEV 4:5, LEV 4:16, LEV 16:32

The high priest

LEV 21:10 See also HAG 1:12–1:14, HAG 2:2–2:4; ZEC 3:1–3:8, ZEC 6:11

Melchizedek, the king-priest

GEN 14:18; ; PSA 110:4 David's son, as king-priest, is appointed to the order of Melchizedek, a priesthood superior to that of Aaron; ; HEB 7:11

High priesthood in the law

Only certain people might be high priests

NUM 3:10

Consecration of a high priest

LEV 8:30

Dignity of the high priesthood

DEU 17:12 See also LEV 21:10

Dress of the high priest

EXO 28:4 See also LEV 8:7–8:9, LEV 16:4

Other high priests mentioned in the OT

1SA 1:9 Eli; ; 1SA 21:2 Ahimelech; ; 1CH 24:3 Zadok; ; 2KI 16:10 Uriah; ; 2KI 22:4 Hilkiyah; ; 2KI 25:18 Seraiah; ; NEH 3:1 Eliashib

7378: high priest, in NT

Under the Roman administration the high priest remained the senior Jewish leader, but his power was limited by Roman supervision.

High priests of the NT

LUK 3:2; ; ACT 23:2 Annas was high priest from A.D. 6 until deposed by the Roman official, Gratus, in A.D. 15. Though replaced by his son Eleazar and, in A.D. 18, by Caiaphas, his son-in-law, Annas retained his authority in Jewish eyes. Strictly, there could only be one high priest at a time. Ananias, the high priest of Ac 23:2, was not related to the family of Annas.

Grandeur of the high priest

JHN 18:10, JHN 18:15 The courtyard was within a palace; ; ACT 6:12, ACT 7:1 The high priest was president of the Sanhedrin.

The high priest's connections with Jesus Christ

Prophesying Jesus Christ's death

JHN 11:49–11:50 Words spoken by Caiaphas in a political sense were seen to be prophetic, pointing forward to the sacrificing role the high priest would play in the death of Jesus Christ. See also JHN 11:51–11:52

Presiding at Jesus Christ's trial

JHN 18:19–18:24 See also MAT 26:57–26:59 parallel MRK 14:53–14:55; MAT 26:62–26:65 parallel MRK 14:61–14:64; LUK 22:54; JHN 18:28 Caiaphas, the necessary go-between, brought Jesus Christ before Pilate.

The high priest's encounters with Peter and John

ACT 4:7 The teaching of Jesus Christ's resurrection was particularly abhorrent to the Sadducees, the priestly party to which Annas and Caiaphas belonged. See also ACT 5:17, ACT 5:21, ACT 5:29

The high priest's encounter with Stephen

ACT 7:1 Stephen was thought to have threatened the temple, the focus of high priestly power. See also ACT 7:57–7:59

Encounters of the high priests with Paul

Commissioning Paul to persecute Christians

ACT 9:1–9:2

Ordering that Paul be struck

ACT 23:3 See also JHN 18:21–18:23

Taking charges against Paul to the Roman governor

ACT 24:1 See also JHN 18:28

NT references to OT high priests

Abiathar

MRK 2:26

Melchizedek

HEB 5:6

Jesus Christ as high priest

HEB 4:14–4:16 See also HEB 8:1–8:2, HEB 9:14

7379: high priest, Jesus Christ as

See [2306: Jesus Christ, as high priest](#)

7382: house of God

The place where God was seen to dwell with his people, initially the tabernacle and subsequently the temple at Jerusalem.

Early references to the house of God

GEN 28:16–28:17 “house of God” was first used by Jacob to commemorate the place where he met with God; **GEN 28:19** “Bethel” means “house of God”. See also GEN 28:22

The tabernacle as the house of God

The tabernacle was referred to as such before its construction

EXO 23:19 See also EXO 34:26

In the wilderness God said he would dwell with his people in the tabernacle

EXO 25:8–25:9

God's presence came and dwelt in the tabernacle when it was completed

EXO 40:33–40:34 See also EXO 40:35–40:38

The temple as the permanent house of God

David's desire to build the LORD a permanent house
2SA 7:1–7:2

This was not the LORD's will for David

2SA 7:5–7:7, 2SA 7:12–7:13 See also ACT 7:45–7:47

Solomon builds the temple in Jerusalem

1KI 5:4–5:5, 1KI 6:1–6:2

God's presence dwelt there but was conditional upon the faithfulness of the people

1KI 8:10–8:13 parallel 2CH 5:11–6:2 See also 1KI 9:6–9:9

Zerubbabel's temple referred to as the house of God

EZR 1:5 EZR 2:68, EZR 3:8-3:9, EZR 3:11, EZR 4:24, EZR 5:2, EZR 5:13, EZR 5:16-5:17; EZR 10:1, EZR 10:6, EZR 10:9; NEH 6:10, NEH 8:16, NEH 10:32, NEH 10:34-10:38, NEH 11:11, NEH 11:22, NEH 12:40; NEH 13:9, NEH 13:11, NEH 13:14

Other names given to the house of God

Sanctuary

EXO 25:8

House of prayer

MAT 21:13 parallels MRK 11:17, LUK 19:46; ; ISA 56:7

God's dwelling-place

ACT 7:45-7:47

The need for due reverence in worship

ECC 5:1

The house of God under the new covenant

In the hearts of God's people

1CO 3:16; GAL 4:6 See also ACT 7:48, ACT 17:24; 1CO 6:19; 2CO 1:22, 2CO 6:16; EPH 3:17

In the church, the body of Christ

HEB 3:6 See also EPH 2:19-2:22; 1PE 2:4-2:5

7384: household gods

Known in the Hebrew as "teraphim", miniature idols small enough for their owners to keep in their homes or to carry with them when travelling.

Examples of the use of household gods

GEN 31:19 See also GEN 31:34; JDG 17:1-17:6, JDG 18:18, JDG 18:30-18:31; ISA 19:13-19:16; EZK 21:21 Three methods of divination are described here, shaking the arrows (belomancy), consulting the household gods (necromancy) and the examination of the liver of a sacrificed victim (hepatoscopy).

The use of household gods was contrary to God's law

DEU 7:25-7:26 See also EXO 20:4-20:6 parallel DEU 5:8-5:10

The removal and condemnation of household gods

2KI 23:24 See also GEN 35:2-35:4; ISA 44:9-44:11; EZK 18:5-18:6; ZEC 10:2

7386: incense

An expensive resin from southern Arabia and the fragrant aroma it emits when offered in worship ritual. It is also called frankincense.

Regulations governing the offering of incense

The priest was to keep incense burning on the altar daily

2CH 13:11 See also EXO 30:7-30:9; NUM 4:16; DEU 33:10; 1SA 2:28; 1CH 6:49, 1CH 9:29; LUK 1:9

Only the priests were to burn incense

Korah, Dathan and Abiram: NUM 16:16-16:18, NUM 16:35, NUM 16:40, NUM 16:46-16:47; 2CH 26:16-26:19 Uzziah's pride

Failure to burn incense is disobedience

2CH 29:7-29:8

The blending of the incense

EXO 30:34-30:38 See also EXO 25:6 parallel EXO 35:8; EXO 35:28

Occasions for offering incense

At the setting up of the tabernacle: EXO 39:38, EXO 40:5, EXO 40:26-40:27; LEV 2:1-2:2, LEV 2:15-2:16, LEV 6:15; LEV 5:11 not to accompany a sin offering; ; LEV 16:12 on the Day of Atonement; ; LEV 24:7 to accompany bread and oil; ; NUM 7:86 As part of the offerings at the dedication of the tabernacle, each leader presented a golden incense dish.

The altar of incense

EXO 30:1 See also EXO 30:27, EXO 31:8, EXO 31:11, EXO 35:15, EXO 37:25-37:29; 1CH 28:18

Burning incense to foreign gods

Incense offered to other gods will not bring answers to prayer

JER 11:12, JER 44:23

Israel disobeyed the LORD's commands

JER 7:9-7:10 See also JER 18:15, JER 19:13, JER 32:29, JER 44:5; EZK 16:18-16:19, EZK 20:28; HOS 11:2

The practice continued under successive kings

In the early days of Solomon's reign: 1KI 3:3, 1KI 11:8; 1KI 22:43 Jehoshaphat; ; 2KI 12:3 Joash; ; 2KI 14:4 Amaziah; ; 2KI 15:4 Azariah; ; 2KI 15:35 Jotham; ; 2KI 16:4 parallel 2CH 28:4 Ahaz

It provoked God's anger

JER 44:3 See also 2KI 22:17; ISA 65:3; JER 1:16, JER 11:17, JER 44:5, JER 44:8, JER 44:21, JER 48:35; HOS 2:13

The destruction of pagan incense altars

As part of God's punishment for disobedience

LEV 26:30; ; EZK 6:4, EZK 6:6, EZK 6:13

Their destruction in religious reformations

2KI 18:4 under Hezekiah; 2KI 23:5, 2KI 23:8; ; 2CH 34:4, 2CH 34:7; NEH 13:5, NEH 13:9

Their destruction brought God's blessing and deliverance

ISA 27:9

The significance of incense

A right heart attitude is more important to God

ISA 66:3; ; JER 6:20

It both accompanies and symbolises prayer

PSA 141:2; ; REV 5:8, REV 8:3-8:4

It symbolises worship

2CH 2:4; ; DAN 2:46; ; MAL 1:11; ; MAT 2:11; ; HEB 9:4

It brings pleasure

PRO 27:9; ; SNG 3:6, SNG 4:6; ; EZK 20:41

7388: kinsman-redeemer

The relative who restores or preserves the full community rights of disadvantaged family members. The concept arises from God's covenant relationship with Israel and points to the redemption of humanity in Jesus Christ.

Covenant rules for the kinsman-redeemer

The kinsman-redeemer's obligation to redeem the land

LEV 25:25-25:28; ; JER 32:6-32:9

The kinsman-redeemer's obligation to redeem the enslaved

LEV 25:47-25:55

The kinsman-redeemer's obligation to provide an heir

GEN 38:8-38:10; ; DEU 25:5-25:10; ; MAT 22:23-22:28 parallels MRK 12:18-12:23, LUK 20:27-20:33

The kinsman-redeemer's obligation to avenge death

NUM 35:16-35:21

The kinsman-redeemer's obligation to be a trustee

NUM 5:5-5:8

The kinsman-redeemer in the book of Ruth

RUT 2:20 See also RUT 3:1-4:17

The LORD as redeemer

EXO 6:6-6:7 See also 2SA 7:22-7:24; ISA 43:1-43:7, ISA 54:5-54:8; JER 50:33-50:34

The kinsman-redeemer reflects God's concern for the poor and oppressed

PRO 23:10-23:11 See also PSA 68:5-68:6, PSA 72:2-72:4

God's provision of Jesus Christ as kinsman-redeemer

GAL 4:4-4:7 See also GAL 3:13-3:14; HEB 2:11-2:18

7390: Levites

Assistants to the Aaronic priests, they exercised an auxiliary ministry, caring for the tabernacle. After the ark was brought to Jerusalem by David their role was re-ordered and extended. They were reconsecrated during the reforms of Josiah and Hezekiah and recommissioned by Ezra and Nehemiah when the Israelites returned from captivity.

The Levites and the care of the tabernacle

The Levites are to transport, erect and guard the tabernacle

NUM 1:48-1:53 See also NUM 2:17; DEU 10:8

The Gershonite branch of the Levites are to care for the coverings and curtains of the tabernacle

NUM 3:25-3:26 See also NUM 4:24-4:27

The Kohathite branch of the Levites are to care for the furnishings of the sanctuary

NUM 3:31 See also NUM 4:4-4:20

The Merarite branch of the Levites are to care for the frames of the tabernacle

NUM 3:36-3:37 See also NUM 4:29-4:33

The Levites are to have an auxiliary ministry

NUM 3:5-3:10 See also NUM 8:19, NUM 18:1-18:7

The Levites are set apart for their ministry

NUM 8:20-8:21 See also NUM 8:5-8:15

The Levites' period of service was between the ages of 25 and 50

NUM 8:23-8:26 See also NUM 4:1-4:3 Some suggest that the reason for the discrepancy in ages between Numbers chapters 4 and 8 is that the Levites had to serve an apprenticeship for the first five years.

Occasions after the settlement when the Levites transport the ark

1SA 6:15; ; 2SA 15:24; ; 1KI 8:3-8:5 parallel 2CH 5:4-5:6; ; 1CH 15:1-15:16

David re-orders and extends the role of the Levites

1CH 23:2-23:6 See also 1CH 6:31-6:49, 1CH 16:4-16:6, 1CH 23:24-23:32, 1CH 25:1-26:32

Hezekiah and Josiah rededicate the Levites

2CH 29:3-29:36, 2CH 35:1-35:6

Ezra and Nehemiah recommission the Levites after the return from exile

EZR 6:16–6:18 See also NEH 12:22–12:26

Ezekiel prophesies a restored but restricted role for the Levites in the new temple

EZK 44:10–44:14

7392: lots, casting of

A means of determining the will of God, prior to the giving of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost. The casting of lots was also used by pagans for the same purpose. Such use reflects the belief that nothing occurred by chance.

Casting lots to determine the will of God

PRO 16:33

In the ministry of the high priest

EXO 28:30 The “Urim and Thummim” were sacred lots maintained for the purpose of determining God’s will. See also LEV 8:7–8:9, LEV 16:6–16:10; NUM 27:21; DEU 33:8; 1SA 28:6; EZR 2:63 parallel NEH 7:65

To apportion land

NUM 33:54 See also NUM 26:54–26:56; JOS 14:2, JOS 18:10

To select individuals

1SA 14:41–14:42 See also JOS 7:14–7:18; JDG 20:9–20:10; 1SA 10:20–10:21; JON 1:7 **ACT 1:15–1:26**

To assign priestly duties

1CH 24:5 See also 1CH 26:12–26:13; NEH 10:34; LUK 1:8–1:9

To settle disputes

PRO 18:18

Casting lots as a means of divination

EZK 21:21–21:22 See also EST 3:7, EST 9:24–9:27 The word “purim” is the plural of “pur” and means “lots”.

Casting lots as a means of distributing plunder

JOL 3:2–3:3 See also NAM 3:10 **MAT 27:35** parallels MRK 15:24, LUK 23:34, JHN 19:24 See also PSA 22:18

7394: memorial

An object, institution or custom established or founded as a reminder of an important person or event held to be worth remembering in the life of the community.

Objects as a memorial

Stones

JOS 4:4–4:7 See also EXO 28:9–28:12 parallel EXO 39:6–39:7; EXO 28:29

Money or gold

EXO 30:16 See also NUM 31:54

Incense

LEV 24:7 See also ISA 66:3

A crown

ZEC 6:9–6:15

Offerings as a memorial

LEV 2:1–2:2 See also LEV 5:11–5:13; NUM 10:10

Meals as a memorial

The Lord’s Supper

1CO 11:23–11:26 See also MAT 26:26–26:28 parallels MRK 14:22–14:24, LUK 22:17–22:20

The Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread

DEU 16:1–16:8 parallels EXO 12:14–12:20, LEV 23:4–23:8, NUM 28:16–28:25

7396: Most Holy Place

The inner sanctuary of the tabernacle set up at Sinai and of Solomon’s temple, where the ark of the covenant was kept. It is a symbol of the unapproachable presence of God.

Terms used to describe the Most Holy Place

EXO 26:33 “the Most Holy Place” (or “Holy of Holies”), in contrast to the “Holy Place” where the altar stood. This superlative suggests increasing closeness to the presence of God. The distinction is not always observed, however. In Leviticus chapter 16 “Holy Place” is used regularly (translated in NIV as “Most Holy Place” in verses 2, 16, 17, 20, 27, and as “sanctuary area” in verse 3, though it is the inner sanctuary that is referred to, as the phrase “behind the curtain” (verse 2) shows); ; 1KI 6:16 the “inner sanctuary” in contrast to the outer; ; HEB 9:7 literally “the second (tabernacle)” in contrast to the first or outer

The structure and design of the Most Holy Place

In the wilderness tabernacle

The only details concern the curtains forming the walls of the two sanctuaries, and in particular the dividing curtain which separates the Most Holy Place from the outer sanctuary: EXO 26:31–26:33, EXO 36:35–36:36, EXO 40:21

In Solomon's temple

1KI 6:16, 1KI 6:19–6:20 parallel 2CH 3:8; ; 1KI 6:23–6:28 parallel 2CH 3:10; ; 1KI 6:31–6:32; ; 2CH 3:14

In the temple in Ezekiel's vision

EZK 41:4, EZK 41:15–41:21, EZK 41:23, EZK 45:3 In Ezekiel's vision a portion of the land was sacred to the LORD and called the Most Holy Place.

The significance and function of the Most Holy Place**To house the ark of the covenant**

EXO 26:33 See also EXO 40:3; 1KI 6:19, 1KI 8:6–8:9 parallel 2CH 5:7–5:9

To house the incense altar (in Solomon's temple)

1KI 6:22; HEB 9:3–9:4 Ex 30:6 and 40:5 suggest that the incense altar was housed in front of the curtain, i.e., in the Holy Place, the outer sanctuary.

To be a symbol of the presence of God

PSA 28:2 See also EXO 26:33 The curtain veiling the Most Holy Place represents the unapproachable presence of the Holy God; LEV 16:2

The Most Holy Place on the Day of Atonement

HEB 9:7 See also LEV 16:16–16:17

The NT understanding of the Most Holy Place as the place of God's heavenly presence**Jesus Christ enters the Most Holy Place as Mediator**

HEB 9:8 See also HEB 6:19–6:20, HEB 9:11–9:12, HEB 9:24

Entry to the Most Holy Place is open to all believers

HEB 10:19–10:22 See also MAT 27:51 parallel LUK 23:45 By Jesus Christ's death the dividing curtain has been torn in two.

7398: New Moon festival

The festival which marked the consecration to God of each new month in the year.

New Moon festivals were required under the Mosaic law

NUM 28:11

New Moon festivals were times of celebration**They were marked by blowing of trumpets**

NUM 10:10 See also PSA 81:3

They were celebrated with offerings

NUM 28:11–28:15; ; 1CH 23:30–23:31; ; 2CH 2:4, 2CH 8:12–8:13, 2CH 31:3 reformed temple worship under Hezekiah; ; NEH 10:32–10:33 New Moon festivals were restored on the return from exile; ; EZK 45:17, EZK 46:1, EZK 46:3, EZK 46:6

They were times when normal work ceased

David was to dine with Saul: 1SA 20:5, 1SA 20:18, 1SA 20:24; 2KI 4:23 the Shunammite woman and her husband; ; AMO 8:5 Some saw them as a hindrance to business.

A wrong inner attitude at New Moon celebrations incurs God's anger

ISA 1:13–1:14; ; HOS 2:11, HOS 5:7

NT reference to the New Moon festival

COL 2:16–2:17

7400: New Year, the

With the exception of one reference (Ex 12:2) the New Year is never specifically dated. The religious calendar apparently began in the spring and the agricultural calendar in the autumn. Later Judaism began its calendar in the autumn.

Evidence that the autumn was regarded as the New Year**The dedication of Solomon's temple**

1KI 8:2 Solomon waited 11 months after the completion of the temple (see 1KI 6:38), before dedicating it, most likely because the great Feast of Tabernacles marked the beginning of the year.

Instructions for celebrating the Year of Jubilee

LEV 25:8–25:9 The Year of Jubilee was to be proclaimed on the tenth day of the seventh month, which was also the Day of Atonement. See also LEV 16:29

Ezekiel's vision of the new temple

EZK 40:1 This vision of the new temple takes place at the beginning of the year. The "tenth of the month" refers presumably to the seventh month.

Jeroboam's institution of an autumnal festival

1KI 12:32 This autumn festival was clearly intended to be equivalent not only to the feast in Judah, but also to other pagan New Year festivals, in spite of the eighth month being distinctive. See also 1KI 12:33

Evidence that the spring was regarded as the New Year**The institution of the Passover**

EXO 12:2 This clearly links the spring Feast of Passover to the New Year. See also LEV 23:5; NUM 9:2

Ezekiel's vision of the worship of the new temple

EZK 45:18–45:19 This purification of Ezekiel's (ideal) temple resembles the Day of Atonement but takes place in the spring. See also EZK 45:21

Occasions associating the New Year with the autumn

The sounding of trumpets

NUM 29:1 See also LEV 23:24

The Day of Atonement

LEV 23:27

The Feast of Tabernacles

DEU 16:13 See also LEV 23:34

Occasions associating the New Year with the spring

Passover

LEV 23:5 See also EXO 12:11

The Feast of Unleavened bread

LEV 23:6 See also EXO 12:17

The Feast of Firstfruits

LEV 23:10–23:11 This is also known as the Feast of Weeks (Ex 23:16; Lev 23:9–21).

7402: offerings

Anything offered up to God by human beings, including sacrificial offerings. A distinction can be made between offerings which involve the taking of life and other gifts made to God.

Sacrificial offerings as a sign of gratitude or repentance

GEN 4:4; PSA 107:22

Tithes were a regular form of offering

GEN 28:20–28:22; LEV 27:30 See also GEN 14:20

Part of every harvest was given as a freewill offering to God

As firstfruits: EXO 22:29; ; NUM 18:12; ; DEU 18:4; ; NEH 10:35; LEV 19:23–19:25 Fruit from a tree could not be eaten until the fifth year; ; LEV 23:38 Extra gifts were offered on the Sabbath.

Offerings and the tabernacle

For its construction

EXO 25:1–25:2 parallel EXO 35:5

At its dedication

See also NUM 7:2–7:3

Offerings and Solomon's temple

David's personal gift

1CH 29:2–29:5

Offerings for upkeep and restoration

In the reign of Joash: 2KI 12:4–12:5; ; 2CH 24:8–24:12; 2KI 22:4–22:6 parallel 2CH 34:9–34:11

Offerings and the second temple

EZR 3:5, EZR 7:16, EZR 8:24–8:30

Offerings and Herod's temple

MRK 12:41–12:43 parallel LUK 21:1–21:3 The poor widow was participating in a regular practice; ; LUK 21:5

Some offerings are not acceptable

MAT 5:23–5:24 Offerings are unacceptable unless the worshipper is reconciled to God. See also GEN 4:3–4:5 Cain's offering was not accepted on account of his incorrect attitude. AMO 4:4–4:5; LUK 18:12 MAT 23:23 parallel LUK 11:42 Meticulous tithing, without mercy or justice, is unacceptable.

Offerings in the future kingdom

From the Gentile nations

PSA 76:11; ; ISA 18:7; ; MAL 1:11

From God's people

EZK 20:40, EZK 44:30

Gifts and offerings in the NT

To help the needy

ACT 4:34–4:35, ACT 11:29–11:30; ; 1CO 16:1–16:4 In several of his letters Paul mentions the freewill offering he was organising for poor Christians at Jerusalem; ; HEB 13:16

To support God's servants

PHP 4:10–4:18

Offerings of praise

HEB 13:15

God's people are themselves an offering to God

JER 2:3; ; JAS 1:18; ; REV 14:4

Offerings as ``Corban''

MRK 7:9–7:13 "Corban" is a technical Jewish religious term, meaning "something dedicated, especially on oath". What Jesus Christ says implies that once the children had donated the amount they would have spent on their ageing parents for religious purposes, they were no longer responsible for their upkeep.

7404: ordinances

Specific acts of worship commanded by God, sometimes including the sacraments.

The ordinance of Passover and Unleavened Bread

EXO 12:14 See also EXO 12:17, EXO 12:24, EXO 12:43, EXO 13:10; NUM 9:12

The ordinance of the Day of Atonement

LEV 16:34 See also LEV 16:29, LEV 16:31, LEV 23:31

The ordinance of the red-heifer ritual

NUM 19:2, NUM 19:10, NUM 19:21

Other occasions of worship as ordinances

LEV 23:41, LEV 24:3; ; NUM 31:21; ; 2CH 2:4; ; PSA 81:4; ; EZK 46:14

Ordinances associated with the priesthood**The Aaronic priests**

EXO 29:9 See also EXO 28:43, EXO 30:21; LEV 7:36, LEV 10:9; NUM 10:8

The Levites

NUM 18:23; ; 2CH 8:14

Ordinances in Christian worship

1CO 11:24–11:25 parallels MAT 26:26–26:28, MRK 14:22–14:24, LUK 22:17–22:20 See also MAT 28:19–28:20 Jesus Christ's commands to observe baptism and the Lord's Supper makes them ordinances of Christian worship; ACT 2:38, ACT 16:15, ACT 18:8, ACT 22:16

Ordinances were to be permanent

LEV 3:17 See also EXO 27:21; LEV 23:14, LEV 23:21

Ordinances were to be obeyed

2KI 17:37 See also 1SA 30:25; 2KI 17:34; 2CH 19:10, 2CH 33:8; EZK 44:24

Ordinances were for Israelites and Gentiles alike

NUM 15:15 See also NUM 9:14

God's ordinances are of supreme value

PSA 19:9

7406: Passover

One of the major OT feasts. It specifically commemorates the exodus from Egypt as an act of God's deliverance. In Israel's calendar of feasts it was always celebrated with the Feast of Unleavened Bread.

The institution of the Passover

EXO 12:25–12:27 The Hebrew term "Passover" derives from a verb meaning "to pass over" with the sense of "to spare".

Celebrating the Passover**Instructions concerning its observance**

See also EXO 12:2–12:11, EXO 12:46–12:47; NUM 9:1–9:5; DEU 16:1–16:8

Combined with the Feast of Unleavened Bread

EXO 34:25

The need for ritual cleansing

JHN 11:55

Provision for ritual uncleanness

NUM 9:6–9:13

Provision for non-Jews

EXO 12:43–12:45, EXO 12:48–12:49; ; NUM 9:14

Its observance in the OT

These occasions are times of spiritual renewal, when the nation remembered how the LORD had saved them: JOS 5:10; ; 2KI 23:21–23:23; ; 2CH 30:1–30:5, 2CH 30:13–30:20; ; EZR 6:19–6:21

Ezekiel's vision of the future observance of the Passover

EZK 45:21–45:24

The Passover in the NT**Its observance**

LUK 2:41–2:42; ; JHN 6:4; ; ACT 12:4

It was celebrated by Jesus Christ

LUK 22:15 At Passover time Jesus Christ himself was sacrificed and he inaugurated the Lord's Supper. See also MAT 26:17–26:19 parallels MRK 14:12–14:16, LUK 22:7–22:13; JHN 2:23 Jesus Christ observed the Passover like other Jews.

Jesus Christ identified with the Passover lamb

1CO 5:7 See also JHN 1:29, JHN 1:36, JHN 19:36 This may refer to the Passover victim; EXO 12:46; REV 5:5–5:6

7408: Pentecost

One of Israel's three major agricultural festivals, the second great feast of the Jewish year. It is a harvest festival, also known as the Feast of Weeks. The original Jewish significance of this festival has been overshadowed by the Christian celebration of the coming of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost.

Pentecost was one of Israel's three major agricultural festivals**It was also known as the Feast of Weeks**

DEU 16:9–16:10 See also EXO 34:22; DEU 16:16–16:17; 2CH 8:13

It is also referred to as the Feast of Harvest

EXO 23:16

Instructions for the celebration of Pentecost

Its timing and sacrifices

LEV 23:15–23:21 The “fifty days” (verse 16) gives rise to the term “Pentecost” which is derived from the Greek word for “fiftieth”; ; NUM 28:26–28:31; ; JER 5:24

Its link with the deliverance from Egypt

DEU 16:12 Pentecost later became associated with covenant renewal and the giving of the Law.

Pentecost in the NT

It was observed by Paul

See also ACT 20:16; 1CO 16:8

Its association with the coming of the Holy Spirit

ACT 2:1–2:4, ACT 2:16–2:21, ACT 11:15 See also JOL 2:28–2:32

7410: phylactery

A leather box containing four sections of the law (Ex 11:13–21) written on parchment, and which Jewish men tied to the forehead and left arm (close to the heart) before morning prayers. The practice of wearing phylacteries arose, probably after the exile, from a literal interpretation by pious Jews of passages such as Ex 13:9.

The significance of wearing phylacteries

A reminder of God’s deliverance

EXO 13:11–13:16 See also EXO 13:1–13:10

A reminder of God’s requirements

DEU 11:13–11:21 Phylacteries, when worn, were to be an outward sign of the importance of taking God’s word into the heart; **PSA 119:11; PRO 3:1–3:3** See also DEU 6:4–6:9, DEU 30:14; ROM 10:8; DEU 32:46; PSA 37:31, PSA 40:8; PRO 6:21, PRO 7:2–7:3; JER 31:33

A sign of allegiance and belonging

ISA 44:5; REV 7:3 See also SNG 8:6; REV 9:4, REV 14:1

The practice of wearing phylacteries

MAT 23:5 Jesus Christ condemns the Pharisees for wearing phylacteries for outward show.

7412: priesthood

The body of people responsible for priestly duties, especially in relation to worship and sacrifice. The OT identifies Aaron and his heirs as having special priestly duties. In the NT, all believers are understood to share in this priesthood. Jesus Christ fulfils the OT concept of priesthood by being both the high priest

and sacrifice, through which forgiveness of sins is completely achieved.

7413: priesthood, in OT

The institution of the priesthood or the particular body of people responsible for priestly duties.

The priesthood as an institution

It was a perpetual institution

EXO 40:15 See also NUM 18:1, NUM 25:13

It was distinct from the laity

NUM 3:10

It was subject to the king’s authority

1KI 2:27

It was a privilege

NUM 18:7 See also EXO 29:9; NUM 16:10; JOS 18:7

The priesthood as the body of people responsible for priestly duties

The Aaronic priesthood

EXO 28:41 See also 1CH 6:49; NEH 10:38

The Shiloh priesthood

JOS 18:1 See also 1SA 3:14; 1KI 2:27; PSA 78:60 The Shiloh priesthood ended when the Philistines took Shiloh (see 1Sa 4:17); JER 7:12

The Melchizedek priesthood

PSA 110:4 See also GEN 14:18; HEB 5:10, HEB 7:11–7:17

The Anathoth priesthood

JER 1:1 See also JOS 21:18; 1KI 2:27

The Zadokite priesthood

EZK 40:46 The priestly line of Zadok lasted until 170 B.C.

The Levitical priesthood

DEU 17:9 The term “the priests, who are Levites” appears only in Deuteronomy. Some think it reflects a situation in which all Levites were priests. Not all passages support this view, however, and the phrase may simply distinguish the ministry of the Levitical priests from the priesthood of the king.

7414: priesthood, in NT

Jesus Christ recognised the function of the OT priesthood, but the gospel belief in Christ as high priest and the priesthood of all believers superseded the earlier concept.

Jesus Christ acknowledged the role of the Jerusalem priesthood

See also MAT 8:4 parallels MRK 1:44, LUK 5:14

Characteristics of the Levitical priesthood

It was equivalent to the order of Aaron
HEB 7:11

It was incompatible with membership of the tribe of Judah
HEB 7:14

It was not established by divine oath
HEB 7:20

Characteristics of the Melchizedek priesthood
HEB 7:15–7:16

How Jesus Christ's priesthood resembled the OT priesthood

He fulfilled the requirement of humanity
HEB 2:17 See also HEB 5:1

He was not self-appointed
HEB 5:4–5:5

He resembled Melchizedek
HEB 5:10

How Jesus Christ's priesthood contrasts with the Levitical priesthood

It involves a change in the applicability of the law
HEB 7:12–7:13

It lasts for ever
HEB 7:23–7:24 See also HEB 10:11–10:12

It was based on a once-for-all sacrifice, not of animals but of himself
HEB 9:26 See also HEB 9:12

It is effective, not simply illustrative
HEB 10:14 See also HEB 8:5, HEB 10:1, HEB 10:4

It is not that of a mere man, but of the Son of God
HEB 7:28 See also HEB 4:14, HEB 7:26

Characteristics of the priesthood of all believers
1PE 2:9

They are to reflect the holiness of their great high priest
1PE 1:15 See also HEB 10:10

They are to offer spiritual sacrifices
1PE 2:5 See also ROM 12:1; PHP 4:18; HEB 13:15

They are to intercede for others before God
1TI 2:1 See also REV 5:8, REV 5:10

They are to represent God before other human beings
2CO 5:20 See also EPH 3:7–3:11

7416: purification

Cleansing from sin or uncleanness, by means of ritual washing under the old covenant, but through the blood of Jesus Christ under the new covenant.

Purification from uncleanness

After contact with something unclean
LEV 11:39–11:40 See also LEV 15:1–15:12, LEV 15:19–15:23, LEV 17:15–17:16; NUM 19:10–19:20

After disease
LEV 15:13–15:15 See also LEV 14:1–14:32

After childbirth and menstruation
LUK 2:22 See also LEV 12:1–12:8; 2SA 11:2–11:4

Purification from sin

1JN 1:7 See also NUM 19:1–19:9; JOB 1:5; HEB 1:3, HEB 9:16–9:24; 1JN 1:9

Purification of people

Priests and Levites
EZR 6:20 See also EXO 30:18–30:21; LEV 16:24–16:28; NUM 8:5–8:22, NUM 19:7; 2CH 4:6; NEH 12:30, NEH 13:22, NEH 13:30

Lay people
ACT 21:24–21:26 See also GEN 35:1–35:2; NUM 19:20, NUM 31:19; 2CH 30:13–30:20; ISA 66:17

Purification of inanimate objects

The temple
2CH 34:8 See also 2CH 29:15–29:19; NEH 13:6–13:9; EZK 45:18–45:20

Sacred objects
EXO 29:36 See also LEV 8:15; 1CH 23:28

Other items
LEV 14:48–14:53 See also NUM 31:19–31:24

Purification of precious metals
PSA 12:6 See also MAL 3:3

Purification of the inner person

2CO 7:1 See also MRK 7:2–7:8; ACT 15:5–15:11; TIT 2:11–2:14; JAS 4:8; 1PE 1:22; 1JN 3:3

7418: Purim

A Jewish festival of rejoicing and feasting celebrated in the month of Adar (February–March) commemorating the deliverance of the Jews recorded in the book of Esther.

The origins of Purim

Esther's position as queen

EST 4:14

Haman's death

EST 7:10

The right of the Jews to avenge themselves on their enemies

EST 8:11

Explanation of the name

EST 9:26 The word “pur”, meaning “lots”, relates to the lots cast to determine the time set for the massacre.

The date for celebrating Purim

See also EST 9:17–9:19 those living in Susa celebrated on 15th Adar, those in rural towns on 14th

The establishment of Purim

EST 9:27, EST 3:7

7420: Rabbi

An honorific title, best translated as “master” or “teacher”, and used to refer to distinguished teachers of the Jewish law. Jesus Christ is called Rabbi in the Gospels, indicating that he was regarded as a respected teacher by his audiences.

John the Baptist's addressed as Rabbi by his disciples

JHN 3:26

Jesus Christ addressed as Rabbi

By two of John the Baptist's disciples

JHN 1:38

By his own disciples

JHN 4:31 See also JHN 6:25, JHN 9:2, JHN 11:8

By Peter

MRK 9:5 See also MRK 11:21

By Nathanael and Nicodemus

JHN 1:49, JHN 3:2

By Judas Iscariot

MAT 26:25 At the Last Supper; **MAT 26:49** parallel MRK 14:45 In the Garden of Gethsemane.

Jesus Christ addressed as Rabboni, the Aramaic form of Rabbi

See also MRK 10:51; JHN 20:16

Jesus Christ taught that his disciples were not to be called Rabbi

MAT 23:7–23:8

7422: ritual

The regulations governing Jewish religious life and worship, especially sacrifices, ritual cleanliness and food laws. By the sacrificial death of Jesus Christ these rituals have been fulfilled and play no part in the new covenant.

The purpose of ritual sacrifices

To atone for sin

LEV 5:12–5:13 See also EXO 29:38–29:43; LEV 1:3–1:13, LEV 4:1–4:3, LEV 4:13–4:14, LEV 4:20–4:23, LEV 4:26–4:28, LEV 4:31–4:35, LEV 5:13, LEV 6:1–6:7, LEV 7:1–7:7, LEV 16:1–16:34

To maintain fellowship between God and his people

LEV 3:1–3:5, LEV 7:11–7:15 The offering was part burnt and part eaten in a fellowship meal and expressed covenant relationship with God.

To express worship and gratitude to God

The grain offering was the only bloodless offering but it accompanied the other offerings and was burnt whole to express gratitude to God for the harvest and for particular blessings: LEV 2:1–2:3, LEV 2:8–2:16, LEV 6:14–6:23, LEV 7:9–7:10, LEV 9:4; ; NUM 6:14–6:17, NUM 28:3–28:13

Rituals for purification from ritual uncleanness

Childbirth

LUK 2:22–2:24 See also LEV 12:1–12:8

Unclean diseases

MRK 1:40–1:44 parallels MAT 8:2–8:4, LUK 5:12–5:14 See also LEV 14:2–14:7

Unclean discharges

LEV 15:32–15:33

Touching dead bodies

NUM 19:11–19:13

Rituals relating to food

Clean and unclean foods

LEV 11:1–11:2 See also LEV 11:44–11:47

The eating of blood is forbidden

GEN 9:4–9:5; ; LEV 17:11–17:12; ; ACT 15:20

Rituals relating to the priesthood

LEV 8:30 See also EXO 29:1–29:9

Rituals relating to the place of worship

2CH 29:4–29:5 See also LEV 16:15–16:20; 1KI 8:62–8:63 parallel 2CH 7:4–7:5; EZR 6:16–6:17

Rituals relating to special days

Festivals

LEV 23:37

The Sabbath

EXO 31:12–31:17; ; MAT 12:2 parallels MRK 2:24, LUK 6:2

The initiation ritual of circumcision

GEN 17:10–17:14

Ritual only has meaning when accompanied by obedience

ROM 2:25 See also ISA 1:11–1:17; MAT 15:16–15:20 parallel MRK 7:18–7:23; MAT 23:25; ROM 2:28–2:29; 1CO 7:19, 1CO 8:8

Rituals of the old covenant are fulfilled by Jesus Christ

COL 2:17 See also MRK 2:27–2:28; COL 2:11; HEB 10:1–10:3, HEB 10:8–10:10

Old covenant rituals are abolished under the new covenant

HEB 9:10 See also MRK 7:19; ACT 10:9–10:15; ROM 7:6, ROM 14:14, ROM 14:20; GAL 5:6, GAL 6:15; EPH 2:15; COL 2:13–2:16

7424: ritual law

The rules and regulations regarding the conduct of the priests and people of Israel in approaching God, especially in worship. They were to be holy as God is holy. The perfect sacrifice of Jesus Christ on the cross is seen by NT writers as fulfilling this demand for holiness and obedience.

The ritual law and the priesthood

The priests were to be careful to obey God's commandments

LEV 22:9 See also LEV 10:10, LEV 22:3

The priests had to avoid ceremonial uncleanness

Contact with the dead caused uncleanness and was forbidden to the high priest: LEV 21:1–21:3, LEV 21:11; ; NUM 19:11, NUM 19:14; LEV 21:16–21:23 No-one with a physical defect could serve as a priest; ; LEV 22:20–22:25 The sacrifices offered by the priests also had to be without defect.

The ritual law and the people of Israel

The people were called to holiness

LEV 19:2, LEV 20:26 See also LEV 11:44–11:45, LEV 20:7, LEV 21:8, LEV 22:32

The ritual law stipulated what they could eat

LEV 11:46–11:47 See also GEN 7:2, GEN 8:20; LEV 11:1–11:23 parallel DEU 14:3–14:20; DEU 14:21

The ritual law regarding childbirth

LEV 12:1–12:5; ; LUK 2:22–2:24

Jesus Christ's obedience and perfect sacrifice on the cross fulfilled the demands of the ritual law

HEB 10:8–10:10 See also EPH 2:15; COL 2:14; HEB 7:11, HEB 7:18, HEB 7:27, HEB 10:1–10:3, HEB 10:11–10:14

7426: ritual washing

The act of washing for consecration or for purification from uncleanness. It involved washing all or part of the body or one's clothing. Jesus Christ's attitude to the Pharisees reflected, not a disavowal of ritual washing, but disapproval of their emphasis on the outward, rather than inward, forms of religion.

Ritual washing for consecration

EXO 19:10–19:11 See also EXO 19:14, EXO 40:12–40:15; NUM 8:5–8:7, NUM 8:21–8:22

Ritual washing for cleansing

LEV 17:15 See also LEV 13:6, LEV 13:34, LEV 15:16–15:18, LEV 15:21–15:23; NUM 19:10, NUM 19:19

Methods of ritual washing

Washing clothes

NUM 31:24 See also LEV 6:27, LEV 11:24–11:28, LEV 11:39–11:40, LEV 13:58, LEV 14:43–14:47; NUM 19:21; REV 7:14, REV 22:14

Bathing

LEV 14:8–14:9 See also LEV 15:4–15:13, LEV 15:27, LEV 16:26–16:28, LEV 17:15; NUM 19:7–19:8; DEU 23:9–23:11; 2KI 5:9–5:14; PSA 51:7; HEB 10:19–10:22

Sprinkling with the water of purification

NUM 19:17–19:19 See also NUM 8:5–8:7, NUM 19:13; EZK 36:24–36:25

Washing hands and feet

EXO 30:17–30:21 See also EXO 40:30–40:32; DEU 21:6–21:9; JHN 13:5–13:10; JAS 4:8

Consequences of the failure to perform ritual washing

NUM 19:20 See also LEV 17:15–17:16; NUM 19:13

The NT perception of ritual washing

It was practised in NT times

JHN 2:6 See also JHN 3:25

The Pharisees over-emphasised its importance

MAT 15:1–15:11 parallel MRK 7:1–7:23 See also LUK 11:37–11:41

Jesus Christ's atoning work rendered it unnecessary
HEB 9:6–9:14

7428: Sabbath

The day of rest laid down for the people of God. The OT treated the seventh day of the week (Saturday) as the Sabbath, a custom continued in modern Judaism. The Christian church, in recognition of the importance of the resurrection of Jesus Christ, observed a day of rest on the first day of the week (Sunday).

7429: Sabbath, in OT

The Sabbath of rest is grounded in God's work of creation. Observance of a Sabbath day is distinctive of the people of God.

The Sabbath grounded in creation itself

GEN 2:3 See also PSA 118:24

The purpose of the Sabbath

To remember God's work in creation

EXO 20:8–20:11 See also GEN 2:2; EXO 35:2

To remember the exodus

DEU 5:12–5:15 The idea of rest relates the concept of the Sabbath to the ultimate conquest of Canaan under David and to the return from exile. See also GEN 8:4; 2SA 7:1; 2SA 7:11; PSA 95:10–95:11; HEB 4:9; REV 14:13

To be a sign of the relationship between Israel and God and to give refreshment

EXO 31:17 See also DEU 5:12–5:14

The Law required the Sabbath to be a holy day free from work

LEV 23:3 See also EXO 34:21, EXO 35:3; LEV 23:38; ISA 56:2, ISA 58:13

The Sabbath was linked with celebration of the New Moon

2KI 4:23 See also ISA 1:13; EZK 46:3; HOS 2:11; AMO 8:5

Abuses of the Sabbath

EXO 16:27–16:28 gathering manna; ; NUM 15:32 gathering wood; ; NEH 13:15–13:18 doing ordinary work; NEH 10:31; ; AMO 8:5; JER 17:21 carrying loads

Punishments for infringing the Sabbath law

The death penalty

EXO 31:14; ; NUM 15:35

Disaster for Jerusalem

JER 17:27; ; EZK 20:13, EZK 22:8, EZK 22:15

Sacrifices to be offered on the Sabbath

Bread

LEV 24:8; ; 1CH 9:32

Burnt offerings

NUM 28:9–28:10; ; 1CH 23:31; ; 2CH 2:4

Other offerings

EZK 46:4

7430: Sabbath, in NT

The NT develops the OT teaching on the Sabbath in three important directions. It declares that the Sabbath should not be observed in a legalistic manner; the Sabbath-rest is treated as an important symbol of the Christian doctrine of salvation; and finally, the NT itself indicates how Sunday, rather than Saturday, came to be seen as the Christian Sabbath.

Gospel incidents connected with the Sabbath

Exorcism

MRK 1:21–1:25 parallel LUK 4:31–4:35

Healing

MAT 12:9–12:14 parallels MRK 3:1–3:6, LUK 6:6–6:11; ; MRK 1:30–1:31 parallel LUK 4:38–4:40; ; LUK 13:10–13:17, LUK 14:1–14:6; ; JHN 5:5–5:18, JHN 9:1–9:16

Teaching

MRK 6:2 parallel MAT 13:54; ; LUK 4:16

Other references

MAT 28:1 parallel MRK 16:1; ; LUK 23:55–23:56; ; JHN 12:2

Jesus Christ's teaching regarding the Sabbath

Jesus Christ observes the Sabbath regulation

LUK 4:16 See also MAT 24:20; ACT 1:12

Human well-being is more important than rigid observance of the Law

MRK 2:27–2:28 See also MAT 12:3

Ceremonial observance must give way before any higher, or more spiritual, motive

MAT 12:5–12:6 See also LUK 6:5

Sabbath reading of Scripture provided an opportunity for reaching the Jews

ACT 17:2 See also ACT 13:14, ACT 13:27, ACT 13:42, ACT 13:44, ACT 15:21, ACT 16:13, ACT 18:4

Sabbath observance was optional for Gentile Christians

COL 2:16

The Lord's Day

REV 1:10 At an early stage the Sabbath was replaced by Sunday (the first day of the week) as the day for rest and worship. See also JHN 20:19, JHN 20:26; ACT 20:7; 1CO 16:2

The Sabbath-rest is seen as a symbol of the salvation of the people of God

HEB 4:1 The OT promise of rest was unfulfilled, on account of Israel's disobedience; **HEB 3:18–3:19**, **HEB 4:9** The OT promise of rest remains open.

7431: Sabbath, sabbatical year

Just as the seventh day was observed as a day of rest, so the OT regarded every seventh year as a sabbath year, to be set aside for rest.

The sabbath year

As a time for leaving fields fallow

EXO 23:10–23:11 See also LEV 25:4, LEV 26:34; NEH 10:31
An important feature was the opportunity for the poor to benefit from unharvested fields.

As a time for cancelling debts

DEU 15:1 See also DEU 15:9, DEU 31:10; NEH 10:31

As a time for freeing slaves

DEU 15:12 See also JER 34:14

The Year of Jubilee as seven Sabbaths

LEV 25:8–25:12

7434: sacrifice

An important aspect of the relationship between God and humanity but whereas the OT describes many sacrifices, the NT announces the fulfilment of sacrifice in Jesus Christ.

7435: sacrifice, in OT

An act that involved offering to God the life of an animal. It expressed gratitude for God's goodness or acknowledgment of sin. It was also associated with establishing a covenant.

Sacrifice was an integral part of worship

See also GEN 46:1; EXO 10:24–10:26; JDG 13:19; 1SA 1:3; 1KI 3:4

Sacrifices were a means of offering thanks to God

GEN 4:4 Abel; ; GEN 8:20 Noah delivered from the flood; ; EXO 18:12 Jethro after God had delivered the Israelites; ; JDG 11:31 Jephthah; ; 1SA 6:15 after the safe return of the ark; EZR 3:3, EZR 8:35; PSA 27:6, PSA 54:6, PSA 107:17–107:22

Sacrifices were offered at regular religious festivals

LEV 23:5–23:8 Passover; ; LEV 23:18–23:20 the Feast of Weeks; ; LEV 23:23–23:25 the Feast of Trumpets; LEV 16:6–16:10, LEV 23:26–23:32; LEV 23:33–23:36 the Feast of Tabernacles

Special occasions were marked by sacrifices

1KI 8:63 the dedication of Solomon's temple; ; 2CH 29:31–29:33 after Hezekiah had purified the temple; ; EZR 3:2–3:3 the Jews who returned from the Babylonian exile; ; EZR 6:17 at the completion of the second temple

Sacrifices as signs of individual and national penitence

LEV 4:1–4:3, LEV 4:13–4:14; ; JDG 2:1–2:5, JDG 20:26; ; 1SA 7:8–7:9; ; 2SA 24:10–24:25

The place of sacrifice

It was divinely chosen

DEU 12:13–12:14 See also LEV 17:3–17:5; DEU 12:2–12:6

Rival places of sacrifice caused the Israelites to sin

1KI 12:28–12:29, 1KI 12:32; ; 2CH 15:17, 2CH 31:1 Under Hezekiah the high places were destroyed.

God condemned certain sacrifices

Sacrifices to other gods

1KI 11:7–11:8 See also NUM 25:1–25:3; 2KI 16:4, 2KI 16:15; PSA 106:28; ISA 57:7, ISA 65:3, ISA 65:7; JER 19:4

Human sacrifices

LEV 18:21; ; DEU 12:31; ; 1KI 16:34; ; 2KI 3:26–3:27, 2KI 16:3, 2KI 17:31, 2KI 21:6; ; EZK 20:31

Sacrifice to the LORD may be rejected

If it is a substitute for obedience

1SA 15:20–15:22; ; JER 7:21–7:22; ; HOS 8:11–8:13; ; AMO 4:4; ; MRK 12:33

If it is a substitute for justice and mercy

ISA 66:2–66:3; ; MIC 6:7–6:8; ; MAT 9:13

If it is imperfect

MAL 1:13–1:14

Blessing is promised when right sacrifices are offered

GEN 22:15–22:18; ; PSA 4:5, PSA 50:14–50:15, PSA 50:23, PSA 51:17

7436: sacrifice, NT fulfilment of

For the people of the new covenant, sacrifice is fulfilled in Jesus Christ. Christians should have nothing

to do with other sacrifices but are to bring their own “spiritual” offerings.

The OT points ahead to the fulfilment of sacrifice in Jesus Christ

A new sacrificial system

ISA 56:6–56:7 See also ISA 19:21

The new people of God

JER 33:18; ; EZK 20:40

The vision of the new temple

EZK 40:46

The perfect sacrifice of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ perceived his death as a sacrifice

MAT 26:28 parallels MRK 14:24, LUK 22:20, 1CO 11:25
See also HEB 5:1

The contrast with the OT sacrificial system

HEB 7:27 See also HEB 9:23–9:26, HEB 10:1–10:3, HEB 10:12

Jesus Christ’s sacrifice of a life dedicated to God makes believers holy

TIT 2:14; ; HEB 10:8–10:10

The sacrifices of Christians

Christians offer themselves as living sacrifices

ROM 12:1 PHP 2:17; ; 2TI 4:6

The sacrifice of praise and good works

HEB 13:15–13:16

Christian attitudes to pagan sacrifice

See also 1CO 10:18–10:22, 1CO 10:25–10:26, 1CO 10:27–10:29 Christians must not appear to compromise with idolatrous worship.

7438: sanctuary

A place or structure set aside for the worship of God. In Scripture the word generally refers to the tabernacle or the Jerusalem temple. By extension the word signifies a location or spiritual state providing refuge from hostile forces, human, spiritual or natural.

The tabernacle

EXO 25:8–25:9 See also EXO 36:1; HEB 8:2, HEB 8:5

Worship in the tabernacle was divinely ordained in great detail

EXO 30:7–30:10; ; LEV 7:37–7:38, LEV 23:44; ; EXO 39:1; ; NUM 3:30–3:31; ; HEB 9:1

The people gave generously for the tabernacle

EXO 36:4–36:5

Approach to God’s sanctuary was strictly regulated

LEV 12:4 See also LEV 21:21–21:23; NUM 3:10, NUM 3:38, NUM 8:19, NUM 18:5, NUM 19:20; 2CH 26:18

A reverent attitude was commanded

LEV 19:30 parallel LEV 26:2

The Jerusalem temple

David made extensive preparations for Solomon to build the temple

1CH 22:17–22:19 See also 1CH 28:2–28:3, 1CH 28:6

The inner sanctuary of the temple corresponded to the Most Holy Place in the tabernacle

1KI 6:19 See also 1KI 8:6 parallel 2CH 5:7; 1CH 6:49; HEB 9:1–9:4

Some places were considered sacred because of God’s presence and activity

EXO 15:17 See also GEN 28:16–28:17; EXO 3:1–3:5; PSA 15:1, PSA 63:2, PSA 73:16–73:17; JER 17:12

Conduct that displeases God will lead to a nation’s sanctuaries being destroyed

Disobedience to God

LEV 26:31 See also 2CH 30:8; EZK 7:24; LAM 2:7; AMO 7:9; MAL 2:11

Dishonesty in dealings

EZK 28:18

Idolatry

See also LEV 20:3; EZK 8:6, EZK 23:38–23:39

Profaning the sanctuary

EZK 44:7–44:8; ; ZEP 3:4

Sanctuary from vengeance: the cities of refuge

JOS 20:2–20:3 See also NUM 35:6, NUM 35:9–35:12

God himself is his people’s sanctuary

PSA 31:20 See also DEU 33:27; PSA 17:7–17:9, PSA 27:1, PSA 32:7, PSA 46:1, PSA 64:1–64:2, PSA 91:4; ISA 25:4; EZK 11:16; ROM 8:38–8:39; PHP 4:7; HEB 6:19

Non-material “sanctuaries” of God

Heaven, where God is perfectly worshipped

PSA 102:19 See also HEB 9:24

God’s worshipping people, in whom God dwells

PSA 114:2 See also 1CO 6:19; EPH 2:21; 1PE 2:5

Jesus Christ himself as the “place” where God dwelt on earth

JHN 2:19–2:21

7440: scapegoat

A goat which was sent into the wilderness by the high priest, as a symbol of the removal of the sins of the people.

The scapegoat as part of an OT ritual

LEV 16:7–16:10, LEV 16:20–16:22 See also LEV 16:26; ISA 53:4

The scapegoat anticipates Jesus Christ's atonement

JHN 1:29; ; 2CO 5:21; ; HEB 9:11–9:14 Jesus Christ's death is here contrasted with the OT sacrificial system.

7442: shrine

A local sanctuary, often dedicated to pagan worship. Before the building of the temple the Israelites worshipped at several divinely sanctioned shrines; afterwards, worship at a central sanctuary was required. True worship of God required that pagan shrines be destroyed. It was Israel's failure to abandon these religious sites that led to syncretism and apostasy.

Common features of pagan shrines

A location on high ground under trees

EZK 6:13 Mountains were considered the dwelling-places of the gods, whilst trees were associated with fertility. See also 2KI 17:10; ISA 1:29 sacred trees; JER 2:20; EZK 18:11 mountain shrines; EZK 20:28

Idols and sacred symbols

ISA 44:13 See also 2KI 10:26–10:27, 2KI 17:29–17:31; 2CH 34:3–34:4; ACT 19:24

A serving priesthood

2KI 23:5, 2KI 23:20

Sacrifice to the deity

JER 48:35 See also 1KI 22:43; 2KI 12:3, 2KI 16:4 parallel 2CH 28:4; 2CH 28:25

Shrine-prostitution

GEN 38:21–38:22; ; DEU 23:17; ; 1KI 14:24, 1KI 15:12; ; JOB 36:14

Pagan shrines were to be destroyed

On Israel's entry into Canaan

DEU 12:2–12:3 See also EXO 34:13–34:14; NUM 33:52; DEU 7:5

As a sign of religious reformation

JDG 6:25; 2KI 23:8–23:20 See also 2KI 10:25; 2CH 14:3, 2CH 17:6; 2KI 18:4

Shrines in Israel for the worship of God

Worship at the high places

1KI 3:2–3:3 Following Canaanite custom, Israel set up shrines on high ground possibly, against God's instruction, at old Baal sites. Worship at these non-legitimate sites was condemned. See also 2CH 33:17

Worship at sites sanctioned by God

EXO 20:24 See also JDG 6:22–6:24; 1SA 9:12–9:14, 1SA 10:5

Examples of shrines dedicated to God

Bethel: GEN 12:8; ; JDG 21:2; JOS 18:1; ; JDG 21:19; JDG 20:1; ; 1SA 7:6; 1KI 3:4–3:5; ; 1CH 16:39–16:40; ; 2CH 1:13

A central place of worship was later required

2KI 18:22 parallel ISA 36:7 Following the building of the temple, worship in various scattered shrines was condemned, probably because of associations with pagan worship. See also DEU 12:4–12:7 The central sanctuary was, initially, the place where the tabernacle was located. Eventually this was superseded by the temple; 2SA 7:13 parallel 1CH 17:12

Israel's failure to abandon worship at the shrines led to apostasy

Improper worship at shrines dedicated to God

JDG 17:5 See also JDG 18:30–18:31; 1KI 12:28–12:31, 1KI 13:32; 2KI 17:32–17:33; 2CH 11:15; AMO 4:4

The corruption of temple worship

2KI 23:4–23:7; ; EZK 8:14–8:16

Shrines dedicated to false gods

1KI 14:23–14:24; EZK 8:12 See also 1KI 11:7–11:8; 2KI 21:2–21:3; JER 7:31, JER 19:5, JER 32:35 AMO 5:26; ACT 7:43

Israel's spiritual adultery

EZK 16:24–16:25 See also JER 3:6; EZK 16:39, EZK 18:6; HOS 4:12–4:13

God's judgment on false places of worship

EZK 6:3–6:6 See also LEV 26:30–26:31; HOS 10:8

7444: sin offering

Offerings to make atonement for both moral and ritual offences. The NT sees them as foreshadowing the death of Jesus Christ as an offering for human sin.

Occasions when a sin offering was required

Unintentional sins against God's laws: LEV 4:2; ; HEB 9:7; LEV 5:1–5:4, LEV 4:20 The consequence of the offering is atonement and forgiveness.; LEV 12:6–12:8; ; LUK 2:24; LEV 14:13–14:31; ; MRK 1:44; LEV 15:15, LEV 15:30

The form the sin offering took depended on who committed the sin

LEV 4:3 a priest who sins; ; LEV 4:14 the sin of the community as a whole; ; LEV 4:22–4:23 a leader who sins unintentionally; LEV 4:27–4:35, LEV 5:5–5:6

The ceremony when presenting an animal as a sin offering

The guilty identify themselves with the offering before killing it

LEV 4:4, LEV 4:15, LEV 4:24

Confession

LEV 5:5

Blood, representing the victim's lifeblood, is put on the altar

LEV 4:25, LEV 4:30, LEV 4:34

The best parts, being burned on the altar, are offered to God

LEV 4:8–4:10, LEV 4:26, LEV 4:35

Male members of priestly families may eat what remains

LEV 6:26, LEV 6:29, LEV 10:16–10:20

Special procedures for the offerings of the poor

LEV 5:7–5:13

The special ceremony for priests and the community presenting a sin offering

Blood is taken into the sanctuary and placed on the altar

LEV 4:5–4:7, LEV 4:16–4:18

The rest of the animal is incinerated, not eaten

LEV 4:11–4:12, LEV 4:21 emphasising the identity between the victim and the sin of the community

Significant occasions when sin offerings were made

LEV 8:14–8:17 at the ordination of Aaron and his sons; ; LEV 16:1–16:34 on the Day of Atonement; ; 2KI 12:16 during Josiah's reformation; ; 2CH 29:21–29:24 at the beginning of Hezekiah's reign; ; EZR 6:17 at the dedication of the second temple; ; EZR 8:35 when the exiles returned; EZK 40:39, EZK 42:13, EZK 43:19, EZK 43:21

The NT perspective on the sin offering

Jesus Christ was the supreme sin offering

ROM 8:3; 2CO 5:21 NIV footnote.

Animal sacrifices had limited value

See also HEB 9:7–9:10

The death of Jesus Christ brings full cleansing and forgiveness

HEB 9:11–9:14 See also 1PE 1:18–1:19

Unlike earthly priests, Jesus Christ needed no sin offering

HEB 7:27 See also HEB 5:1–5:3

7446: slavery

The state of being an unpaid servant, whether through forcible subjection or voluntary submission. Slavery was common in biblical times, and Scripture lays down strict guidelines as to how slaves are to be treated by their masters, stressing the new status that slaves have as a result of being believers in Jesus Christ. The image of slavery is also used to describe the state of sinful human beings.

7447: slavery, in OT

Slavery in the OT occurs when someone either voluntarily or forcibly becomes completely subject to another person's control.

Reasons for slavery

War

DEU 20:10–20:11 See also GEN 14:21; NUM 31:9; 2KI 5:2; 2CH 28:8

Purchase

LEV 25:44–25:45 See also GEN 37:23–37:28

Debt

2KI 4:1 See also EXO 22:2–22:3; LEV 25:39, LEV 25:47–25:48; DEU 15:12; NEH 5:1–5:5

Birth

EXO 21:4 See also GEN 17:12–17:13; ECC 2:7; JER 2:14

Conscription of foreigners as forced labour

2SA 12:29–12:31 See also EXO 1:11–1:14; JOS 9:22–9:23, JOS 16:10; JDG 1:28; 1KI 9:20–9:21

Rights of slaves

Rights of protection against physical and sexual abuse

LEV 25:43 See also EXO 21:7–21:11, EXO 21:20–21:21, EXO 21:26–21:27

Rights to participate in religious feasts and festivals

EXO 23:12 See also EXO 20:9–20:10; DEU 12:11–12:12

Rights to inherit property

GEN 15:3

Rights of asylum

DEU 23:15

The release of slaves

Release in the Year of Jubilee

LEV 25:54–25:55 See also LEV 25:39–25:41

Release after six years of service

EXO 21:2 See also EXO 21:3–21:6; DEU 15:12–15:18; JER 34:8–34:20 The six-year principle was being abused in the time of Jeremiah.

Release through redemption by a near relative

LEV 25:47–25:53

The status of slaves

Slaves as property

LEV 25:46 See also EXO 21:32; LEV 25:39–25:42 Fellow Israelites were not to be regarded as property.

Slaves as trusted advisors

1SA 9:5–9:10

7448: slavery, in NT

The NT does not condone slavery but recognises that slavery exists, and that many slaves have become believers. The status of slaves in the church is transformed by the work of Jesus Christ. Slaves were accorded greater respect because they were seen to be spiritually equal with others.

Examples of slavery in the NT

ACT 16:16–16:21 Paul and Silas deliver a demon-possessed slave girl; ; PHM 1:8–1:21 Paul returns the runaway slave Onesimus to his master.

The gospel transforms the status of slaves

1CO 12:13; GAL 3:26–3:28

Instructions concerning slavery

Instructions to Christian slaves

EPH 6:5–6:8 See also 1CO 7:20–7:24; COL 3:22–3:24; 1TI 6:1–6:2; TIT 2:9–2:10; 1PE 2:18–2:21

Instructions to Christian masters

EPH 6:9 See also COL 4:1; PHM 1:8–1:17

The immorality of trading in slaves

1TI 1:9–1:10

7449: slavery, spiritual

Because of sin humanity is in a state of slavery. On account of the atoning work of Jesus Christ, believers can break free from slavery to sin and enter into the glorious liberty of the children of God.

Humanity is enslaved

To sin

JHN 8:33–8:36 See also ROM 6:12–6:18; ROM 7:7–7:25; TIT 3:3; 2PE 2:19

To the law

GAL 5:1 See also GAL 4:1–4:7

To fear

ROM 8:15 See also HEB 2:14–2:15

Jesus Christ as the example of the true slave

JHN 13:1–13:17 Washing feet was the responsibility of the slaves of the household. See also MAT 20:25–20:28 parallel MRK 10:42–10:45; PHP 2:5–2:11

Believers as slaves of God

They are God's servants

ROM 6:22 See also MAT 6:24 parallel LUK 16:13; ROM 1:1; COL 3:23–3:24; JAS 1:1; 1PE 2:16; 2PE 1:1

They are sons and heirs

GAL 4:1–4:7 See also ROM 8:12–8:17

They have friendship with Jesus Christ

JHN 15:15 See also JAS 2:21–2:23

They have true freedom

JHN 8:31–8:36 See also GAL 4:21–4:31

Believers as slaves of righteousness

ROM 6:15–6:23

Believers as slaves of others

MAT 20:25–20:28 parallel MRK 10:42–10:45 See also 1CO 9:19; 2CO 4:5; GAL 5:13

The image of slavery in the teaching of Jesus Christ

MAT 24:45–24:51 parallel LUK 12:42–12:46 Slavery involves readiness for the Master's return; ; MAT 25:14–25:20 parallel LUK 19:12–19:17 Slavery involves faithfulness to the Master's purpose; ; LUK 17:7–17:10 Slavery involves diligence for the Master's good.

Creation is itself in slavery until Jesus Christ returns

ROM 8:19–8:22

7452: snake, bronze

The means of salvation for Israel in the wilderness, a parallel to be found in Jesus Christ.

Healing and salvation resulted from looking at the bronze snake

NUM 21:8–21:9 See also NUM 21:4–21:7

The bronze snake became an object of idolatrous worship

2KI 18:4

The bronze snake parallels Jesus Christ's crucifixion

JHN 3:14–3:15

7454: sprinkling

In the OT, the blood of a sacrificial animal was sprinkled against the altar as a sign of atonement or consecration to the LORD. The NT uses the same image to refer to the gaining of forgiveness through the sacrificial death of Jesus Christ.

Sprinkling of an animal's blood as a sign of atonement

On the altar

LEV 7:2 See also EXO 24:6; LEV 1:5, LEV 1:11, LEV 3:2, LEV 3:8, LEV 3:13, LEV 5:9, LEV 9:12, LEV 9:18, LEV 17:6; NUM 18:17; 2KI 16:13, 2KI 16:15; 2CH 29:22–29:24, 2CH 30:16, 2CH 35:11; EZK 43:18, EZK 43:20; HEB 9:21

In front of the inner curtain in the tabernacle

LEV 4:6 See also LEV 4:17

Towards the front of the Tent of Meeting

NUM 19:4

On the front of the atonement cover

LEV 16:14–16:16

On the door-frames of the houses where the Passover lamb was eaten

EXO 12:7 See also EXO 12:22; HEB 11:28

Sprinkling of blood as a sign of consecration

The consecration of people

EXO 24:8 See also EXO 29:20–29:21; LEV 8:23; HEB 9:19

The consecration of the altar

LEV 16:18–16:19

Sprinkling of oil as a sign of consecration

LEV 8:11 See also LEV 8:30, LEV 14:15–14:16, LEV 14:27

Sprinkling (usually with water) as a sign of cleansing

NUM 8:7; EZK 36:25 See also LEV 14:7, LEV 14:51; NUM 19:13, NUM 19:18–19:21; ISA 52:15; HEB 9:13

Sprinkling as an image of forgiveness in Christ

1PE 1:2 See also HEB 9:11–9:14, HEB 9:18–9:28, HEB 10:22, HEB 12:24

Sprinkling of dust as a visible sign of mourning

JOS 7:6 See also JOB 2:12; LAM 2:10; EZK 27:30

7456: synagogue

A word meaning literally “a gathering together”. In the NT it sometimes refers to a group of Jews meeting for worship but most often to the building in which they met.

Synagogue worship may have begun during the exile

EZK 14:1 Unable to sacrifice in the temple, the community met together with spiritual leaders. See also EZK 20:1

A synagogue might be established anywhere

MRK 1:21 See also ACT 6:9 in Jerusalem ACT 16:12–16:13, ACT 16:16 ACT 17:1, ACT 17:10, ACT 18:19

The role of the synagogue

It was a focus for prayer and the reading of Scripture

ACT 13:15 See also NEH 8:2–8:8, NEH 9:3; LUK 4:15–4:33

It was a centre for community affairs

MAT 10:17; ; MRK 13:9; ; LUK 12:11

Exclusion from the synagogue was used as a punishment

JHN 9:22, JHN 12:42

The leading of synagogue worship

It was the responsibility of the synagogue ruler

MRK 5:22; ; ACT 18:8

Qualified laymen were allowed to teach

LUK 4:16 See also ACT 13:15

Attendance at the synagogue

It was the practice of Jesus Christ

MAT 9:35 See also MRK 6:2; LUK 4:16; JHN 6:59

It was the practice of Paul and other Jewish Christians

ACT 9:19–9:20 See also ACT 14:1–14:2, ACT 17:2, ACT 19:8

The first Christians continued to worship in the synagogues

LUK 24:53; ; ACT 19:8–19:9

7458: tabernacle, the

The tabernacle (tent) was a portable and temporary shrine used for worship before the temple was built. It denotes the temporary dwelling of God among his people.

7459: tabernacle, in OT

A prefabricated portable structure that was used for worship from the wilderness period until Solomon built the Jerusalem temple.

The tabernacle was the place of God's presence

EXO 33:9–33:10 See also EXO 25:8, EXO 40:34–40:35

The construction of the tabernacle**It was built at God's command**

EXO 25:9 See also EXO 25:40, EXO 39:32, EXO 39:43

The materials used in its construction

EXO 25:3–25:7 Many of these materials were available in the desert. Others, such as gold, would have been obtained from the Egyptians (Ex 12:35–36); ; EXO 35:21–35:24

The plan for its construction

EXO 26:1, EXO 26:7, EXO 26:14–26:15, EXO 26:26

The skilled labour employed in its construction

EXO 31:1–31:6 parallel EXO 35:30–35:35 See also EXO 35:10, EXO 35:26, EXO 36:1–36:2

The tabernacle courtyard and its contents**Its dimensions and construction**

EXO 27:9, EXO 27:12, EXO 27:18

The altar of burnt offering

EXO 27:1

The laver

EXO 30:17–30:18

The tabernacle's Holy Place and its contents**Its construction**

EXO 26:36–26:37

The incense altar

EXO 30:1, EXO 30:5

The lampstand

EXO 25:31

The golden table for the bread of the Presence

EXO 25:23, EXO 25:30, EXO 26:35

The tabernacle's Most Holy Place and its contents**It was separated from the Holy Place by a curtain**

EXO 26:31–26:33 It was designed as a perfect cube with sides of 10 cubits (4.5 metres).

It contained the ark of the covenant

EXO 26:33–26:34

The Levites were responsible for the tabernacle

NUM 1:50–1:51

The non-religious functions of the tabernacle**As a reference point for locating the different tribes in camp**

NUM 2:1–2:2 Symbolising that God was central to the life of the nation.

The movement of the cloud of glory showed when it was time to make or break camp

See also EXO 40:36–40:38

Places where the tabernacle was sited

The tabernacle was dedicated at Sinai: EXO 40:1–40:2, EXO 40:9–40:11; JOS 18:1; ; 1SA 1:3; ; PSA 78:60; 1SA 21:1 Nob; ; 1CH 16:39 Gibeon; ; 2CH 5:2–5:6 Jerusalem

7460: tabernacle, in NT

The NT sees the tabernacle and its ceremonies as symbolising the saving work of Jesus Christ in his incarnation and death and in the experience of believers.

Jesus Christ as the tabernacle where God dwells

JHN 1:14, JHN 2:19–2:21

The tabernacle showed that God was not limited to one place

See also ACT 7:44–7:47

The spiritual significance of the tabernacle

HEB 9:1–9:5

The earthly tabernacle as a copy of the heavenly one

HEB 8:5 See also HEB 8:1–8:2

The altar

REV 6:9–6:10, REV 8:3–8:5

The ark of the covenant

REV 11:19

The atonement cover

EXO 25:22; ; HEB 4:16

The curtain preventing access to the holiest place

MAT 27:51; ; HEB 6:19–6:20, HEB 9:8, HEB 10:19–10:20

Jesus Christ as high priest**Cleansing the earthly tabernacle**

HEB 9:21 See also HEB 9:6–9:8 on the Day of Atonement; HEB 9:25

Through the blood of the cross, Jesus Christ enters the heavenly sanctuary

HEB 9:24 See also HEB 9:28

7462: tassel

A fringe of twisted threads attached to the bottom edge of Israelite men's cloaks. The Pharisees lengthened the tassels on their cloaks to draw attention to their piety.

Tassels attached to outer garments

On the corners of garments

NUM 15:38 See also DEU 22:12

On the cloak of Jesus Christ

MAT 9:20 parallels MRK 5:27, LUK 8:44 The woman probably touched the tassels on Jesus Christ's cloak. See also MAT 14:36 parallel MRK 6:56

Tassels as a reminder of God's law

NUM 15:39–15:41 The movement of the tassels would draw back wandering eyes to God and his law.

Ostentatious tassels symbolise outward religious show

MAT 23:5–23:7 parallels MRK 12:38–12:39, LUK 20:46 See also MAT 6:1–6:6

7464: teachers of the law

Those professionally trained to develop, teach and apply the OT law. In the application of the law the oral teaching of these people often assumed greater authority than the written law. Thus, by the time of the NT, the teachers of the law were in conflict with Jesus Christ and the apostles, who taught with authority and condemned the outward religious acts that the teachers had fostered.

Teachers of the law mentioned by name

Ezra

EZR 7:1–7:21; ; NEH 8:1–8:18 Teachers of the law arose after the exile from amongst the earlier scribes whose duties were more strictly secretarial.

Nicodemus

JHN 3:10

Gamaliel

ACT 5:34 Teachers of the law belonged mainly to the Pharisees but as a body were distinct from them.

Teachers of the law in conflict with Jesus Christ

Concerning righteousness

MAT 5:20

Concerning Jesus Christ's authority

MAT 9:2–9:8 parallels MRK 2:5–2:12, LUK 5:20–5:26 See also MRK 3:22–3:27, MRK 11:27–11:33 parallel LUK 20:1–20:8

Concerning the seeking of signs

MAT 12:38–12:39

Concerning hypocrisy

MAT 23:2–23:33 parallels MRK 12:38–12:40, LUK 13:34–13:35, LUK 20:46 See also MAT 15:1–15:8 parallel MRK 7:1–7:8; ISA 29:13

Concerning the children's praise

MAT 21:15–21:16 See also PSA 8:2

Concerning Jesus Christ's mixing with sinners

MRK 2:16–2:17 parallel LUK 5:30–5:32 See also LUK 15:1–15:7

Concerning Jesus Christ's identity

MRK 12:35–12:37 See also PSA 110:1

Concerning the Sabbath

LUK 6:7–6:11

The teachers of the law sought to get rid of Jesus Christ

By falsely accusing him

LUK 23:10 See also MAT 26:57–26:60 parallel MRK 14:53–14:56 The teachers of the law were entrusted with the administration of the law as judges in the Sanhedrin; JHN 8:3–8:6

By looking for ways to arrest and kill him

MRK 11:18 parallel LUK 19:47 See also MRK 14:1 parallel LUK 22:2; MRK 14:43; LUK 20:19 parallel MRK 12:12

By sending him to be tried before Pilate

MRK 15:1 See also LUK 22:66–23:1

The teachers of the law, with others, mocked Christ crucified

MAT 27:41–27:42 parallel MRK 15:31–15:32

Jesus Christ foretold the opposition of the teachers of the law

MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22 See also MAT 20:18–20:19 parallel MRK 10:33–10:34

Teachers of the law in conflict with the apostles

ACT 4:5–4:7, ACT 6:12

Teachers of the law in a non-confrontational setting

MAT 2:4, MAT 8:19–8:20, MAT 13:52; LUK 20:39; 1TI 1:7 See also MAT 7:28–7:29, MAT 17:10 parallel MRK 9:11; MRK 1:22; ACT 23:9

7466: temples

Buildings for the worship of local or national gods. After settling in the promised land, Israel felt the need for a permanent building set apart for worship of the LORD. Three temples were built at different periods in Jerusalem. In the NT the individual believer (or the body of the church) is seen as the true temple or dwelling-place of God.

7467: temple, Solomon's

From the exodus until the reign of Solomon, the tabernacle located in various places served as Israel's "temple" and the ordained place of sacrifice. Solomon built the first temple in Jerusalem.

Centres for worship and sacrifice before the temple was built

JOS 18:1; ; 1SA 7:2

David's preparations for the building and worship in the first temple

The plan for its construction

2SA 7:12-7:13; ; 1CH 17:1 parallel 2SA 7:1; ; 1CH 28:11-28:12, 1CH 28:19

The gifts for its construction

1CH 29:2-29:3, 1CH 29:6

Arrangements for the temple worship

1CH 23:3-23:5

Solomon's construction of the temple

1KI 5:1-5:13, 1KI 6:7; ; 2CH 2:17-2:18

The completion of the temple and its furnishings

2CH 2:5 Although it followed the basic pattern of the tabernacle, Solomon intended the temple to reflect God's greatness. See also 1KI 6:20-6:22 parallel 2CH 3:4-3:9 The inner walls were overlaid with gold; 1KI 6:27 parallel 2CH 3:11-3:12 The wings of the cherubim reached from wall to wall; 1KI 6:38 1KI 7:23 parallel 2CH 4:2; 1KI 7:26-7:27 parallel 2CH 4:5; 1KI 7:30 1KI 7:49 not one golden lampstand but ten; 2CH 4:8 not one table for the bread of the Presence but ten

The dedication of the temple

At the Feast of Tabernacles

1KI 8:2 parallel 2CH 5:3

The glory of the LORD filled the temple

1KI 8:6 parallel 2CH 5:7; ; 1KI 8:10-8:11; ; 2CH 5:11, 2CH 5:13-5:14

The offering of sacrifices

1KI 8:62-8:63 parallel 2CH 7:5

Solomon's prayer

1KI 8:27 parallel 2CH 6:18

The temple after the division of the kingdom

See also 1KI 12:26-12:30; 2CH 13:4-13:12

Later kings of Judah used the temple treasures for political purposes

1KI 15:18-15:19 parallel 2CH 16:2-16:3 Asa took silver and gold to persuade the king of Aram to be his ally against Israel; ; 2KI 12:17-12:18 Joash sent money and treasures to prevent the king of Aram attacking Jerusalem; ; 2KI 16:7-16:8 parallel 2CH 28:21 Ahaz used gold and silver to gain the support of the king of Assyria against his enemies; ; 2KI 18:14-18:15 Hezekiah used temple silver to placate the king of Assyria.

Foreign kings pillaged the temple

1KI 14:25-14:26 parallel 2CH 12:9 Shishak king of Egypt; ; 2KI 24:13; ; 2CH 36:18 Nebuchadnezzar

Under certain kings the temple was cleansed and repaired

Joash: 2KI 12:4-12:5 parallel 2CH 24:5; ; 2CH 24:13-24:14; 2KI 15:35 parallel 2CH 27:3 Jotham; 2CH 29:3-29:5, 2CH 29:15-29:16, 2CH 29:18-29:19, 2CH 29:25; 2KI 22:3-22:7 parallel 2CH 34:8-34:11 Josiah

The destruction of the temple by the Babylonians

2KI 25:13-25:15 parallel JER 52:17-52:19; ; 2CH 36:18

The temple and the ministry of the prophets

Isaiah received his call in the temple

ISA 6:1-6:8

Ezekiel had a vision of the glory of God departing

EZK 10:18-10:19

Micah's prophecy concerning the temple's fate

JER 26:18; ; MIC 3:12

Jeremiah's ministry was closely linked to the temple

JER 7:2, JER 7:4, JER 7:14, JER 19:14

7468: temple, rebuilding of

Following the exile Solomon's ruined temple was rebuilt and became the focus of the Jewish faith worldwide.

Preparations for rebuilding the temple

EZR 1:1-1:4 parallel 2CH 36:22-36:23 Cyrus gave permission for the exiled Jews to return to Jerusalem to rebuild the temple (538 B.C.); ; EZR 1:7 He sent back the temple treasures.

Rebuilding the temple under the leadership of Jeshua and Zerubbabel

EZR 3:3–3:6, EZR 3:8–3:13, EZR 4:1–4:3

Interruptions to the rebuilding

The Jews' enemies persuaded Artaxerxes to order the work to cease

EZR 4:8, EZR 4:12–4:15, EZR 4:17, EZR 4:20–4:21, EZR 4:24

The prophets Haggai and Zechariah called Zerubbabel and the people to restart work

HAG 1:4 See also EZR 5:1–5:12; HAG 1:5–1:7, HAG 1:14–1:15

The rebuilding authorised by King Darius

EZR 5:3, EZR 5:11, EZR 5:13, EZR 6:3–6:5, EZR 6:7–6:8

The dedication and worship of the rebuilt temple

EZR 6:16, EZR 7:11–7:17

The post-exilic temple and its worship was regarded as the spiritual centre for Jews world-wide

PSA 87:1–87:7, PSA 135:21

The temple is the place where God is to be praised

PSA 100:4, PSA 134:1–134:2 See also PSA 135:19–135:20, PSA 138:2

Prophecies of restoration of the temple

ZEC 1:16 See also JER 31:6, JER 31:23, JER 33:18; EZK 40:1–43:27

7469: temple, Herod's

Herod's temple, familiar to Jesus Christ and his disciples and frequented by the first Christians, was destroyed by the Romans in A.D. 70.

The building of Herod the Great's temple

JHN 2:20

Jesus Christ visited the temple and taught in its courts

He was taken there as a baby

LUK 2:22, LUK 2:34, LUK 2:36–2:38

He stayed in the temple courts after his parents had returned home from the Passover Feast

LUK 2:41–2:43, LUK 2:46

He cast out of the temple court those who used it for material profit

MAT 21:12–21:13 parallels MRK 11:15–11:17, LUK 19:45–19:46; ; JHN 2:14–2:16

He taught in the temple

MRK 12:35, MRK 12:41–12:43 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4; ; JHN 7:14; JHN 7:32, JHN 7:45–7:46; JHN 8:2–8:3, JHN 10:22–10:24

The religious leaders challenged his authority

MAT 21:23 parallels MRK 11:27–11:28, LUK 20:1–20:2

He foretold the complete destruction of the temple buildings

MAT 24:1–24:2 parallels MRK 13:1–13:2, LUK 21:5–21:6

The crucifixion and the temple

One of the charges against Jesus Christ was that he had said he would destroy the temple

MAT 26:60–26:61

The curtain of the temple was torn in two at Jesus Christ's death

MAT 27:51 The curtain symbolised the barrier between God and his people caused by their sins.

Believers in Jerusalem met in the temple courtyards

See also ACT 2:46, ACT 5:12 Solomon's Colonnade was on the east side of the temple courtyard.

Apostles taught and healed in the temple courtyards

ACT 3:1–3:26, ACT 5:19–5:26

Stephen was stoned for allegedly speaking against the temple

ACT 6:12–6:14 **ACT 7:48–7:49**

Paul was accused of taking Gentiles into temple courtyards forbidden to them

See also ACT 21:27–21:28

7470: temple, significance of

The temple was both idealised and spiritualised by OT and NT writers.

The OT concept of an ideal temple in the future age of salvation

ISA 2:3 parallel MIC 4:2 See also ISA 56:4–56:7, ISA 66:20; JER 33:11; EZK 37:28, EZK 40:2–40:4 Ezekiel received a vision of a rebuilt temple to which the glory of the LORD had returned. Chapters 40–48 describe this temple and its worship in detail; HAG 2:6–2:8; ZEC 14:16; MAL 3:1–3:3

The superstitious belief that the presence of the temple in Jerusalem safeguarded the city

The origin of such a belief

2KI 19:32–19:36; ; PSA 132:13–132:18

The prophets knew that disobedience to God would be judged in spite of the temple

MIC 3:12 See also JER 7:4, JER 7:12–7:14

The link between the earthly temple and heaven

Heaven is described as God's temple

PSA 11:4 See also HAB 2:20; HEB 8:5, HEB 9:24; REV 11:19, REV 14:15–14:17, REV 15:5–15:8

The ultimate “city of God” needs no temple, since it is permeated by God's presence

REV 21:22 See also REV 21:3

The risen Christ as the temple where God's glory is revealed

JHN 2:19–2:21

The church as the temple where God's presence dwells

The individual believer as the temple of the Holy Spirit

1CO 6:19

The local church as God's temple

See also 1CO 3:16–3:17

The whole church as God's temple

EPH 2:21–2:22 See also 2CO 6:16; 1PE 2:5 “house” here alludes to the temple. The church offers not animal sacrifices but “spiritual sacrifices” of praise and service.

7471: temples, heathen

Other nations also built temples to their gods, and apostate kings of Judah and Israel were condemned for erecting heathen temples in their own countries.

Heathen temples

The temple of Dagon: JDG 16:28–16:30; ; 1SA 5:2–5:4; 1SA 31:8–31:10; ; 2KI 5:18 the temple of Rimmon; ; NAM 1:14

Idolatrous temples in Israel and Judah

1KI 12:26–12:30 Jeroboam's temples at Bethel and Dan; 1KI 16:32; ; 2KI 10:21, 2KI 10:23–10:27; 2CH 23:17 A temple to Baal in Judah was destroyed in the reign of Joash.

The command to destroy pagan places of worship in Israel

DEU 12:2–12:3

Holy things and holy places were used for pagan worship

Ahaz: 2KI 16:10–16:13; ; 2CH 28:23; 2KI 21:4–21:5; ; 2CH 33:5, 2CH 33:7; 2CH 24:7 Athaliah's sons used objects from the temple for the worship of the Baals; ; EZK 8:12–8:16 God showed Ezekiel a vision of people worshipping false gods in the temple; ; 2CH 26:16–26:20 Uzziah incurred judgment by usurping the priestly task of offering incense in the temple.

7474: Tent of Meeting

A tent pitched by Moses outside the Israelite camp in the wilderness. There Moses met with God and others would enquire of the LORD. God's presence was shown there by a pillar of cloud. It seems to predate the construction and setting up of the tabernacle, after which, the term became synonymous with the tabernacle.

Moses pitched the Tent of Meeting outside the Israelite camp

EXO 33:7 The tent was outside the camp because of the LORD's estrangement from his people (Ex 33:3) following their making the golden calf. It was possibly a temporary structure used until the tabernacle was completed.

The Tent of Meeting was where the faithful met with God

Moses

See also EXO 33:9, EXO 33:11

Those who wished to enquire of the LORD

EXO 33:7

Joshua

EXO 33:11

The pillar of cloud at the Tent of Meeting

It indicated God's presence

EXO 33:9

Those who saw the cloud worshipped the LORD

EXO 33:10

The Tent of Meeting and the tabernacle

This Tent of Meeting may be distinct from the tabernacle

EXO 25:8–25:9

The tabernacle was constructed (in accordance with detailed instructions) after the Tent of Meeting

See also EXO 35:10–35:11, EXO 39:32–39:43

The tabernacle was set up after the Tent of Meeting
EXO 40:1–40:2, EXO 40:33

The Tent of Meeting as a synonym for the tabernacle

EXO 40:2 Afterwards “Tent of Meeting” became a synonym for the tabernacle, especially the tent part of the whole complex. See also EXO 40:6–40:7, EXO 40:22, EXO 40:24, EXO 40:29–40:30, EXO 40:34–40:35; LEV 1:1, LEV 24:3; NUM 1:1, NUM 31:54; DEU 31:14–31:15; JOS 18:1, JOS 19:51; 1SA 2:22; 1KI 8:4 parallel 2CH 5:5; 1CH 6:32, 1CH 9:21; 2CH 1:3

7476: thank-offering

Together with vows and freewill offerings this was one of the three kinds of fellowship offering.

Presenting a thank-offering

An animal sacrifice

LEV 7:15 See also LEV 22:29

Accompanied by bread, wafers and cakes

LEV 7:12–7:13 Cakes made with yeast can be offered, since these are not to be burned on the altar.

The priest shares the meal

LEV 7:14, LEV 22:29–22:30

The occasions for presenting thank-offerings

For deliverance from distress, death or sickness

PSA 50:23, PSA 107:21–107:22 See also PSA 56:12–56:13 deliverance from death; PSA 116:17 Deliverance from sickness; the earlier verses show the psalmist has been ill.

Following a vow

PSA 7:17 A vow to praise God in anticipation of an answer to prayer. See also PSA 66:13–66:14

At times of religious renewal

2CH 29:31 Hezekiah’s reformation; ; 2CH 33:15–33:16 Manasseh’s repentance; JER 17:26, JER 33:11

7478: washing

The physical or ritual cleansing of part or all of a person’s body, a person’s clothing or certain vessels. Washing can be symbolic of purification from defilement or cleansing from sin. It can also be part of preparation for a special act of religious service.

Washing as the cleansing of the body, clothing or certain vessels

EXO 30:17–30:21; LEV 13:53–13:54 See also EXO 40:30–40:32; LEV 6:27, LEV 14:8–14:9, LEV 15:2–15:13, LEV 16:24,

LEV 16:26–16:28; NUM 31:24; 2CH 4:6 parallel 1KI 7:38; JHN 2:6

Jesus Christ taught that inner purity was more important than ritual washing

MAT 15:17–15:20 parallel MRK 7:20–7:23 See also MRK 7:1–7:9 parallel MAT 15:1–15:3; MRK 7:14–7:15 parallel MAT 15:10–15:11; LUK 11:37–11:41

Washing as a symbolic act

Of purification from defilement

LEV 11:24–11:25 See also LEV 11:28, LEV 11:40, LEV 13:6, LEV 13:34, LEV 15:4–15:8, LEV 17:15–17:16; DEU 23:10–23:11; 2KI 5:10

Of cleansing from sin

1CO 6:9–6:11; EPH 5:25–5:27 See also PSA 51:2, PSA 51:7; ISA 1:16, ISA 4:4; JER 4:14; ACT 22:16; TIT 3:5; HEB 10:22; JAS 4:8; REV 7:14, REV 22:14

Of personal cleansing before a special act of religious service

LEV 16:24 See also EXO 19:10–19:11, EXO 29:4, EXO 40:12–40:13, EXO 40:30–40:32; LEV 8:6; NUM 8:6–8:7, NUM 8:21

Washing one’s hands was used as a symbolic declaration of innocence

DEU 21:6–21:7 See also PSA 26:6, PSA 73:13; MAT 27:24

7480: wave offering

A gift specially dedicated to God. The term itself may not be intended to convey a particular action.

The wave offering was part of every fellowship offering

LEV 7:34 Although given to the priests, the offering belonged to the LORD. See also LEV 7:28–7:32, LEV 9:21

The wave offering was eaten by the priests

EXO 29:26–29:28; ; LEV 10:15; ; NUM 18:11, NUM 18:18

Occasions for making a wave offering

As a cereal offering when priests were consecrated
EXO 29:23–29:24; ; LEV 8:27–8:29

As a guilt offering sacrificed at a ceremonial cleansing
LEV 14:12, LEV 14:21, LEV 14:24

As part of the ritual when a woman was accused of adultery
NUM 5:25

When celebrating harvest

LEV 23:10–23:11 the firstfruits of the harvest; LEV 23:15–23:17, LEV 23:20

When presenting a gift to God

Materials given for constructing the tabernacle: EXO 35:22, EXO 38:24, EXO 38:29

When dedicating the Levites to God

NUM 8:11 The dedication to God of the Levites symbolised the consecration of the whole nation. See also NUM 8:13, NUM 8:15, NUM 8:21

7482: Year of Jubilee

Celebrated in the fiftieth year as the culmination of seven sabbatical years. During this year property was restored and Hebrew slaves were released. This year of liberation gave opportunity for a new start, and is alluded to as a type of the Messianic age.

The institution of the Year of Jubilee

LEV 25:8–25:10

Land was left fallow in the Year of Jubilee

See also LEV 25:11–25:12, LEV 25:20–25:22 These instructions apply to the sabbatical year. The Year of Jubilee may have been an additional fallow year, or may have coincided with the seventh sabbatical year.

The restoration of property in the Year of Jubilee

LEV 25:13

Regulating the value of property

See also LEV 25:15–25:16, LEV 27:16–27:19, LEV 27:23

Underlining the fact that God is the true owner of the land

LEV 25:23–25:24 The restoration of property to those to whom God had originally entrusted it is a reminder that the land belongs to him. See also JOS 21:43; 1CH 29:15; HEB 11:13

A means of preserving the inheritance from God

LEV 25:25–25:28 Families are urged to buy back land assigned to them by God. As a last resort, land is restored in the Year of Jubilee. See also LEV 25:32–25:33, LEV 27:24; NUM 36:4, NUM 36:7–36:9; 1KI 21:3; EZK 46:16–46:18

The release of Hebrew slaves in the Year of Jubilee

DEU 15:12–15:15 The release of slaves reflects God's redemption and preserves the freedom he has given;

LEV 25:54–25:55 The Israelites may not be held permanently as slaves because they belong to God. See also LEV 25:39–25:43, LEV 25:50–25:52; JER 34:8–34:9, JER 34:13–34:14

The Year of Jubilee is the year of the Lord's favour

LUK 4:18–4:19 Jesus Christ alludes to the Year of Jubilee in proclaiming spiritual release and restoration. See also ISA 61:1–61:2

7500: Jews and Gentiles

- 7505: Jews, the
- 7510: Gentiles
- 7515: anti-semitism
- 7520: dispersion, the
- 7525: exclusiveness
- 7530: foreigners
- 7535: Greeks
- 7540: Judaism
- 7545: outsiders
- 7550: Pharisees
- 7555: Sadducees
- 7560: Samaritans, the
- 7565: Sanhedrin
- 7570: sects

7505: Jews, the

A post-exilic designation for descendants of the people from the kingdom of Judah and also for adherents to their religion from other nations. The term is used extensively in the NT where it has a variety of nuances.

Early use of the term ``Jews''**Pre-exilic and exilic use**

JER 40:11–40:12 See also JER 32:12, JER 34:8–34:9, JER 38:19, JER 40:15, JER 41:3, JER 43:8–43:9, JER 44:1, JER 44:26–44:27, JER 52:28–52:30; DAN 3:8–3:12

Used of the citizens of the province of Judah

EZR 5:1 See also EZR 4:23, EZR 5:5, EZR 6:7–6:8, EZR 6:14; NEH 2:16, NEH 4:1–4:2, NEH 4:12, NEH 5:6–5:8, NEH 5:17, NEH 6:5–6:7; ZEC 8:23

Used of the descendants of the exiles from the southern kingdom

EST 2:5 See also EZR 4:11–4:12, EZR 7:12–7:20; EST 3:1–3:6, EST 3:13, EST 4:3, EST 4:12–4:14, EST 6:12–6:13, EST 8:5–8:13, EST 9:1–9:3, EST 9:30–9:31, EST 10:3

NT use of the term ``Jews''**Jewish people in general**

MRK 7:3 See also MAT 28:15; LUK 7:3; JHN 2:6, JHN 4:9, JHN 4:19–4:22, JHN 8:31–8:32, JHN 11:18–11:19, JHN 11:31–11:33, JHN 11:45, JHN 12:9–12:11, JHN 18:20

Those Jewish leaders who were hostile to Jesus Christ

JHN 19:31 See also JHN 2:18–2:20, JHN 5:1–5:18, JHN 6:35–6:42, JHN 7:1, JHN 7:11–7:15, JHN 8:48–8:59, JHN 9:1–9:34, JHN 10:22–10:33, JHN 18:12–18:14, JHN 18:28–18:31, JHN 19:38, JHN 20:19

Jesus Christ as “king of the Jews”

MAT 27:37 parallels MRK 15:26, LUK 23:38, JHN 19:19–19:21 See also MAT 2:1–2:2, MAT 27:11 parallels MRK 15:2, JHN 18:33; MAT 27:27–27:31 parallel MRK 15:16–15:20; JHN 19:1–19:6; MRK 15:6–15:14 parallel JHN 18:38–18:40

The gospel first preached to the Jews

ACT 11:19; ROM 10:16–10:21 See also ACT 2:1–2:41, ACT 10:23–10:48, ACT 13:14–13:43; ROM 1:16, ROM 15:8–15:9; GAL 2:7–2:9

Opposition of certain Jews to the gospel

ACT 20:19 See also ACT 6:8–6:14, ACT 9:23–9:25, ACT 9:28–9:30, ACT 12:1–12:3, ACT 13:44–13:45, ACT 13:49–13:50, ACT 14:1–14:6, ACT 14:19, ACT 17:4–17:9, ACT 17:13, ACT 18:1–18:6, ACT 18:12–18:17, ACT 20:3; 2CO 11:23–11:25; ACT 21:27–21:36, ACT 23:12–23:15, ACT 24:1–24:9, ACT 25:1–25:7, ACT 26:19–26:21

Believers described as Jews and Gentiles

ACT 6:1 See also ACT 21:20–21:21, ACT 21:39, ACT 22:1–22:3; ROM 9:23–9:24; 1CO 1:22–1:24, 1CO 12:13

Jews and Gentiles equal in Christ

ROM 11:25–11:32; GAL 3:26–3:29 See also ROM 3:27–3:30, ROM 10:12–10:13; 1CO 12:12–12:13; COL 3:11

Jews and Gentiles equally in need of salvation

ROM 3:1–3:20

7510: Gentiles

Those who are not physical descendants of Abraham and were therefore regarded as being excluded from the promise made to him and his descendants. The Gentiles are often referred to as “the nations” in OT writings.

7511: Gentiles, in OT

Under the OT, Gentiles were generally excluded from the worship of the synagogue and from all the privileges of being Jewish. However, the OT made provision for non-Jews who believed in the God of Israel.

Believing foreigners were permitted to participate in worship

EXO 12:48–12:49 See also NUM 9:14, NUM 15:13–15:16; 1KI 8:41–8:43; ISA 56:6–56:8

Foreigners living in Israel were to be treated kindly

EXO 23:9 See also EXO 22:21; LEV 19:9–19:10, LEV 24:22; DEU 26:12–26:15, DEU 27:19

Divine promises concerning the Gentiles

All people will be blessed through Abraham

GEN 12:3 See also GEN 18:18, GEN 22:18; GAL 3:8–3:9

All nations will bow before God

PSA 22:27–22:28 See also PSA 86:9; DAN 7:14; AMO 9:11–9:12

The Gentiles will be enlightened

ISA 49:6 See also ISA 9:1–9:2, ISA 42:6, ISA 60:1–60:3; LUK 2:30–2:32

The Messiah will bring justice to the Gentiles

MAT 12:18–12:21 See also ISA 42:1–42:4

Gentiles will become God’s people

ROM 9:22–9:25 See also HOS 2:23; 1PE 2:10

Gentiles will praise God

ROM 15:9–15:12 See also DEU 32:43; 2SA 22:50; PSA 18:49; ISA 11:10

7512: Gentiles, in NT

Although Jesus Christ initially preached to Israel, his mission was soon extended to the Gentiles. From the outset, the Christian church accepted Gentiles as full members, refusing to make any distinction between Jew and Gentile. Paul, “the apostle to the Gentiles”, laid particular emphasis on their role in the purposes of God.

Gentiles in Jesus Christ’s earthly ministry

Jesus Christ’s contact with Gentiles

MAT 8:5–8:13 parallel LUK 7:1–7:10; ; **MAT 15:21–15:28** parallel MRK 7:24–7:30

Jesus Christ’s teaching concerning Gentiles

MAT 21:33–21:43 parallels MRK 12:1–12:11, LUK 20:9–20:16 **LUK 21:20–21:24**

Jesus Christ’s instructions to his disciples concerning Gentiles

See also MAT 10:5–10:6 Initially the disciples were commanded to preach to Jews, but after his resurrection, Jesus Christ commissioned them to preach the message of the kingdom of God to all nations. **MAT 28:19–28:20** MRK 16:15–16:16; LUK 24:46–24:47

Peter sent to Gentiles

ACT 10:28 See also ACT 10:9–10:20, ACT 11:5–11:14 **ACT 10:44–10:48** See also ACT 11:15, ACT 15:7–15:8

Paul, apostle to the Gentiles

GAL 2:7–2:9 See also ACT 9:15, ACT 22:21, ACT 26:15–26:23; ROM 1:13–1:15, ROM 11:13, ROM 15:15–15:19; GAL 2:2; EPH 3:1; 1TI 2:7; 2TI 4:17

Rejected by Jews, Paul turns more to the Gentiles

ACT 18:6 See also ACT 13:46, ACT 28:28

Response of the Gentiles to Paul's preaching

ACT 13:48 See also ACT 14:1–14:2, ACT 15:12, ACT 21:19; 1CO 1:23–1:24

Difficulties concerning the acceptance of Gentiles into the church

The question of mixing with Gentiles

ACT 11:2–11:3 See also ACT 11:15–11:18; GAL 2:12–2:13

The question of circumcision

ACT 15:5–15:31 See also GAL 2:1–2:5, GAL 5:1–5:6

NT teaching on Gentiles

Gentiles now share the inheritance of God's people Israel

EPH 2:13; REV 5:9–5:10 See also ROM 3:29, ROM 11:11–11:21; GAL 3:29; REV 7:9, REV 14:6

There is no distinction between Jews and Gentiles

GAL 3:28 See also ROM 2:9–2:11; EPH 2:19–2:20; COL 3:11

God calls both Jew and Gentile

JHN 10:16; ACT 13:47–13:48 See also ROM 9:24–9:26; 1CO 1:24–1:25; 2TI 4:17

Both Jews and Gentiles are justified by faith

GAL 3:6–3:14 See also ROM 4:9–4:12, ROM 4:16; GAL 5:6

7515: anti-semitism

A modern term, used to refer to a hatred of Jews or Arabs. Traces of anti-semitism may be discerned in biblical times.

The development of anti-semitism

EXO 1:8–1:14 Strictly speaking, this hostility towards the Israelites in Egypt after the death of Joseph was not anti-semitism as this word is now understood. See also EXO 1:15–1:16, EXO 1:22, EXO 3:9, EXO 5:6–5:9

Anti-semitism under Persian rule

EST 3:1–3:14 See also EZR 4:1–4:8, EZR 4:24

Anti-semitism under Babylonian rule

DAN 3:8–3:23 See also DAN 6:3–6:14

Anti-semitism under Roman rule

ACT 18:1–18:2

7520: dispersion, the

A technical term used to refer to God's people as they are scattered throughout the world.

The dispersion of the Jews

Promised and predicted

DEU 4:25–4:28; 1KI 14:15 See also DEU 28:15–28:68; LEV 26:27–26:35; NEH 1:8–1:9; JER 13:24; EZK 6:8–6:10, EZK 20:23–20:24, EZK 22:15

The prediction fulfilled

JER 50:17; DAN 9:7 See also EST 3:8; PSA 44:9–44:16; LAM 4:16; EZK 36:17–36:20; ZEP 3:10; ZEC 1:19; JHN 7:35 In NT times there were more Jews living outside Palestine than within.

The promise of return

ISA 11:12 See also DEU 4:29–4:31; JER 31:10; EZK 11:16–11:17

The dispersion of Christians

ACT 8:1 Christians scattered because of persecution;

1PE 1:1 See also ACT 8:4, ACT 11:19; JAS 1:1

7525: exclusiveness

The keeping of a distinctive group identity by drawing clear boundary lines, to separate those within the group from outsiders with whom they are unwilling to associate.

The practice of exclusiveness by God's people, grounded in God's claim to exclusive worship

EXO 20:3 parallel DEU 5:7 See also EXO 34:14; DEU 6:14–6:15; 2KI 17:35–17:39; ISA 42:8

Exclusiveness in Israel, a practical expression of being a people set apart

An expression of being set apart for God

LEV 20:26 See also LEV 15:31, LEV 20:23–20:24; DEU 7:1–7:6

An expression of being set apart from others

NUM 23:9 See also JOS 23:7; EZR 6:21; NEH 13:1–13:3; EZK 44:9

The practice of exclusiveness

Expressed in the avoidance of marrying outsiders

NEH 10:30 See also DEU 7:3–7:4; EZR 9:1–9:4, EZR 10:9–10:17; NEH 13:23–13:27

Expressed in a refusal to eat with outsiders

MAT 9:10–9:11 parallels MRK 2:15–2:16, LUK 5:29–5:30 See also LUK 15:1–15:2; GAL 2:12

The marks of Jewish exclusiveness

Circumcision

GEN 17:9–17:14 See also EXO 12:48; LEV 12:3; ACT 7:8

Festival observance

EXO 12:14–12:16 See also EXO 12:17–12:20; LEV 23:26–23:29; NUM 9:13

Observance of food laws

LEV 3:17 See also LEV 7:22–7:27, LEV 11:1–11:47, LEV 17:10–17:14; ACT 15:29 While food restrictions were not a requirement of the gospel, Gentile believers are here asked to respect the scruples of Jewish Christians in those areas that were traditionally important to them.

Sexual relations restricted

LEV 18:6 See also LEV 18:7–18:30, LEV 20:10–20:21; DEU 27:20–27:23

Effects of Jewish exclusiveness

Division between Jews and Samaritans

JHN 4:9 See also EZR 4:1–4:3; MAT 10:5–10:6 Jesus Christ was here dealing with his priority for that time; LUK 9:51–9:53

Division between Jews and Gentiles

ACT 10:28 See also MAT 10:5, MAT 15:21–15:28 parallel MRK 7:24–7:30 Jesus Christ restricted his earthly ministry in general to the people of Israel, but instigated a mission to the Gentiles after his resurrection; JHN 18:28

The problem of Jewish exclusiveness among the first Christians

The negative evaluation of Gentiles

ACT 11:1–11:18 See also GAL 2:11–2:13, GAL 2:15

The requirement that Gentile believers be circumcised

ACT 15:1 See also ACT 15:5; GAL 5:2–5:6, GAL 6:12; TIT 1:10

Jewish exclusiveness overturned

By God giving his Spirit to the uncircumcised Gentiles

ACT 15:8 See also ACT 10:44–11:18; 1CO 12:13; GAL 3:2–3:5

By the argument of justification by faith

GAL 2:15–2:16 See also ACT 15:9–15:11; ROM 3:28–3:30, ROM 4:9–4:12

7530: foreigners

Foreigners played a major role in the life of Israel. They surrounded her, and lived within her borders. In order to fulfil her mission as the bearer of God's law, Israel

had to distinguish herself from foreign nations and individuals, especially with regard to their religious beliefs. A clear distinction is made between foreign nations and foreign individuals, who are to be allowed to live freely among Israelites within the land.

The origins of foreign nations

GEN 9:19 See also GEN 11:1–11:9

The foreign nations of Ammon and Moab

GEN 19:30–19:38

The relation of Israel and Edom

GEN 25:21–25:34

Israel's relationship with foreign nations

Israel's captivity in Egypt

EXO 6:6 See also AMO 1:3, AMO 1:6, AMO 1:9, AMO 1:11, AMO 1:13; ISA 10:24–10:25 God's judgment on Assyria; ISA 47:6 the fall of Babylon prophesied; EZK 25:3, EZK 25:8, EZK 25:12, EZK 25:15, EZK 26:2; NAM 1:14 Nineveh's destruction foretold

Foreign nations as a threat to Israel

DEU 7:1–7:4 See also GEN 9:25, GEN 15:16 "Amorites" and "Canaanites" are both terms used to describe generically the races expelled by Israel from the land of promise, a fate brought on themselves by flagrant sin; LEV 18:25, LEV 20:23; DEU 18:12

The need for Israel to keep separate from foreign nations

LEV 20:26 See also NUM 23:9; DEU 7:4; JOS 23:7; JDG 2:2; 1KI 11:1–11:2, 1KI 16:31; EZR 4:3, EZR 6:21, EZR 9:12, EZR 10:11; NEH 10:30, NEH 13:3 Foreign religious beliefs and practices were seen as a constant threat to faith in the LORD. The command that Israel keep apart from foreign nations partly reflects a concern that Israel might adopt religious beliefs which compromise her commitment to the LORD.

Foreign nations are described as uncircumcised

ISA 52:1 Circumcision was a sign of being within God's covenant. But some foreigners were also circumcised (Jer 9:25–26). See also GEN 34:14; EXO 12:48; JDG 14:3, JDG 15:18; 1SA 14:6, 1SA 17:26; 2SA 1:20; EZK 28:10, EZK 32:26

Israel's relation with foreigners within her boundaries

Foreigners are to be treated graciously

LEV 19:34 See also LEV 19:10, LEV 23:22; DEU 10:19, DEU 14:29, DEU 24:19–24:21, DEU 26:12–26:13

Foreigners must not be oppressed

LEV 19:33 See also EXO 22:21, EXO 23:9; DEU 24:14, DEU 24:17, DEU 27:19; PSA 146:9; JER 7:6, JER 22:3; ZEC 7:10

Foreigners have a positive role to play in Israel
ISA 14:1

The rights of foreigners within Israel

Foreigners are to share in Sabbath-rest
 See also EXO 20:10 parallel DEU 5:14; EXO 23:12

Foreigners are to receive a fair trial
 DEU 1:16

Foreigners are to participate in festivals and ceremonies
 DEU 16:11, DEU 16:14, DEU 26:11, DEU 29:10–29:11, DEU 31:12; ; 2CH 30:25

Ultimately inheritance rights were envisaged for foreigners
 EZK 47:22–47:23

The obligations of foreigners are similar to those of native Israelites

NUM 9:14 See also EXO 12:19, EXO 12:48–12:49; LEV 16:29, LEV 17:8, LEV 17:12–17:13, LEV 17:15, LEV 18:26, LEV 20:2, LEV 22:18, LEV 24:16 The penalties for blasphemy apply to Israelite and foreigner alike; LEV 24:22; NUM 15:14–15:16 The rules on the presentation of offerings are to be the same for both the Israelites and the foreigner; NUM 19:10, NUM 35:15; EZK 14:7

Occasional distinctions made for foreigners
 LEV 25:47–25:48; ; DEU 14:21, DEU 28:43

7535: Greeks

The inhabitants of Greece and her empire. The term is also used to describe non-Jews, so that “Greek”, in the NT, is virtually synonymous with “Gentile”. While distinctions between Greek and Jew on the one hand, and Greek and barbarian on the other, were important in the world at large, such divisions are to have no place within the church.

The cultural distinctiveness of Greeks in NT times
JHN 7:35 See also MRK 7:26; ACT 6:1, ACT 9:29; ROM 1:14

“Greeks” used to describe non-Jews

ACT 21:27–21:28 See also ACT 16:1–16:3, ACT 20:21; GAL 2:3

“Greeks” used to refer to God-fearers

JHN 12:20 See also ACT 17:4, ACT 17:12, ACT 17:17, ACT 18:4

Greeks may reject the gospel as foolishness

1CO 1:22–1:23 The high value placed by the Greeks upon human wisdom could hinder their response to the gospel. See also ACT 17:18–17:34

In Christ there is no distinction between Greeks and Jews

Greeks and Jews share the same salvation
ROM 10:11–10:13 See also ROM 3:28–3:30; 1CO 1:22–1:24

Greeks and Jews are united in Christ
COL 3:11 See also 1CO 12:13; GAL 3:26–3:29

7540: Judaism

Derived from “Judah” (the southern kingdom of the divided monarchy) the term refers to the religion and culture of the Jews from the time of the exile (586 B.C.) onwards.

The exile and the beginnings of Judaism

The people of Judah become known as Jews

EZR 4:12; ; NEH 4:2; ; EST 3:6; ; JER 32:12; ; MAT 2:2; ; JHN 2:6

Jewish communities were formed in many places

JER 44:1; ; EZR 2:1 many stayed in Babylon; ; JHN 7:35; ; ACT 2:8–2:11

Far from the Jerusalem temple, the exiles had difficulty in knowing how to worship

PSA 137:4 See also HOS 3:4 This prophecy to Israel also expresses the dilemma of the Jerusalem exiles.

New forms of religion after the exile, probably beginning in Babylon

Emphasis on the Scriptures

NEH 7:73–8:3

Synagogue worship

LUK 4:16–4:17 Unable to sacrifice in the temple, the exiles would have focused their worship on the Scriptures, a practice which developed into synagogue worship.

Carefully observing the law

Ezra went from Babylon to Jerusalem with the express intention of seeing that God’s law was observed: EZR 7:11, EZR 7:14, EZR 7:25

The temple and sacrifice

The returning exiles recommence the sacrifices
 EZR 3:1–3:6

The temple rebuilt

EZR 3:8, EZR 6:14–6:15

The temple as a focus for pilgrims

JHN 12:20; ; ACT 2:5 They had probably come for Passover and were staying until Pentecost; ; ACT 8:27

The temple regarded with great reverence

MAT 26:59–26:61 parallel MRK 14:57–14:58; ; ACT 6:13, ACT 21:27–21:29

Studying and obeying the law

Studying Scripture

JHN 5:39

Total obedience essential

MAT 23:23; ; JAS 2:10

Human rules added to God's law

MAT 23:16–23:18; ; MRK 7:1–7:13 parallel MAT 15:1–15:9

High regard for the Sabbath and traditional rules associated with it

MAT 12:1–12:2 parallels MRK 2:23–2:24, LUK 6:1–6:2

Groups within NT Judaism

Pharisees

MRK 7:3–7:4 The Pharisees stressed the fulfilment of the law by individuals. See also LUK 11:38, LUK 18:10–18:12; ACT 26:5

Sadducees

ACT 5:17 A powerful minority group, politically astute whilst theologically conservative, they saw temple worship as the chief purpose of the law. See also MAT 3:7; MRK 12:18 parallels MAT 22:23, LUK 20:27

Teachers of the law (scribes)

They preserved, copied, taught and administered the law: MAT 17:10; ; MRK 9:14; ; LUK 2:46; ; ACT 4:5

Zealots

LUK 6:15 They favoured a “holy war” to drive out the Romans.

Non-Jewish converts

MAT 23:15; ; ACT 2:11, ACT 6:5, ACT 13:43

Judaism and Christianity

Conflict between Jesus Christ and the Jewish authorities

MRK 14:1 See also JHN 11:45–11:50

Conflict between the first Christians and Judaism

JHN 16:2; ; ACT 4:1–4:3, ACT 5:17–5:18; ; GAL 1:13–1:14

Conflict produced by Jewish influence among the first Christians

ACT 15:5 See also ACT 15:1–15:2; GAL 2:11–2:16 Judaism gave birth to Christianity. After an initial uneasy co-existence a total break finally ensued.

7545: outsiders

Israel recognised two general categories of outsiders: those who lived outside Israel, usually referred to as “the nations” or “the Gentiles”, and foreigners resident within Israel’s boundaries. The latter, usually referred to as “aliens”, were given considerable privileges under the covenant between God and Israel.

Israel's attitude to the Gentiles as outsiders

The nations as outsiders

LEV 20:26; ; NEH 1:8; ; PSA 2:1, PSA 46:10, PSA 106:35; ; HOS 7:8; ; JOL 2:17

The conversion of the Gentiles foretold

ISA 60:3 See also GEN 22:18; PSA 22:27; ISA 9:2; HOS 2:23

Israel's mission to the Gentiles was fulfilled in Jesus Christ

ACT 13:47 See also ISA 49:6; LUK 2:32; ACT 28:28; ROM 11:11; EPH 3:6

Jesus Christ calls both Jew and Gentile

JHN 10:16 See also ACT 13:47–13:48; ROM 9:24–9:26; 1CO 1:24; 2TI 4:17

Israel's attitude to aliens as outsiders

Aliens are to be treated as members of the people of God

EXO 23:9 See also DEU 29:9–29:15, DEU 31:12; JOS 8:33–8:35

Aliens are protected by God

PSA 146:9

Aliens must not be oppressed

JER 22:3 See also JER 7:2–7:7; EZK 22:29; ZEC 7:9–7:10

Aliens may share in Israel's worship

EXO 12:17–12:20, EXO 12:43–12:49; ; LEV 22:17–22:19; ; DEU 16:13–16:15

The Samaritans as outsiders in Israel in NT times

JHN 4:9 By including Samaritans in his ministry, Jesus Christ demonstrated his concern for those who were treated as outsiders by society. See also LUK 10:33, LUK 17:16; JHN 4:7

Christians are compared to aliens in the world

1PE 2:11

The witness of believers to outsiders

COL 4:5 See also MRK 4:11; 1CO 5:12–5:13; 1TH 4:11–4:12; 1TI 3:7

7550: Pharisees

A Jewish religious party whose members required a very strict adherence to the ritual law and to the traditions of their predecessors. They were hostile to the teaching of Jesus Christ, which they regarded as compromising their interpretation of the law.

7551: Pharisees, beliefs of

The Pharisees placed considerable emphasis upon the rigorous upholding of the law, particularly the traditional forms in which the law had been established by their predecessors.

Pharisaic interpretation of the law

Pharisees were the recognised custodians of the law
MAT 23:1–23:3

Pharisees emphasised the traditions of the elders
MRK 7:3–7:4 For the Pharisees the oral law, the traditions of their predecessors, had an authority equal to that of the written law. See also MAT 15:1–15:2 parallel MRK 7:5; GAL 1:14

Pharisaic observance of the law

The Sabbath

MAT 12:1–12:2 parallels MRK 2:23–2:24, LUK 6:1–6:2 See also LUK 13:14

Fasting

MAT 9:14 parallels MRK 2:18, LUK 5:33 See also LUK 18:9–18:12

Tithing

MAT 23:23 parallel LUK 11:42

Pharisaic doctrine

ACT 23:6–23:9

Pharisaic proselytism

MAT 23:15

7552: Pharisees, attitudes to Jesus Christ

Pharisees opposed Jesus Christ during his ministry and were among those who brought about his crucifixion. Some Pharisees, however, accepted Christ's teaching and believed in him.

Dialogue between Jesus Christ and Pharisees

They demanded a sign to prove his messiahship

MAT 12:38–12:42 parallel LUK 11:29–11:32 See also MAT 16:1–16:4 parallel MRK 8:11–8:12

They questioned him on matters of the law

MAT 19:3–19:9 parallel MRK 10:2–10:9 See also MAT 22:15–22:22 parallels MRK 12:13–12:17, LUK 20:20–20:26; MAT 22:34–22:40 parallel MRK 12:28–12:34; JHN 8:3–8:11

They called him Teacher

MRK 12:13–12:14 parallel MAT 22:15–22:16 See also MAT 12:38, MAT 22:34–22:36; LUK 7:39–7:40, LUK 19:39, LUK 20:21, LUK 20:28; JHN 3:2, JHN 8:3–8:4

Jesus Christ questioned them

MAT 22:41–22:46 parallels MRK 12:35–12:40, LUK 20:41–20:44 See also MAT 12:9–12:14 parallels MRK 3:1–3:6, LUK 6:6–6:11; MAT 21:24–21:27 parallels MRK 11:29–11:33, LUK 20:3–20:8; LUK 14:1–14:6

Social contact between Jesus Christ and Pharisees

LUK 7:36 See also MRK 7:1–7:2; LUK 11:37, LUK 13:31, LUK 14:1

Jesus Christ criticised the Pharisees

LUK 12:1 See also MAT 5:20, MAT 16:5–16:12 parallel MRK 8:14–8:21; MAT 21:33–21:45 parallels MRK 12:1–12:11, LUK 20:9–20:19; MAT 23:1–23:36 parallels MRK 12:38–12:40, LUK 20:45–20:47; LUK 11:37–11:52, LUK 16:1–16:15, LUK 18:9–18:14

The Pharisees opposed Jesus Christ

LUK 11:53–11:54 MAT 9:2–9:7 parallels MRK 2:3–2:12, LUK 5:17–5:26; MAT 9:10–9:13 parallels MRK 2:15–2:17, LUK 5:29–5:32; MAT 9:32–9:34, MAT 12:22–12:24; ; MRK 3:22; MAT 12:1–12:2 parallels MRK 2:23–2:24, LUK 6:1–6:2; MAT 12:9–12:14; ; MRK 3:1–3:6; ; LUK 6:7, LUK 14:1–14:6; ; JHN 9:13–9:16; LUK 7:36–7:39, LUK 15:1–15:2, LUK 19:37–19:40; ; JHN 8:13, JHN 9:39–9:41

The Pharisees were among those who engineered Jesus Christ's death

MRK 3:6 parallels MAT 12:14, LUK 6:11 See also MAT 21:45–21:46 parallels MRK 12:12, LUK 20:19; MRK 12:13 parallel LUK 20:20; MAT 27:62–27:64; JHN 7:32–7:49

Some Pharisees believed in Jesus Christ

PHP 3:4–3:11 See also JHN 3:1–3:2, JHN 12:42, JHN 19:38–19:40; ACT 15:5, ACT 23:6–23:9, ACT 26:5

7555: Sadducees

An influential Jewish party that denied the existence of the spirit world and the possibility of resurrection. Its members are portrayed as opposing Jesus Christ and the first Christians.

Many priests were Sadducees

ACT 5:17

Sadducees rejected the concepts of resurrection and spirit world

ACT 23:8

Sadducees questioned Jesus Christ about the resurrection

MAT 22:23–22:32 parallels MRK 12:18–12:27, LUK 20:27–20:38

Sadducees denounced by John the Baptist

MAT 3:7–3:10

Sadducees denounced by Jesus Christ

MAT 16:6–16:12 See also MAT 21:28–21:45 The chief priests were probably Sadducees (see Ac 5:17).

The Sadducees oppose the first Christians

ACT 4:1–4:3 See also ACT 5:17–5:18

7560: Samaritans, the

The people of the northern kingdom of Israel, named after its capital city established by Omri. At the time of the NT, Samaritans were despised by Jews, on account of their intermarriage with Gentiles after the fall of the northern kingdom in 721 B.C. However, the NT presents them as generally responding favourably to the gospel.

Samaria as the name of the northern kingdom

1KI 21:1 The entire northern kingdom is represented by the name of its royal capital, just as Jerusalem often represents Judah. See also 1KI 18:1–18:6; 2KI 17:24, 2KI 23:19; JER 31:5

The fall of Samaria

2KI 17:3–17:5

Samaria's population deported

2KI 17:6–17:18 Sargon II of Assyria completed the siege begun by Shalmaneser V, deporting (according to his own annals) over 27,000 of Samaria's inhabitants. See also 2KI 18:11–18:12

Samaria resettled by other peoples

2KI 17:24 This resettlement, the first of several, led to intermarriage, and is seen by many as the origin of the Samaritans of NT times. See also EZR 4:2, EZR 4:9–4:10

Religion in Samaria after its fall

Syncretism arises in Samaria

2KI 17:25–17:41 Those resettled brought their own gods with them, but also worshipped the LORD as the god of the land. Ultimately these inter-mixed peoples would abandon their polytheism and would accept the law of Moses.

Some in Samaria remain faithful and still make pilgrimage to Jerusalem

2CH 30:10–30:11 See also 2CH 30:1, 2CH 34:9; JER 41:4–41:5

Samaritans and the restoration of Jerusalem

Samaritans offer to rebuild the temple with the returning exiles but are rejected

EZR 4:1–4:5 The response of the Samaritans to this rejection, based on the Jews' desire to keep the faith pure, reflects the double-mindedness of their offer.

Ongoing opposition from the Samaritans to the work of the returned exiles

See also EZR 4:6, EZR 4:7–4:23

Samaria's religious background by the time of the NT

Samaria had established its own temple

JHN 4:20 The Samaritans built their own temple on Mount Gerizim. It was later destroyed by the Jews, which led to a hardening of attitudes between the two groups.

Samaritan Scriptures contained only the Pentateuch

JHN 4:22 Jesus Christ highlights the limited revelation of the Samaritans. Since their Scriptures contained only the Pentateuch, they were expecting a Messiah that they could know little about.

Samaritan and Jewish attitudes to one another

JHN 4:9 Samaritans were seen as being very lax in their religious observance, and Jews would not therefore share drinking vessels with them. By NT times the gulf between Jew and Samaritan was quite wide and bitter. See also LUK 9:51–9:56 The three-day journey from Galilee to Jerusalem involved overnight accommodation, which the Samaritans generally refused, causing many Jews to travel on the eastern side of the Jordan.

Samaritans and the ministry of Jesus Christ

Initially Jesus Christ instructs his disciples not to go to the Samaritans

MAT 10:5–10:6

Jesus Christ is opposed by some Samaritans

See also LUK 9:51–9:56

Jesus Christ ministers to a Samaritan woman and many Samaritans believe in him

JHN 4:4–4:30, JHN 4:39–4:42

Jesus Christ heals a Samaritan leper

LUK 17:11–17:19

Jesus Christ tells a parable about a good Samaritan
 LUK 10:30–10:37 For the Jews, the concept of a “good” Samaritan would have seemed very strange; but Jesus Christ shows that love and faith is not restricted to Israel’s boundaries.

Samaria and the ministry of the early first Christians

The risen Christ includes Samaria in the church’s mission

ACT 1:8

The church takes the gospel to Samaria

ACT 8:1 See also ACT 8:4–8:13, ACT 8:25

The apostles pray for the gift of the Spirit for the Samaritan converts

ACT 8:14–8:17 The delay in their reception of the Spirit until the apostles came from Jerusalem may have been God’s way of removing the old Jewish-Samaritan divide in the infant church.

The Samaritan church grows

ACT 9:31

7565: Sanhedrin

The Hebrew form of the Greek word “synedrion”, a council. The high court of the Jews, presided over by the high priest. Its 71 members included chief priests, elders and teachers of the law.

Jesus Christ and the Sanhedrin

Herod called together the Sanhedrin on hearing of the birth of Jesus Christ

MAT 2:4 This is probably a reference to the entire Sanhedrin.

Jesus Christ acknowledged the authority of the Sanhedrin

MAT 5:22

Jesus Christ foretold that he would suffer at the hands of the Sanhedrin

MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22 See also MAT 20:18 parallel MRK 10:33

These prophecies were fulfilled

MAT 26:57–26:68 parallel MRK 14:58–14:65

The Sanhedrin plotted to kill Jesus Christ after he had raised Lazarus

JHN 11:47–11:53

The Sanhedrin, powerless to execute anyone, brought Jesus Christ to Pilate

JHN 18:28–18:31

Nicodemus and Joseph of Arimathea were members of the Sanhedrin

See also JHN 3:1; MRK 15:43 parallel LUK 23:50–23:52

The term Sanhedrin could also apply to local councils

MAT 10:17 parallel MRK 13:9

Peter and John were brought before the Sanhedrin

ACT 4:5–4:21 See also ACT 5:21, ACT 5:27, ACT 5:34, ACT 5:41

Stephen appeared before the Sanhedrin

ACT 6:12, ACT 6:15

Stephen angered the Sanhedrin by his defence

ACT 7:54, ACT 7:57–7:58

Paul and the Sanhedrin

Paul was commissioned by the chief priests to persecute the church

ACT 9:14 Ac 22:5 makes it clear that the entire Sanhedrin was involved. See also ACT 9:1–9:2, ACT 9:21, ACT 26:10–26:12

Paul was brought before the Sanhedrin

ACT 22:30–23:1 See also ACT 23:6, ACT 23:28, ACT 24:20

Conspirators plotted to bring Paul before the Sanhedrin again, but he escaped

ACT 23:12–23:15, ACT 23:20

The Sanhedrin brought Paul to the Roman governor, Festus

ACT 25:1–25:2, ACT 25:15

7570: sects

The Pharisees described as a sect

ACT 26:5 The word “sect” in the NT does not have the same negative connotations as in modern society. The Greek word for “sect” is also translated as “party” in the NIV. See also LUK 5:30; ACT 15:5

The Sadducees described as a sect

ACT 5:17

Christians described as a sect

ACT 24:14 See also ACT 24:5, ACT 28:21–28:22

Sectarianism condemned

1CO 3:3–3:4; ; 2CO 12:20; ; GAL 5:20

7600: History of God's people in NT

- 7610: Council of Jerusalem

- 7620: disciples
- 7630: Twelve, the

7610: Council of Jerusalem

The Council of Jerusalem was possibly the first ``assembly'' of the Christian church, held c. A.D. 49

The Council met to consider whether circumcision was necessary for salvation

ACT 15:1 See also ROM 4:9; GAL 5:2-5:3

Paul and Barnabas came from Antioch to Jerusalem to meet with the apostles and elders

ACT 15:2-15:12

The Council agreed not to make it difficult for Gentiles who turned to God

ACT 15:19-15:21 The Council was concerned to avoid forcing Gentiles to adopt Jewish customs (such as circumcision), and at the same time to require Gentiles to behave considerately towards their "weaker brothers" of Jewish birth, not all of whom could be expected to acquire immediately the emancipated outlook on food-laws and the like that Peter and Paul had.

James showed how the decision had confirmed an earlier prophecy

See also ACT 15:15-15:18; AMO 9:11-9:12

The written judgment was taken to the Gentile believers by Paul, Barnabas, Silas and Judas

ACT 15:23-15:29, ACT 16:4

The Council's judgment proved to be a great encouragement to the Gentile believers

ACT 15:30-15:31, ACT 16:5

7620: disciples

The group of people called to follow and serve Jesus Christ.

7621: disciples, calling of

The term is applied to Christians in general, not to the Twelve only. It emphasises the importance of Jesus Christ's followers learning from Christ as their teacher.

Disciples learning from their master

ISA 8:16; AMO 7:14 See also 1KI 20:35; NEH 3:8; ISA 19:11; MAT 10:24; MRK 2:18 parallel LUK 5:33; LUK 6:40; JHN 1:35, JHN 9:28

Those referred to as disciples in the NT

The disciples as the apostles

MAT 10:1-10:2 The apostles were uniquely appointed as founding pillars of the church, but in some respects they were also representative disciples.

The disciples as believers in general

MAT 28:19; ACT 19:1-19:2 Christian believers, not fully mature. See also LUK 6:13, LUK 6:17; ACT 6:2, ACT 11:26

The disciples as an intimate circle of believers

MAT 18:1; ; MRK 4:10

How disciples are called

It sometimes implies physically following Jesus Christ and leaving everything

MAT 4:19 parallel MRK 1:16-1:20; ; MAT 8:18-8:22 parallel LUK 9:57-9:60; ; MAT 9:9 parallel MRK 2:14

Calling in a more general spiritual sense

JHN 21:19 See also LUK 9:23, LUK 14:25-14:27; JHN 8:12, JHN 12:26, JHN 21:22

How disciples learn from Jesus Christ the teacher

By repeating the words of Jesus Christ

LUK 11:1-11:4 The rhythmical form of much of Jesus Christ's teaching suggests he intended his words to be remembered verbatim. See also MAT 5:3-5:10

By signs

JHN 2:11 See also MRK 5:37, MRK 5:40 parallel LUK 8:51

By understanding the OT Scriptures

JHN 1:45 See also LUK 18:31-18:33, LUK 24:27, LUK 24:32, LUK 24:44-24:45

By understanding the parables

MRK 4:11-4:12 parallels MAT 13:10-13:11, LUK 8:9-8:10
See also MRK 4:34

By practical experience of mission

LUK 10:23-10:24 These words follow the sending out of the seventy-two. See also MRK 6:6-6:11; LUK 9:1-9:2 parallel MAT 10:1

In periods of being alone with Jesus Christ

MRK 6:31 See also MAT 16:21

In spite of their faulty understanding

LUK 24:25 See also MRK 9:32 parallel LUK 9:45; LUK 18:34

7622: disciples, characteristics of

The content of discipleship is most clearly seen in the Christian's relationship to Jesus Christ. But this also affects a person's relationship to God the Father, the cross, the church and the world.

Disciples and their relationship to Jesus Christ

Coming to Christ and following him

MAT 4:19 See also MAT 11:28; MRK 10:21; LUK 18:16

Receiving him

REV 3:20 See also JHN 1:12

Learning from him

MAT 11:29 See also MAT 24:32 parallel MRK 13:28

Lovingly obeying him

JHN 14:15

Trusting him

JHN 14:1

Confessing him

MAT 10:38 parallel LUK 14:27 See also MRK 8:38 parallel LUK 9:26

Imitating him

1CO 11:1; ; 1PE 2:21

Reflecting him

MAT 5:16

Abiding in him

JHN 15:4 See also JHN 6:66–6:68

Disciples and their relationship to God the Father

True sons and daughters of God

MAT 5:44–5:45

Discipleship and glorifying God

See also MAT 5:16

Disciples and their relationship to the cross

Self-denial

MAT 16:24 parallels MRK 8:34, LUK 9:23

Disciples and their relationship to the church

Treating other Christians as family

MRK 3:34–3:35 See also MAT 18:15–18:17; JHN 15:12, JHN 15:17

Disciples and their relationship to the world

They are to be active in the world but are to be distinct from it

MAT 5:13 See also MAT 5:14–5:16; JHN 17:11–17:23

They are to make other disciples

MAT 28:19 See also ACT 1:8

7630: Twelve, the

The inner circle of the twelve disciples, called by Jesus Christ to follow him and carry on his mission after his death and resurrection.

7631: Twelve, calling of

Jesus Christ's chosen companions, whom he called and trained to carry on his mission after his death and resurrection.

The calling of the Twelve

Their names

MAT 10:1–10:4 parallel MRK 3:14–3:19 See also LUK 6:12–6:16; ACT 1:12–1:13

Their selection was preceded by prayer

LUK 6:12–6:13

As Jesus Christ's companions, they were to share in his mission

MRK 3:14–3:15, MRK 6:7–6:13 parallels MAT 10:1, MAT 10:9–10:14, LUK 9:1–9:6; ; LUK 8:1

Jesus Christ promised them authority at the final judgment

MAT 19:28 parallel LUK 22:30

After Judas' death the Twelve became the Eleven

MAT 28:16; ; MRK 16:14; ; LUK 24:9, LUK 24:33; ; ACT 2:14

The Eleven became the Twelve again with the election of Matthias

ACT 1:26

The ministry of the Twelve after the resurrection supplemented by the appointment of deacons

ACT 6:2–6:3

The symbolic significance of the Twelve

The twelve tribes of Israel

GEN 49:28; ; EZK 47:13; ; MAT 19:28 parallel LUK 22:30
Twelve symbolises completeness and is associated with the rule of God.

7632: Twelve, diverse characters of

The Twelve were men of varied background, gifts and character.

The varied backgrounds of the Twelve

Peter, Andrew, James and John were fishermen: MAT 4:18, MAT 4:21; MAT 9:9 Matthew was a tax collector; ; MAT 10:4 Simon was a political activist.

The varied roles of the Twelve

Some took a prominent role in the group

GAL 2:9

Some played minor but significant roles

See also JHN 1:40–1:42 Andrew brought Peter to Jesus Christ; JHN 1:45–1:46 Philip brought Nathanael; JHN

12:20–12:22 Philip and Andrew brought the Greeks to Jesus Christ.

The varied temperaments of the Twelve

MAT 14:28 Peter was impetuous; ; LUK 9:54 James and John were fiery; ; LUK 22:4 Judas Iscariot was a traitorous loner; ; JHN 20:25 Thomas was cautious.

The Twelve had a common call to discipleship and witness

ACT 1:21–1:22

The fallibility of the Twelve

MRK 8:31–8:33 Peter misunderstood; ; MRK 16:14 Jesus Christ rebuked the Eleven for not believing reports of his resurrection; ; LUK 9:12–9:13 Jesus Christ tested their reaction to human need; ; JHN 14:8–14:9 Philip asked the way to the Father.

Jesus Christ gave the Twelve special teaching

MRK 4:10–4:11 about his parables; ; MRK 9:35 about power and position; ; LUK 18:31 about his destiny

Jesus Christ spent his last days and hours with the Twelve

MRK 11:11 after the triumphal entry into Jerusalem; ; MRK 14:17 at the Last Supper

The Twelve failed Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ's concern that they would leave him

JHN 6:67–6:70

Judas betrayed him

MAT 26:14–26:16 parallels MRK 14:10, LUK 22:3–22:4

They failed to support him in his final agony of prayer

MAT 26:40–26:41 parallels MRK 14:37–14:38, LUK 22:45–22:46

Peter disowned Jesus Christ

MAT 26:74–26:75 parallels MRK 14:71–14:72, LUK 22:60–22:61

All abandoned Jesus Christ

MAT 26:56 the exception was “the disciple whom Jesus loved”, present at the crucifixion (Jn 19:25–27)

7700: Leadership and the people of God

- 7703: apologetics
- 7706: apostles
- 7712: convincing
- 7715: deacons
- 7718: elders
- 7724: evangelists
- 7730: explanation

- 7733: leaders
- 7739: missionaries
- 7745: ordination
- 7748: overseers
- 7751: persuasion
- 7754: preaching
- 7766: priests
- 7772: prophets
- 7778: school of prophets
- 7781: seer
- 7784: shepherd
- 7793: teachers
- 7796: teaching

7703: apologetics

The art of explaining the faith in such a way as to make a reasoned defence against its detractors. Paul's Areopagus sermon is a classic example of biblical apologetics, which can be of value to all who are called upon to defend the faith today.

Paul's Areopagus sermon, a classic example of biblical apologetics

Paul speaks to his listeners on their own ground, starting on their own terms

ACT 17:22–17:23

Paul presents the Christian position

ACT 17:24–17:27

Paul supports his argument in a culturally appropriate way

ACT 17:28 Paul quotes from two secular writers, first from the Cretan poet Epimenides, and secondly from the Cilician poet Aratus.

Paul concludes his argument and calls for a response

ACT 17:29–17:31

Apologetics as a regular feature of Paul's ministry

ACT 18:4 See also ACT 9:26–9:30, ACT 18:19, ACT 19:8–19:10, ACT 28:17–28:31

Apologetics is part of the work of church leaders

TIT 1:9

All Christians share responsibility for the task of apologetics

1PE 3:15

Other examples of Christians engaging in apologetics

ACT 18:28 See also ACT 2:14–2:41, ACT 6:8–6:10

Apologetics alone is an inadequate way of presenting the gospel

1CO 1:17–1:25 See also 1CO 2:1–2:5

7706: apostles

Appointed representatives, deriving authority and responsibilities from the person or group represented. The word refers especially to Jesus Christ's twelve disciples and also to Paul. Scripture identifies the functions of apostles and their authority, which is derived directly from Jesus Christ.

7707: apostles, designation of

An apostle is one who is "sent" by Jesus Christ. The word is used to refer especially to the inner circle of Christ's twelve disciples, but is also used specifically to refer to Paul, who was commissioned as an apostle by the risen Christ. The term is also applied more loosely to certain other leading Christians in the NT period.

Jesus Christ as an apostle

HEB 3:1 This is the only place where the word "apostle" is used of Jesus Christ, though many passages refer to him as "sent"; **JHN 20:21** Jesus Christ, as God's "sent one", sets the standard and pattern for all who are likewise "sent" (i.e., for all apostolic ministry). See also MAT 10:40; MRK 9:37; JHN 5:23–5:24, JHN 12:44–12:45

The twelve apostles called by Jesus Christ

Their appointment

MRK 3:13–3:19 parallels MAT 10:1–10:4, LUK 6:12–6:16

Their number

JHN 6:70 "the Twelve" is frequently used to designate these specially chosen disciples. The number twelve evokes the twelve tribes of Israel. See also MAT 19:28, MAT 20:17; MRK 11:11; LUK 8:1; ACT 6:2; 1CO 15:5; REV 21:14

Their commissioning by the risen Christ

MAT 28:18–28:20

The replacement for Judas

See also ACT 1:15–1:26 The symbolic number (twelve) is thus preserved.

The qualifications for being an apostle

ACT 1:21–1:22

Paul as an apostle

His self-designation

GAL 1:1 See also ROM 1:1; 1CO 1:1; 1TI 2:7

His commissioning by Jesus Christ

ACT 26:12–26:18 Although not one of the Twelve, Paul saw the risen Christ and was directly commissioned by him, sent especially to the Gentiles; ; 1CO 15:3–15:10; ; GAL 2:8

Paul's apostleship and the church

1CO 9:1–9:2 In Paul's case the sense of title or office and the ministry and function virtually coincide. He is an apostle both because he has seen and been commissioned by the risen Christ and because he functioned as an apostle by founding churches.

Other apostles

Barnabas

Here apostles" may refer to their ministry as missionary evangelists or to their role assent" by the church at Antioch: ACT 14:4, ACT 14:14

James, the Lord's brother

1CO 15:7 The most natural meaning of the words is that James is an apostle. This interpretation is confirmed by other references to James; ; GAL 1:19, GAL 2:9

Andronicus and Junias

ROM 16:7

Silas

1TH 2:6

``Apostles" of the churches

2CO 8:23 "representatives" is the translation here for "apostles"; ; PHP 2:25 "messenger" is the translation here for "apostle"

False apostles

2CO 11:5 Paul ironically refers to his opponents as "super-apostles"; ; 2CO 11:13, 2CO 12:11; ; REV 2:2

7708: apostles, function of

In the NT apostles are servants, first of Jesus Christ and then of the church. Apostolic service embraces a wide range of specific functions.

The functions of apostles during the earthly life and ministry of Jesus Christ

Being with Jesus Christ

MRK 3:14 See also MAT 17:1; MRK 6:30–6:32 parallel LUK 9:10

Learning from Jesus Christ

MRK 8:31 See also MAT 18:1–18:4; MRK 4:10–4:12; ACT 1:2

Being sent out on a mission by Jesus Christ

LUK 9:1–9:6 parallels MAT 10:5–10:10, MRK 6:7–6:13 As Jesus Christ's representatives their ministry was an extension of his. See also MRK 3:14–3:15

Being commissioned to witness to Jesus Christ

ACT 1:8, ACT 10:39 See also MAT 28:18–28:20; MRK 16:15; LUK 24:46–24:49; JHN 17:18, JHN 20:21

Apostles in the early church**They were witnesses of the resurrection**

ACT 1:21–1:22 See also ACT 2:32, ACT 3:15, ACT 4:33, ACT 13:31; 1PE 5:1

They were servants of Jesus Christ

2PE 1:1 See also ROM 1:1; 1CO 4:1; 2CO 11:23; PHP 1:1; TIT 1:1

They were servants of the church

2CO 13:4 See also ROM 15:25; 2CO 4:5, 2CO 11:8; 1PE 5:1–5:3

They were the foundations of the church

EPH 2:20 Probably a reference to the apostolic preaching. The absence of the article before “prophets” suggests that “the apostles and prophets” represents one group of people, not two. See also 1CO 12:28; GAL 2:9; JUD 1:17 the prophetic ministry of the apostles

They preached the gospel

ROM 1:1–1:5 See also MRK 16:20; ROM 15:19–15:20; 1CO 1:17; GAL 1:15–1:16

They were guardians and teachers of the truth

ACT 2:42 See also JHN 16:13–16:15; ACT 5:42, ACT 6:2; EPH 3:2–3:6; 2TH 2:15; 2TI 1:11

They founded churches

1CO 9:1–9:2 See also 1CO 3:5–3:6, 1CO 3:10

They were authority figures within the church

ACT 6:2–6:6 The apostles took the initiative. Whilst they did not themselves appoint the Seven, they confirmed their appointment.

They were called to suffer

2TI 1:11–1:12 See also ACT 5:18; 1CO 4:9; 2CO 11:23–11:29

They were empowered by the Spirit

ACT 4:8 See also JHN 20:22; ACT 1:8, ACT 2:4; EPH 3:4–3:5

They were able to bestow the Spirit

ACT 8:14–8:18 Peter and John officially induct Samaritans as members of the body of Christ; ; ACT 19:6

7709: apostles, authority of

Apostolic authority derives directly from Jesus Christ, who commissions apostles. It is rigorously upheld within the church.

Apostolic authority is based on divine commission

ROM 1:5 See also ROM 1:1; 2CO 1:1; GAL 1:1; EPH 1:1; COL 1:1; 1TI 1:1; 2TI 1:1

Apostolic authority derives from Jesus Christ

MAT 10:40 See also MAT 28:18–28:20; MRK 6:7; 2PE 3:2

The authority of apostles is related to their ministry role

1CO 12:28 There appears to be a definite order of priority with apostles at the head. See also EPH 4:11

The exercise of apostolic authority within the church**In building up the body**

2CO 13:10 Paul had special authority as founder of this church. See also 2CO 10:8

In general oversight

ACT 4:34–4:35, ACT 6:2–6:6, ACT 15:6, ACT 15:22–15:23, ACT 16:4

In teaching

1TH 4:2 See also GAL 1:11–1:12; 1TH 2:4, 1TH 4:8

In appointing leaders

ACT 14:23

In church discipline

ACT 5:3–5:4, ACT 5:7–5:9; ; 1CO 5:3–5:5

The right to be supported

1TH 2:6 Paul did not demand such support (see 1TH 2:9). See also 1CO 9:4, 1CO 9:11–9:14; 2CO 11:7–11:9

The marks of a true apostle**False apostles exist**

1CO 9:2 See also 2CO 11:4–11:5, 2CO 12:11

Fruit confirms apostolic ministry

2CO 3:1–3:3

Signs confirm apostolic authority

2CO 12:12 See also MRK 16:20; ACT 5:12; ROM 15:19

7712: convincing

Persuading one's hearers of the truth of one's case. Scripture gives examples of people who have been convinced of the truth of God's word and of the gospel.

Examples of prophets convincing their hearers**Elijah at Mount Carmel**

1KI 18:20–18:39

Jonah at Nineveh

JON 3:1–3:9

Hardness of heart can prevent individuals from being convinced of the truth

The ministry of the prophets

JER 6:10 See also 1KI 22:15–22:28 parallel 2CH 18:14–18:27; JER 35:15; EZK 2:4–2:5; AMO 7:10–7:13

The ministry of Jesus Christ

JHN 12:37–12:40 See also ISA 53:1, ISA 6:10; MAT 13:13–13:15 parallels MRK 4:10–4:12, LUK 8:10; ISA 6:9–6:10; JHN 7:25–7:43

Examples of individuals convinced of the truth of the gospel

The Ethiopian eunuch

ACT 8:26–8:38

Paul

ROM 8:38–8:39 See also 2CO 5:14–5:15; 2TI 1:12

Paul sought to convince others of the truth of the gospel

ACT 18:4 See also ACT 17:2–17:4, ACT 19:8, ACT 26:28–26:29, ACT 28:23–28:24; 2CO 5:11

7715: deacons

Those who “serve” in the Christian community, assisting the elders or overseers (bishops). The Greek word which the NIV translates four times as “deacon” occurs a further 25 times in the NT, where it is translated as “servant”. It seems that all Christians have a general servant role, whereas some (deacons) are called to a specific office of service within the church.

The Seven: assistants to the apostles

Why they were needed

ACT 6:1–6:4 The verb “wait” means “to serve”.

Their qualifications and selection

ACT 6:3

Their names and appointment

ACT 6:5–6:6 Although the Seven are not actually called “deacons”, they were probably the earliest example of Christians carrying out the tasks which came to be linked with deacons.

Deacons were assistants to overseers in Philippi

PHP 1:1 All Christians are “saints” (that is, set apart for God), but overseers and deacons have specific roles assigned to them.

Qualifications for men and women deacons

1TI 3:8–3:13 There is no NT description of the precise role of deacons (although Ac 6:1–4 may imply a certain role). These qualifications would be appropriate for

people responsible for financial management, administration, and social service, such as that offered to widows; **1TI 3:11** The women may be deacons’ wives (NIV text), or deaconesses (NIV footnote).

Phoebe, a deaconess

ROM 16:1 NIV footnote.

7718: elders

Senior figures within Israel and the Christian church who are given special responsibilities for their people.

7719: elders, as community leaders

Since older men act as responsible leaders in many communities, “elder” is used as the title for a recognised leader.

Elders in early Israel

Elders represented their people

EXO 19:7 See also EXO 3:16, EXO 4:29, EXO 12:21–12:28, EXO 24:1

Elders assisted Moses

NUM 11:16–11:17 See also EXO 18:21–18:26; NUM 11:24–11:25

Elders met in a national assembly

JOS 23:2, JOS 24:1; ; JDG 21:16

Elders functioned as judges, sometimes in the town gate

DEU 19:11–19:12; ; JDG 8:14; ; RUT 4:1–4:12

Elders during the period of the monarchy

Tribal and town elders

1SA 30:26–30:31; ; 2KI 10:5, 2KI 23:1; ; JER 19:1

Elders were local representatives at national functions

1KI 8:1

Elders advised the king

1KI 12:6–12:8

Elders functioned as judges at the town gate

PRO 31:23 See also 1KI 21:8–21:14

Elders in Israel during and after the exile

EZR 10:8, EZR 10:14; ; EZK 8:1, EZK 14:1, EZK 20:1–20:3

Elders in NT Jewish society

Elders were local town and synagogue leaders

MRK 5:22; ; LUK 7:1–7:5

Elders were members of the Sanhedrin

MRK 15:1 See also MAT 5:22

Elders were guardians of religious traditions**MAT 15:1–15:2** parallel MRK 7:5 See also MRK 7:3**The elders' rejection of Jesus Christ predicted by him****MAT 16:21** parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22**The involvement of the elders in the trial and condemnation of Jesus Christ****MAT 27:1** parallel MRK 15:1**The elders' involvement with the first Christians**

See also ACT 4:5, ACT 4:8, ACT 4:23, ACT 5:21, ACT 6:12, ACT 23:14, ACT 25:15

7720: elders, in the church

In the NT a group of leaders responsible for managing and teaching a local church. As the name implies, they were normally men of experience and maturity. Although women played a very significant part in early Christian ministry, there is no specific NT evidence for women as elders.

Elders in the Jerusalem church**ACT 15:4** See also ACT 11:30, ACT 15:2, ACT 15:6, ACT 15:22–15:23, ACT 16:4, ACT 21:18**Elders are also called “overseers”****ACT 20:28** In Ac 20:17 they are described as “elders”. Here they are “overseers”. See also TIT 1:6–1:7**Elders are appointed by apostles or their delegates****ACT 14:23** Here, as always in the NT, people are appointed to a joint eldership. There is no NT example of a single elder leading a church. See also TIT 1:5**Qualifications for elders****TIT 1:6–1:9** As in Ac 20:17,28, “elder” is here synonymous with “overseer”. See also 1TI 3:1–3:7**The role of elders****As leaders****1TI 5:17** See also 1TI 3:5**As teachers****1TI 5:17** See also 1TI 3:2**As pastors and guardians against false teaching****ACT 20:28–20:31** See also TIT 1:9; 1PE 5:1–5:4**In the healing ministry****JAS 5:14****The remuneration and correction of elders**

See also 1TI 5:17–5:20

Elders are to receive respect and submission from church members**HEB 13:17** “leaders” is an alternative term for “elders”. See also 1TH 5:12; HEB 13:7**The twenty-four elders in heaven****The elders are seated on thrones****REV 4:4** These elders may be angelic beings corresponding to the 24 orders of Levites (1Chronicles chapters 24–25) or symbolise Israel and the church (compare Rev 21:12–14). See also REV 5:5–5:6, REV 11:16, REV 14:3**The elders worship God and the Lamb****REV 4:10–4:11** See also REV 5:8–5:14, REV 7:11–7:13, REV 19:4**7724: evangelists**

Those called by God to announce good news and, especially, to proclaim the good news of Jesus Christ. The work was first committed to the apostles and then to other believers gifted by the Holy Spirit for the task.

7725: evangelists, identity of

Some OT figures announced good news, but most evangelists are seen in the NT. The task was first given by Jesus Christ to the apostles and then to other believers. All Christians have a part in evangelism; there is, too, a special role of evangelist within the church, fulfilled by those with a particular gifting from the Holy Spirit.

An evangelist as one who announces good news**God as an announcer of good news****GAL 3:8** See also GEN 12:2–12:3, GEN 22:18, GEN 26:4; JER 31:3–31:4; ACT 10:36**OT messengers announce good news****PSA 96:2–96:3** parallel 1CH 16:23–16:24 **ISA 40:9** The good news of the end of the Babylonian exile. See also 2KI 7:9; PSA 40:10; ISA 40:1–40:5, ISA 41:27, ISA 52:7; NAM 1:15 the good news of the deliverance from Assyria; MAT 12:41 parallel LUK 11:32; ROM 10:15; 2PE 2:5**Angels announce good news****LUK 2:10–2:11** See also LUK 1:19; REV 14:6**John the Baptist announces good news****LUK 3:18** See also LUK 3:3, LUK 16:16**Jesus Christ as an evangelist****LUK 4:18–4:19** See also ISA 61:1–61:2; MAT 4:23, MAT 9:35; MRK 1:14–1:15; LUK 4:43, LUK 8:1

The disciples as evangelists

Jesus Christ sends out the Twelve

MRK 3:14 See also MAT 10:7-10:8; LUK 9:1-9:2, LUK 9:6

Jesus Christ commissions the apostles

MRK 16:15 See also MAT 28:18-28:20; LUK 24:47; ACT 1:8

The evangelism of the apostles

ACT 5:42 See also ACT 8:25 Peter and John preach the gospel in Samaria; ACT 15:7 Peter preaches the gospel to Cornelius.

Other believers as evangelists

Evangelists are gifted by God

EPH 4:11

Paul as an evangelist

ACT 20:24 See also ROM 1:9, ROM 15:19-15:20; 1CO 1:17; 2CO 2:12; GAL 2:7

Philip the evangelist

ACT 21:8 See also ACT 8:5, ACT 8:12, ACT 8:35, ACT 8:40

Other evangelists

ACT 8:4; 2TI 4:5 Timothy's calling includes that of an evangelist. See also MRK 5:20 parallel LUK 8:39; JHN 4:28-4:29; ACT 18:26 Priscilla and Aquila; 1PE 3:15

Evangelists within the family

MRK 5:19 1CO 7:16; ; 1PE 3:1-3:2; EPH 6:4; ; 2TI 1:5; ; TIT 1:6

7726: evangelists, ministry of

Evangelists proclaim the good news of Jesus Christ, calling those who hear to believe in him. This may be in the context of missionary journeys, often in partnership with others, or within a more settled ministry. Carrying out the task requires integrity and commitment in the face of hardships and danger; it also brings joy at seeing the church grow.

The task of evangelists

Announcing good news

ISA 52:7; LUK 4:43 See also ACT 5:42, ACT 8:12, ACT 11:20; ROM 10:15

Proclaiming the gospel

ROM 15:16, ROM 15:20-15:21 See also ACT 8:5, ACT 15:7; 1CO 1:17, 1CO 9:16, 1CO 15:1-15:2; 2CO 10:15-10:16

Testifying to the truth about Jesus Christ

ACT 10:42-10:43 See also JHN 1:35-1:36, JHN 15:26-15:27; ACT 1:8, ACT 2:32-2:33, ACT 17:2-17:3; 1JN 1:1-1:3

Calling people to believe in Jesus Christ

ROM 10:13-10:14 See also MRK 1:14-1:15; ACT 13:38-13:39, ACT 16:30-16:34, ACT 18:4, ACT 26:28; ROM 1:5; 1CO 15:11; 2CO 5:11

The context of the evangelist's work

Missionary journeys

ACT 13:4-13:5, ACT 14:24-14:25, ACT 16:9-16:10

In partnership with others

LUK 10:1 See also MRK 6:7; ACT 10:23, ACT 14:1, ACT 16:6, ACT 17:14-17:15; PHP 1:5

Within a settled period of ministry

2TI 4:5 Timothy as a pastor is also to do the work of an evangelist. See also ACT 18:9-18:11 Paul spends a year and a half in Corinth; ACT 28:30-28:31 Paul preaches the gospel whilst under house arrest in Rome; 1TI 4:13-4:14; 2TI 4:2

The evangelist's integrity

2CO 2:17 See also 2CO 1:12; 1TH 2:3-2:5

The evangelist's commitment

Working so as not to be a burden

1TH 2:8-2:9 See also ACT 20:33-20:34; 1CO 4:12, 1CO 9:6

Facing hardship and danger

2CO 11:23-11:29 ACT 5:18, ACT 20:23-20:24, ACT 21:33; ; EPH 6:19-6:20; ACT 5:40, ACT 16:22-16:23; ACT 7:58, ACT 14:19; ACT 9:29, ACT 21:30-21:31; ACT 20:19; ; 1TH 2:2; ROM 9:1-9:2, ROM 10:1

Financial support for evangelists

1CO 9:11-9:14 See also 1TI 5:18

The evangelist's blessing

Joy at seeing the church grow

1TH 3:7-3:9 See also ACT 15:3; 1TH 2:19-2:20

The satisfaction of seeing new converts grow in their faith

1CO 1:4-1:7; ; EPH 1:15-1:16; ; PHP 1:3-1:6; ; 1TH 1:2-1:3

7730: explanation

The provision of the understanding of a dream, vision, parable, teaching or other matter, the meaning of which is less than obvious.

Examples of the explanation of dreams

By Joseph

GEN 40:6-40:19, GEN 41:10-41:32

By Daniel

DAN 2:16, DAN 2:24, DAN 2:27-2:45, DAN 5:12, DAN 5:17

By angels

DAN 7:15-7:18, DAN 7:23-7:27

Examples of the explanation of visions

By Gabriel

DAN 8:15–8:16

By an angel

See also ZEC 1:8–1:10, ZEC 1:18–1:21; REV 17:3–17:7, REV 17:18

By Peter

ACT 11:4–11:17

Jesus Christ gave his disciples explanations

Of his parables

MRK 4:34 See also MAT 15:15–15:20 parallel MRK 7:17–7:23; MAT 13:36–13:43

Of the Scriptures referring to himself and his relationship to his Father

LUK 24:27 See also JHN 16:25, JHN 16:29–16:30

Of his suffering, death and resurrection

MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22 See also JHN 4:25–4:26

The gospel was explained

By Peter, at Pentecost: ACT 2:14, ACT 2:16; ACT 8:30–8:31, ACT 8:34–8:35; ACT 17:2–17:3, ACT 28:23; ACT 18:24–18:26
by Aquila and Priscilla

Examples of other explanations

JDG 14:12–14:17 The Philistines desperately wanted the answer to Samson's riddle.; 1SA 8:9, 1SA 10:25; 1KI 4:29–4:34, 1KI 10:1–10:3 parallel 2CH 9:1–9:2; ; NEH 8:7–8:8

7733: leaders

God calls individuals to positions of leadership, both spiritual and political. Such leadership is seen as carrying responsibilities towards both God and his people and is to be exercised with humility.

7734: leaders, spiritual

Under the old covenant God called priests and prophets as spiritual leaders. Later the Pharisees gave spiritual leadership. After Jesus Christ had inaugurated the new covenant, authority was given to the apostles, who in turn appointed leaders in the churches they founded.

Priests as spiritual leaders

They were called by God

HEB 5:4 See also EXO 28:1; DEU 18:5

The high priest represented the people in the presence of God

HEB 5:1 See also EXO 28:29–28:30; NUM 27:21; HEB 8:3

Priests taught and explained God's law

MAL 2:7 See also LEV 10:11; HAG 2:11–2:13

Examples of priests as spiritual leaders

1SA 4:18 The priest Eli was described as leading Israel; ; 1SA 7:5–7:9 Samuel acted as priest on behalf of the people; ; 2CH 24:14 Jehoiada the priest influenced Joash to serve God.

Prophets as spiritual leaders

They were called by God

2PE 1:21 See also ISA 6:8–6:9; JER 1:5

Examples of prophets as spiritual leaders

Samuel led the people from idolatry back to the worship of God: 1SA 7:3–7:4, 1SA 12:20–12:24; 1KI 18:18–18:21 Elijah; ; HAG 1:7–1:9 Haggai

Spiritual leaders in NT times

MAT 2:4 officially recognised teachers of the law; ; MAT 16:1, MAT 21:23 At a local level, elders had social and religious authority in local councils. Nationally, they were included in the Sanhedrin; ; MAT 23:2, MAT 26:59

The failure of spiritual leaders

In the OT

ISA 28:7; ; JER 23:11, JER 23:13–23:17, JER 23:25–23:32; ; MAL 2:1–2:2

In the NT

MAT 23:4–23:15; ; MRK 10:42–10:45 Jesus Christ taught his disciples the qualities required for spiritual leadership.

Spiritual leadership in the church

The apostles delegated authority

ACT 4:34–4:35, ACT 6:2–6:3, ACT 14:23; ; TIT 1:5

The qualifications for church leadership

1TI 3:1–3:9; ; TIT 1:6–1:9

Advice to leaders

ACT 20:28 See also ACT 20:31, ACT 20:35; 1TI 5:17–5:20; 1PE 5:2–5:3

7735: leaders, political

Since God is the ultimate ruler of all things, earthly authority derives from him. Although political leadership was exercised in various ways in Israel, there was always some overlap between political and spiritual leadership.

Israel had a variety of political leaders

Judges

JDG 2:16, JDG 4:4

Kings

1SA 8:1–8:21, 1SA 10:1, 1SA 16:1–16:13; ; 2SA 7:12; ; 1KI 1:28–1:40

Tribal elders and judges

EXO 19:7; ; DEU 21:1–21:2; ; RUT 4:1–4:2; ; JOB 29:7–29:12

Foreign powers imposed rulers on Israel

LUK 3:1

Examples of those who were both political and spiritual leaders

1SA 7:15 Samuel was both prophet and judge. EXO 34:1, EXO 34:27–34:28; JDG 6:25–6:27 Gideon; ; 2KI 18:4 parallel 2CH 31:1 Hezekiah; ; 1CH 6:31 David

Political leaders, like spiritual ones, were called by God

1KI 11:31 The prophet Ahijah confers authority on the leader of a revolt. See also EXO 3:10 Moses; JDG 6:14 Gideon 1SA 16:1, 1SA 16:6–16:12 ISA 45:1–45:2 Cyrus was a Persian king, yet he is described as God's "anointed".

To reject God's leadership is to reject God

1SA 8:6–8:8 See also 1SA 8:5, 1SA 8:19–8:20 Israel wanted a human ruler so that they might be like the surrounding nations.

Responsibilities of leaders**To protect the weak**

PSA 72:12–72:14

To administer justice

PSA 72:2; ; PRO 20:8, PRO 29:4, PRO 29:14; ; ISA 9:7, ISA 11:3–11:4

To shepherd the people

PSA 78:70–78:72; ; EZK 34:2–34:6

Attributes required in leaders

ISA 11:1–11:2 Being anointed by the Spirit of God. DEU 17:18–17:20; ; ISA 11:3; ISA 11:5 trustworthiness; ; PRO 8:15–8:16 wisdom

The failure of leaders**Through exploiting their subjects**

MAT 20:25 See also DEU 17:16–17:17; 1SA 8:11–8:17; 1KI 12:4; JER 22:13

Through usurping religious authority

1SA 13:8–13:13; ; 2CH 26:16–26:18

Through apostasy

1KI 11:7–11:8; ; 2KI 21:1–21:6

Through trusting in alliances with heathen powers

ISA 31:1 See also 2KI 20:12, 2KI 20:17–20:18; ISA 30:1–30:2; HOS 7:11

Godless leadership is evil

LUK 13:32 See also DAN 7:1–7:7; REV 13:1–13:3

People must have a right attitude to political leaders**They are to be obeyed**

ROM 13:1 See also ROM 13:5; 1PE 2:13–2:17

But obedience to God must come first

ACT 5:29 See also DAN 3:18, DAN 6:13

Prayers are to be made for them

1TI 2:1–2:2

7739: missionaries

Those called and commissioned by God to fulfil specific tasks, especially that of taking the gospel to those who have not heard it. Missionaries may be sent to other towns, cities or nations, or may be called to fulfil their task closer to home.

7740: missionaries, call of

God calls and sends out his people into the world. All believers are called to share the good news of the gospel, though some are specially commissioned by God, confirmed by the church and compelled by the gospel message to missionary service.

The call to all God's people

PSA 96:2–96:3 parallel 1CH 16:23–16:24 **MAT 28:19** See also MRK 16:15; JHN 20:21; ACT 1:8

Missionaries in the OT**Those sent to their own people**

ISA 6:8–6:10 See also 2PE 2:5 Noah; JER 2:1–2:4 Jeremiah's ministry extended further but was primarily to his own people, Judah; EZK 2:3 Ezekiel

Those sent to other peoples

2KI 17:27–17:28 A priest from Samaria returns to teach the resettled population about the LORD. ISA 42:6, ISA 49:6; ; ACT 13:47; AMO 7:15 Amos, from Judah, is sent to the northern kingdom of Israel; JON 1:1–1:2, JON 3:1–3:2

Missionaries in the NT**John the Baptist**

JHN 1:6–1:7 See also MAL 4:5–4:6; MAT 11:10 parallel LUK 7:27; MRK 1:2–1:4; MAL 3:1; ISA 40:3; JHN 1:33

Jesus Christ's disciples

LUK 9:1–9:6 Healing and deliverance accompanies preaching as part of the disciples' mission. See also MAT 10:5–10:16 During Jesus Christ's earthly ministry the disciples' mission was limited to Israel; MRK 6:7–6:11; LUK 10:1

Other believers

ACT 11:19–11:20 See also ACT 8:5 Philip; ACT 18:24 Apollos; ACT 26:15–26:18 Paul

Receiving the missionary call

The call given by God

JER 1:4–1:10 See also MAT 4:19 Peter and Andrew; ACT 8:26 Philip; ACT 22:21 Paul

The call confirmed by the church

ACT 13:2–13:3 See also ACT 14:26–14:27, ACT 15:40, ACT 22:14–22:15 Paul's call to be a missionary to the Gentiles is communicated through Ananias; GAL 2:7–2:9 Paul's mission to the Gentiles is recognised by the other apostles.

The call through circumstances

ACT 8:4 Persecution drove the early church to wider mission. See also GEN 45:4–45:5 Joseph sold into slavery in Egypt; DAN 1:3–1:6 Daniel among those taken into exile in Babylon; ACT 18:1–18:2 Priscilla and Aquila left Rome because of persecution.

Missionaries compelled by the message

ACT 4:18–4:20 See also 1CO 9:16; 2CO 5:14

7741: missionaries, task of

God commits various tasks to his servants. A principal task of those sent by God is to take the good news of the gospel to those who have not heard it, and so to be a means through which others come to faith.

The need for missionaries

ROM 10:14–10:15 See also ISA 52:7; MAT 9:37–9:38 parallel LUK 10:2

The work of missionaries

Proclaiming good news

ISA 61:1–61:2 See also LUK 4:18–4:19 **LUK 4:43** See also MAT 4:23, MAT 9:35 **ACT 11:20** See also ACT 5:42, ACT 8:12, ACT 8:25, ACT 14:6–14:7; ROM 15:16

Calling people to turn to God

ACT 26:20 See also 2CH 30:6–30:9; MRK 1:4 parallel LUK 3:3; 2CO 5:19–5:20

Announcing judgment

JON 3:4 See also JER 25:30–25:31, JER 26:12–26:13; EZK 21:2–21:3; ACT 10:42

Teaching and baptising new believers

MAT 28:19–28:20 See also ACT 2:41–2:42, ACT 8:12–8:13; 1CO 4:17

Taking the message further afield

2CO 10:15–10:16 See also ROM 15:18–15:20, ROM 15:28; MAT 24:14; LUK 24:47; ACT 16:9–16:10, ACT 23:11

Strengthening newly established churches

ACT 18:23 See also ACT 8:14–8:17, ACT 14:21–14:23, ACT 15:36–15:41, ACT 16:4–16:5

Examples of other specific assignments

EXO 3:10 Moses is sent by God to Pharaoh; ; JOS 22:3 The eastern tribes complete their mission to help the others take possession of Canaan; ; JDG 6:14 Gideon is sent by God against the Midianites; ; 1SA 15:18–15:20 Saul is given the task of destroying the Amalekites; ; 1SA 16:1 Samuel is sent by God to anoint David as king; ; ISA 48:15 Cyrus is appointed to bring deliverance from Babylon; ACT 11:30, ACT 12:25; EPH 6:22; ; COL 4:7–4:8

7742: missionaries, support for

Though facing hardships, missionaries receive strength from God to enable them to carry out their task. They are entitled, too, to receive support, encouragement and financial assistance from other believers.

Missionaries face hardships

Physical and emotional stress

MAT 10:17–10:23 parallels MRK 13:11–13:13, LUK 21:12–21:19 **2CO 7:5** See also ROM 8:35–8:36; 2CO 4:11–4:13, 2CO 6:3–6:5, 2CO 6:8–6:10, 2CO 11:23–11:29; PHP 4:12

Opposition to the message

1CO 16:9 See also ACT 4:17–4:18, ACT 6:9, ACT 13:6–13:8; 1TH 2:2

Missionaries strengthened by God

The Holy Spirit gives power to witness

JHN 20:21–20:22 See also LUK 24:49; ACT 1:8; ROM 15:18–15:19; 1CO 2:4–2:5

Jesus Christ promises his presence

MAT 28:20 See also MRK 16:20; ACT 18:10

Missionaries supported by the church

Missionaries supported by the sending church

ACT 14:26 See also ACT 13:3, ACT 15:40

Missionaries supported by believers

ACT 18:27 See also ROM 15:24; 2CO 8:23–8:24; TIT 3:13

Missionary work supported by church leaders

ACT 8:14 See also ACT 11:22–11:23, ACT 15:30–15:32; GAL 2:7–2:9

Missionaries given financial support

PHP 4:14–4:18 See also PHP 2:25; 1CO 9:11–9:14, 1CO 16:5–16:6; GAL 6:6; 1TH 2:6–2:8

Missionaries supported in prayer

COL 4:3 See also EPH 6:19–6:20; PHP 1:19; 1TH 5:25; 2TH 3:1

Missionaries encouraged by visits and news

ACT 28:15 See also PHP 2:19; 2TI 4:9–4:11; TIT 3:12; PHM 1:12–1:13

7745: ordination

The appointment to a public ministry or office, including investing with the authority required for this ministry. The most important biblical model of ordination is provided by the OT priesthood.

Ordination of the OT priesthood**The ceremony of ordination**

EXO 28:41 See also EXO 29:29–29:46, EXO 30:30; LEV 8:30, LEV 8:33; NUM 3:3

The role of the ordained priest

To properly apply the blood of the ordination offering: EXO 29:20–29:21; ; LEV 7:37, LEV 8:18; LEV 16:32 to make atonement; ; LEV 21:10–21:12 to observe a strict code of behaviour

Jesus is the Messiah, the anointed one

MAT 16:16 The Greek word “Christos”, like the Hebrew word “Messiah”, means “anointed (by God)”.

Ordination in the NT**Jesus Christ appointed disciples without reference to a ceremony of ordination**

MRK 3:14–3:15 parallel LUK 6:13

The apostles commissioned people for service by laying on of hands

ACT 6:6 See also NUM 8:10–8:11, NUM 27:18–27:23; ACT 13:3 Barnabas and Saul were commissioned for missionary work.

The appointment of elders

ACT 14:23; ; 1TI 1:18, 1TI 4:14, 1TI 5:22; ; 2TI 1:6; ; TIT 1:5, TIT 1:6–1:9 Certain qualities are required in an appointed elder or minister.

7748: overseers

In the OT a variety of supervisory roles are mentioned. In the NT “overseers” (traditionally translated “bishops”) describes the role of local church leaders.

Overseers in the OT**In secular life**

EXO 5:6; ; RUT 2:5–2:6; ; 1KI 5:16; ; 2CH 2:2; ; NEH 3:5; ; PRO 6:6–6:7

In religious life

NUM 8:22; ; 1CH 25:2; ; 2CH 23:18; ; EZR 3:9; ; NEH 11:11; ; JER 20:1

Overseers in the NT**In secular life**

MAT 20:8

In the church

PHP 1:1 A title for local church leaders.

The role of local church “elders”

ACT 20:28 Here, as elsewhere in the NT, “elders” and “overseers” are virtually synonymous. See also 1PE 5:1–5:4

Their qualifications

1TI 3:1–3:7 See also TIT 1:7

A title of Jesus Christ

1PE 2:25

7751: persuasion

Attempting to win others over to one’s own point of view. It can be either positive, as with preaching the gospel, or it can spring from a malign intent to seduce people from the truth.

Means of persuasion**The persuasiveness of argument**

ACT 16:15 See also JDG 19:3, JDG 19:7; 2SA 3:35; ACT 5:40, ACT 19:32–19:41, ACT 21:14

The persuasiveness of proof

ACT 1:3 See also GEN 45:25–45:28

The persuasiveness of experience

1CO 14:24–14:25

The first Christians were persuaded of the truth of their faith

2TI 1:12 See also ROM 4:20–4:21, ROM 8:38–8:39; 2TI 3:14

The apostles tried to persuade others of the truth of the gospel

ACT 18:4 See also ACT 17:2–17:4, ACT 19:8, ACT 26:26–26:29, ACT 28:23–28:24; 2CO 5:11

Scripture advises patience when seeking to persuade those in power

PRO 25:15 See also LUK 18:1–18:5

Scripture warns against the persuasiveness of evil**The persuasiveness of adulterers**

PRO 7:21 See also PRO 5:3, PRO 7:5

The persuasiveness of false prophets **JER 28:15**

Examples of God's servants suffering through the persuasiveness of others
MAT 27:20 parallel MRK 15:11 See also ACT 14:19

7754: preaching

The announcing of the good news of God by his servants through the faithful revelation of God's will, the exposition of God's word and the proclamation of Jesus Christ, the Son of God. Jesus Christ had an important preaching ministry.

7755: preaching, importance of

Preaching has a central place among God's people and is vital to their life and growth. It is authorised by God, empowered by the Holy Spirit and expressed supremely by Jesus Christ.

Preaching has its origin in God

It is a divine command

MRK 16:15 parallel MAT 28:18–28:20 See also JON 1:1–1:2; MAT 10:5–10:7 parallels MRK 6:7–6:12, LUK 9:1–9:6

It is rooted in God's grace

EPH 3:7–3:9 See also ISA 6:1–6:10; ROM 15:15–15:16

It is empowered by God's Spirit

ACT 1:8 See also ISA 61:1–61:3; LUK 24:46–24:49; ACT 2:1–2:11, ACT 4:8–4:12, ACT 10:44; 1CO 2:4–2:5

The importance of preaching and Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ himself came to preach

MRK 1:38 parallel LUK 4:43 See also EPH 2:17

Jesus Christ's own ministry involved much preaching

MAT 4:23 See also MAT 11:1–11:5 parallel LUK 7:18–7:22

Jesus Christ commissioned his disciples to preach

MRK 3:14–3:15 See also MAT 10:5–10:7 parallel LUK 9:1–9:2

The importance of preaching and the church

It is a natural part of the church's life

ACT 8:4 See also ACT 3:11–3:26, ACT 15:35

It is a trust from God

GAL 2:7 See also 1TH 2:4; 1TI 1:11; TIT 1:3

It is an integral aspect of key ministries in the church

1TI 3:2 See also EPH 4:11–4:12; 2TI 4:2–4:5; TIT 1:7–1:9

Its importance to Paul

1CO 1:17–1:18 See also ACT 9:20–9:22, ACT 18:5; ROM 1:14–1:15; 1CO 1:22–1:25

It is an apostolic command

1TI 4:13 See also 2TI 4:2

The importance of preaching for salvation

ROM 10:14–10:15 See also ISA 52:7; ROM 10:17; 1CO 1:21

The importance of preaching means preachers and teachers will be judged more strictly

JAS 3:1 See also ROM 2:17–2:24

7756: preaching, content of

Preaching is centred on the nature and will of God and his claims on all people. Expressed in prophecy, declaration or teaching, it includes the proclamation of the way of salvation to unbelievers and instruction about the faith to believers.

Preaching and the revelation of God's character, word and will

ACT 20:26–20:27 See also EXO 8:1; 1KI 12:21–12:24; JER 7:1–7:11; EZK 2:3–3:4

Preaching and the declaration of the gospel

Declaring the kingdom

MRK 1:14–1:15 parallel MAT 4:17 See also MAT 4:23 parallel LUK 8:1; ACT 19:8, ACT 20:25

Declaring the person of Jesus Christ and his life

ACT 2:22 See also ACT 10:36–10:38, ACT 28:31; 2CO 1:19

Declaring the facts of the cross and the resurrection

ACT 2:23–2:24 See also ACT 5:30, ACT 10:39–10:42, ACT 13:28–13:31; 1CO 1:22–1:24, 1CO 15:12–15:17

Declaring the victory and exaltation of Jesus Christ

ACT 2:33–2:35 See also ACT 5:31; 1PE 3:18–3:22

Declaring that Jesus is both Messiah (Christ) and Lord

ACT 2:36 See also ACT 5:42, ACT 8:5, ACT 9:20–9:22, ACT 10:36, ACT 18:5

Declaring the call to repent

ACT 17:30 See also MRK 1:15 parallel MAT 4:17; ACT 2:38, ACT 3:19, ACT 26:20

Declaring the promise of forgiveness

ACT 13:38 See also LUK 24:46–24:47; ACT 2:38, ACT 5:31, ACT 10:43

Preaching finds expression in the teaching of believers

The central place of teaching in the lives of the first Christians

ACT 2:42 See also ACT 6:2, ACT 11:25–11:26, ACT 15:35, ACT 18:24–18:26, ACT 20:20

Teaching from the Scriptures

ACT 18:11 See also 2CH 17:7–17:9; NEH 8:2–8:8

Teaching on how to live

MAT 28:19–28:20 See also EPH 4:20–4:24; 1TH 4:1–4:2; TIT 2:1–2:15

Preaching and the edification of believers

2TI 4:2 See also ACT 13:42–13:43, ACT 14:21–14:22, ACT 20:2; 1CO 14:26–14:31

Preaching and the continuation of apostolic doctrine

Preaching should be rooted in apostolic doctrine, which is to be faithfully handed on

2TI 2:2 See also 1CO 11:2; 2TH 2:15; 2TI 1:13–1:14

Preaching that does not conform to apostolic doctrine is to be rejected

1TI 1:3–1:4 See also GAL 1:6–1:9; 1TI 4:1–4:7; TIT 1:9–1:14

Preaching and the rejection of merely human wisdom

1CO 2:1–2:5 See also 1CO 1:18–1:25

7757: preaching, effects of

Faithful preaching leads to, through the grace of God, the repentance of sinners, the birth of faith and the nourishment of believers. It can also evoke hostility from unbelievers.

The basis of effective preaching

It depends upon the grace of God

ACT 4:33 See also ISA 55:10–55:11; ACT 14:26–14:27; 1CO 15:10–15:11

It depends upon the power of the cross, not human wisdom

1CO 1:17–1:25 See also 1CO 2:1–2:5

It depends upon the power of the Holy Spirit

LUK 4:18–4:19 See also ISA 61:1–61:2; ACT 2:1–2:11, ACT 10:44–10:48; 1CO 2:4–2:5

It requires effective, supporting prayer

COL 4:3–4:4 See also ACT 4:29–4:31, ACT 6:2–6:4, ACT 13:1–13:5; 2TH 3:1

It needs to be received with faith

HEB 4:2 See also 1TH 2:13

Preaching and the repentance of sinners

MAT 12:41 parallel LUK 11:32 See also JON 3:1–3:10; MAT 3:1–3:6 parallels MRK 1:3–1:5, LUK 3:3–3:6

Preaching and the birth of faith

ACT 4:4 See also ACT 2:38–2:41, ACT 8:9–8:13, ACT 17:11–17:12; 1CO 15:1–15:2

Preaching and the nourishment of believers

ACT 14:21–14:22 See also ROM 16:25–16:27; EPH 4:11–4:16; COL 2:6–2:7

Effective preaching and its authentication by miracles

MRK 16:20 See also MAT 4:23–4:25; LUK 9:1–9:6 parallels MAT 10:5–10:14, MRK 6:7–6:11; ACT 4:29–4:30, ACT 8:5–8:8, ACT 14:1–14:3

Inappropriate responses to preaching

Amazement

MAT 7:28–7:29 See also LUK 4:31–4:32 parallel MRK 1:21–1:22; ACT 2:5–2:12, ACT 4:13–4:14

Offence

MRK 6:1–6:6 parallel MAT 13:54–13:58 See also 1CO 1:22–1:23

Mere academic interest

ACT 17:16–17:32 Paul in Athens and before the Areopagus; ; ACT 24:22–24:26 Paul before Felix and Drusilla

Mockery

ACT 17:32 See also 2CH 36:15–36:16; ACT 2:13

Hostility

ACT 17:13 See also ACT 4:1–4:3, ACT 5:27–5:40, ACT 7:54–7:60, ACT 13:49–13:51, ACT 17:5–17:9

7758: preachers, call of

God declares his word through called and anointed preachers. He overcomes their reluctance, helps their weakness, authorises their message and confirms the truth of what they declare.

God's call of preachers

It is not dependent upon background

AMO 7:14–7:15 See also JER 1:1–1:5; MAT 4:18–4:20 parallels MRK 1:16–1:19, LUK 5:1–5:11; ACT 9:10–9:16

It is not dependent upon ability

EXO 4:10–4:12 See also JER 1:6–1:9; ACT 4:13

It is not dependent upon willingness

EXO 4:13 See also JON 1:1–1:3; ACT 9:1–9:6

It is a matter of God's sovereign choice

JER 1:4–1:5 See also ISA 49:1–49:6; EZK 2:1–2:5; AMO 7:14–7:15; LUK 4:18–4:19; ISA 61:1–61:2; GAL 1:15

God's commissioning of preachers**They are commissioned to declare God's word**

EZK 3:1; ROM 10:13–10:15 See also JER 1:9; JON 3:1–3:2; MAT 28:18–28:20

They are to declare God's word with authority

TIT 2:15 See also JER 1:9–1:10; MRK 3:14–3:15; LUK 9:1–9:2

They are to declare God's word without fear

JER 1:7–1:8 See also EZK 2:3–2:7, EZK 3:7–3:9; ACT 5:27–5:29; 2TI 1:6–1:8

God's constraint upon preachers

1CO 9:16 See also JER 20:8–20:9; ACT 4:18–4:20; ROM 1:14–1:15

God's confirmation of his call upon preachers

ACT 14:3 See also EXO 4:1–4:9; 1KI 17:17–17:24; MRK 16:20; ACT 4:29–4:31; 1CO 2:4

7759: preachers, qualifications for

Those entrusted with the task of preaching must ensure that their lives are in line with their message. They must be of good character and conduct, be consistent in all they teach and do and be accountable to others.

Preachers must be of good character

1TI 4:12 See also 1TH 2:9–2:10; 1TI 4:16; 2TI 2:20–2:26; TIT 2:7–2:8; JAS 3:1 That the judgment is based on character, and not just on teaching, seems clear from the references to guarding the tongue which follow.

Preachers must practise what they preach

MAT 23:2–23:4 See also ROM 2:21–2:23; GAL 2:11–2:14

Preachers must be accountable to others and to God

MRK 6:30 parallel LUK 9:10 See also ACT 14:26–14:27, ACT 21:17–21:19; GAL 2:1–2:2

Preachers must not look for honour for themselves

MRK 12:38–12:40 parallels MAT 23:5–23:12, LUK 20:45–20:47 See also ACT 14:11–14:15; 1CO 3:5–3:6; 1TH 2:3–2:6

Preachers must not look for personal gain

2CO 2:17 See also ACT 20:33–20:35; 2CO 11:7–11:9; 1TH 2:6–2:9

Preachers must be people of integrity

2CO 4:2 See also 2CO 1:12; 1TH 2:3–2:6

7760: preachers, responsibilities of

Those entrusted with the responsibility of preaching are to discharge it faithfully, boldly and persistently in the power of the Holy Spirit. The Christian community should honour faithful preachers and challenge those who fail to honour their responsibility.

The responsibilities of preachers**They must be diligent in their preaching**

2TI 2:15 See also 1TI 4:13–4:16; 2TI 4:1–4:5

They must be faithful in their preaching

ACT 20:20 See also JER 26:1–26:2, JER 42:4; ACT 20:25–20:27

They must be persistent in their preaching

2TI 4:1–4:5 See also ACT 18:4–18:6, ACT 20:31; 1TH 2:1–2:2

They must be bold in their preaching

ACT 28:31 See also JER 26:7–26:15; AMO 7:10–7:17; ACT 4:18–4:20, ACT 5:27–5:29, ACT 14:1–14:3

They must be encouraging in their preaching

ACT 14:21–14:22 See also ACT 15:32; 1CO 14:3–14:5; 1TH 2:11–2:12; 2TI 4:2

They must be filled with the Holy Spirit

ACT 1:8; 1CO 2:4 See also ACT 4:31–4:33; 1TH 1:5; 1PE 1:12

They must be compassionate in their preaching

MRK 6:34 See also MAT 9:35–9:38

The responsibilities of the church towards preachers**Faithful preachers should be honoured**

1TI 5:17 See also MAT 13:53–13:57 parallel MRK 6:2–6:4; LUK 10:3–10:8; HEB 13:7

Unfaithful preachers are to be exposed and will be judged

GAL 1:6–1:9 See also JER 14:14–14:16; EZK 13:1–13:23; 1TI 1:3–1:4, 1TI 4:1–4:7; TIT 1:10–1:11; 2PE 2:1–2:3; REV 2:14–2:16, REV 2:20–2:23

7761: preaching, and Holy Spirit

See [3224: Holy Spirit, and preaching](#)

7762: preaching, of Jesus Christ

See [2363: Jesus Christ, preaching and teaching of](#)

7766: priests

A group of men charged with the responsibility of mediating between God and his people, ensuring proper worship, and maintaining the spiritual health of the people of God.

7767: priests, institution in OT times

Priests played an important role in the OT and were regarded as having a special status and place in the life of Israel.

Pagan priests in the OT

1SA 6:1–6:2; ; 2KI 23:5; ; HOS 10:5; ; ZEP 1:4

The special status of priests

EZR 1:5; ; ISA 24:2; ; HOS 4:9; ; MIC 3:11

Associated with the descendants of Levi through Aaron

The exclusive nature of the priesthood

1CH 6:49 Only God has the right to nominate those who mediate between him and humanity. See also EXO 6:16–6:20 This genealogy shows Moses and Aaron were both descended from Levi; EXO 28:1, EXO 29:44, EXO 30:30; NUM 16:40 DEU 18:1; JER 33:21

Micah's priest

JDG 17:13

The Shiloh priesthood

1CH 24:3 See also 1CH 6:27

The priests in Dan

JDG 18:30

Descendants of Zadok

EZK 44:15–44:16 See also 2SA 8:17; 1CH 6:50–6:53, 1CH 24:3

Criticism of priestly appointments that were not Levitical

1KI 12:31 See also 1KI 13:33; 2CH 11:13–11:14, 2CH 13:9

The appointment of priests

Their preliminary purification

EXO 29:4 See also EXO 30:19, EXO 40:12

Their anointing

EXO 30:30–30:32 See also LEV 8:30; NUM 3:3 Kings and priests also were anointed.

Their consecration

EXO 29:1 See also EXO 29:12–29:14, EXO 29:18, EXO 29:20–29:21; LEV 8:12

Their ordination

EXO 29:35 See also EXO 29:9, EXO 29:29, EXO 29:33; LEV 8:22, LEV 8:33; JDG 17:5, JDG 17:12

The dress of the priests

EXO 28:40 See also EXO 28:42, EXO 39:27–39:29; LEV 8:13

7768: priests, function in OT times

Priests had a unique role: administering the sanctuary, offering sacrifice and leading and teaching the people. Accordingly they were set apart by a special code of conduct.

The priests were set apart

They were consecrated to the LORD

LEV 22:9 See also EXO 28:1, EXO 28:4, EXO 28:41, EXO 29:1, EXO 29:44, EXO 30:34, EXO 31:10, EXO 35:19, EXO 39:41

They were not to incur uncleanness

LEV 21:1 Some exceptions to uncleanness by touching a corpse are listed in verses 2–3. See also EZK 44:25

They were not to shave or mutilate themselves

LEV 21:5 See also EZK 44:20

They were not to marry any but a virtuous Israelite

LEV 21:7 See also EZK 44:22

They were not to drink wine before entering the sanctuary

LEV 10:9 See also EZK 44:21

They were disqualified by physical defects

LEV 21:17 See also LEV 21:18–21:22

They were not to allow outsiders to eat the sacred offerings

LEV 22:15–22:16 See also LEV 24:9; 1SA 21:4; MAT 12:4

They were not to own land in Israel

NUM 18:20 See also EZK 44:28

They were not to offer unacceptable sacrifices

LEV 22:20 See also MAL 1:7–1:9

They were to obey God's law meticulously

LEV 22:31 See also EZK 44:24

The priests supervised the sanctuary

They only had access to holy things

NUM 3:10 See also NUM 4:5; EZK 40:45–40:46, EZK 44:16; JOL 2:17

They tended the sanctuary lamps

EXO 27:21

They carried the ark

DEU 31:9 See also JOS 3:8, JOS 3:15, JOS 3:17, JOS 4:9, JOS 4:16, JOS 6:12

The priests supervised the sacrifices

LEV 1:5 See also LEV 1:8, LEV 2:2; 1CH 9:30

The priests led the nation

As role models

MAL 2:6

As teachers

EZK 44:23 See also LEV 10:10; DEU 31:10–31:13; EZR 7:6; MAL 2:7

As judges

DEU 17:9 See also DEU 19:17, DEU 21:5; 2CH 19:8; EZK 44:24

As encouragers in battle

NUM 10:8 See also JOS 6:4; 2CH 13:12

Prophetic criticism of the priests

LAM 4:13 See also JER 2:8, JER 6:13; EZK 7:26, EZK 22:26; HOS 4:6–4:9, HOS 6:9; ZEP 3:4

7769: priests, types of in NT times

The NT points to the fulfilment of the OT priesthood in Jesus Christ, and develops the idea that all Christian believers can be seen as priests. It also records the continuing role of priests in the life of Israel and pagan nations at this time.

Pagan priests

ACT 14:13

Jewish priests

The chief priests

MAT 16:21

The Sadducees

ACT 5:17 The Sadducees were a conservative party composed entirely of priests who were influential in the Sanhedrin.

Zechariah

LUK 1:5 See also 1CH 24:10

Emissaries to John the Baptist

JHN 1:19 Levites were closely associated with priests as temple personnel, perhaps mentioned here because of their teaching function. See also 2CH 35:3; NEH 8:7–8:9; LUK 10:31–10:32

Jesus Christ as high priest

HEB 8:1–8:2 See also HEB 4:14–4:16

Christians as priests

REV 1:5–1:6 See also 1PE 2:5, 1PE 2:9; REV 5:10, REV 20:6

7770: priests, tasks in NT times

The priests mentioned in the NT performed various functions, all of which are fulfilled in Jesus Christ and the church, which is his body.

Priests offered sacrifices

Sacrifices made by pagan priests

ACT 14:13

Jewish sacrifice

HEB 10:11

The sacrifice of Jesus Christ

HEB 9:14 Jesus Christ is both priest and victim: his own body takes the place occupied by sacrifices in the OT ritual. See also HEB 10:10

The Christian sacrifice of a surrendered life

ROM 12:1 See also HEB 13:16

The Christian sacrifice of praise

HEB 13:15

Priests made intercession

The burning of incense

LUK 1:9 See also EXO 30:7–30:8

Christian intercession

REV 5:8 See also 1PE 2:5; REV 1:6, REV 5:10, REV 20:6

Priests were guardians of tradition

They were trained in the teaching and application of OT law

MAT 2:3–2:6; ; JHN 1:19

The Christian ``tradition``

1CO 15:1–15:5; ; 2TI 1:13–1:14, 2TI 2:2; ; JUD 1:3

Priests declared people clean or unclean

They supplied ritual certification of cleansing

MAT 8:4 parallels MRK 1:44, LUK 5:14 See also LEV 13:2–13:3, LEV 14:2; LUK 17:14

Christians pronounce forgiveness

JHN 20:21–20:23; ; JAS 5:16

7772: prophets

Individuals called and empowered by God to declare his will to his people, including the disclosure of his future intentions to save and judge his people. The term refers particularly to the great OT prophets, such as Isaiah and Jeremiah, who were raised up to guide the people of God at critical moments in their history and whose ministries and teaching remain of continuing importance today. At several points in his ministry, Jesus Christ was acclaimed as a prophet.

7773: prophets, role of

As agents of God, prophets acted in various capacities, as was required of them, in order to carry out his will and fulfil his purpose.

Prophets as God's spokesmen

They heralded impending judgment

JON 3:4 See also 1KI 16:7; 2KI 22:15–22:17 parallel 2CH 34:23–34:25; JER 1:14–1:16, JER 5:14–5:17; EZK 5:8–5:12, EZK 38:17

They advocated repentance

2KI 17:13 See also 2CH 24:19; JER 3:12–3:13, JER 35:15, JER 44:4; ZEC 1:3–1:6

They conveyed messages from God to the nations

EZK 25:8–25:11 See also JER 46:13, JER 47:1, JER 49:34, JER 50:1; EZK 25:2, EZK 25:12–25:14, EZK 26:3; AMO 1:9; EZK 29:2; AMO 1:3, AMO 1:6, AMO 1:13, AMO 2:1

The supernatural activities of prophets

They revealed future events

EZK 17:16–17:21 See also 1KI 11:29–11:31, 1KI 20:13; ISA 7:13–7:14 the birth of Immanuel; JER 29:10; DAN 2:38–2:44, DAN 9:2; MAT 2:15; HOS 11:1; MAT 2:17–2:18; JER 31:15; MAT 8:17; ISA 53:4; ACT 3:18, ACT 11:27–11:29, ACT 21:10–21:11

They received dreams and visions

NUM 12:6 See also EZK 7:26; DAN 7:1, DAN 8:1; HOS 12:10

They worked miracles

2KI 5:3 See also 1KI 17:13–17:24; 2KI 4:3–4:6, 2KI 4:15–4:17, 2KI 4:32–4:35, 2KI 4:40–4:44, 2KI 6:5–6:6

Prophets as intermediaries

Between God and the people

DEU 18:16–18:18 See also EXO 6:30–7:1; 2SA 7:4–7:7, 2SA 12:7–12:14, 2SA 12:24–12:25, 2SA 24:11–24:12; 1KI 20:42; 2KI 20:1 parallel ISA 38:1; 2CH 12:5, 2CH 28:9–28:11

Between the people and God

1SA 7:9 See also GEN 20:7; 2KI 20:11; 2CH 32:20; JER 11:14, JER 27:18; EZK 14:7

Their responsibility as watchmen

EZK 3:17–3:21 The intermediary role of the prophet is highlighted by the image of a watchman who receives messages from God and conveys them to the people. See also EZK 33:1–33:7; HOS 9:8

Prophets as leaders in the community

They gave advice

ZEC 7:2–7:3 See also 1SA 9:6; 1KI 22:6; 2KI 3:11, 2KI 6:8–6:10, 2KI 22:14 parallel 2CH 34:22; 2CH 29:25; ISA 37:2

They gave encouragement

ACT 15:32 See also EZR 5:1–5:2; JER 29:4–29:7; EZK 11:17–11:21; HAG 1:13, HAG 2:4

They led the people

HOS 12:13 See also DEU 18:15; 1SA 7:6; 1KI 18:40

They appointed kings and leaders

1SA 10:1 See also 1SA 16:13; 1KI 1:34, 1KI 1:38, 1KI 19:15–19:16; 2KI 9:6

Prophets as writers

1CH 29:29 See also 2CH 9:29, 2CH 13:22, 2CH 26:22, 2CH 32:32; ISA 30:8; JER 30:2, JER 36:4, JER 51:60; EZK 43:11; HAB 2:2

7774: prophets, false

Men or women who falsely claim to speak on God's behalf. They are denounced in the OT and NT for leading people astray. Scripture provides criteria by which true prophets may be recognised and distinguished from false prophets, who often speak from base motives.

Criteria for recognising true prophets

A true prophet's word will be fulfilled

DEU 18:21–18:22 See also JER 28:8–28:9

A true prophet's teaching commends righteous behaviour

DEU 13:1–13:4 See also EZK 13:17–13:23, EZK 14:4–14:8; LAM 2:14

A true prophet's godly life will reflect his calling

MAT 7:15–7:20 See also ISA 28:7; JER 23:10–23:11, JER 23:14; ZEP 3:4

A true prophet will acknowledge Jesus Christ as divine

1JN 4:1–4:6

The motivations of false prophets

Their messages originate with themselves

JER 23:16 See also JER 14:13–14:14, JER 23:25–23:32, JER 23:36; EZK 13:1–13:7

Their messages may be occasioned by popular demand

JER 29:8–29:9 NUM 22:35, NUM 22:38, NUM 23:12, NUM 23:26, NUM 24:12–24:13; ; 1KI 22:13–22:14; ISA 30:10–30:11; ; JER 5:30–5:31; ; MIC 2:11

Their messages may be given for financial reward

NEH 6:12–6:13 See also JER 6:13–6:14; EZK 13:19; MIC 3:11; 2PE 2:1–2:3

Their messages may be the result of deception

1KI 22:19–22:23 parallel 2CH 18:18–18:22 See also EZK 14:9

Their messages may be inspired by divination

JER 14:14 See also EZK 13:6–13:7, EZK 22:28; ACT 13:6

Examples of false prophets**In the OT**

NEH 6:10–6:13 See also 1KI 22:1–22:28 parallel 2CH 18:1–18:27; JER 27:9–27:10, JER 27:14–27:18

False prophetesses

NEH 6:14; ; EZK 13:17

Prophets of other gods

JER 23:13 See also 1KI 18:19–18:40; 2KI 10:19; JER 2:8

In the NT

MAT 24:24 parallel MRK 13:22 See also MAT 24:10–24:11; ACT 13:6–13:11REV 2:20, REV 16:13, REV 19:20, REV 20:10

The punishment of false prophets

DEU 18:20 See also DEU 13:5; ZEC 13:3; JER 14:15JER 28:15–28:17, JER 29:21–29:23, JER 29:30–29:32 JER 23:34–23:40; EZK 13:8–13:16; MIC 3:5–3:6

7775: prophets, lives of

God called individuals from differing backgrounds to speak as prophets on his behalf, sometimes in difficult circumstances.

The backgrounds of the prophets

EXO 2:1–2:10 Moses was brought up in the Egyptian royal court; ; ISA 1:21–1:28 Samuel was a temple servant at Shiloh; ; 1KI 19:19–19:21 Elisha was a farmer; ; EZK 1:3 Ezekiel was a priest living in exile in Babylonia; AMO 1:1, AMO 7:14

The calling of the prophets**Their initial encounter with God**

ISA 6:1–6:4 See also EXO 3:1–3:6; EZK 1:4–1:28

God communicating his call

JER 1:4–1:5 See also ISA 6:8–6:10; EZK 2:3–3:5; JON 1:1, JON 3:1

Their response to God's call

JER 1:6–1:10 See also EXO 3:11–3:12

The family life of the prophets

JER 16:1–16:4 See also ISA 7:3, ISA 8:1–8:4; EZK 24:15–24:24; HOS 1:2–1:11, HOS 3:1–3:5

The hardships faced by prophets**Persecution**

HEB 11:32–11:38 See also ACT 7:52

Reviling and beating

LUK 6:22–6:23 parallel MAT 5:11–5:12 See also JER 20:1–20:2; JAS 5:10

Imprisonment

JER 37:11–37:16 See also 1KI 22:26–22:27 parallel 2CH 18:25–18:26; 2CH 16:10; JER 37:21, JER 38:6–38:13

Killing

1KI 19:14 See also 1KI 18:4, 1KI 18:13, 1KI 19:2; JER 26:8–26:11, JER 26:20–26:23; MAT 23:29–23:31, MAT 23:37 parallel LUK 13:34; LUK 11:47–11:49; 1TH 2:4–2:15

The death of prophets

DEU 34:1–34:8 Moses; ; 1SA 28:3 Samuel; ; 2KI 2:11–2:12 Elijah did not die but was taken up in a chariot of fire.

7776: prophet, Jesus Christ as

See [2318: Jesus Christ, as prophet](#)

7778: school of prophets

A company of prophets working and prophesying together under the instruction and leadership of a more experienced prophet. There were also similar companies of false prophets.

A school of prophets used by God to influence others

1SA 19:19–19:24 See also 1SA 10:5–10:6, 1SA 10:10–10:13; 2KI 9:1–9:3; EZR 5:2

Schools of prophets associated with particular places**Bethel**

2KI 2:3

Jericho

2KI 2:15

Leaders of schools of prophets**Samuel and a school of prophets**

1SA 19:20

Elisha and a school of prophets

2KI 2:15 See also 2KI 4:1, 2KI 4:38, 2KI 6:1–6:4

A school of prophets in danger

1KI 18:4 See also 1KI 18:13

Schools of false prophets

1KI 18:19, 1KI 18:40, 1KI 22:6 parallel 2CH 18:5; ; 1KI 22:10 parallel 2CH 18:9; ; 1KI 22:12–22:14 parallel 2CH 18:11–18:13; ; 1KI 22:19–22:23 parallel 2CH 18:18–18:22; ; NEH 6:14

7781: seer

Seer as an alternative title for a prophet

1SA 9:9 Literally, a “seer” is “one who sees”, especially one who claims to see into the future or to have insight into the will of God. See also 2SA 24:11 parallel 1CH 21:9

Seers used by people to enquire of God

1SA 9:8–9:9

David had seers to enquire of God for him

1CH 25:1–25:5 See also 2SA 24:11 parallel 1CH 21:9; 2SA 15:27; 2CH 29:25, 2CH 35:15

Seers were used by God to bring his word to the people

2KI 17:13

Seers were used by God to bring his word to the king

2CH 16:7–16:10, 2CH 33:18

The words of a seer were sometimes unwelcome

2CH 16:7–16:10; ; ISA 30:10; ; AMO 7:12–7:13

Samuel was called a seer

1SA 9:11–9:14, 1SA 9:18–9:19; ; 1CH 9:22, 1CH 26:28, 1CH 29:29

Asaph, the psalmist, called a seer

2CH 29:30

Seers wrote Israel’s history

2CH 33:18–33:19 See also 1CH 29:29; 2CH 9:29, 2CH 12:15

God judges Israel by blinding the seers

ISA 29:10; ; MIC 3:7

7784: shepherd

The work of a shepherd was important and responsible in the rural world of ancient Palestine. Since it involved leading, protecting and feeding a flock, it is seen as a metaphor for the task of leadership. Scripture declares that God is the Shepherd of his people.

7785: shepherd, as occupation

The occupation of a shepherd was both humble and honourable. In the marginal hill country of Palestine it was particularly demanding.

A shepherd as a keeper of flocks of animals

GEN 46:32 The Hebrew word refers to a keeper of goats and cattle as well as sheep.

The tasks of a shepherd

Tending, feeding and watering

PSA 23:2 See also GEN 29:3, GEN 26:19–26:22; EXO 22:5; LUK 13:15; JHN 21:15–21:17

Keeping and protecting

JER 31:10 See also GEN 4:2; PSA 23:4 The rod is a crook (for extracting sheep from difficulty) and the staff a club (for warding off wild animals); 1SA 17:34–17:37

Leading, not driving, sheep

JHN 10:3–10:4 See also EXO 3:1; PSA 23:2, PSA 77:20; ISA 40:11; JER 50:6

Gathering animals together

JHN 10:3 See also PSA 147:4; ISA 40:26; MAT 25:32

The shepherd’s routine

The search for pasture

GEN 37:17

The midday rest

SNG 1:7

The night-watch

LUK 2:8; ; JER 43:12

Shearing, an annual festival

1SA 25:7–25:8

The use of pens and folds

PSA 50:9; ; HAB 3:17; ; JHN 10:1, JHN 10:16

Breeding

GEN 30:40

Rearing

Rebekah’s ruse depended on a method used to get a ewe to accept an alien lamb: GEN 27:16, GEN 27:27

The problems faced by shepherds

Drought and dry winds

JER 12:4; ; HOS 4:3, HOS 13:15; ; JOL 1:17–1:20; ; AMO 1:2

With animals and thieves

1SA 17:34–17:37, 1SA 25:15; ; JHN 10:1, JHN 10:12

Shepherds as employers

JOB 1:3 See also 1SA 25:2; 2KI 3:4; AMO 1:1

Shepherds as employees

The status of a shepherd

1SA 16:11, 1SA 17:28; ; LUK 2:8

The responsibilities of a shepherd

GEN 31:39; ; AMO 3:12 A shepherd who lost an animal to wild beasts had to produce evidence; ; MAT 18:12 parallel LUK 15:4

7786: shepherd, as king and leader

Shepherd was a standard term for a leader or king throughout the ancient world. In this sense it often appears in the Bible.

General term for a king or leader

ISA 44:28 The prophet describes this non-Jewish king as God's shepherd; **JER 6:3** See also 2SA 7:7; PSA 77:20; ISA 31:4; JER 12:10, JER 49:19, JER 50:44

The LORD as shepherd

Of Israel

PSA 80:1 See also GEN 49:24; PSA 28:9; ISA 40:11

Of the individual

PSA 23:1 See also GEN 48:15

David as the model of a good shepherd

Experience as a real shepherd

PSA 78:70–78:71 See also 1SA 17:34–17:37; 2SA 12:1–12:7 The king is brought to his senses by a "shepherd" story; PSA 23:1–23:4

The shepherd faces death for his flock

2SA 24:17 See also EXO 32:32; JHN 10:11, JHN 10:15, JHN 10:17

David as a model of the coming Messiah

EZK 34:23 See also JER 23:4–23:5, JER 30:9; HOS 3:5

A good shepherd as a leader ``after God's own heart''

JER 3:15 See also ISA 40:11; JER 31:10; EZK 34:12

A bad shepherd

1KI 22:17

Criticisms of the shepherds of Israel

JER 23:1–23:2 See also JER 10:21, JER 22:21–22:22; EZK 34:1–34:10

7787: shepherd, God the

See [1220: God, as shepherd](#)

7788: shepherd, Jesus Christ as

See [2330: Jesus Christ, as shepherd](#)

7789: shepherd, as church leader

Church leaders are likened to shepherds, on account of their pastoral responsibilities and tasks.

Jesus Christ, the archetypal shepherd

1PE 5:4

Appointment of shepherds

EPH 4:11 See also MRK 3:14; ACT 14:23; 1CO 12:28

Shepherd responsibilities

Feeding the flock

JHN 21:15 See also MRK 6:34; JHN 21:17; 1CO 3:2; HEB 5:12–5:14; JUD 1:12

Caring for the flock

JHN 21:16 See also MAT 25:36; ACT 20:28; PHP 1:1; 1TI 3:1–3:2; 2TI 1:17; TIT 1:7; JAS 1:27; 1PE 5:2

Protecting, from false teachers

ACT 20:29 See also MAT 7:15; JHN 10:1, JHN 10:10

Leading, not exploiting

1PE 5:3

Being accountable

See also HEB 13:17

Risking death

JHN 10:15; ; ACT 12:1–12:4, ACT 21:13

7793: teachers

Those who have responsibility for instructing others, especially in relation to matters of faith and life: in the home, parents; in Israel, priests and teachers of the law and in the NT church, apostles, prophets, pastors and teachers. At a less formal level Christians should seek to teach one another. God is the supreme teacher of his people.

God is the supreme teacher

HEB 8:10–8:11 See also JER 31:33–31:34; DEU 8:3; PSA 32:8; JHN 14:26; 1TH 4:9; TIT 2:11–2:12

Parents as teachers

EPH 6:4 See also DEU 4:9–4:10, DEU 6:4–6:9, DEU 11:18–11:19; PSA 78:5–78:6; 2TI 3:14–3:15

Priests as Israel's teachers

MAL 2:4–2:7 See also LEV 10:11; 2KI 12:2; 2CH 35:3; NEH 8:7–8:8; EZK 44:23

The apostles and their helpers as teachers

The apostles generally

ACT 5:42 See also MAT 28:19–28:20; ACT 4:2, ACT 4:18, ACT 5:21, ACT 5:28

Paul

ACT 20:20 See also ACT 11:26, ACT 15:35, ACT 18:11; 1CO 4:17, 1CO 14:19; 1TH 4:1–4:2; 1TI 2:7; 2TI 1:11

Timothy

1TI 4:6–4:16; ; 2TI 2:23–2:25

The gift of teachers in the church

EPH 4:11 See also ACT 13:1; 1CO 12:28–12:29, 1CO 14:29–14:34; GAL 6:6; 1TI 2:12; 2TI 2:2

Elders as teachers

TIT 1:9 See also 1TI 3:2, 1TI 5:17

Christians as teachers of one another

COL 3:16 See also ROM 15:14; 1CO 14:26

7796: teaching

The act of instructing someone in matters of faith and morals, especially in the home or church. Teaching was a major aspect of the ministry of Jesus Christ.

7797: teaching

The apostles' teaching formed the basis of the instruction given to the first Christians. Parts of the NT draw a distinction between preaching and teaching, seeing the former as a means of converting individuals, and the latter as a means of instructing them after conversion.

The importance of teaching

ECC 12:11–12:12 “goads” prod the sluggish to action, while “embedded nails” furnish a kind of mental anchorage. “Shepherd” is almost certainly a reference to God himself. See also PRO 1:8–1:9, PRO 3:1–3:2, PRO 4:1–4:4, PRO 6:20–6:23; MAT 5:19; 1CO 14:6; 2TI 4:2–4:3

Teaching given by parents

PRO 22:6 See also DEU 6:6–6:9, DEU 11:18–11:19; EPH 6:1–6:4

The apostles' teaching

ACT 2:42; TIT 1:9 See also MAT 28:19–28:20; ROM 6:17, ROM 16:17; 1TH 4:8; 2TH 2:15; 1TI 1:10–1:11, 1TI 4:6, 1TI 6:3; 2TI 1:13–1:14, 2TI 4:3; TIT 2:1

The gift of teaching in the church

ROM 12:7 See also 1TI 4:13–4:14

Ways of teaching believers**Through example**

1TH 1:5–1:6 See also 1CO 4:17, 1CO 11:1; PHP 4:9; 1TH 2:14; 2TI 3:10; TIT 2:3–2:7

Through dialogue with the teacher

ACT 20:7, ACT 19:8–19:9

Through explanation of ceremonies

EXO 12:26–12:27, EXO 13:14–13:16

Through proverbs

PRO 1:1–1:6, PRO 1:20–1:28

Through the law

DEU 6:6–6:9, DEU 11:18–11:19, DEU 27:1–27:26; ; PSA 78:5–78:8

Through mutual edification

COL 3:16 See also ROM 15:14; 1TH 5:11; HEB 5:12

Through the instruction of different groups within the church

EPH 5:22–6:9; ; COL 3:18–4:1; ; TIT 2:1–2:10; ; 1PE 2:18–3:7, 1PE 5:1–5:5

The distinction between teaching and preaching

ACT 15:35 See also MAT 4:23, MAT 9:35, MAT 11:1; LUK 20:1; ACT 4:2, ACT 5:42, ACT 28:31

Examples of major themes taught in the NT church**Righteousness from God through faith in Jesus Christ**

ROM 3:21–3:22 See also GAL 2:20–2:21

Freedom in Christ from the demands of the law

GAL 5:1–5:3

The humility of Jesus Christ

PHP 2:5–2:8 See also HEB 13:12–13:13

The supremacy of Jesus Christ

COL 1:18

The superiority of Jesus Christ

HEB 3:3 Hebrews also shows Jesus Christ to be superior to the angels, the high priest and the sacrifices.

Godly behaviour

EPH 4:22–4:24 See also ROM 12:1–12:2; 1TI 6:1–6:2

7798: teaching, of Jesus Christ

See [2363: Jesus Christ, preaching and teaching of](#)

7900: The life of the church

- 7903: baptism
- 7912: collections
- 7915: confirmation
- 7918: excommunication
- 7921: fellowship
- 7927: hymn
- 7930: Lord's Day, the

- 7933: Lord's Supper
- 7936: love feast
- 7939: ministry
- 7948: mission
- 7957: sacraments
- 7960: singing
- 7963: song
- 7966: spiritual gifts
- 7972: tongues, gift of

7903: baptism

A washing with water, which symbolises the cleansing of believers from the stain and dirt of sin through the grace of God. Jesus Christ submitted to baptism as an example to believers. Through the work of the Holy Spirit, baptism is linked with union with the risen Jesus Christ.

7904: baptism, of Jesus Christ

See [2510: Jesus Christ, baptism of](#)

7905: baptism, with Holy Spirit

See [3242: Holy Spirit, baptism with](#)

7906: baptism, in the Gospels

In the Gospels baptising is based on the symbolic practice in the OT and Judaism of cleansing with water.

Washing was the means of achieving ritual purity

EXO 30:19–30:20; ; MRK 7:3–7:4 The Greek word here translated “wash” is “baptizo”, from which the English “baptise” comes.

Sprinkling with water symbolises spiritual cleansing

EZK 36:25 See also ZEC 13:1; HEB 10:22

Being baptised by John was a confession that cleansing was needed

MAT 3:11 See also MAT 3:6; MRK 1:4–1:5 parallel LUK 3:3; ACT 19:1–19:4

John promised that the Messiah would cleanse with the baptism of the Holy Spirit

MAT 3:11 parallels MRK 1:8, LUK 3:16 See also ISA 44:3; EZK 36:25–36:26

Baptism involves both water and the Holy Spirit

JHN 3:5

The disciples of Jesus Christ baptised like John's

See also JHN 3:22–3:23, JHN 4:1

Jesus Christ was baptised by John

MAT 3:13–3:17 parallels MRK 1:9–1:11, LUK 3:21–3:22, JHN 1:32–1:33

7907: baptism, practice of

Baptism is associated with repenting of sin, believing the gospel message and becoming a member of Christ's body.

Baptism is ordained by Jesus Christ himself

MAT 28:19 See also ACT 9:17–9:18, ACT 16:14–16:15

Baptism is linked with repentance

ACT 2:38 See also HEB 6:1–6:2 The “baptisms” referred to here may imply teaching about Jewish rituals or the baptism offered by John the Baptist.

Baptism follows the decision to believe

ACT 2:41, ACT 18:8 See also ACT 8:12–8:13, ACT 16:31–16:33

Baptism in the name of God or Jesus Christ

Baptism in or into the name of Jesus Christ

ACT 19:5 See also ACT 2:38, ACT 8:16, ACT 10:48

Baptism in the name of the Trinity

MAT 28:18–28:20

Baptism was by immersion

ROM 6:4 The word “buried” implies immersion. See also ACT 8:38

Baptism is linked with the gift of the Holy Spirit

MRK 1:8; ACT 1:5 See also ACT 2:4, ACT 11:16 **1CO 12:13** All the Christians at Corinth had been spiritually baptised into Christ and thus united with him.

Manifestations of the Holy Spirit may follow or precede water baptism

See also ACT 8:12–8:17, ACT 9:17–9:18, ACT 10:44–10:48

The person who baptises is of little importance

1CO 1:14 What matters is not who baptises but the Saviour in whose name it is done.

Baptism “for the dead”

1CO 15:29 It is not certain if there was a ceremony of baptism “for the dead” in the NT church, nor whether, if it existed, Paul approved of it.

Passages which may imply infant baptism

The “households” (not merely individuals) may well have included children: ACT 16:15, ACT 16:33, ACT 18:8; ; **1CO 1:16**; MRK 10:13–10:16; ; **1CO 7:14**; ; COL 2:11–2:12 If

baptism is here equated with circumcision, this suggests baptism is the sign of the new covenant.

Passages apparently negating infant baptism

ACT 2:38–2:41 infants cannot repent and believe; ; GAL 3:7 Under the new covenant it is faith in Jesus Christ, not an outward sign, that makes a person a child of God.

7908: baptism, significance of

The NT uses a variety of images to explain the meaning of baptism, such as dying and rising with Christ, sharing in his death and being cleansed from sin.

Baptism is a symbol of the death of Jesus Christ

LUK 12:50 Jesus Christ described his death as a baptism or a flood overwhelming him. See also PSA 42:7, PSA 69:1–69:2, PSA 88:7; MRK 10:38–10:39

Baptism is a symbol of the burial of Jesus Christ

ROM 6:3–6:4 Immersion in water symbolises how the old sinful life is buried with Christ. ROM 8:13; ; COL 3:5

Baptism is a symbol of being saved from the flood

1PE 3:21 The flood/baptism symbolises both judgment (the death of sinners and the death of Jesus Christ) and salvation (those in the ark and those in Christ passing safely through judgment). See also GEN 7:6–7:7

Baptism is the gospel equivalent of circumcision

COL 2:11–2:12 The “circumcision in Christ” may refer either to his death on the cross or to baptism. See also DEU 10:16

Baptism recalls the exodus

1CO 10:1–10:2 In and through the exodus experience Israel was united with and obedient to Moses, as Jesus Christ’s people are to him. See also EXO 14:19–14:24

Baptism symbolises washing from sin

ACT 22:16 Baptism is an outward sign of cleansing from sin and from a defiled life and conscience. See also 1CO 6:11; TIT 3:5; 1PE 3:21

Baptism is a symbol of putting on Christ

GAL 3:27 Baptism is seen as putting on Christ, as one might put on a coat or garment, and thus be “clothed with Christ”.

Baptism as a symbol of unity

EPH 4:5 See also 1CO 12:13

7912: collections

The financial burden of God’s work has always been shared amongst God’s people. In the OT, this was mainly by compulsory tithes; in the NT by voluntary contributions.

The collection of compulsory tithes and other religious taxes

Tithes

LEV 27:30 See also NUM 18:21

Redemption money

EXO 30:12; ; NUM 3:46–3:47

Temple taxes

2CH 24:5; ; MAT 17:24

The collection of voluntary contributions

For the tabernacle

EXO 36:3 See also NUM 7:2–7:3, NUM 7:84–7:88

For the temple

1CH 29:1–29:9

For the rebuilding of the temple

EZR 1:4

For the teaching ministry of the church

GAL 6:6 See also LUK 8:1–8:3; PHP 4:15–4:16; 1TI 5:17–5:18

For the relief of the poor

ROM 15:26; 1CO 16:1 See also ACT 2:45, ACT 4:34–4:35, ACT 11:29–11:30

The aim of collections

To share burdens equally

2CO 8:13–8:15

To supply people’s needs

2CO 9:12

To arouse thanksgiving

2CO 9:12–9:15

The right attitude to collections

Generosity

EXO 36:4–36:6; ; 2CO 8:11, 2CO 9:6

Cheerfulness

2CO 9:7

Discipline

1CO 16:2–16:4

Humility

MAT 6:2–6:4

A willing spirit

2CO 8:12

A sacrificial spirit

MRK 12:41–12:44 parallel LUK 21:1–21:4; ; 2CO 8:1–8:4

The faithful administration of collections

2KI 22:7; ; ACT 11:30; ; 2CO 8:19–8:21

7915: confirmation

The act of publicly affirming something or someone, usually with a view to declaring trustworthiness. God confirmed his covenants, oaths and promises to emphasise his intention to fulfil them and he confirms the gospel to demonstrate its truthfulness.

Confirmation of covenants

DEU 4:31 See also GEN 17:1–17:22; DEU 8:18; 2KI 23:3; 1CH 16:17; PSA 105:10; DAN 9:26–9:27

Confirmation of oaths

PSA 119:106 See also GEN 26:1–26:5

Confirmation of promises

ROM 15:8 See also DEU 29:12–29:13; 2CH 1:9; HEB 6:17

Confirmation of the gospel

MRK 16:20 See also ACT 14:3; 1CO 1:4–1:6; PHP 1:7; HEB 2:3

Confirmation of wisdom

JOB 28:25–28:28

Confirmation of vows

See also NUM 30:1–30:16 A vow made by a woman could be either confirmed or nullified by her father or husband.

Confirmation of a witness's testimony

DEU 19:15 Evidence accepted in court required confirmation by more than one witness. See also 1KI 1:11–1:14; MRK 14:56–14:59 The proper judicial procedure was not followed at the trial of Jesus Christ; ROM 9:1–9:4 Paul here invokes the Holy Spirit as a witness; HEB 6:16

Confirmation of letters

ACT 15:27 This constituted verification of the authenticity of a letter which could easily have been forged or tampered with. See also EST 9:29–9:32

Confirmation of office or position

1SA 11:15

7918: excommunication

The last but reversible step in church discipline, resulting in exclusion from the fellowship of believers. The grounds that Scripture suggests for excommunication include public sin and immorality.

Jesus Christ authorises the church to excommunicate a sinning brother

MAT 18:15–18:18 The binding of sinners is thought to refer to their exclusion from God's people, and loosening, to their restoration after repentance (compare Mt 16:19).

Paul exhorts the Corinthian church to excommunicate an immoral brother

1CO 5:1–5:6 By “hand this man over to Satan” (see also 1Ti 1:20) Paul means to expel him, by putting him out into the devil's territory, in the hope that being officially ostracised, he might repent and forsake his wicked way. Such discipline was necessary not only for the reclaiming of the sinner but also for the safety and purity of the church (verse 6). See also 1CO 5:11–5:13

Excommunicated offenders who repent are to be lovingly restored to fellowship

2CO 2:5–2:11 This passage probably refers to the offender mentioned in 1Corinthians chapter 5.

7921: fellowship

Association based upon the sharing of something in common. Believers have fellowship with one another on the basis of their common fellowship with God, their participation in the blessings of the gospel and their common task of mission. True fellowship is demonstrated in concern for, and practical commitment to, one another.

7922: fellowship, with God

The relationship with God, disrupted by sin yet established through Jesus Christ, which provides the only proper basis for true human fellowship. God's desire for fellowship with humanity is made known through his calling of a people to be his own and to reflect his holiness and love.

God's fellowship with his people is shown by his presence**God's presence with Israel**

LEV 26:12 See also EXO 33:14; ISA 63:9; HAG 1:13

God's presence in the tabernacle

EXO 25:8 See also EXO 29:45–29:46, EXO 40:34–40:36; LEV 26:11; DEU 12:11

God's presence in the temple

1KI 6:12–6:13 See also 1KI 8:29 parallel 2CH 6:20; 2CH 7:1–7:2; ISA 6:1

God's presence in the new Jerusalem

ZEC 2:10–2:13 See also EZK 37:26–37:28, EZK 43:4–43:7, EZK 48:35; REV 21:3

The church's fellowship with God**Fellowship with the Father, Son and Holy Spirit**

JHN 14:23 See also JHN 14:7, JHN 14:16–14:17 fellowship with the Spirit

Fellowship is made possible through Jesus Christ

EPH 2:18–2:19 See also ROM 5:10; 2CO 5:18–5:19; COL 1:20–1:22; HEB 10:19–10:22

Fellowship with Jesus Christ

1CO 1:9 See also MAT 28:20 Jesus Christ's presence with his disciples; JHN 15:4–15:5 abiding in Christ; ROM 6:4–6:5 united with Christ in his death and resurrection; 1CO 10:15–10:16 communion with Christ at the Lord's Supper; PHP 3:10 sharing in Christ's sufferings

Fellowship with God is inseparable from fellowship with one another

1JN 1:3 See also MAT 18:20; MRK 9:37; JHN 17:21; 2CO 13:11

The demands of fellowship with God**Holiness**

LEV 20:26; 2CO 6:14–6:18 See also EXO 34:12–34:14; EZR 6:21; 1CO 5:11; EPH 5:8–5:11; JAS 4:4

Obedience to God's will

1JN 3:24 See also ISA 57:15; MAT 12:49–12:50 parallels MRK 3:34–3:35, LUK 8:21; JHN 14:21

Sin separates people from fellowship with God

ISA 59:2; 1JN 1:5–1:6 See also GEN 3:8; EZK 39:23

Examples of fellowship with God

GEN 5:22 Enoch; ; GEN 6:9 Noah; ; 2CH 20:7 Abraham; EXO 33:11; ; NUM 12:3; JOS 1:9 Joshua; ; MAL 2:6 Levi

7923: fellowship, in the gospel

A mutual participation in the blessings of God's grace. Believers are united with one another on the basis of their common reception of the benefits of salvation.

Fellowship and the community of God's people

God calls out a community of people, for fellowship with himself

DEU 7:6 See also EXO 19:5–19:6; 1PE 2:5, 1PE 2:9–2:11

God will bless a people united in fellowship

MAT 18:19–18:20; ; 2CH 7:14; ; JER 31:23–31:25; ; 1CO 11:29–11:34 Wrong relationships between God's people hinder the flow of his blessing.

God will restore fellowship with his scattered people

MIC 2:12 See also ISA 11:12–11:13; JER 3:18, JER 31:1, JER 50:4–50:5

Sharing in God's grace**Fellowship in a common blessing**

PSA 106:4–106:5 See also NUM 10:32; JOS 22:19

Fellowship in a common salvation

JUD 1:3 See also 1CO 9:23 sharing in the blessings of the gospel; PHP 1:7 sharing in God's grace; TIT 1:4 sharing a common faith; HEB 3:1 sharing a common calling; 1PE 5:1 sharing a common hope; 2PE 1:4 sharing the divine nature; 1JN 1:7 sharing in sanctification

Fellowship in a common inheritance

COL 1:12 See also ROM 8:17; 1PE 3:7

Fellowship in God's family

HEB 2:11 See also MAL 2:10; MAT 6:9 parallel LUK 11:2 the family prayer in which believers together address God as Father; MAT 12:49–12:50 parallels MRK 3:34–3:35, LUK 8:21; MAT 23:8–23:9

Fellowship between Jew and Gentile

EPH 3:6 See also ROM 11:17, ROM 15:27; EPH 2:16–2:18

Fellowship in holding a common truth

2TH 2:15 See also PSA 119:63; 1CO 11:2, 1CO 15:2–15:3; 2TI 2:2, 2TI 3:14; TIT 2:15

Fellowship in union with Christ

1CO 10:16–10:17; EPH 2:19–2:22 See also ROM 12:5; 1CO 12:12, 1CO 12:27; EPH 4:4–4:5; COL 1:15; 1PE 2:4–2:5

Fellowship through the Holy Spirit

1CO 12:13 See also EZK 36:27–36:28; 2CO 13:14; EPH 4:3; PHP 2:1

7924: fellowship, in Christian service

Partnership in a common enterprise. God's people are called to work together especially in the task of mission, to recognise one another's gifts and to give support to one another's ministries.

Fellowship in mission**Partnership in preaching the gospel**

GAL 2:9 See also MRK 10:7; LUK 10:1–10:2; PHP 1:5

Supporting the work of others

ACT 14:26; PHP 4:14–4:16 The Philippians share in Paul's work through their giving. See also ACT 13:2–13:3, ACT 15:40; 2CO 11:9; 3JN 1:5–1:8

Standing together in adversity

HEB 10:32–10:34 See also 2CO 1:7; PHP 1:27–1:30, PHP 4:14; HEB 11:25

Fellowship between Paul and his co-workers

PHP 4:3 ACT 11:26–11:30, ACT 13:42–13:50, ACT 14:1–14:23, ACT 15:22–15:29; ROM 16:3 Priscilla and Aquila; ; ROM 16:9 Urbanus; ; ROM 16:21 Timothy; ; 2CO 8:23 Titus; ; PHP 2:25 Epaphroditus; ; PHM 1:1 Philemon; ; PHM 1:24 Mark, Aristarchus, Demas and Luke

In fellowship different gifts are combined for effective service

1CO 12:12 See also 1CO 12:4–12:6

Spiritual gifts are given to all to share

1CO 12:7 See also ROM 12:4–12:8; 1CO 12:14–12:20; 1PE 4:10

Recognising one another's gifts

1CO 12:21–12:26

Accepting one another's ministries

GAL 2:7–2:8 See also 1CO 12:27–12:31, 1CO 16:15–16:18; 2PE 3:15–3:16

Examples of sharing in different roles

NEH 4:16–4:22; 1CO 3:5–3:8 See also EXO 4:15–4:16, EXO 17:10–17:13; 1CO 12:8–12:11

Examples of working together in fellowship

ECC 4:9–4:12 See also DEU 3:18–3:20 the Reubenites and the Gadites join with the rest of Israel to conquer Canaan; JDG 20:11 all Israel unites against Gibeah; EZR 3:8–3:10 Those returning from exile work together to rebuild the temple; NEH 4:6 The Israelites work together to rebuild the walls of Jerusalem; LUK 5:7–5:10 Peter and Andrew, James and John are business partners.

7925: fellowship, among believers

The fellowship that believers share as a result of their common union with God through Jesus Christ is expressed in life together. It is evident in worship together, in a love for one another which reflects God's own love and in a practical commitment to one another which is demonstrated in concern for the weak and readiness to share with the poor and needy.

Sharing in the fellowship of God's love

1JN 4:10–4:12 See also JHN 13:34, JHN 15:12; EPH 5:1–5:2; 1JN 3:10

Sharing in the fellowship of a common devotional life

ACT 2:42

Worshipping together

PSA 55:14 See also PSA 42:4; 1CO 14:26; EPH 5:19; COL 3:16

Praying together

ACT 1:14 See also ACT 4:24, ACT 12:12; JAS 5:16

Breaking bread together

1CO 10:16–10:17; ; 2PE 2:13; ; JUD 1:12 Love feasts accompanied the Lord's Supper though these were open to abuse.

True fellowship means sharing with those in need

HEB 13:16 See also ACT 20:34–20:35; EPH 4:28

Showing hospitality

ROM 12:13 See also ISA 58:7; HEB 13:1–13:2; 1PE 4:9; 3JN 1:8

Sharing money and possessions

DEU 15:10–15:11; ACT 2:44–2:45 See also DEU 10:18–10:19 God's people are to reflect his concern for the needy in society; MAT 25:35–25:36; LUK 3:11; ACT 4:32–4:35; 2CO 8:13–8:15; 1TI 6:17–6:18; JAS 1:27, JAS 2:15–2:16

Examples of sharing with the needy

JOB 31:16–31:20 Job's compassion for the needy; ; ACT 6:1 the daily distribution to widows; ; ACT 9:36 Tabitha's concern for the poor; ACT 11:29–11:30; ; ROM 15:26; ; 2CO 8:3–8:4

Strengthening one another in fellowship together**Bearing with the weak**

GAL 6:1–6:2 See also ISA 42:3; ROM 14:1, ROM 15:1; 1TH 5:14

Strengthening the weak

ISA 35:3–35:4 See also JOB 4:3–4:4

Encouraging one another

HEB 10:24–10:25 See also 1SA 23:16; ROM 1:12; 1TH 5:11; HEB 13:3

Putting the needs of others first

ROM 15:2 See also 1CO 10:24, 1CO 10:32–10:33

True fellowship means living in harmony

1PE 3:8 See also ROM 12:16; EPH 4:2–4:3; PHP 2:1–2:4; COL 3:12–3:14

Showing equal concern for all

ACT 10:34; ; 1CO 12:25; ; JAS 2:1–2:4

Examples of fellowship

NUM 10:31–10:32 Moses and Hobab; ; 1SA 18:3 David and Jonathan; ; 2KI 10:15–10:16 Jehu and Jehonadab

Failure to exhibit true fellowship

1SA 30:22 Troublemakers in David's army are unwilling to share the spoils; ; 1CO 1:11–1:12 factions within the church at Corinth; ; 1CO 11:17–11:22 Selfishness at love feasts humiliates the poor.

7927: hymn

Poetry sung to the praise of God and for the mutual encouragement of believers. Hymns and songs are not clearly distinguished in Scripture, but the NT contains examples of possible early Christian hymns.

Hymns are sung to the praise of God's name

PSA 40:3; ROM 15:8–15:11 Because of Jesus Christ the Gentiles are now called upon to join with God's people in praising God. See also DEU 32:43; 2SA 22:50; PSA 18:49, PSA 117:1; HEB 2:12

Christians are to sing hymns together for mutual encouragement

1CO 14:26 See also EPH 5:19; COL 3:16 "Psalms" refers to the OT psalms (see Lk 20:42; 24:44; Ac 1:20; 13:33) some of which may have been set to music by Christians. "Psalm" could also describe a song newly composed for Christian worship (see 1Co 14:26 where "hymn" translates Greek "psalmos").

Examples of singing hymns**By Jesus Christ and his disciples**

MAT 26:30 parallel MRK 14:26

By Paul and Silas in prison

ACT 16:25

Examples of hymns**The Benedictus: Zechariah's song of thanksgiving at the birth of his son, John the Baptist**

See also LUK 1:68–1:79

The Magnificat: Mary's song of praise as the future mother of the Lord

LUK 1:46–1:55

The Nunc Dimittis: Simeon's response to seeing the child Jesus

LUK 2:29–2:32

Other examples of possible early Christian hymns

ROM 11:33–11:36; ; EPH 5:14; ; PHP 2:6–2:11; ; COL 1:15–1:20; ; 1TI 3:16

7930: Lord's Day, the

As well as keeping the Sabbath, the first Christians assembled together on the first day of the week to commemorate Jesus Christ's resurrection through the Lord's Supper. The Lord's Day quickly became the focal point of the Christian week, eventually assuming the characteristics of the Jewish Sabbath, namely worship and rest.

The disciples continued to observe the Sabbath

LUK 23:56 See also ACT 13:14, ACT 13:42, ACT 16:13, ACT 17:2, ACT 18:4

The Lord's Day commemorated Jesus Christ's resurrection

The resurrection took place on the first day of the week

MRK 16:9 See also MAT 28:1–28:7 parallels MRK 16:1–16:7, LUK 24:1–24:6, JHN 20:1

The disciples assembled together on the first day of the week

ACT 20:7 See also JHN 20:19–20:20, JHN 20:24–20:26

The Lord's Day took over the role of the Sabbath

1CO 16:2 See also REV 1:10

7933: Lord's Supper

The commemoration and remembrance of Jesus Christ's last supper, and all the benefits that result to believers. Other terms have been used subsequently by Christians, including "Communion" and "Eucharist".

Terms for the Lord's Supper in the NT

ACT 2:42 "breaking of bread" could mean both eating together and also celebrating the Lord's Supper; ; 1CO 10:16 The Greek word "koinonia", here translated "participation", is traditionally translated "communion": hence the term "Holy Communion"; ; 1CO 11:20 the Lord's Supper; ; 1CO 11:24 Underlying "had given thanks" is the Greek "eucharisteo", from which comes the term "Eucharist".

Jesus Christ's institution of the Lord's Supper

1CO 11:23–11:25 parallels MAT 26:26–26:28, MRK 14:22–14:24, LUK 22:17–22:20

Celebrating the Lord's Supper in the NT**As part of an ordinary meal**

1CO 11:21 The church was not necessarily wrong to include the sacrament in an ordinary meal; this should have been conducted in a charitable way.

On the Lord's day**ACT 20:7** See also JHN 20:26**The fourfold formula for breaking bread: taking, giving thanks, breaking, giving****MAT 26:26** parallels MRK 14:22, LUK 22:19 See also LUK 24:30; JHN 6:11; 1CO 11:24**The sharing of the cup****1CO 11:25** parallels MAT 26:27-26:28, MRK 14:23-14:24, LUK 22:20**Themes connected with the Lord's Supper****The Passover****1CO 5:7-5:8** See also JHN 11:50 Caiaphas' words may have an unintended Passover significance; JHN 13:1, JHN 19:14, JHN 19:33, JHN 19:36; EXO 12:46; NUM 9:12**The new covenant****1CO 11:25** parallels MAT 26:27-26:28, MRK 14:23-14:24, LUK 22:20 The reference to the (new) covenant implies a personal relationship with God and sins forgiven.**Remembrance****1CO 11:24** parallel LUK 22:19**Thanksgiving, fellowship and unity****1CO 10:16** See also MAT 26:26-26:27 parallels MRK 14:22-14:23, LUK 22:19; 1CO 11:20-11:21**The Lord's return****1CO 11:26** See also MAT 26:29 parallels MRK 14:25, LUK 22:16; 1CO 16:22; REV 22:20**Separation from sin****1CO 10:21** Paul is referring to feasts in heathen temples. See also 1CO 11:27-11:32**A foretaste of heaven****MAT 26:29** parallel MRK 14:25**7936: love feast**

The first Christians generally celebrated the Lord's Supper with the accompaniment of a meal, called the "agape" or "love feast".

OT antecedents of the love feast**The Passover meal**

See also EXO 12:3-12:11, EXO 12:15-12:16; MAT 26:17-26:18 parallels MRK 14:12-14:15, LUK 22:7-22:12; 1CO 11:23-11:25

Other festive occasions

DEU 12:7; ; NEH 8:10

The NT practice of the love feast**It was linked with the Lord's Supper****ACT 2:46** See also ACT 20:7; 1CO 11:17-11:34**The name "love feasts"****JUD 1:12** See also 2PE 2:13; JHN 13:2, JHN 13:34 It was at the Last Supper that Jesus Christ gave his new commandment to his disciples to love one another as he had loved them.**The charitable distribution of food**

ACT 6:1

Abuses of the love feast**Selfishness, indulgence and ostentation****1CO 11:20-11:22** See also 1CO 11:33-11:34**Licentiousness****2PE 2:13****Ungodly participants, especially false teachers****JUD 1:4, JUD 1:12** See also 2PE 2:1, 2PE 2:13**The heavenly love feast****Foretold by Jesus Christ****MAT 26:29** parallel MRK 14:25**The marriage supper of the Lamb****REV 19:9** See also ISA 25:6; MAT 22:2-22:14 The parable of the marriage supper indicates the prerequisites for attendance at the supper.**7939: ministry**

Service of a general, as well as a religious, nature. In its broadest sense ministry refers to service rendered to God or to people. Its more restricted sense refers to the official service of individuals, specially set aside by the church.

7940: ministry, of Jesus ChristSee [2300: Jesus Christ, ministry and work of](#)**7941: ministry, of Holy Spirit**See [3200: Holy Spirit, ministry and work of](#)**7942: ministry, nature of**

All creatures owe their Creator a ministry of service to him and to humanity. The example and teaching of Jesus Christ illustrate this.

All human beings owe a ministry of service to God

The debt owed by the creature to the Creator

ROM 1:25

The service of the nations and their rulers**PSA 148:7–148:11** See also JER 3:17; JOL 3:1–3:2; REV 15:4**Examples of the service of rulers**

EZR 1:1–1:2 Cyrus of Persia; JER 25:9, JER 27:6, JER 43:10; ROM 13:4, ROM 13:6; ; 1PE 2:13–2:14

The ministry of the people of God**In the OT****EXO 19:6** See also ISA 61:6**In the NT****1PE 2:5, 1PE 2:9** See also REV 1:6, REV 20:6 resurrected martyrs**The ministry of priests, kings and prophets in the OT****The priests**

Aaron: EXO 28:35; ; NUM 18:2; DEU 17:12; 1CH 15:2; ; JER 33:22; EZR 2:63; ; HEB 9:6, HEB 13:10

The rulers

David: 2SA 3:18; ; PSA 78:70; ; LUK 1:69; ; ACT 4:25; HAG 2:23 Zerubbabel, governor of Judah

The prophets

Moses: NUM 12:7–12:8; ; JOS 12:6; ; 2CO 3:7; ; HEB 3:5; 1SA 2:18 the young Samuel; 2KI 9:36, 2KI 10:10; 1CH 25:1; ; ISA 20:3 Isaiah; ; ISA 42:1–42:4; ; JER 7:25, JER 25:4; ; 1PE 1:12; ; REV 10:7, REV 11:18

The ministry of those specially set aside by the church

1CO 12:28; ; 1TI 3:10 Deacons; ; TIT 1:5 Elders; ; 1PE 5:2 Overseers; ; EPH 4:11

Jesus Christ fulfils the OT understanding of ministry**His ministry as servant****MAT 12:18** See also ISA 42:1; MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45; ACT 3:13, ACT 3:26, ACT 4:27, ACT 4:30**His ministry as shepherd, teacher and prophet****JHN 10:11, JHN 13:13; ACT 3:22****His ministry as priest****HEB 6:20** See also HEB 8:6**His ministry as king****JHN 18:37****NT ministry follows the pattern of Jesus Christ****In servanthood****MAT 20:26–20:28** parallels MRK 10:43–10:45, LUK 22:26–22:27 See also MAT 23:11 parallel MRK 10:43**In teaching****MAT 28:20****In shepherding****JHN 21:15–21:17****In priesthood by self-sacrifice and intercession in prayer****PHP 2:17; 1TI 2:1** See also 1PE 2:5**Jesus Christ's servants can expect the same response that he received****JHN 15:20****The ministry of angels**

Angels are both ministers to God's people and fellow-servants with them: HEB 1:7, HEB 1:14; ; REV 19:10, REV 22:9

7943: ministry, in the church

The regular ministry of officially appointed or recognised ministers is a particular instance of the duty and call of all God's people.

The responsibilities of those in recognised ministry**As shepherds****ACT 20:28** See also 1PE 5:2**As watchmen****HEB 13:17** See also ROM 16:17; PHP 3:2**As teachers****1TI 3:2** See also 2TI 2:2, 2TI 2:24**As examples****1TI 4:16** See also ACT 20:28; 1PE 5:3**What believers owe to those with recognised ministries****Respect****1TH 5:12–5:13** See also PHP 2:29; 1TI 5:17**Obedience****HEB 13:17** See also 1CO 16:15–16:16**Support****1CO 9:14** Despite Jesus Christ's command, Paul did not claim his rights in this matter, but supported himself as a tentmaker. See also LUK 10:7; GAL 6:6; 1TI 5:18; DEU 25:4**Prayer****ROM 15:30** See also EPH 6:19; PHP 1:19; 1TH 5:25; HEB 13:18**Hospitality****PHP 2:29–2:30** See also GAL 4:14

Imitation**HEB 13:7****Recognised ministers should encourage the ministries of other believers**

COL 4:17 See also ROM 12:6–12:8; 1CO 12:4–12:11 The Holy Spirit allocates gifts and enables ministries. No individual has all the gifts; ministry is shared and mutual; EPH 4:7, EPH 4:11–4:13

The motivation of ministry is mutual love

GAL 5:13 See also ROM 12:10, ROM 13:8; COL 3:12–3:14; 1TH 3:12; HEB 13:1; 1PE 1:22; 1JN 3:23

How love is expressed in mutual ministry**In humility**

EPH 4:2 See also ROM 12:10, ROM 12:16; GAL 5:26; 1PE 5:5

In patience

1TH 5:14 See also JAS 5:9

In acceptance and forbearance

ROM 15:7 See also COL 3:13

In kindness, compassion and forgiveness

EPH 4:32 See also COL 3:13; 1TH 5:15

In burden-bearing

GAL 6:2

In encouragement

1TH 5:11 See also HEB 3:13, HEB 10:24–10:25

In teaching and admonition

COL 3:16 See also ROM 15:14; EPH 5:19; 1TH 5:14

In prayer and confession of sin

JAS 5:16

In hospitality

1PE 4:9

7944: ministry, qualifications for

God, who calls his people to minister, also equips his people. The chief qualifications are a response to God's call, faithfulness, godliness and Christlikeness.

God calls people to minister**Qualification is by call, not gifting or achievement**

DEU 7:7–7:8 See also DEU 9:4–9:5

God calls those who the world regards as weak or foolish

1CO 1:27–1:29

Feelings of inadequacy to God's call are common

EXO 3:11 Moses; ; JDG 6:15 Gideon; ; 1SA 9:21 Saul; ; 1SA 18:18 David; ; 1KI 3:7 Solomon; ; ISA 6:5 Isaiah; ; JER 1:6 Jeremiah

Responding to God's call to minister**Readiness and availability**

1SA 3:10; ; ISA 6:8

Faith, rather than natural talent or moral perfection, is required

HEB 11:1–11:2 See also GEN 27:19–27:24 Jacob was a deceiver; NUM 27:12–27:14 Moses and Aaron disobeyed God. 2SA 11:4, 2SA 11:14–11:15 1KI 11:9–11:13 Solomon disobeyed God's command.

NT ministers are recognised by call rather than their achievement**The Twelve**

MAT 10:1–10:4 parallels MRK 3:14–3:19, LUK 6:12–6:16 The Twelve, including Peter and Judas, failed Jesus Christ at critical times.

Paul

ACT 9:15, ACT 26:6; ; 2CO 4:7–4:12, 2CO 12:7 Though greatly gifted, Paul was kept humble by his sense of unworthiness, difficulties and disappointments and his "thorn in the flesh"; ; 1TI 1:16

Ministry in the NT is described as service**Serving God**

ROM 1:9; ; JAS 1:1

Serving Jesus Christ

ROM 1:1; ; JUD 1:1; ; REV 1:1

Serving the gospel

EPH 3:7; ; COL 1:23

Serving the church

ROM 15:31, ROM 16:1; ; 1CO 16:15; ; 2CO 9:1; ; EPH 6:21; ; COL 1:7, COL 1:25

Ministry is described in terms of its source, content or nature**Its source**

It is of the Spirit: 2CO 3:6, 2CO 3:8; 2CO 4:1 It is from God.

Its content

ACT 6:2–6:4 the word of God; ; 2CO 5:18 reconciliation

Its nature

Apostolic: ACT 1:25; ; GAL 2:8; ROM 15:16 priestly

Various ministries are equally linked by qualifications of character

ACT 1:21 the replacement for Judas; ; ACT 6:3 the Seven; 1TI 3:2-3:7; ; TIT 1:7-1:9; 1TI 3:8-3:13 deacons; ; 1TI 6:11 Timothy

The personal qualifications for ministry

Faithfulness

1TI 6:11-6:14 Timothy; ; 2TI 4:7 Paul's claim for his own ministry; COL 1:7, COL 4:7

Godliness

ACT 8:21 Simon was not right with God.; 1TI 6:11, 1TI 6:20-6:21

Christlikeness

ACT 1:21-1:22 The replacement apostle for Judas had to have been with Jesus Christ from the beginning.

7948: mission

Specific actions that bear witness to the good news of what God has done for his people. Israel, Jesus Christ and the church all in their different ways bear witness to the saving acts of God in history. Christian mission is empowered by the Holy Spirit.

7949: mission, of Israel

God chose Israel to be his own people, and bring the good news of his salvation to the world. God's mission through Israel is fulfilled in the mission of his servant and continues through the mission of the church.

Israel as a channel of God's blessing

Blessings for all people through Abraham

GEN 18:18 See also GEN 12:2-12:3, GEN 22:18, GEN 26:4 God's promise repeated to Isaac; GEN 28:13-28:14 God's promise repeated to Jacob; ACT 3:25; GAL 3:8

Israel's call to be a nation of priests

EXO 19:5-19:6 See also ISA 61:6

God's desire to display his glory

God's glory is to fill the earth

HAB 2:14 See also NUM 14:21; PSA 72:18-72:19; ISA 6:3

God's people display his glory

ISA 60:1-60:3 See also ISA 46:13, ISA 49:3, ISA 55:5

God's people declare his glory among the nations

PSA 96:3 See also PSA 57:9, PSA 96:10, PSA 105:1-105:2 parallel 1CH 16:8-16:9; PSA 145:11-145:12

The nations will be drawn to God's people

In recognition of God's presence among his people

ZEC 8:20-8:23 See also 1KI 10:1 parallel 2CH 9:1; ISA 45:14; JER 16:19; EZK 37:27-37:28, EZK 39:7

To Jerusalem as the centre of universal worship

ISA 2:2-2:4 parallel MIC 4:1-4:3 See also ISA 11:9, ISA 25:6-25:8, ISA 27:13, ISA 56:6-56:8; ZEC 14:16

God made known through his mighty acts

God's deliverance of Israel

EXO 7:5 See also PSA 98:1-98:3, PSA 102:15-102:16; ISA 49:26; EZK 38:23

God's action on behalf of Israel

EXO 34:10 See also EXO 8:19; JOS 4:24; 1KI 8:41-8:43 parallel 2CH 6:32-6:33; PSA 67:1-67:4, PSA 126:2

God's renewal of Israel

EZK 36:23 See also EZK 20:40-20:41, EZK 28:24-28:25, EZK 38:16

Israel as a witness to other nations

God's people sent to other nations

ISA 66:19 See also 1KI 17:9; JON 1:2, JON 3:2; MAT 23:15

Examples of God's people bearing witness to him

GEN 41:16 Joseph; ; EXO 7:16-7:17 Moses and Aaron; ; 2KI 5:3 Naaman's servant girl; ; DAN 2:44-2:47 Daniel; ; DAN 3:16-3:18 Shadrach, Meshach and Abednego

Israel's failure in mission

ISA 26:18 See also EZK 36:20-36:21

The fulfilment of God's mission through Israel

The mission of God's Messiah

ISA 11:10 See also ROM 15:12; PSA 72:17 God's promise to Abraham is fulfilled through the Messianic king; GAL 3:16

The mission of God's servant

ISA 49:6 See also ISA 42:1-42:6, ISA 52:15

The mission of the church

1PE 2:9 See also ROM 15:16

7950: mission, of Jesus Christ

Jesus Christ came to reveal God, to announce the coming of God's kingdom and to redeem a fallen humanity through his death on the cross. Though he came first to the Jews, the scope of Christ's mission includes the whole human race and continues through the Spirit-empowered witness of the church.

Jesus Christ's mission originated with God

It was purposed by God

1PE 1:18–1:20 See also ACT 2:23; EPH 1:4–1:5

The Father sent the Son

GAL 4:4–4:5 See also JHN 5:37–5:38, JHN 7:29, JHN 8:42, JHN 10:36, JHN 17:8; 1JN 4:14

Jesus Christ came in willing obedience to the Father

JHN 6:38; ; PHP 2:5–2:8

Jesus Christ's mission was motivated by God's love

JHN 3:16 See also ROM 5:8; 1JN 4:10

Jesus Christ's mission was to make God known

He reveals God in his own person

JHN 1:18 See also JHN 14:9, JHN 17:26; COL 1:15; HEB 1:1–1:3

He reveals God through his teaching

JHN 18:37 See also MAT 7:28–7:29; JHN 3:11–3:13

Jesus Christ's mission was to announce God's kingdom

LUK 4:43 See also MAT 4:17; MRK 1:14–1:15; MAT 12:28 parallel LUK 11:20 Jesus Christ's miracles reveal the presence of God's kingdom.

Jesus Christ's mission was to redeem humanity

He came to seek and save the lost

LUK 19:10 See also LUK 15:1–15:10

He came to save from sin

MAT 1:21 See also ROM 3:25–3:26; 1TI 1:15

He came to break the devil's power

1JN 3:8 See also GEN 3:15; JHN 12:31; HEB 2:14–2:15

He came to bring eternal life

JHN 10:10 See also JHN 6:38–6:40, JHN 17:2–17:3

He came to give access to God

EPH 2:18, EPH 3:12; ; HEB 10:19–10:20

He came to restore a fallen humanity

ROM 5:17–5:18; ; 1CO 15:21–15:22

Jesus Christ's mission was to establish the church

MAT 16:18 See also EPH 2:17–2:19, EPH 5:25–5:27; 1PE 2:4–2:5, 1PE 2:9–2:10

The scope of Jesus Christ's mission

Jesus Christ came first to Israel

MAT 10:5–10:6, MAT 15:24; ; JHN 1:11

Jesus Christ's mission extends to all peoples

ISA 49:6; ; MAT 8:11; ; JHN 10:16; ; MAT 8:10 parallel LUK 7:9 Jesus Christ commends the faith of a Roman centurion; ; MAT 15:28 parallel MRK 7:29 Jesus Christ grants the request of a Canaanite woman; ; ACT 1:8 Jesus Christ sends his disciples out into the whole world; ; ACT 26:17–26:18 Paul's commission to go to the Gentiles is received directly from Jesus Christ.

Jesus Christ's mission made the cross necessary

MAT 20:28 parallel MRK 10:45 See also MAT 16:21 parallels MRK 8:31, LUK 9:22; LUK 12:50; COL 2:14–2:15; HEB 12:2

Jesus Christ's mission will be completed at his return

1JN 3:2 See also MAT 24:31 parallel MRK 13:27; COL 3:4; 1TH 4:16–4:17

Jesus Christ's mission continues through the church

JHN 20:21–20:22 See also MAT 28:18–28:20; JHN 15:26–15:27

7951: mission, of Holy Spirit

See [3257: Holy Spirit, gift of](#)

7952: mission, and Holy Spirit

See [3212: Holy Spirit, and mission](#)

7953: mission, of the church

The continuation of Jesus Christ's mission through his followers. Believers are empowered by the Holy Spirit and sent out by Christ to bear witness to him and to preach, heal, teach, baptise and make disciples of all peoples.

The power and authority of the church's mission

Believers are sent out by Jesus Christ

JHN 15:16 See also MAT 9:37–9:38; LUK 10:1–10:3; JHN 4:36–4:38

Believers are given authority by Jesus Christ

LUK 9:1 See also MAT 10:1, MAT 28:18; MRK 6:7, MRK 16:17–16:18; LUK 10:17–10:19

Believers continue Jesus Christ's mission

JHN 20:21 See also JHN 17:18

Believers are empowered by the Holy Spirit

ACT 1:8 See also LUK 24:49; JHN 20:22; ACT 4:31; HEB 2:4

The task of the church in mission

Making disciples

MAT 28:19–28:20 See also ACT 2:41–2:42, ACT 14:15, ACT 16:14–16:15, ACT 18:8; ROM 10:14–10:15; 1JN 1:2–1:3

Preaching and healing

LUK 9:2 See also MAT 10:7–10:8; MRK 16:20; LUK 9:6

Proclaiming the gospel

ACT 20:24 See also ACT 8:40; ROM 1:9, ROM 15:20; 2TI 1:11

Bearing witness to Jesus Christ

ACT 5:30–5:32 See also LUK 24:48; JHN 15:26–15:27; ACT 4:20

Bringing honour to God

EPH 3:10–3:11 See also JHN 15:8; 1PE 2:12

The universal scope of the church's mission

LUK 24:47 See also MAT 24:14 parallel MRK 13:10; MRK 16:15

The church reaching out in mission

To the Jews

MAT 10:5–10:6 The disciples' mission began with the Jews. See also MAT 10:9–10:15 parallels MRK 6:8–6:11, LUK 9:3–9:5, LUK 10:4–10:12; ACT 11:19 The scattered believers at first preached only to Jews.

To the Samaritans

ACT 8:4–8:8 See also ACT 8:14–8:17, ACT 8:25

To the Gentiles

Paul as the apostle to the Gentiles: ACT 9:15; ; ROM 11:13, ROM 15:16; ACT 10:34–10:35 Peter preaches to Cornelius and his family; ; ACT 11:20–11:21 Scattered believers preach to the Gentiles; ; ACT 13:1–13:3 Paul begins his first missionary journey (with Barnabas); ; ACT 15:40–15:41 Paul begins his second missionary journey (with Silas); ; ACT 16:9–16:10 Paul is called to preach the gospel in Macedonia; ; ACT 18:23 Paul's third missionary journey; ; ACT 28:31 Paul preaches the gospel in Rome.

Missions undertaken by church officials

ACT 11:22–11:23 Barnabas is sent to Antioch to strengthen the new church.; ACT 11:30, ACT 12:25; ACT 15:22–15:23 Judas and Silas are sent to Antioch with a letter from the apostles and elders.

7957: sacraments

The sacraments of baptism and the Lord's Supper were instituted by Jesus Christ as signs and seals of the covenant. They explain the basis of this covenant and apply its benefits to believers. They replace circumci-

sion and the Passover which were the sacraments of the old covenant.

The sacraments as signs of the new covenant

Baptism

MAT 28:19 Baptism is one sign of being a disciple of Jesus Christ. See also ACT 2:38, ACT 2:41

The Lord's Supper

1CO 11:23–11:25 parallels MAT 26:26–26:28, MRK 14:22–14:24, LUK 22:17–22:20 The new covenant was sealed by the blood of Jesus Christ.

The sacraments as a participation in the body of Christ

Baptism

GAL 3:27 In the NT baptism immediately follows conversion and testifies to the individual's union with Christ. See also ROM 6:3

The Lord's Supper

1CO 10:16–10:17 The "body of Christ" is a term which goes beyond Jesus Christ to the church. Those who partake of the bread in this way are declaring their membership of the church. See also MAT 26:26 parallels MRK 14:22, LUK 22:19, 1CO 11:24; JHN 6:32–6:35, JHN 6:48 Jesus Christ likens himself to bread as he is the source of spiritual life and nourishment; JHN 6:50–6:58 The believer who eats the bread of the Lord's Supper is renewing his or her dependence on Jesus Christ for spiritual life.

The sacraments as a participation in the death of Christ

Baptism

ROM 6:3–6:4 Through baptism individuals declare that they have applied to themselves the death of Jesus Christ which atones for sin. See also ACT 2:38, ACT 22:16 Baptism does not accomplish the cleansing from sin but it is the outward sign that this has taken place by faith; ROM 6:5–6:7; COL 2:12; TIT 3:5; 1PE 3:21

The Lord's Supper

1CO 11:26 In taking the emblems of Jesus Christ's broken body and shed blood individuals perpetually apply the merits of Christ's death (i.e., forgiveness of sins) to themselves. See also MAT 26:27–26:28 parallels MRK 14:23–14:24, LUK 22:20, 1CO 11:25; JHN 6:53–6:56; 1CO 10:16

The sacraments of the old covenant

Circumcision

ACT 7:8 Circumcision was the initiation rite under the old covenant. See also GEN 17:10–17:14; ROM 2:28–2:29

Circumcision was never meant as merely an outward rite. To be effective it required a right attitude of heart; ROM 4:10–4:11 Circumcision was the seal of Abraham's righteousness imputed to him by his faith; COL 2:11–2:12 Circumcision has now been superseded by baptism for the Christian as the rite of initiation.

The Passover

EXO 12:25–12:27 The Passover meal was instituted as a regular commemoration of Israel's redemption from slavery in Egypt. See also LUK 22:15–22:16 The death of Jesus Christ is closely associated with the Passover by its timing and meaning. The Lord's Supper has superseded the Passover as the corporate meal commemorating the act of redemption; 1CO 5:7

7960: singing

The musical voicing of praise to God. On account of God's majesty and great acts of salvation singing was a regular part of the life of Israel and of the early church. In Israel musicians and singers were set aside solely for this purpose.

The call to sing praise to God

PSA 33:1–33:3, PSA 96:1–96:2 See also PSA 5:11, PSA 9:11, PSA 30:4, PSA 47:6, PSA 68:4, PSA 68:32, PSA 81:1–81:2, PSA 95:1, PSA 98:1, PSA 98:4–98:5, PSA 98:8–98:9, PSA 117:1, PSA 147:7, PSA 149:1; ISA 44:23, ISA 49:13, ISA 52:9; ROM 15:11

The resolve to sing praise to God

PSA 104:33 See also PSA 7:17, PSA 9:2, PSA 13:6, PSA 57:8–57:9, PSA 59:16–59:17, PSA 89:1, PSA 101:1, PSA 147:1

Singing in response to God's deliverance from enemies and sin

ISA 35:10 See also PSA 18:47–18:49, PSA 71:22–71:24; ISA 54:1, ISA 55:12; REV 5:11–5:14, REV 15:3–15:4

God sings of his delight and love for his people ZEP 3:17

Singing in Israel

Singing accompanied major events

See also 1CH 15:27–15:28 the bringing of the ark to Jerusalem; 2CH 5:12–5:13 the dedication of the temple; 2CH 20:21–20:22 a march into battle; 2CH 23:11–23:13 a coronation; 2CH 29:27–29:28 the purification of the temple; 2CH 30:21, 2CH 35:15 NEH 12:27–12:29 the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem

Part of day-to-day worship

2CH 23:18; ; NEH 11:23

Accompanied by instruments

1CH 15:16 See also 1KI 10:12 parallel 2CH 9:11; PSA 137:1–137:4

Musicians and singers appointed to lead Israel's singing

1CH 9:33, 1CH 15:22 See also 1CH 6:31–6:32, 1CH 25:6–25:7; EZR 2:41 parallel NEH 7:44; EZR 2:65; NEH 11:22, NEH 12:46

Singing in the NT

EPH 5:19–5:20; JAS 5:13 See also MAT 26:30 parallel MRK 14:26; ACT 16:25; 1CO 14:15; COL 3:16

Singing is not always appropriate

PRO 25:20 See also ECC 7:5 **AMO 5:23** God detests the songs of Israel that are not accompanied by obedience and justice. See also ISA 24:14–24:17, ISA 25:5; EZK 26:13; AMO 6:5–6:7, AMO 8:3, AMO 8:10

7963: song

In Scripture, songs express praise, thanksgiving, joy, victory and love. They also express sadness and derision and can be used to teach and warn. In heaven believers will sing a new song to God.

Different kinds of song

Songs of praise and thanksgiving

2CH 5:13; PSA 69:30 See also NEH 12:8, NEH 12:46; PSA 28:7, PSA 95:2; JER 30:18–30:19; JON 2:9; JAS 5:13

Songs of joy and celebration

PSA 98:4 See also 2SA 6:5 parallel 1CH 13:8; 1CH 15:16; PSA 100:2, PSA 107:22, PSA 126:2, PSA 126:6; ISA 52:9, ISA 55:12

Songs of victory and deliverance

EXO 15:1–15:18 The song celebrating God's spectacular victory over Pharaoh and his army (compare with Rev 15:3). See also JDG 5:1–5:3; 1SA 18:6–18:7; 2SA 22:1–22:4; PSA 18:2, PSA 32:7, PSA 42:8, PSA 118:15; ISA 26:1, ISA 44:23, ISA 49:13

Psalms and hymns

COL 3:16 "psalms, hymns and spiritual songs" are not clearly distinguished from each other in Scripture. See also 1CH 16:7; PSA 40:3, PSA 47:7; MAT 26:30 parallel MRK 14:26; 1CO 14:26; ACT 16:25; EPH 5:19

Songs of ascent

PSA 122:0 Psalms 120–134, the so-called "Songs of Ascent", are thought to have been sung by pilgrims on their way to Jerusalem.

Songs of love

PSA 45:0 The title to this psalm describes it as "a wedding song"; ; SNG 1:1; ; ISA 5:1; ; EZK 33:32

Laments

2SA 1:17–1:19 See also 2SA 3:33–3:34; 2CH 35:25; PSA 102:1–102:2; JER 7:29, JER 9:10, JER 9:20; LAM 2:5 The book of Lamentations is a series of laments after the fall of Jerusalem; EZK 19:1, EZK 19:14, EZK 26:17–26:18, EZK 27:2, EZK 27:32, EZK 28:12, EZK 32:16; AMO 5:1

Songs of derision

JOB 30:9; ; PSA 69:12; ; LAM 3:14, LAM 3:63; ; MIC 2:4

God is described as the song of believers

PSA 118:14 See also EXO 15:2; ISA 12:2

Songs can teach and warn

DEU 32:44–32:46 See also DEU 31:19, DEU 31:22, DEU 31:30; PSA 119:54; EPH 5:19

A new song

Singing a new song to God expresses a renewed desire to praise him

PSA 40:1–40:3 See also PSA 33:3, PSA 98:1, PSA 144:9, PSA 149:1; ISA 42:10

In heaven God's people will sing a new song

REV 5:9–5:10 See also REV 14:3

7966: spiritual gifts

Although all believers have received the gift of the Holy Spirit, Scripture points to God giving individuals certain special gifts of a spiritual nature for the fulfilling of specific tasks.

7967: spiritual gifts, and responsibility

A spiritual gift may be intended to equip its recipient for a specific function or appointment. Those who are equipped in this way need the enabling power of God's spirit to carry out their appointed tasks.

OT examples of God's gifts or appointments

God appoints prophets

JER 1:5

God appoints Israel's kings

ISA 15:11 See also 2SA 7:8, 2SA 12:7

God appoints the Persian king Cyrus

ISA 45:1 See also ISA 41:2

God empowers leaders and kings with his Spirit

NUM 27:18 See also JDG 3:10, JDG 6:34, JDG 11:29, JDG 13:25, JDG 14:6, JDG 14:19, JDG 15:14; 1SA 10:6, 1SA 10:10, 1SA 11:6, 1SA 16:13–16:14

The Spirit is given to the servant of the LORD

ISA 42:1 See also ISA 61:1

Jesus Christ is endowed with the Holy Spirit

MAT 3:16–3:17 parallels MRK 1:10–1:11, LUK 3:21–3:22 See also JHN 1:32–1:33; ACT 10:38

The apostles are endowed with the Holy Spirit

ACT 1:8

Spiritual gifts given to the church

EPH 4:11 See also 1CO 12:28

Many functions within the church yet unity is preserved

EPH 4:4–4:7 See also 1CO 12:4–12:11

All Christians are appointed to build up the church

EPH 4:15–4:16 See also 1CO 12:12

The experience of spiritual gifts

Associated with the laying on of hands

2TI 1:6–1:7 See also NUM 8:10, NUM 27:18; DEU 34:9; ACT 6:6; 1TI 4:14, 1TI 5:22

Associated with prayer and fasting

ACT 14:23 See also ACT 13:3

Spiritual gifts must not to be neglected

1TI 4:14 See also LUK 19:11–19:26

7968: spiritual gifts, nature of

In both the OT and the NT God graciously pours out gifts on his people. They are to be welcomed and used for the good of all.

OT examples of God giving special gifts

God's gracious provision from above

JOL 2:23–2:24 This gracious provision of material needs from above can be seen as foreshadowing God's bestowal of spiritual gifts. See also EXO 16:4, EXO 16:8, EXO 16:13–16:14; DEU 11:14; 1KI 17:6; JOB 5:10; ISA 55:10

Distribution of land to tribes

JOS 13:6–13:7 The Hebrew word for "give" often includes the sense of "apportion" or "assign". See also EZK 47:21

The future promise of spiritual gifts

JOL 2:28–2:29 See also ACT 2:17–2:18

In his earthly ministry Jesus Christ offers supernatural gifts

MAT 11:28 See also MAT 16:19; LUK 10:19; JHN 4:14, JHN 6:51

Spiritual gifts linked with grace

ROM 12:6 See also MAT 10:8; 1CO 4:7

Specific reference to spiritual gifts

1CO 12:1 See also ROM 1:11; 1CO 14:1, 1CO 14:12, 1CO 14:37

Diverse gifts, one giver

1CO 12:4–12:6 See also ROM 12:6–12:8; 1CO 7:7, 1CO 7:17, 1CO 12:8–12:11, 1CO 12:27; EPH 4:11; HEB 2:4; 1PE 4:10–4:11

The purpose of spiritual gifts is to build up the church

1CO 14:12 See also 1CO 12:7, 1CO 14:2–14:5, 1CO 14:17–14:19, 1CO 14:26, 1CO 14:31; EPH 4:16

The body of Christ benefits from these varied gifts

1CO 12:12 See also 1CO 12:14–12:31; ROM 12:4–12:6

Encouragement to aspire to the greater spiritual gifts

1CO 12:31, 1CO 14:1

The importance of love in exercising spiritual gifts

1CO 13:1 See also ROM 12:5–12:9; 1CO 14:1

Warnings about spiritual gifts

1CO 14:39 See also 1CO 14:37; 1TH 5:19–5:20

7972: tongues, gift of

The divine enabling of a believer to use a language, unknown to the speaker. The gift of tongues may be used to praise God or to utter a message from God that, supplemented by the gift of interpretation of tongues, edifies other believers. Note that “tongues” can simply mean “other languages” at times.

Tongues is a gift of the Holy Spirit**It is given to individual believers**

ACT 2:4 See also 1CO 12:11, 1CO 12:30 it is not universal among Christians

It was foretold in the OT

1CO 14:21; ; ISA 28:11

It is a divine gift in response to faith

MRK 16:17

It may be given through the laying on of hands

ACT 19:6

It is a sign of the presence of the Holy Spirit

ACT 10:44–10:46

Tongues in relation to other gifts**The need for love**

1CO 13:1

The need for prophecy

1CO 14:4–14:6

The need for intelligibility

See also 1CO 14:9, 1CO 14:13, 1CO 14:16–14:19, 1CO 14:23

The need for interpretation

1CO 12:8–12:10, 1CO 14:12–14:13

The transience of tongues

1CO 13:8

The use of tongues within the church**In prayer and praise**

See also ROM 8:26; 1CO 14:14–14:15, 1CO 14:26, 1CO 14:28; EPH 6:18; JUD 1:20

For the benefit of believers

1CO 12:7–12:10 See also 1CO 14:5, 1CO 14:16–14:17, 1CO 14:26

In public it needs to be augmented by the gift of interpretation

1CO 14:26–14:28 See also 1CO 12:30, 1CO 14:5, 1CO 14:13